

PRoNTo Manual

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Chapter 1

Introduction

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1.1 Background

Advances in neuroimaging techniques have radically changed the way neuroscientists address questions about functional anatomy, especially in relation to behavioural and clinical disorders. Many questions about brain function, previously investigated using intracranial electrophysiological recordings in animals can now be addressed non-invasively in humans. Such studies have yielded important results in cognitive neuroscience and neuropsychology. Amongst the various neuroimaging modalities available, Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) has become widely used due to its relatively high spatial and temporal resolution, and because it is safe and non-invasive. By selecting specific MRI sequence parameters, different MR signals can be obtained from different tissue types, giving images with high contrast among organs, between normal and abnormal tissues and/or between activated and deactivated brain areas. MRI is often sub-categorized into structural MRI (MRI) and functional MRI (fMRI). Examples of other of imaging modalities that measure brain signals are Positron Emission Tomography (PET), ElectroEncephaloGraphy (EEG) recordings and MagnetoEncephaloGraphy (MEG) recordings. Neuroimaging data are inherently multivariate, since each measure (scan or recording) contains information from thousands of locations (e.g. voxels in MRI or electrodes in EEG). Considering that most brain functions are distributed processes involving a network of brain regions, it would seem desirable to use the spatially distributed information contained in the data to give a better understanding of brain functions in normal and abnormal conditions.

The typical analysis pipeline in neuroimaging is strongly rooted in a mass-univariate statistical approach, which assumes that activity in one brain region occurs independently from activity in other regions. Although this has yielded great insights over the years, specially in terms of function localization, and continues to be the tool of choice for data analysis, there is a growing recognition that the spatial dependencies among signal from different brain regions should be properly modelled. The effect of interest can be subtle and spatially distributed over the brain - a case of high-dimensional, multivariate data modelling for which conventional tools may lack sensitivity.

Therefore, there has been an increasing interest in investigating this spatially distributed information using multivariate pattern recognition approaches, often referred to as multi-voxel pattern analysis (MVPA) (see [13], [7] and [14]). Where pattern recognition has been used in neuroimaging, it has led to fundamental advances in the understanding of how the brain represents information and has been applied to many diagnostic applications. For the latter, this approach can be used to predict the status of the patient scanned (healthy vs. diseased or disease A vs. B) and can provide the discriminating pattern leading to this classification. Pattern recognition techniques can also be used to identify relationships between patterns of brain structure or activity and continuous measures such as age or a clinical score. Such information can then be used to predict individual-level measures for new individuals (i.e. regression models).

Several active areas of research in machine learning are crucially important for the difficult problem of neuroimaging data analysis: modelling of high-dimensional multivariate time series, sparsity, regularisation, dimensionality reduction, causal modelling, and ensembling to name a few. However, the application of pattern recognition approaches to the analysis of neuroimaging data is limited mainly by the lack of user-friendly and comprehensive tools available to the fundamental, cognitive, and clinical neuroscience communities. Furthermore, it is not uncommon for these methods to be used incorrectly, with the most typical case being improper separation of training and testing datasets.

1.2 Methods

PRoNTo (Pattern Recognition for Neuroimaging Toolbox) is a toolbox based on pattern recognition techniques for the analysis of neuroimaging data. Statistical pattern recognition is a field within the area of machine learning which is concerned with automatic discovery of regularities in data through the use of computer algorithms, and with the use of these regularities to take actions such as classifying the data into different categories [3]. In PRoNTo, brain images are treated as spatial patterns and statistical learning models are used to identify statistical properties of the data that can be used to discriminate between experimental conditions or groups of subjects (classification models) or to predict a continuous measure (regression models).

PRoNTo is MATLABbased and includes five main modules: ‘Data & Design’, ‘Prepare feature set’, ‘Specify model’, ‘Run model’ and ‘Compute weights’. The results can displayed in terms of the performance of the estimated model, as well as in terms of model parameters. Additional review options enable the user to review information about the data, features and models. All modules were implemented using a graphical user interface (GUI) and the MATLABBatch System. Using the MATLAB Batch System the user can run each module as batch jobs, which enables a very efficient analysis framework. All information about the data, experimental design, models and results are saved in a structure called PRT. PRoNTo also creates additional files during the analysis that are described in details in the next chapters.

The toolbox code will be distributed for free, but as copyright software under the terms of the GNU General Public License as published by the Free Software Foundation.

1.2.1 Inputs and preprocessing

In terms of neuroimaging modalities, PRoNTo accepts NIFTI files. Mostly designed to analyse structural and functional Magnetic Resonance Imaging and PET, it can be used on any dataset converted to a NIFTI file. It assumes that the neuroimaging data has been previously pre-processed using SPM (<http://www.fil.ion.ucl.ac.uk/spm/>) or a similar software for neuroimaging analysis. In general, raw fMRI data should be previously corrected for movement

artefact (realigned) and time difference in slice acquisition (slice time correction), mapped to a common template (normalized) and spatially smoothed. The normalisation and spatial smoothing steps might not be necessary for single subject analysis.

In addition the General Linear Model (GLM) can be applied as a pre-processing step for pattern recognition analysis. In this case, the GLM coefficients (e.g. beta images in SPM) will correspond to the spatial patterns. Using beta images should be preferred in the case of event-related designs with short inter-stimulus time and/or event duration to better take into account the Haemodynamic Response Function (HRF). **Important note:** Beta images output by SPM contain NaNs (Not a Number) values in some voxels. For better performance of the model, a mask should be created to exclude the corresponding voxels from the analysis. Practically, a mask should be built (e.g. using SPM `imcalc` batch or a script provided in ‘utils’) to specify which voxels have scalar values (0 and 1 in mask) or NaN. The updated mask should then be input in the Data & Design window. To ease this extra preprocessing step, a script is provided in *your PRoNTo folder/utils*. It takes as inputs the images (i.e. beta images in nifti format), the mask to update (e.g. `SPMnoeyes.nii` provided in *your PRoNTo folder/mask*) and the directory to save the updated mask. Inputs are optional, and just typing in the MATLAB command: `prt_utils_update_mask` will ask for the different inputs using file and path selectors.

In the current version of the software, regression models and regressing out effect of covariates from the data is provided only when selecting images by scans (i.e. for one image per subject). Therefore, we suggest that users interested in removing covariates from datasets with a (fMRI) design perform a GLM analysis before hand and input the derived beta images as patterns.

Raw structural MRI data should be previously mapped to a common template (normalized) and spatially smoothed. Raw PET data should be realigned, normalized and smoothed. PET data is also usually scaled. This operation can be performed before hand or during the building of the feature set.

1.2.2 Machine learning algorithms

In PRoNTo different pattern recognition algorithms correspond to different machines. The machine library in PRoNTo v2 includes four classification models: Support Vector Machine ([4], [12]), Gaussian Process Classifier (binary and multiclass, [16], [9]) and L1-Multiple Kernel Learning [15]. Four regression models are available: Kernel Ridge Regression [18], Relevance Vector Regression [19], Gaussian Process Regression [16] and L1-Multiple Kernel regression [15]. New machines will be added to the library in future versions of the toolbox.

PRoNTo should facilitate the interaction between machine learning and neuroimaging communities. On one hand the machine learning community should be able to contribute to the toolbox with novel published machine learning models. On the other hand the toolbox should provide a variety of tools for the neuroscience and clinical neuroscience communities, enabling them to ask new questions that cannot be easily investigated using existing statistical analysis tools.

1.3 Installing & launching the toolbox

In order to work properly, PRoNTo requires 2 other softwares:

- a recent version of MATLAB. We used versions 7.5 (R2007b) to 9.4 (R2018a) to develop PRoNTo, and it will not work with earlier versions¹. The statistics toolbox of MATLAB is also required. Note: Windows and Mac users may encounter compiler issues when using R2016b and R2017b. Files may need to be compiled again. Users can install the MATLAB required compiler from Add-Ons, or by manually downloading MinGW.
- SPM12[10] installed on your computer². Users are recommended to have the latest updates by typing: `spm_update` (check if there are new updates available) and `spm_update update`

¹Any later MATLAB version should work, *in theory*.

²SPM12 can be downloaded from the following website: <http://www.fil.ion.ucl.ac.uk/spm/software/>. You should install it in a suitable directory, for example `C:\SPM12\`, then make sure that this directory is on the MATLAB path. No need to include the subdirectories!

(start updating files). **Important note:** if you already have a version of SPM on your computer, please update it. Various bugs, especially in terms of weight visualization, arise from out of date SPM versions.

PRoNTTo latest public version can be downloaded, after registration, from the following address: <http://www.mlnl.cs.ucl.ac.uk/pronto/prtsoftware.html>.

1.3.1 Installation

After downloading the zipped file containing PRoNTTo, the installation proceeds as follow:

1. Uncompress the zipped file in your favourite directory, for example `C:\PRoNTTo\`;
2. Launch MATLAB;
3. Go to the “File” menu → “Set path”;
4. Click on the “Add folder” button and select the PRoNTTo folder, i.e. `C:\PRoNTTo\` if you followed the example;
5. Click on save.

Some routines, in particular the ‘machines’, are written in C++ (.cpp files) for increased efficiency. We are trying to provide these compiled routines for the usual Operating Systems (OS’s) such as: Windows XP (32 bits), Windows 7/10 (64 bits), Mac OS 10, Linux (32 and 64 bits). If your OS is not listed or routines do not work properly then you should compile the routines for your specific OS.

1.3.2 Launching and batching

Once installed, there are three ways to call up PRoNTTo functionalities. To launch the toolbox GUI, just type `prt` or `pronto` at the MATLAB prompt and the main GUI figure will pop up, see Fig. 1.1. From there on simply click on the processing step needed (see Part I of this manual). Most functions of PRoNTTo have been integrated into the `matlabbatch` batching system [5] (like SPM8) and the batching GUI is launched from the main GUI by clicking on the **Batch** button (see Part II of this manual). Of course most tools can also be called individually by calling them directly from the MATLAB prompt, or for scripting in a .m file (see Part IV of this manual).

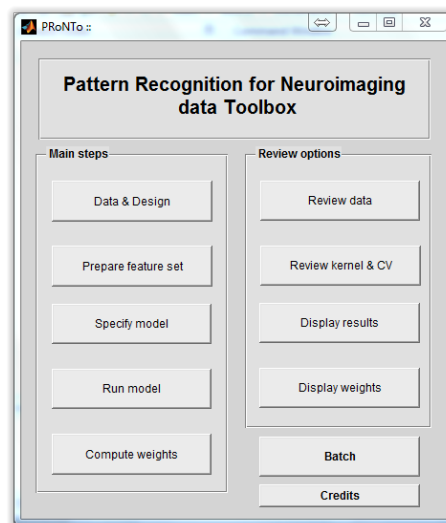


Figure 1.1: Main GUI interface: each button launches a specific processing step.

1.3.3 Troubleshooting

Compiling libsvm

Some problems when using SVMs might arise due to libsvm, in which case, you might need to compile it on your own. The first thing that needs to be done is to download the desired libsvm version (usually the latest one) from the following website: <http://www.csie.ntu.edu.tw/~cjlin/libsvm/>. Then, the process will depend on your operating system.

If the steps described below do not work, please refer to the README file that comes with libsvm.

Microsoft Windows

- Make sure you have a C++ compiler install. If not, you can install Microsoft Visual C/C++;
- Copy the libsvm folder to the 'machines' directory of your PRoNTo instalation (e.g. C:\PRoNTo\machines\);
- Open a DOS command window and change to the libsvm folder in the previous step (`cd C:\PRoNTo\machines\libsvm-3.17\`). If the environment variables of VC++ have not been set, run the following command:
C:\Program Files\Microsoft Visual Studio 10.0\VC\bin\vcvars32.bat. This command might be different, depending on the path of your Visual Studio installation;
- In the libsvm folder run the command: `nmake -f Makefile.win clean all`
- If no errors appear, open MATLAB;
- Change to the 'matlab' folder inside the libsvm folder (e.g. C:\PRoNTo\machines\libsvm-3.17\matlab\);
- Run `make` in the MATLAB Command Window. If there are no errors, you have just successfully compiled libsvm to be used with MATLAB.

Remember, if you want to use the version that you have just compiled, you have to add the libsvm folder to your path in MATLAB. If you have more than one libsvm folder inside the 'machines' folder, please remove one of them from the MATLAB path. You should only have one libsvm folder in your path.

Unix (Mac OS or Linux)

- Make sure you have a C++ compiler installed. If you are using Mac OS, please install 'Xcode'. On Linux systems, you should already have 'gcc' installed;
- Copy the libsvm folder to the 'machines' directory of your PRoNTo instalation (e.g. /home/<username>/PRoNTo/machines/);
- Open a terminal window and change to the 'machines' directory: `cd PRoNTo/machines/`
- Compile libsvm by running the following command: `make`
- If no errors appear, open MATLAB;
- Change to the 'matlab' folder inside the libsvm folder (e.g. PRoNTo/machines/libsvm-3.17/matlab/);
- Run `make` in the MATLAB Command Window. If there are no errors, you have just successfully compiled libsvm to be used with MATLAB.

Remember, if you want to use the version that you have just compiled, you have to add the libsvm folder to your path in MATLAB. If you have more than one libsvm folder inside the 'machines' folder, please remove one of them from the MATLAB path. You should only have one libsvm folder in your path.

1.4 What's new?

1.4.1 Version 2.1

This version of the toolbox is released mainly to provide a bug-fixed version of v2.0. One new functionality is added: removing confounds at the subject level. A detailed description of this functionality can be found at http://www.cs.ucl.ac.uk/fileadmin/UCL-CS/research/Research_Notes/RN_17_09_ARJMM.pdf.

Below is a list of selected bug fixes that might affect your use of the software or previously obtained results:

- **HRF delay and overlap:** In the Data&Design module users can define parameters to approximate the HRF shape (namely HRF delay and overlap). In earlier versions, the values could only be entered once and applied to all modalities. This has now been fixed to allow different values for different modalities, in the batch and in the GUI.
- **Freeze the Review Data window:** In relation to the HRF delay and overlap bug fix, the Review data is now 'on wait' until closed. This means that no operation (in PRoNTo or in Matlab) can be done until the window is closed. This ensures that values input in the Data review GUI are passed to the main Data and Design window.
- **ROC and AUC:** There was a bug in how we computed the area under the curve (AUC) and plotted the receiver operating characteristic (ROC) curve that we have now fixed. This means that different AUC values and ROC plots might be observed, if comparing previously obtained results in older versions and in v2.1. We hence recommend re-computing AUC and re-plotting ROC if needed.
- **k-fold CV:** Before v2.1, when using k-fold cross validation (CV) and the number of samples is not divisible by k, we re-allocated the remainder to the last fold by default. For example, a 4 fold CV with 43 samples would lead to 4 folds of size 10,10,10 and 13 respectively. In v2.1, the remainder is evenly re-allocated to each fold, starting from the first. The above example would then lead to folds of size 11, 11, 11 and 10. This change affects all k-fold CV scheme and should then be taken into consideration if comparing results from older versions with results from v2.1.

1.4.2 Version 2.0

This version of the toolbox (2015) aims at providing multiple new functionalities, including:

- **Build one kernel per modality:** When there are multiple modalities in the same dataset, it is now possible to build one kernel per modality and use them in the same model later on. If this option is not chosen, the selected modalities can still be concatenated as additional samples/examples or sessions (if they have the same dimensions) or used separately.
- **Build one kernel per region:** It is also possible to specify an atlas, comprising regions of interest (ROIs) as defined by values in the atlas ranging from 1 to *number of ROIs*. For each anatomically defined ROI, a kernel will be built taking into account the multivariate pattern within the region. It is possible to use this feature in combination with the previous one (e.g. one kernel per region and per modality, or concatenate modalities as additional samples and build one kernel per region).
- **New machines:** The list of available machines was extended, and now includes L1-Multiple Kernel Learning (MKL, classification and regression). The latter corresponds to a hierarchical model defined by weights at two levels: the voxel level and the kernel level (i.e. ROI and/or modality).
- **Flexible cross-validation:** A GUI is provided to manually specify a custom cross-validation matrix. It allows to either specify a basis (e.g. leave-one-subject-out), load a .mat or specify the number of folds. Then the user can, for each fold, select which examples are part of the training set, test set, or won't be used. The resulting matrix can be saved for further use.

- **Nested cross-validation for hyperparameter optimization:** It is now possible to optimize the hyperparameter(s) of some machines (e.g. the soft-margin parameter, C , in SVM) using a nested cross-validation (CV) framework. The number of folds in the nested cross-validation, used only to estimate the value of the hyperparameter leading to the highest performance, does not need to be the same as the ‘outer’ cross-validation (i.e. the one estimating the final model performance). For example, to decrease computational expenses, the nested CV can be a 4-fold CV while the outer CV can be a leave-one-out.
- **Display results:** The display of the results was divided into two modules (Display Results and Display Weights). This allows to review the model performance in one window, with all the statistics. A new graph displaying the effect of the hyperparameter (if optimized) was also included.
- **Weights per ROI:** For each model it is possible to build images representing the weights per voxel and also images summarising the weights per regions of interest as defined by an atlas. If an MKL model was built on ROIs, the contribution of each ROI (regional weight) is explicitly derived. On the other hand, if a simple kernel model was selected (e.g. SVM on the whole brain), the weights per voxel will be averaged (in absolute value) within each region, as defined by an atlas specified by the user. In both cases, an additional image, with weights per ROI, is created and saved.
- **Display weights:** The weights of each model can be displayed at the voxel level in this window. If weights per ROI were derived (either summarized or from an MKL on ROIs), weights per region can be displayed as an image, as well as in a sorted list of regions. The same applies for MKL models on multiple modalities. A histogram is also displayed representing the contribution/weight of each ROI/modality to the model. The table can be exported as text for future use in publications/communications.

1.4.3 Version 1.1

In 2012, PRoNTTo v1.1 was released mainly to provide bug fixes for version v1.0. Two features were also added:

- automatic compiling of the machines (in particular: no more issues with SVM, nor with Matlab toolboxes and paths).
- k-folds Cross-Validation (CV): specify the number of folds or set it to 1 for half-half CV (train on first half, test on second).

1.4.4 Version 1.0

Launched in 2011, this version of PRoNTTo allows to perform all the analysis steps, from Data & Design to computing the weights for three classification machines (SVM, binary and multi-class GP) and two regression machines (KRR, SVR).

1.5 How to cite

Please cite:

- Schrouff J, Rosa MJ, Rondina JM, Marquand AF, Chu C, Ashburner J, Phillips C, Richiardi J, Mourao-Miranda J. PRoNTTo: Pattern Recognition for Neuroimaging Toolbox. *Neuroinformatics*, 2013, 11(3), 319-337.

when using PRoNTTo analyses in any type of publication. In addition, Multiple Kernel Learning analyses should refer to a second paper:

- Schrouff J, Monteiro, JM, Portugal L, Rosa MJ, Phillips C, Mourao-Miranda J. Embedding Anatomical or Functional Knowledge in Whole-Brain Multiple Kernel Learning Models. *Neuroinformatics*, 2018, 16(1), 117-143.

And

- Schrouff J, Cremers J, Garraux G, Baldassarre L, Mourao-Miranda J, Phillips C. Localizing and Comparing Weight Maps Generated from Linear Kernel Machine Learning Models. International Workshop on Pattern Recognition in Neuroimaging (PRNI), 2013, 124-127, DOI: 10.1109/PRNI.2013.40.

for a posteriori weight summarization using atlas-defined regions of interest.

1.6 Main contributors

PRoNTTo is developed by the Machine Learning & Neuroimaging Laboratory, Computer Science department, University College London, UK (<http://www.mlnl.cs.ucl.ac.uk>) and associated researchers.

The main contributors, in alphabetical order, are:

- Dr. John Ashburner** is a Professor of Imaging Science at the Wellcome Trust Centre for Neuroimaging at the University College London Institute of Neurology. He is mainly interested in modelling brain anatomy from MR scans, and more recently in applying pattern recognition methods to make predictions about individual subjects. He is a co-developer of the SPM software (intra- and inter-subject registration, tissue classification, visualization and image file formats), which is used internationally by thousands of neuroimaging researchers. He has a Web of Science h-index of 63. He did not contribute any actual code to PRoNTTo, but he did attend many of the meetings;
- Dr. Carlton Chu** is a research scientist at Google DeepMind. Before joining DeepMind, he was a research fellow in brain imaging at the National Institute of Mental Health (NIMH), NIH. He received the B.Eng. degree (1st class Honours) from Auckland University, in 2002 and the master of Biomedical Engineering from University of New South Wales, in 2004. Carlton obtained a PhD in Neuroimaging method from University College London in 2009, working in the statistical methods group at the Wellcome Trust Centre for Neuroimaging, creators of the famous “SPM” program. There he developed innovative pattern recognition methods to automatically detect the early stages of neurodegenerative diseases such as Alzheimer’s and Huntington’s from structural brain images. In 2007, Carlton won the first prize in the 2nd Pittsburgh Brain Activity Interpretation Competition (PBAIC), a prestigious international competition involving the application of machine learning to the problem of classification of brain activity. He led a small research team to victory, acclaim from peers in the field, and the \$10K first prize. His current research interests include image segmentation using convolutional neural networks and applications of deep-learning. Carlton was involved in the development of PRoNTTo version 1.0;
- Dr. Andre Marquand** is a Principal Investigator and an assistant professor at the Donders Institute for Brain Cognition and Behaviour. His research focuses on the application of probabilistic machine learning techniques to neuroimaging data, particularly for clinical applications. His recent work includes the development of multi-class, multi-task and multi-modality pattern classification methods that offer many advantages over current techniques including more sensitive and specific detection of disease effects. He did his PhD in Clinical Neuroscience, King’s College London, UK;
- Dr. Janaina Mourao-Miranda** is a Wellcome Trust Senior Research Fellow at the Centre for Computational Statistics and Machine Learning (CSML), UCL. Over the past years her research has involved developing and applying pattern recognition methods to analyze neuroimaging data, in particular brain activation and structural patterns that distinguish between controls and patients. Her current research focuses on developing machine-learning models to investigate complex relationships between neuroimaging data and multidimensional descriptions of mental health disorders. She has been coordinating the PRoNTTo developments and contributed to PRoNTTo versions 1.0, 1.1 and 2.0;

- Dr. Joao M. Monteiro** is a former MPhil/PhD Student at University College London under the supervision of Prof. John Shawe-Taylor and Dr. Janaina Mourao-Miranda. His research focused on the application of unsupervised machine learning methods to neuroimaging. He contributed to PRoNTo versions 1.1, 2.0 and 2.1;
- Dr. Christophe Phillips** is FRS-FNRS Research Associate at the Cyclotron Research Centre and adjunct Assistant Professor at the Department of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, University of Liège, Belgium. His research focuses on the processing of multi-modal neuroimaging data. Recent work within the field of “brain decoding” aimed at distinguishing between levels of consciousness in unresponsive patients or between typical and atypical Parkinson Disease patients using Positron Emission Tomography (PET) imaging, as well as tracking mnesic traces in trained healthy subjects with fMRI;
- Dr. Anil Rao** was a post-doctoral researcher in Centre for Medical Image Computing (CMIC) and Max Planck University College London Centre for Computational Psychiatry and Ageing Research at the University College London. He contributed to version 2.1, especially to the removing confounds functionality.
- Dr. Jonas Richiardi** is currently Clinical Research Lead in the Department of Radiology, Lausanne University Hospital, with a joint affiliation to Siemens Healthcare Switzerland’s Advanced Clinical Imaging Technology group. He was previously a Marie Curie Fellow with a project on ‘Modelling and Inference on brain Networks for Diagnosis’, jointly affiliated to the FINDlab at Stanford University and LabNIC at the University of Geneva. His research interests include the combination of imaging modalities with other biological information sources including genomic data, learning with graphs, machine learning for neuroimaging, brain connectivity / resting-state data analysis, interpretability of brain decoding results, and functional biomarkers. Jonas contributed to PRoNTo versions 1.0 and 1.1;
- Dr. Jane Rondina** is a research fellow at the University College London Institute of Neurology. Previously, she was a post-doctoral research associate at the Centre for Neuroimaging Sciences, King’s College London. In the past years, her research has involved application of pattern recognition methods to neuroimaging data and development of a stability-based method for feature selection and mapping in neuroimaging. Her current research focuses on prognosis and prediction of treatment response, mainly addressing approaches to combine complementary information from different imaging modalities and other sources of data (clinical, demographic and genetic). She contributed to the development of PRoNTo version 1.0 and 2.0;
- Dr. Maria J. Rosa** is an Advanced Support Engineer at MathWorks. Before joining Mathworks, she was an imaging scientist at IXICO, plc. Before, she was a Post-Doctoral Research Fellow at the Institute of Psychiatry, King’s College London (KCL) and a Wellcome Trust post doctoral research associate at the Centre for Computational Statistics and Machine Learning (CSML), UCL. Maria’s main area of work is the development and application of machine learning and multivariate methods to neuroimaging data. She did her PhD at the Wellcome Trust Centre for Neuroimaging, UCL. She contributed to PRoNTo versions 1.0, 1.1, 2.0 and materials for v3.0;
- Dr. Jessica Schrouff** got her PhD from the University of Liège, under the supervision of Dr. C. Phillips. She was a post-doctoral researcher at the Laboratory of Behavioral and Cognitive Neuroscience, Stanford University before obtaining a Marie Curie fellowship with Stanford and University College London. Her research focuses on the detection and characterization of memory traces in resting state wakefulness using machine learning techniques, based on fMRI data (Ph.D. thesis) and intracranial EEG recordings. She contributed to PRoNTo versions 1.0, 1.1, 2.0 and 2.1. She has also started adapting the toolbox for analysis of electrophysiological recordings (version 3.0);
- Dr. Tong Wu** got her PhD from the University of Queensland in Australia, under supervision of Dr. Tianzi Jiang, Dr. David Reutens and Dr. Simone Bosshard. She is a post-doctoral researcher in Centre for Medical Image Computing (CMIC) at University College London.

Her research focus during PhD was resting-state mouse fMRI in both wild type mice and a schizophrenia mouse model. She contributed to PRoNTo version 2.1 and is involved in version 3.0.

We also thank students and post-docs for their help in testing the software and writing this manual: Fabio Ferreira, Dr Agoston Mihalik, Rafael Ramos, Dr. Juan E. Arco, Dr. Liana Lima Portugal, Liane Canas, Dr. Ana Regia Neves, Rochelle Silva, Dr. Orlando Fernandes Junior and Dr. Qinquan Gao.

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Part I

Description of P_{Ro}NTo tools

Chapter 2

Data & Design

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2.1 Introduction

The first step in a statistical analysis of neuroimaging data, whether it's in a pattern recognition or general linear model (GLM) framework, usually entails providing to the analysis software all the information regarding the data and experimental design. PRoNTTo is no exception. After preprocessing the data (if required), the analysis in PRoNTTo starts with the 'Data and Design' module. It is important to note that PRoNTTo does not perform any spatial or temporal preprocessing, and if not performed with another software, pattern recognition might be affected by misalignment and noise in the data.

In the 'Data and design' module the user can enter the image/scan files, experimental conditions (TR, durations and onsets of events), as well as other parameters, covariates and regression values. PRoNTTo supports multi-modality datasets and therefore it allows the user to enter more than one data modality, such fMRI, MRI, PET and ASL, per analysis. This module is therefore essential for the rest of the framework and stores all the information that is needed from the data to be used by the rest of the software modules, such as feature set preparation, model specification and estimation.

Below is a summary of what the 'Data and Design' module does. The Methods section discusses how the module is organised and what its main output is. It also mentions a few issues that need to be taken into consideration when entering the information and how they affect subsequent steps. This chapter then presents the graphical user interface (GUI) that is used to enter the data and design information and how it is used. Finally, the chapter finishes by

mentioning the corresponding ‘Data and Design’ `matlabbatch` module, and particular issues that do not apply to the GUI.

2.2 Methods

2.2.1 Data and design input

PRoNTo provides two types of interfaces for entering the data and design information, a PRoNTo-specific graphical user interface (GUI) and the `matlabbatch` system that is also currently used by SPM. These two interfaces are also available for the other modules, as discussed in the Introduction chapter.

The information that needs to be entered is almost exactly the same for both the GUI and batch (the small differences are explained below in the `matlabbatch` section) and, more importantly, the output is exactly the same. Therefore it is up to the user to decide which system is best suited for his/her analyses. For instance, the GUI can be used as a first approach to the toolbox and by users not familiar with SPM, whilst the batch can be used by more advanced or SPM users, who know how to take advantage of the batch system to optimise their analyses.

As mentioned, PRoNTo supports multi-modality analyses. Therefore the data and design module is prepared to receive as input the following types of data: fMRI, sMRI, PET and beta images (created from a previous GLM analysis). Other types of data can also be entered at the user’s risk, as long as they comprise nifti files.

Regardless of which interface the user chooses to enter the data and design (GUI or batch), the organisation is very similar and starts (after choosing the directory to save `PRT.mat`) with the definition of Groups. In neuroimaging datasets, it is common to have a few subjects with a lot of images/scans per subject, such as the time-series in fMRI. However, the opposite is also common: lots of subjects with one image per subject, such as encountered in PET or MRI studies. Therefore, for each group, PRoNTo provides two ways of entering the rest of the information, i.e. subjects, modalities and design, which are referred to as the ‘select by subject’ or ‘select by scans’ option, respectively (as is shown below). If one chooses to enter the data by ‘scans’, PRoNTo allows the user to enter, for each modality, all subjects (one image/scan per subject) at once, which is a lot quicker than entering each subject at a time. It is important to note that when using *Regression* models this is the only way of inputting the data. As explained below, only the ‘select by scans’ option allows the users to enter regression values (one value per subject/image). This option however is not appropriate for modalities which have an experimental design and more than one image per subject, such as fMRI or multiple beta images. For these datasets the user should choose the ‘subjects’ option. For each subject one can specify the modalities, experimental conditions and enter more than one image/scan. Both options are valid and produce exactly the same output structure (if used with the same dataset).

2.2.2 Data and design output

The output of the ‘Data and Design’ module is the PRT structure (as discussed in the Introduction). This structure contains subfields with all the information that is needed from the data for the subsequent analysis steps and is saved in a ‘PRT.mat’ file. For advanced users the fields of this structure can be edited directly and saved, therefore bypassing the need to use the GUI or `matlabbatch` to create the PRT. However, this structure is the core of PRoNTo and should be carefully created because it affects everything else.

2.2.3 Review

The ‘Data and Design’ module also allows the user to review the information that has been entered (through the GUI, batch or manually). The main aim of the ‘Review’ function is to check if the data and design has been correctly specified. It can also be used to inspect if the design is appropriate for subsequent analysis. For example, the review window shows the number of subjects in each group, and for modalities with experimental design, it can be used to show and alter the number of used and unused scans (see below).

2.2.4 HRF correction

For datasets such as fMRI, there is a very important issue that needs to be carefully addressed when specifying the data and design. As is well known, the hemodynamic response function (HRF) is a delayed and dispersed version of the underlying neuronal response to an experimental event (Figure 2.1). This means that, depending on the TR, the effect of the HRF can be felt over multiple scans, and therefore the acquired scans are not independent and might contain information from both past and present events. This can confound subsequent analyses and needs to be accounted for. For instance, in SPM, the stimulus time-series are convolved with a canonical HRF. Although convenient in the GLM framework, the convolution approach is not appropriate in the pattern recognition context. Therefore, the solution used in PRoNTTo is to discard all overlapping scans. This is done as follows: PRoNTTo allows the user to control a delay (time it takes for the hemodynamic response to peak after the stimulus) and overlap (width of the response) parameter that determine the shape of the HRF. As can be seen in Figure 2.1, the delay means that the scans corresponding to a given condition are actually shifted in time, and the overlap means that the number of independent scans, for which the signal corresponds only to a given condition, is smaller than the total number of acquired scans for each condition. Given the delay, PRoNTTo finds which scans correspond to each condition and discards the last scans in the time-series for which the response has not yet peaked. It then uses the overlap to determine which consecutive scans contain information from only one condition (i.e. the response does not overlap with the response from the previous condition) and discards the ones for which there is overlap (as shown in Figure 2.1, bottom right). The discarded scans are not actually deleted but are not used in further analyses.

When using the GUI, the default value for the HRF parameters is 0 seconds and can only be changed in the ‘Review’ window (as shown below). Therefore, for fMRI, the user should review the data and design and change these parameters to a more appropriate value (e.g. 6 seconds each). In the `matlabbatch`, the default value for these parameters is also 0 seconds but can be changed directly within the batch (no need to open Review window). Again, for fMRI, these values should be changed (e.g. to 6 seconds).

Importantly, if one wants to avoid discarding scans and having to correct for the shape of the HRF, as explained in the above paragraph, one should use as input the beta (coefficients) images obtained by first running a GLM analysis on the original data. The GLM analysis accounts for the HRF delay and overlap using the convolution approach. This is normally the best approach in case of rapid event-related design experiments, in which there can be a lot of overlap, i.e. the number of discarded scans can be very high.

The steps to specify the information relative to the data and design using both the GUI and the `matlabbatch` system are described in the following sections.

2.2.5 Covariates

When providing one image per subject for multiple subjects, the user can introduce ‘Covariates’, i.e. one or more variables that covary with the data (subjects) but of no interest to the subsequent analyses. This option is functional in version 2.1 of PRoNTTo. It requires the input of a matrix, with one row per image/subject. Before entering covariates in PRoNTTo, we recommend users to firstly check that their covariates do not correlate with the targets as this could lead to biases (positive or negative) in the obtained results [11]. In addition, if users have categorical covariates, such as genders, scanner centres, handedness et al., we recommend one-hot encoding before constructing the covariate matrix. One-hot encoding represents each value of a variable (for example ‘center1’, ‘center2’) as a boolean ‘True/False’ variable. The obtained variables are then concatenated. This process ensures that all values of the categorical variable are treated with the same importance. This wouldn’t be the case if mapping the categorical values to integers, e.g. ‘center1’ to 1 and ‘center2’ to 2. In this last example, we’d assume that ‘center2’ is *bigger* than ‘center1’ although there is no reason to encode an ordinal relationship between ‘center1’ and ‘center2’. Here is an example code to perform one-hot encoding for an illustration covariate variable ‘cov’ for 12 samples/images and 4 possible values:

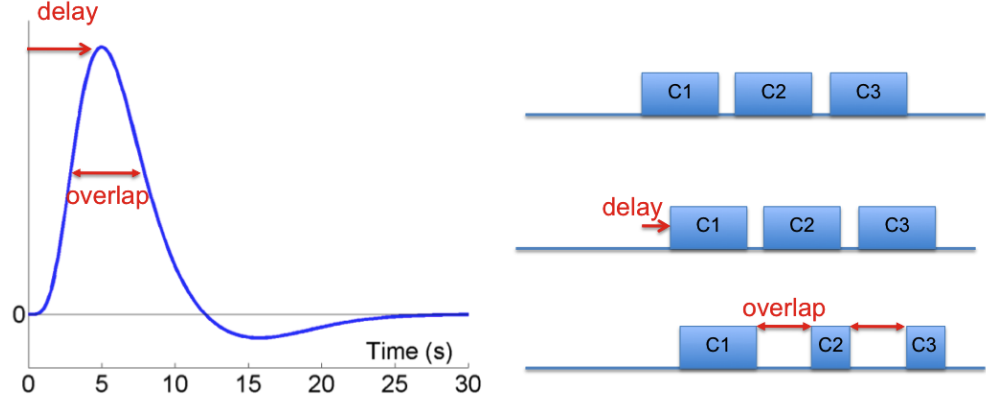


Figure 2.1: HRF correction. On the left is the standard HRF response. On the right is the effect of the delay and overlap on the number of independent scans (C1, C2 and C3 correspond to three different experimental conditions and the blue boxes correspond to various scans acquired during each condition). In fMRI datasets, the nature of the HRF (i.e. being a delayed and dispersed version of the neuronal response to an experimental event) might lead to less independent scans/events than the ones originally acquired. In PRoNTTo, this issue is accounted for by discarding overlapping scans.

```
cov = [4 8 1 5 4 8 1 5 1 5 4 8];
vals = unique(cov);
newcovs = zeros(length(cov),length(vals));
for i = 1:length(vals)
    newcovs(:,i) = cov== vals(i);
end
```

If multiple categorical variables need to be encoded, this process should be repeated and all obtained matrices concatenated to obtain a $\#samples/images \times \#variables$ matrix. Please note: a variant of this scheme ignores the last value as it is implicitly encoded by $[0, \dots, 0]$. In the case of removing confounds, this is however not appropriate.

Important note on covariates: Regressing out covariates is still a matter of debate [11] and should be considered with care. The removal of confounds is a linear regression and wouldn't account for more complex relationships between confounds and variables of interest or between multiple confounds (e.g. all older patients recorded at one site). Balanced and careful experimental designs should be preferred.

2.3 Graphical User interface

The graphical user interface to specify the data and design is presented in Figure 2.2. This GUI can be launched by typing 'prt' in the Matlab window and then clicking the first button on the left, in the main steps panel.

2.3.1 PRT directory

The first thing the user should specify is the directory in which to save the PRT structure. This can be done by browsing existing directories (previously created by the user) from the top of the data and design interface (Figure 2.2). It is recommended to have different directories for different datasets (note that a dataset can include different modalities in case of multimodal analysis) because PRoNTTo overwrites an existing PRT in the selected directory. The later modules in PRoNTTo will then add more fields to this structure with further information, such as the models, features and kernels used in subsequent analyses. The file created is called 'PRT.mat'.

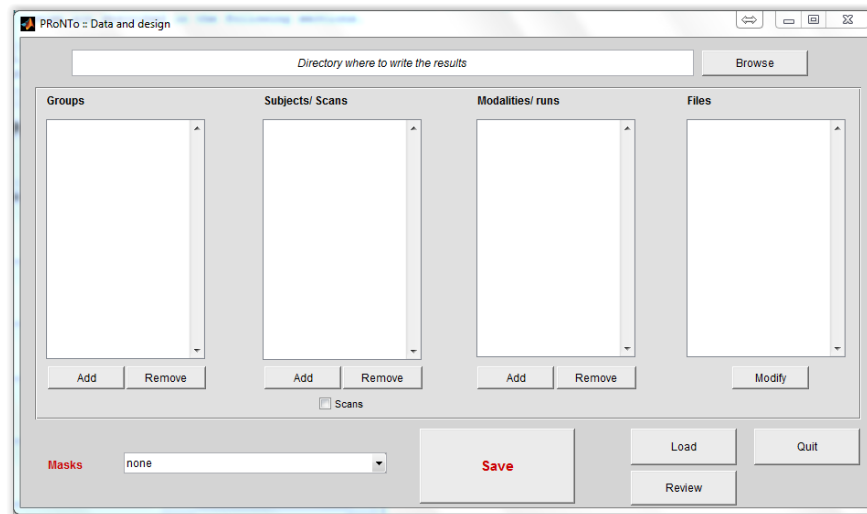


Figure 2.2: Data and design graphical user interface. This interface allows the user to enter all the information relative to the data, including the experimental design and masks. After introducing all the fields, PRoNTTo creates the PRT structure, which is saved in the specified directory, as ‘PRT.mat’ file.

2.3.2 Groups

The group panel allows one to add or remove a group of subjects. The minimum number of groups is one, but there is no maximum number. When ‘Add’ is clicked, the user should provide a name to the group. Any alphanumeric string is sufficient and there should be no spaces in the string (this applies to all names throughout the toolbox). The name of the group can be later modified by right clicking on the name. When ‘Remove’ is clicked, all the information relative to this group (including all subjects and corresponding data) is deleted. PRoNTTo does not restore the deleted information and it can only be re-entered again by clicking ‘Add’.

The following panel after ‘Groups’ is ‘Subjects/Scans’. Here, as mentioned above, there are two ways of entering the data: by ‘subjects’ or by ‘scans’. The former is chosen by clicking ‘Add’ under the ‘Subjects/Scans’ panel and filling in the fields for each added subject at a time. The latter is done by clicking the tick box ‘Scans’ under the ‘Subjects/Scans’ panel. The subjects panel is then de-activated and the user can enter the modalities and files straight away. The fields to be filled under these two options are described below.

2.3.3 Subjects

Select by scans The ‘select by scans’ option allows the users to skip the subject step. To identify that this option has been selected, PRoNTTo writes ‘scans’ in the subjects panel (Figure 2.3). The user can then add modalities and for each modality a new window will appear (bottom of Figure 2.3).

It is important to remember that when the ‘scans’ box is clicked all the information in the subjects panel is automatically deleted. Unselecting the ‘scans’ box also deletes all the information!

Select by subjects The ‘Subjects/Scans’ panel allows the user to add/remove subjects. This panel works exactly like the groups panel, but the subject name is automatically generated. This name can be later modified by right clicking on it. For each subject one can then specify the modalities in the next panel.

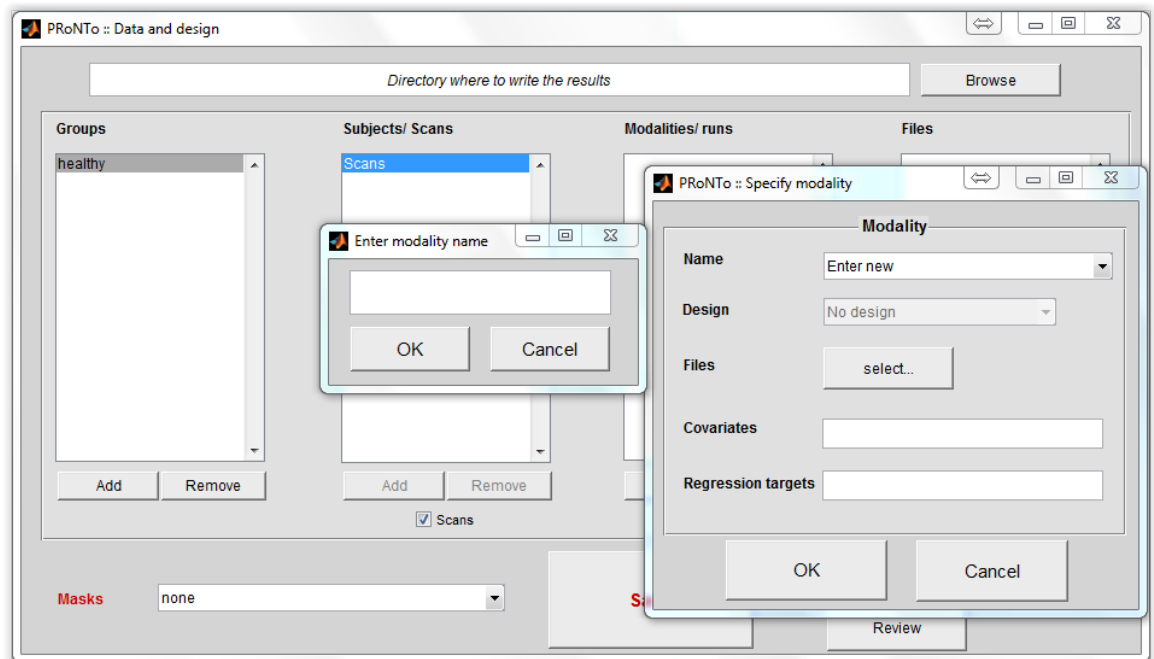


Figure 2.3: Data and design graphical user interface. If one chooses to specify everything using the ‘Scans’ option (tick box below the ‘Subjects/Scans’ panel), one can introduce the data for all subjects at once for each modality, but one cannot specify any design. This is the optimal approach when one has a lot of subjects with only one image/scan per subject, such can be the case of MRI and PET datasets.

2.3.4 Modalities

The modalities panel works like the group and subjects panel, but allows one to add and remove modalities. When a modality is added, a name needs to be provided (unless the modality has already been defined for a previous subject or through the masks menu, see below). It is important to note that a different modality can be a different type of data, such as fMRI and PET, or a different session of the same type of data, e.g. different runs/sessions of the same fMRI experiment. This way the different sessions can be integrated later into the same model and analysis.

The steps to enter the modality information are slightly different if one ticks the ‘scans’ box or not.

Select by scans Here the data is assumed to have been acquired without an experimental design, and therefore the ‘No design’ option is automatically selected and cannot be changed (bottom window in Figure 2.3).

When selecting by scans, the user can introduce ‘Covariates’, i.e. one or more variables that covary with the data (subjects) but of no interest to the subsequent analyses. This option is functional in version 2.1 of PRoNTTo. It requires the input of a matrix, with one row per image/subject. This matrix can either be entered as a Matlab command in the editable box, or as the full path to a .mat containing the matrix (variable named ‘R’). This last option is recommended to input a matrix (i.e. more than one covariate). The order of covariates should match the order the imaging files are selected. Please see 2.2.5 for important considerations on covariates.

The last empty field can be used to enter ‘Regression targets’ (Figure 2.3). This option allows the users to introduce a real number per subject to be used later for regression if that is the case. A file can also be selected, with all regression target values stored in a variable called ‘rt_subj’ and of size $\#images \times 1$. As mentioned above, this is the only way of entering the data and

regression values when doing *Regression* models.

If users want to modify covariates and/or targets, simply right-click on the modality name to amend. In v2.1, we only display the entered value when reviewing single subjects while ‘Entered’ is displayed to indicate that values have been filled (Figure 2.4).

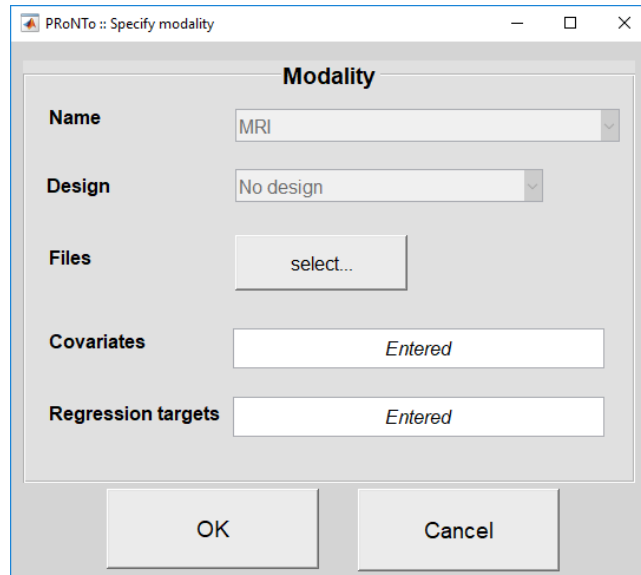


Figure 2.4: When modifying a previously specified modality/run, input covariates and regression targets will appear as ‘Entered’. Actual values are displayed when reviewing single subjects (i.e. after saving and reloading the PRT).

Select by subjects When entering the data by subjects, the modality window allows one to specify the experimental design (Figure 2.3). Here there are three options. The last option is simply ‘No design’, which means that for this modality there are no experimental conditions (this option is normally used when there is only one image per subject e.g. structural MRI or beta images from GLM analysis). The first option is to load an SPM.mat with a previously specified design. This option can be chosen if the user has created an SPM structure containing all the experimental fields using the SPM software. In this case, the user does not need to specify anything else, only the files (scans/images) for this subject/modality. The design information is extracted directly from the SPM structure and saved in PRT.mat. Finally, the ‘Specify design’ option allows one to introduce all the conditions (durations and onsets), TR and other parameters corresponding to the experimental paradigm used for this subject and modality (this option is normally used with time series data, e.g. fMRI). After the design of the first subject has been specified, a new option will appear in the menu that allows to ‘Replicate design of subject 1’, for the same modality and group. This facilitates design specification for groups of subjects with controlled (i.e. non-random) event onset and duration.

Design To create a new design one selects the option ‘Specify design’ as explained in the previous paragraph (Figure 2.3). This will then open another window (after choosing how many conditions you have) (Figure 2.5). In this window one can then write the names, onsets, and durations of each condition. The units in which this information is read is specified below. There are two options ‘Scans’ or ‘Seconds’. If the unit scans is selected, it is good to bear in mind that PRoNTTo follows the convention, adopted in SPM, that the first scan is scan 0. In the durations field, one can introduce as many values as the number of onsets or just simply one value, which assumes the events all have the same duration. In this window there is also the option of introducing the Interscan Interval (TR), which is always read in seconds.

One issue to have in mind when specifying the design is the following: if there are more scans than experimental events, these extra scans will not be used in later analyses. They are not

deleted and the corresponding indexes can be found in the PRT structure:
PRT.group(g).subject(s).modality(m).design.conds(c).discardedscans.

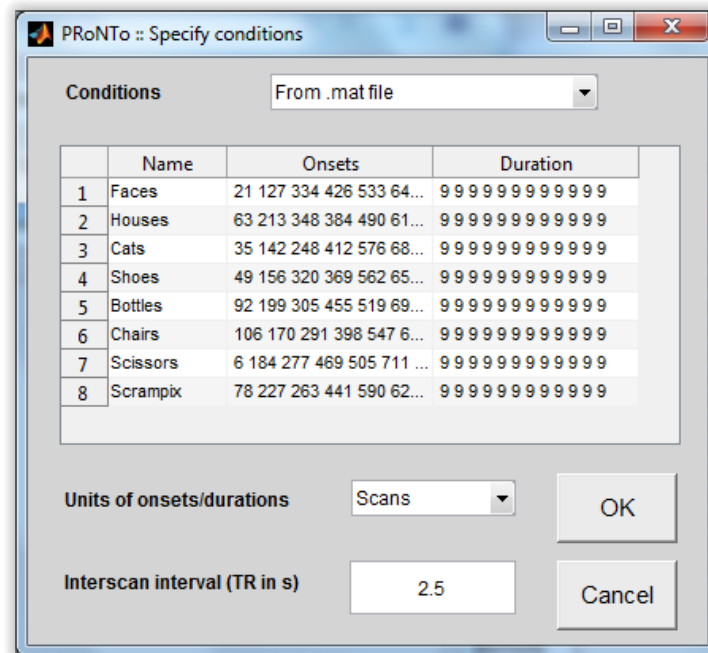


Figure 2.5: Data and design graphical user interface. The ‘specify conditions’ window is available from the modality interface when the user chooses to enter the data by subjects and clicks ‘specify design’. This window is used to enter the conditions (names, onsets and durations) as well as the units of design, TR and covariates.

Modify design The user can later modify a design by loading a PRT.mat in the Data and Design window. Please note that if feature sets or models have been previously computed, they will be discarded if changes are performed to the dataset. If the user wants to keep those, he/she should change the directory before saving any modification to the design.

After loading a previously saved PRT, any change can be performed: subjects, groups or files can be added or removed. If the design needs to be modified, a right-click (ctrl+left-click in Mac) on the name of the concerned modality proposes to re-open the modality definition window. To review or modify the onsets/durations/blocks, the user can access their definition via the ‘specify design option’. Similar right-clicks (ctrl+left-click in Mac) allow renaming groups or subjects.

To modify the HRF parameters (delay or overlap), there is no need to load the PRT in Data and Design. Loading it within the Data Review allows the user to keep all previously computed feature sets and models. However, if the HRF parameters are changed, feature sets have to be computed anew since they do not correspond to the modified design. Changing the desired parameter (e.g. replacing ‘0’ by ‘6’) and hitting the ‘return’ key updates the PRT directly in terms of scans selected for modelling. Please remember to keep an eye on the Matlab window, since important information are displayed on the workspace!

Files Finally, independent of the way the user entered the information (by subjects or scans) the ‘Files’ option allows one to choose which image files to use (Figure 2.6). This will open another window that shows all image files available in each directory. These can be selected one by one or all at once, by using the mouse’s right button on the right panel of the window (or shift key).

All that is needed for each group, subject and modality has been specified and can now be viewed on the main window (Figure 2.7) under each panel. The last panel shows which files have been entered for each modality and can be modified directly (click Modify). When Modify is

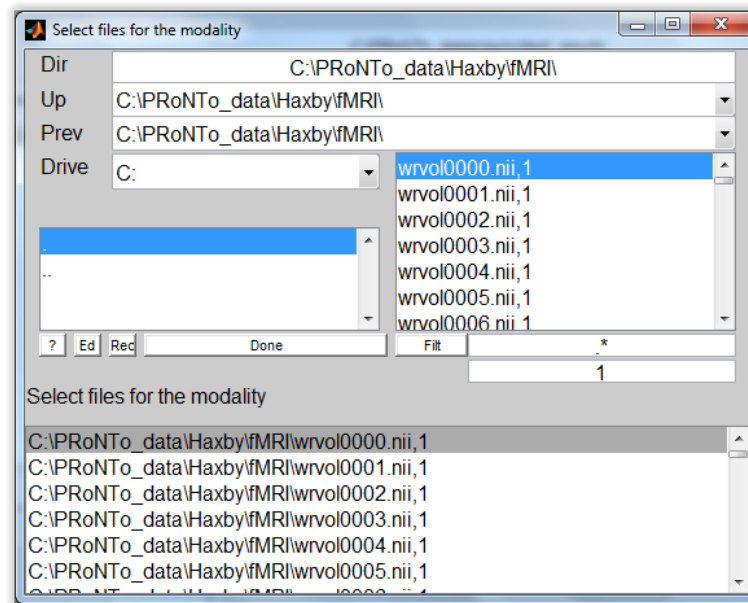


Figure 2.6: This window is called when one clicks ‘Files’ and is used to select the scans/images for each subject/modality.

clicked and no files are then selected all the previous files are deleted! Figure 2.7 shows how the data and design interface should look like once all the fields have been specified (using select by subject). The design and files for each modality can also be modified by right clicking on the modality name in the modality panel. This option can be useful to visualise the design (onsets and durations) that has been previously entered and change it if necessary. For instance, one can check the design of the first subject and if changes are needed these can then be replicated for all other subjects as explained above.

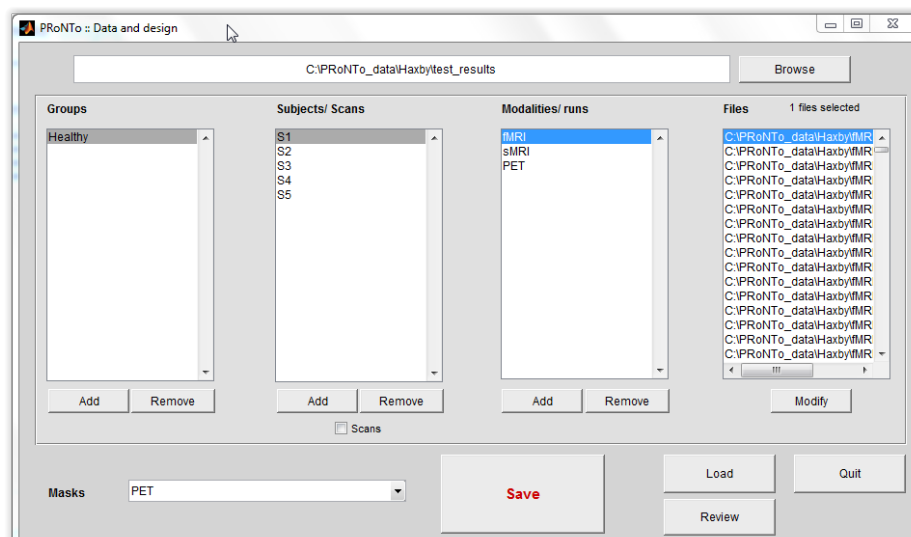


Figure 2.7: Data and design graphical user interface. After filling in all the fields using the select by subject option (the select by scans case is very similar) the data and design interface should look like this example figure.

2.3.5 Masks

This popdown menu on the bottom of the main data and design window is where the user enters a binary image mask for each modality. This mask can be previously created by the user or simply chosen from a list of default masks available in the masks directory of PRoNTTo. Every modality has to have a mask, which can be the same for all modalities. This is a first-level mask and is used simply to optimise the prepare feature set step by discarding all uninteresting features, such as voxels outside the brain. Later in the analysis one can choose another mask (second-level mask) that is more relevant to the scientific question and that can, for example, restrict the analysis to certain areas of the brain. To specify the mask one needs only to select the modality and then enter an image file. If the modalities have not yet been created, then one can create the modalities here, which will then appear in the modality panel.

Important note: If the first-level mask overlaps with areas that do not have values (NaN) in the specified images, those areas will still be taken into account for further analysis. This might affect the results if those areas are not the same across images (typically, performance will be lower). We therefore advise the user to check the overlap between the first-level mask and his/her data. This issue would typically arise when using beta images estimated from a SPM GLM analysis. We provide a script to update the mask automatically (see [1](#), Inputs and preprocessing).

2.3.6 Review

The ‘Review’ button allows one to review the data and design for each modality (Figure [2.8](#)). On the top right is the information relative to the number of groups and modalities that have been entered. The plot on the left displays the number of subjects per group. This is particularly important to check if the design is too imbalanced in terms of subjects. Then on the bottom right panel is the design information for each modality (if the selected modalities have an experimental design). Here, the user can view the number of conditions and can also edit the parameters that control the HRF delay and overlap (as explained above). The user can change the default value of 0 seconds and the effect is immediately seen on the number of scans plotted on the left (number of selected scans and number of discarded scans for each condition). The higher the value of the HRF peak and overlap, the higher the number of discarded scans. One can also read on the main Matlab window information regarding which group/subjects have had some scans discarded. The information below the HRF parameters corresponds to the interval between successive scans before and after the HRF delay/overlap correction. These values also change according to the changes entered in the boxes above. Please note, as mentioned in the section ‘Modify design’, that information regarding the PRT being updated after changing the HRF parameters is written on the main Matlab window. In v2.1, this window is frozen, waiting for users’ inputs. Hence other modules won’t continue until this window is closed. This means that users who prefer to use the Batch to execute multiple modules together and choose Review in Data&Design need to close this window first to let the following modules run.

Again, if you have previously computed feature sets and models, you have to recompute them because they do not correspond to the data anymore (changing the HRF delay and overlap parameters changes the data).

The information regarding which scans have been removed or not from the analysis can be found in the PRT structure:

```
PRT.group(g).subject(s).modality(m).design.conds(c).hrfdiscardedscans.
```

2.3.7 Load, Save and Quit

The ‘Save’ button allows the user to create the `PRT.mat` file with the PRT structure containing all the information that has been specified here (Figure [2.7](#)). Incomplete information cannot be saved. At least one group should have all the required fields so that `PRT.mat` can be created. ‘Load’ allows the user to load the data and design information from a previously saved `PRT.mat`. The user can then edit the fields and update PRT by clicking again the ‘Save’ button. It’s very important to click ‘Save’ because all the other steps in the analysis rely on the PRT structure. Without this structure one cannot proceed. However, when the `PRT.mat` contains fields that have

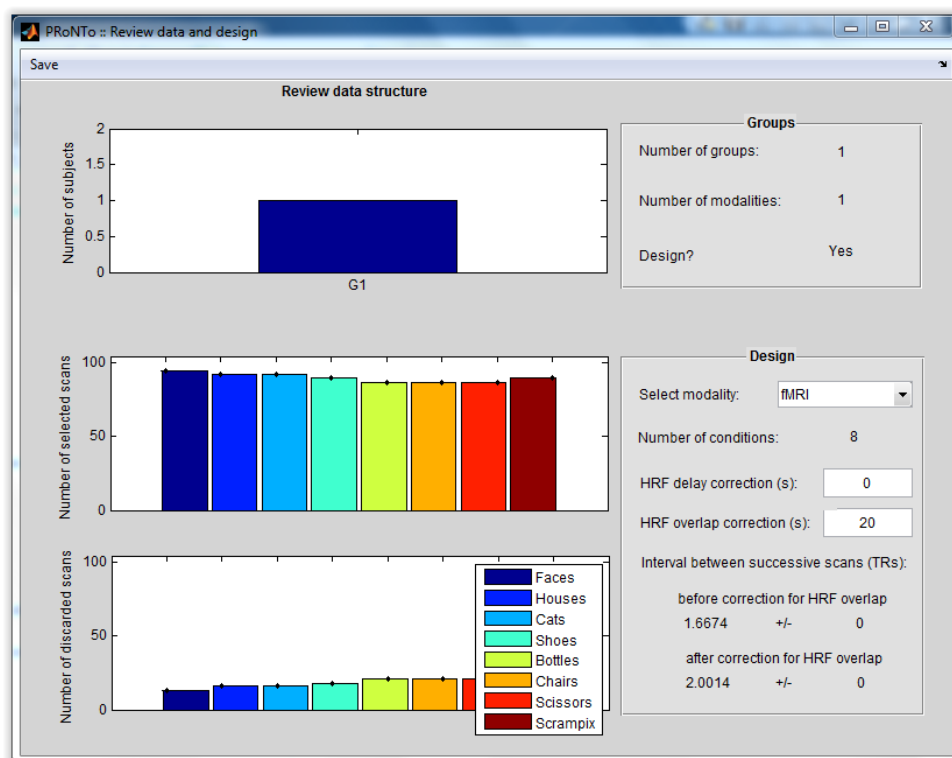


Figure 2.8: Data and design graphical user interface - ‘Review’ window. This window allows the user to check the data and design, including the number of subjects per group. It also allows the user to change the HRF delay and overlap parameters that control the number of discarded scans (appropriate only for modalities such as fMRI). When there is no experimental design only the top plot and information is shown.

been added by the ‘Prepare feature set’ or other modules, if the Save button is clicked, these fields will be deleted. The option ‘Quit’ allows the user to leave the interface without saving the information. This is also the case when the user closes the window without first using the Save button.

2.4 matlabbatch interface

The ‘Data and Design’ module in the `matlabbatch` is called either by first typing ‘prt’ and clicking the ‘Batch’ button or by typing ‘prt_batch’. The user can then find on top of the batch a PRoNTTo menu and under this menu the first module corresponds to the data and design module.

The options presented in the ‘Data and Design’ GUI, mentioned above, are all available in the `matlabbatch` interface (Figure 2.9). However, there are a few things in the batch that differ from the GUI. One issue to note here is that, when using the batch one needs to be very careful with the names of the modalities specified for each subject (or using select by scans) and specified for each mask. The number of modalities should be exactly the same for each group and subject and the names should be consistent between groups/subjects and correspond to the names of the modalities under the masks field. In the GUI the names are made automatically consistent. The names of the conditions should also be the same across subjects and will be later used to define classes in the ‘Specify model’ batch module.

Another issue is the HRF delay and overlap correction values. In the batch, the user can directly alter these values (instead of having to use the ‘Review’ window) but the default is 0 seconds and should be changed (e.g. to 6 seconds) for modalities that depend on the HRF, such as fMRI. In earlier versions, HRF delay and overlap values couldn’t be changed separately for

each modality. In v2.1, we have corrected this.

As mentioned in the Introduction, the batch job can be saved as a .mat, and loaded again whenever needed, or as a .m that can be edited using the Matlab editor. This is a powerful tool that can make the specification of the data and design a lot easier and quicker, for example by editing and scripting existing batch files (for further information see the `matlabbatch` chapter below).

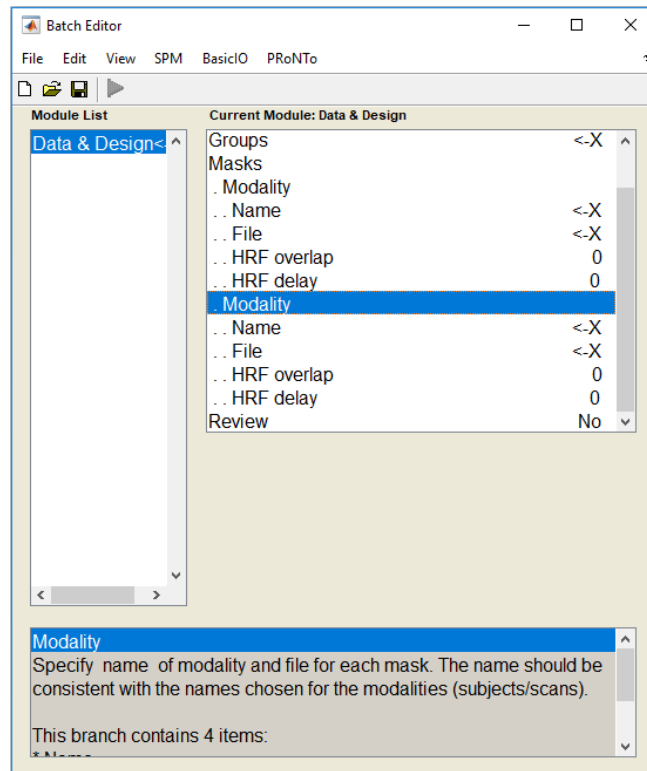


Figure 2.9: Data and design module in `matlabbatch`. The `matlabbatch` contains two extra options relative to the Data and Design interface. These options allow one to specify the delay and overlap of the HRF response (in the GUI it can only be changed in the ‘Review’ window) separately for different modalities, and which are then used to determine the number of discarded scans.

Chapter 3

Prepare feature set

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3.1 Introduction

One of the main inputs of a machine learning algorithm consists in a $N_{samples} \times N_{features}$ data matrix, containing the values of selected features for each sample. This matrix can either be input directly into the machine or be used to compute a “similarity matrix”, or kernel, of size $N_{samples} \times N_{samples}$, which is then input into the classification/regression algorithm [see “kernel trick” [8, 1]]. PRoNTto computes a linear kernel (i.e. dot product) between the samples. The ‘Prepare Feature Set’ step computes both the feature and linear kernel matrices from one or more modalities, as defined in the previously built dataset (see chapter 2). It allows detrending the features in the case of time series (such as fMRI) and scaling each image by a constant factor (input by the user) in the case of quantitative modalities (such as PET). Masks can be specified to perform the classification/regression on specific voxels only (e.g. Regions of Interest).

Multiple runs entered as different modalities (e.g. modality 1 is ‘fMRI_run1’, modality 2 is ‘fMRI_run2’,...) can be concatenated in terms of samples during this step. The images from different runs should then have the same number of features (i.e. selected voxels). In addition, version 2.0 allows to build multiple kernels, either from multiple modalities, or based on different anatomically labelled regions as defined by an atlas. In the case of multiple modalities, it is required that the selected modalities have the same number of samples, i.e. images.

3.2 Methods and resources

After the selection of the dataset and of which modality to include in the feature set (further referred to as FS), the toolbox accesses each image, i.e. it gets the value of the voxels which are comprised in the first level mask selected for that modality (mask specified at the data and design step, see chapter ‘Data and Design’). This access is performed by ‘blocks’ of features, not to overload the RAM memory. In the case of time-series, the user can specify detrending methods and parameters to apply to the time course of each feature. Methods comprise a polynomial detrending (parameter: order of the polynomial) or a Discrete Cosine Transform high-pass filter (SPM, parameter: frequency cutoff in seconds). An example of a linear detrending (polynomial detrending of order 1) is shown in Fig. 3.1.

For each modality, the (detrended) features are then written in a file array (SPM, with a ‘.dat’ extension), on the hard drive (in the same directory as the dataset). Please note that in the case of large datasets, this operation may require many Gb of free space on the hard drive

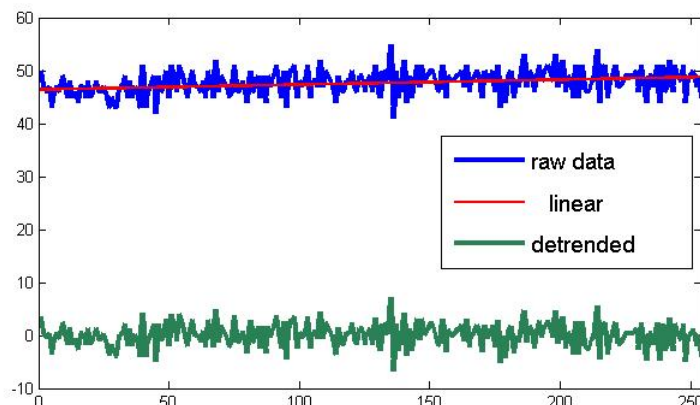


Figure 3.1: Example of detrending: the original signal over time of one feature (in blue) was approximated by a polynomial of order 1 (red line), which was then subtracted from the original signal to give the detrended signal (in green).

and long computational times. Therefore, if the first condition can't be fulfilled, we recommend the use of external drives for the whole analysis. Regarding the computational expenses, we tried to minimize their effect by computing the features only once per modality: when preparing other feature sets using the same modality and detrending parameters, the built file array will be accessed for the next steps.

Be careful that using the same modality but different detrending methods and/or parameters will force the re-computation of the file array for the considered modality. In the same way, changing the dataset (`PRT.mat`) from directory might lead to the re-computation of the feature sets if the file arrays were not moved accordingly.

From the feature set(s), a linear kernel can then be computed. Different options can be specified:

- All scans/ All conds: In 'all scans' the kernel matrix will be computed between all scans within the time series of all subjects and in 'all conds' the kernel matrix is computed only between the scans corresponding to the specified conditions of interest (see 'Data and Design'). By default, the toolbox will use all scans to compute the kernel. With large datasets however, computational expenses can be reduced by selecting the last option.
- Scaling: allows the specification of constant values to scale each scan. The user has to enter a `.mat` containing a variable called 'scaling' and of the same size as the number of scans in that modality. In case of quantitative modalities such as PET, this step is required since it insures the convergence of the machine learning algorithm.
- Additional mask for selected modality: this option allows the specification of a 'second-level' mask, which would for example define Regions of Interest (ROIs) on which the classification/regression can be performed. In this case, the voxels used to compute the kernel (and only the kernel) would be the ones contained in both the first and second-level masks. Therefore, using one first-level mask and two second-level masks would create two kernels but only one file array.
- Build one kernel per region: starting from version v2.0, PRoNTo allows to build one kernel per region as defined by an anatomically defined atlas, specified by the user¹. One atlas (Anatomical Automatic Labelling, AAL) is provided in *your PRoNTo folder/atlas*. Atlases can be generated easily through SPM, or manually by the user. There are no constraints on how regions are built, as long as all the voxels within each region have a specific integer

¹The atlas corresponds to a mask, except that the value of the voxels in each defined area correspond to a unique value, e.g. all voxels in fusiform have the value 3, and all voxels in orbito-frontal have the value 50.

value. The toolbox will identify the different regions based on the values in the voxels. Each region will then act as a second-level mask and one kernel will be built for each region. The kernels are all saved in a same feature set and will then all be used at the modelling stage.

These options are performed at the kernel level only. This means that any change in one of these options would lead to the computation of a new kernel but not to the (re)computation of the file arrays. The use of different second-level masks or scaling parameters can therefore be easily envisaged.

ProNTo version 2.0 allows to build multiple kernels. These kernels can be derived from multiple modalities or from multiple regions of interest as defined by an atlas within each modality. These two options are not mutually exclusive and it is also possible to build multiple kernels within each modality and then combine those modalities as multiple kernels. The number of kernels would hence become *number of modalities* $\times$ *number of regions*. In the same way, it is possible to concatenate multiple runs of an experiment while building one kernel per region.

The `PRT.mat` structure saves all information linked to the file arrays in a `fas` field (standing for “File Array Structure”), which size corresponds to the number of selected modality in all feature sets. The selected options and the link to the kernel (saved on the disk as a `.mat`) are stored in a `fs` field (standing for “Feature Set”), which size corresponds to the number of feature sets defined by the user.

3.3 Graphical User interfaces

After clicking on the “Prepare Feature Set” button in the main interface (see Fig. 3.2), a second window will appear (Fig. 3.3), allowing the user to select a saved `PRT.mat`, to name the FS and to define the number of modalities which should be included in the FS.

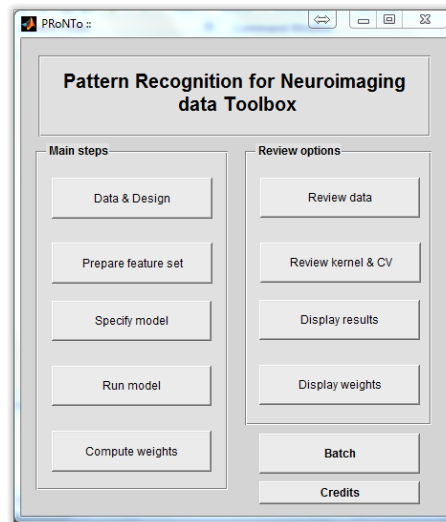


Figure 3.2: Main interface: button to launch the ‘Prepare Feature Set’ step.

To define the number of modalities to include, the user should click in the appropriate edit box, type the number and then ‘return’. This will launch a third window (Fig. 3.4), allowing the specification of the different options and parameters for each modality. When the dataset contains only one modality, this window is launched directly and (Fig. 3.3) is filled automatically expect for the feature set name.

In this third window, the user has to choose which modality to include based on its name (first pull-down menu) and which scans to use to build the kernel (all or only those linked to the design). All other options are facultative. The first panel refers to operations to perform on the features:

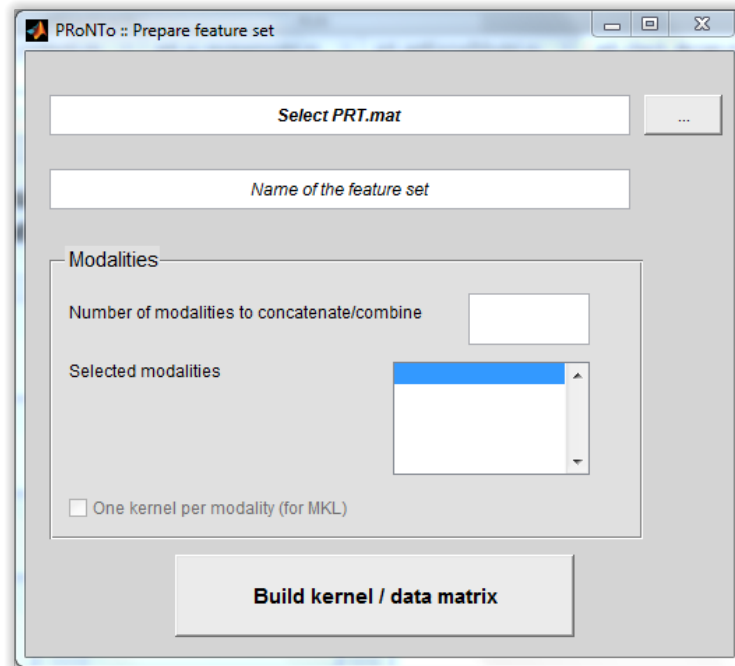


Figure 3.3: Interface of the ‘Prepare Feature Set’ step. Top: Dataset selection: type the full name (with path) or browse to select the dataset to prepare. Feature set name: Type the FS name, which will be used to save the kernel as a .mat on the hard drive. Modalities: Number of modalities to select with the list containing the names of the modalities included in the FS (no user interaction possible). A checkbox allows to build one kernel per modality if multiple modalities are present/have been selected in the FS. Build kernel/data matrix: builds the feature set and kernel(s).

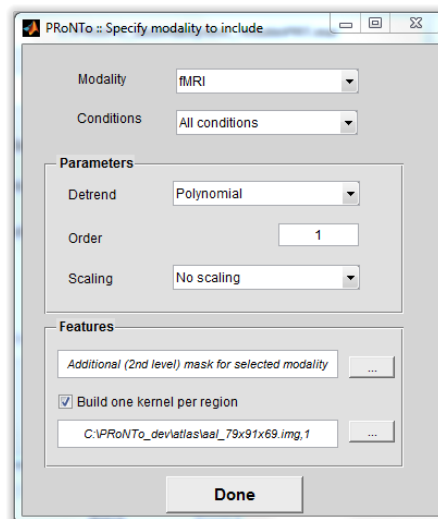


Figure 3.4: Specification of options and parameters for each modality. Modality: Select the modality name from a pull-down menu. Conditions: choose to build All scans or All conditions. Parameters: Detrend to perform with its parameter, as well as Scaling of the scans or not. Features: Selection of a second-level mask and/or of an atlas to build one kernel per region.

- the detrending parameters: by default, the parameter is set to ‘No detrending’. However,

we recommend to perform a detrending in the case of time series data such as fMRI (and only in that case). When selecting polynomial, the ‘order’ parameter will appear, with a default value of 1. Changing this value will increase the order of the polynomial used to fit the data. If ‘Discrete Cosine Transform’ is selected, the editable parameter corresponds to the cutoff frequency (in seconds) of the high-pass filter. Please note that, when including more than one run (‘modality’) into a feature set, nothing will prevent the user from using different detrending methods/parameters. We however highly recommend to use a consistent detrending in the same FS.

- the scaling: ‘no scaling’ is the default option. However, when dealing with quantitative modalities such as PET, the user should provide one value per scan, stored in a vector in a .mat file under the variable name ‘scaling’.

As previously mentioned, the detrending is performed before the features are saved in the file array, while the scaling is performed only when building the kernel.

The second panel allows to select a subset of the saved features to build the kernel. Two options are available:

- the specification of a second-level mask: type the full name (with path) of the mask or browse to select the mask image. When left empty or untouched, voxels are selected from the first-level mask specified in the data and design step. Otherwise, voxels within both the first and second-level masks will be selected to build the kernel.
- the building of one kernel per region: when selecting this option, the user should load an atlas which defines regions in terms of their anatomy (in MNI space). Each region will then act as a second-level mask and one kernel will be built for each region.

When working with Graphical User Interfaces (GUIs), some messages might appear in MATLABworkspace. These can display information about the operations currently performed or explain why the toolbox does not do as the user expected (e.g. when a file could not be loaded or if information was input in a wrong format). Therefore we strongly encourage the user to have a look at MATLABprompt when using GUIs.

3.4 matlabbatch interface

The `matlabbatch` system allows the input/selection of all parameters and options aforementioned. Just note that the batch is based on the names of the modalities and/or conditions. Therefore, for the batch to work properly, names should be consistent across all steps, starting from data and design to the model specification and running. The hierarchy for the case of a feature set containing one fMRI modality is displayed in (Fig. 3.5). For this feature set, we chose to load an atlas, and build multiple kernels based on the regions it defines.

Important note: Defining all important steps in one batch and running that batch will overwrite the `PRT.mat` previously created and thus delete the links between the `PRT.mat` and the computed kernel(s) and feature set(s). The file arrays would then be recomputed each time the batch is launched. For large datasets, we therefore recommend splitting the batch in two parts: a data and design and prepare feature set part and a second part comprising the model specification, run model and compute weights modules. This would indeed allow changing, e.g. model parameters, without recomputing the feature sets and kernels.

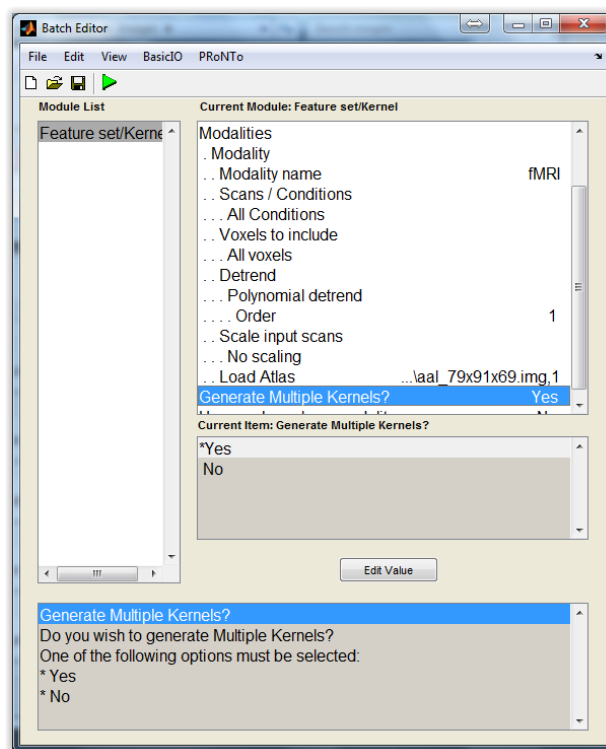


Figure 3.5: matlabbatch GUI for feature set building.

Chapter 4

Model Specification and Estimation

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4.1 Introduction

The specification of a model is the core step of the pattern recognition pipeline and entails setting up the combination of the different components making up the analysis. For example, model specification is where you select which data features to use as input (i.e. a feature set), the type of prediction to perform (e.g. classification or regression), which machine learning algorithm to employ (e.g. Support Vector Machines, Gaussian processes, ...), which cross-validation strategy to employ (e.g. leave one subject out, leave one run out, ...) and which operations or manipulations to apply to the kernel before the algorithm is trained. The framework provided by PRoNTTo is highly flexible and supports most types of pattern recognition analysis typically performed in neuroimaging. This chapter provides an overview of each of the components making up a model in PRoNTTo. The presentation will focus on the user interface although it is important to note that the batch system provides several advanced options not available in the user interface (described further).

4.2 Beginning a model specification

To begin a model specification with the PRoNTTo user interface, select ‘Specify model’ from the main PRoNTTo window. This will launch the model specification window (Figure 4.1)

Next, select the `PRT.mat` containing your experimental parameters. Note that at least one feature set must be defined in this structure before a model can be created. See chapter 3 for details on constructing feature sets.

Enter a unique name to identify the model, which is used internally in PRoNTTo, by the batch system and for display purposes. It is a good idea to select a meaningful but short name (without

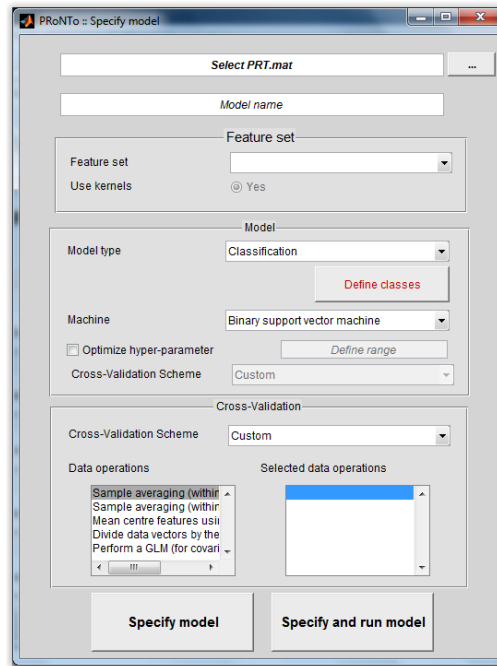


Figure 4.1: Model specification graphical user interface

spaces). **Note:** the `PRT.mat` data structure retains a permanent record of all models created but if a model with the specified name already exists in the `PRT.mat` data structure, it will be automatically overwritten.

4.3 Feature set

The drop-down list entitled ‘Feature set’ will be populated once a `PRT.mat` containing one or more feature sets is selected. Select the appropriate feature set from the drop-down list. Note that a single feature set may contain more than one data modality (see chapter 3), which can be combined to build multimodal classification and regression models (e.g. L1-Multiple Kernel Learning models). This might also be useful if more than one run/session is available for each subject, in which case each run could be input as an independent modality in the data and design step and a single-subject classifier might be specified using leave-one-run-out cross-validation.

In the current release of PRoNTTo, only kernel machines are supported via the user interface. The capability to support non-kernel techniques will be added in a future release. Thus, the ‘Use kernel’ radio button should always be set to true.

4.4 Model type / pattern recognition algorithm

In this part of the model specification input form, select the pattern recognition algorithm to employ (referred to in PRoNTTo as a ‘machine’). In the current release, three classification algorithms are supported (binary support vector machines, Gaussian processes (binary and multiclass) and L1-Multiple Kernel Learning) and four multivariate regression methods (Gaussian process regression, kernel ridge regression¹, relevance vector regression and L1-Multiple Kernel Learning).

Note: if a feature set contains multiple kernels (either from regions of interest or based on different modalities) but the selected classification/regression technique is a single kernel method (e.g. SVM or KRR), the kernels will first be summed before entering the classification/regression

¹Kernel ridge regression is equivalent to a *maximum a posteriori* approach to Gaussian process regression with fixed prior variance and no explicit noise term

phase. This corresponds to concatenating the features before building the kernel. For regions of interest in a single modality, the summed kernel is hence equivalent to a whole brain model.

The PRoNTTo user interface provides a mechanism for flexible definition of which components of the data design should be used for each classification or regression model. Note that this will not necessarily be the whole experiment; for example, in a complex fMRI experiment there may be several groups, each containing multiple subjects, each in turn having multiple experimental conditions (e.g. corresponding to different subprocesses of a cognitive task). In such cases, it is usually desirable to ask several different questions using the data, such as discriminating between groups for a given experimental condition (“between group comparison”), discriminating between experimental conditions for a fixed group (‘between-task comparison’) or training independent pattern recognition models for different subsets of subjects. All of these can be easily defined via the user interface by clicking the ‘Define classes’ button (for classification) or ‘Select subjects/scan’ (for regression).

4.4.1 Classification

The class selection panel is displayed in figure 4.2. First, define the number of classes, noting that some classification algorithms (e.g. support vector machines) are limited to binary classification, while other classification algorithms (e.g. Gaussian processes) support more than two classes. Enter a name for each class - again, it is a good idea to make these names informative but short. Notice that immediately after the number of classes has been specified, the group-, subject- and condition selection panels are greyed out. To enable them, simply select one of the classes from the drop-down menu.

For each class, select the subjects and conditions (if any) that collectively define that class. It is possible to select multiple experimental conditions in the same class, but this complicates model interpretability and potentially also model performance (since by definition conditions are not identically distributed). If a condition or subject is erroneously selected, click on it in the ‘selected subject(s)’ or ‘selected condition(s)’ panel and it will be removed from the list. The performance of classification models is evaluated based on measures such as total accuracy, class accuracies and positive predictive values (representing the sensitivity and specificity).

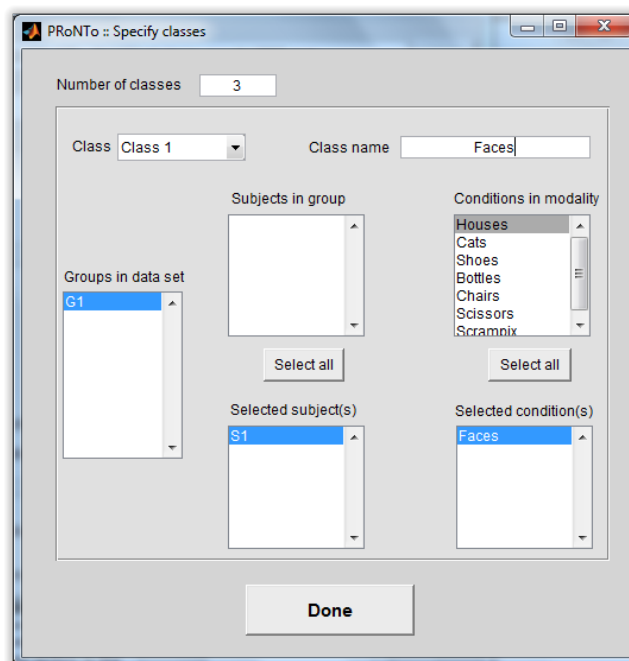


Figure 4.2: Subject / condition selection panel for classification models

4.4.2 Regression

Regression is a generic term for all methods attempting to fit a model to observed data in order to quantify the relationship between two groups of variables. Traditionally in neuroimaging massively univariate strategies (e.g. GLM) have been largely used, where data for each voxel are independently fitted with the same model. Statistics test are used to make inferences on the presence of an effect at each voxel (e.g. *t-test*). Multivariate regression, on the other hand, takes into account several input variables (voxels) simultaneously, thus modelling the property of interest considering existing relations among the voxels.

Although most studies exploring predictive analyses in neuroimaging have been related to classification, regression analysis has aroused interest in neuroscience community for its ability to decode continuous characteristics from neuroimaging data. This approach has potential to be used when the examples (patterns) can be associated to a range of real values. The objective is to predict a continuous value instead of predicting a class to which the example belongs. These values usually refer to demographic, clinical or behavioural data (as age, blood pressure or scores resulting from a test, for example). For validation, different metrics can be used to compute the agreement between the predicted values and the actual ones, such as Pearson's correlation coefficient (r) and Mean Squared Error (MSE).

The specification of which subjects and scans to include in regression models is similar to that for classification, see Figure 4.3 and for the purposes of model specification in PRoNTTo, regression can be thought of as a classification problem with a single class. In the current release, regression is only supported if there is a single scan per subject (e.g. structural images or beta images from a GLM analysis). In a future release it will be possible to perform regression where an independent regression target is supplied for each trial, block or condition. To perform a regression, the regression targets are specified during the design stage. It is important to emphasize that in the current implementation, regression is only supported using the "select by scans" option (see chapter 2).

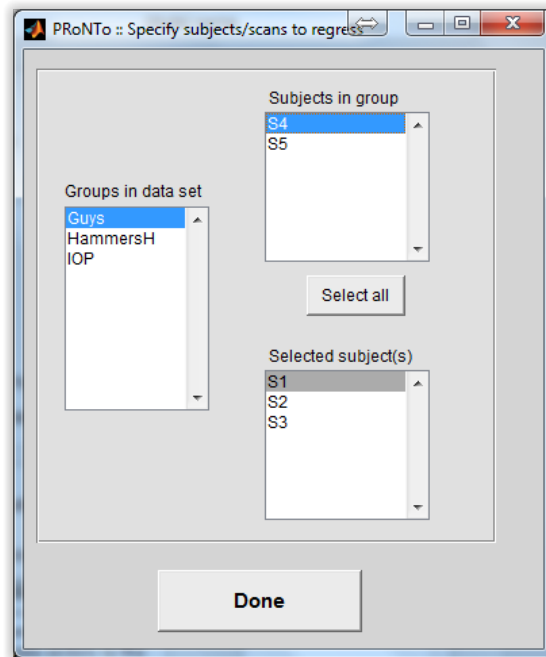


Figure 4.3: Subject / condition selection panel for regression models

4.4.3 Hyper-parameter optimization

From PRoNTTo version 2.0, it is possible to optimize hyper-parameters of the machine learning models. For example, the soft-margin (a.k.a. C) hyper-parameter in SVM can be optimized, using

a nested cross-validation scheme. In this case, there are two loops in the cross-validation scheme. The inner loop is used for parameter optimization and the outer loop is used for assessing the model’s performance. More specifically, the data is divided into training and testing sets according to the cross-validation scheme selected (outer loop). For each fold of the outer loop the training set is further divided into training and testing sets according to the cross-validation scheme selected (inner/nested loop). The inner loop is used to train and test the model with each value of the hyper-parameter specified by the user. The parameter leading to the highest performance in the inner/nested loop (balanced accuracy for classification and Mean Squared Error for regression) is then used in the outer loop. For each fold of the outer loop, the model is trained using the ‘optimal’ value of the hyper-parameter and tested on the data that was left out (and which was not used for parameter optimization). This nested CV procedure can lead to different values of the hyper-parameter to be selected in each fold. These are stored in the outputs of the model and can be reviewed in the ‘Display Results’ panel.

Optimizing the hyper-parameter might lead to improved results compared to fixed values. This will usually depend on the number of features selected to model the data: for example, for whole brain models based on SVM classifiers, with many more features than images/trials, it is reasonable to assume that changing the hyper-parameter won’t affect the model performance significantly due to the high dimensionality of the data with respect to the number of examples. However, when using (e.g.) regions of interest (in a second-level mask or in a MKL model), the ratio between the number of features and the number of examples will be much smaller. In this case, different values of the hyper-parameter might lead to different decision functions and optimizing the hyper-parameter is desirable.

Performing a nested cross-validation can be computationally expensive. For computational efficiency, P_{RoNT}o allows to specify different cross-validation schemes for the ‘outer’ and the ‘nested’ CV².

In the current version of P_{RoNT}o, the soft-margin parameter can be optimized for SVM and for MKL (classification and regression). In the same way, it is possible to optimize the λ ridge parameter for KRR. If no value is provided, those parameters will take the values 0.01, 0.1, 1, 10, 100 and 1000, i.e. $10.^{[-2:3]}$.

4.5 Cross-validation

In the final part of the specify model input form, select the type of cross-validation to employ. Cross-validation is a crucial part of the pattern recognition modelling and is used to assess the generalisation ability of the model and to ensure the model has not overfit to the data. Typically this is done by partitioning the data into one or more partitions: a ‘training set’, used to train the model (e.g. fit parameters) and a ‘testing set’ used to assess performance on unseen data. By repeatedly repartitioning the data in this way, it is possible to derive an approximately unbiased estimate of the true generalisation error of the model.

The most common cross-validation schemes in neuroimaging applications are leave-one-subject out (LOSO; exclude one subject for testing, train with the remaining), leave-one-run-out (LORO; leave one fMRI run out for testing, train with the remainder) and leave-one-block-out (LOBO; leave out a single block or event and train with the remainder). LOSO is suitable for multi-subject designs, while LORO and LOBO are suitable for single subject designs, where the former is better suited to designs having multiple experimental runs and the latter is appropriate if there is only a single run. The current release of P_{RoNT}o supports each of these, and also supports leave-one-subject-per-group-out (LOGO) for classification, which is appropriate if the subjects in each group are paired or for repeated measures experimental designs. Please note that LOGO is not appropriate for classes defined from a design. Versions 1.1 and later allows k-fold cross-validation for each of the available schemes. This means that the user specifies the number of folds (‘k’) and that the data is partitioned according to that number. For example, specifying $k = 4$ will use 25% of the data to test the model, and 75% to train it. Note: $k = 1$ splits the data in half, training the model on the first half and testing on the second, i.e. there is no circular

²For example, the outer CV could have more folds, to use as much data as possible in each fold for prediction, while the nested CV would not need as many folds to select the ‘optimal’ value of the hyper-parameter (e.g. k-folds CV).

partitioning. We recommend using k-folds CV when possible as Leave-One-Out has been shown to lead to over-optimistic model performance estimation.

In version 2.0, a GUI allows the user to fully specify his/her cross-validation scheme. First, a ‘basis’ needs to be specified (Figure 4.4). Three options are available:

- Load a .mat containing a previously computed CV matrix (needs to contain the variable ‘CV’).
- Select a basis from the pop-down list (contains the same options as for the outer CV).
- Specify the number of folds.

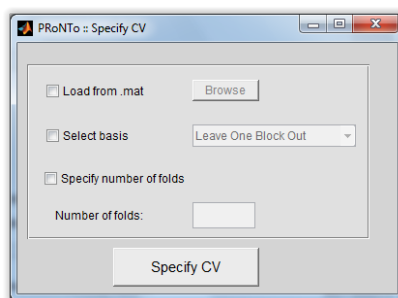


Figure 4.4: Specify basis to build custom cross-validation

When an option has been selected, a new window will appear (Figure 4.5). The top panel of this window is a table that can be edited. Each row refers to a trial/image selected in the definition of the classes (or to perform regression on). Each column represents a fold. For each column, the different trials can have a value of 2 (test set), 1 (train set) or 0 (unused in this fold). Setting a whole fold to 0 takes it out of the CV matrix. Note: it is possible to change the value of multiple trials by changing the value of the last trial to modify, then shift-select the first one to modify. This also works across folds. The bottom panel displays the structure of the data selected for further classification or regression, along with a preview of the built CV matrix.

The resulting CV matrix can be saved in a .mat, alongside the PRT (name: *model name_CV.mat*). This matrix can be loaded as a custom CV in the batch, if exactly the same trials were selected for modelling. **Note:** The ‘custom’ CV option is not available as a nested/inner cross-validation scheme.

Information concerning the cross-validation structure is stored internally in matrix format, and can be visualised by clicking ‘Review Kernel and CV’ from the main ProNTTo window (see 4.6 for an example). In the left panel, this figure indicates which group, subject, modality and condition each scan in the feature set belongs to. On the right, each cross-validation fold (partition) is displayed as a separate column and each scan is colour coded according to whether it is in the training or testing set (or if it is unused).

It should be emphasised that the type of cross-validation selected should be appropriate for the experimental design. For example, it is nonsensical to select a leave-one-subject-out cross-validation approach for single subject designs. It is also important to ensure that the training and testing sets are completely independent to avoid the cross-validation statistics becoming biased. This is particularly important for fMRI, where successive scans in time are highly correlated. For example, if a leave-one-block-out approach is employed and the blocks are too close together then the independence of the training and testing set will be violated, and the cross-validation statistics will be biased (technically this is governed by the autocorrelation length of the fMRI timeseries and the temporal blurring induced by the haemodynamic response function). This can be avoided if care is taken to ensure that overlapping scans are discarded from the design (see chapter 2), but it is a very important issue, and the user should still be careful to ensure that cross-validation folds are sufficiently far apart in time (especially for LOBO cross-validation).

During this part of the model specification, it is also possible to select one or more operations to apply to the data. Each of these operations is defined below:

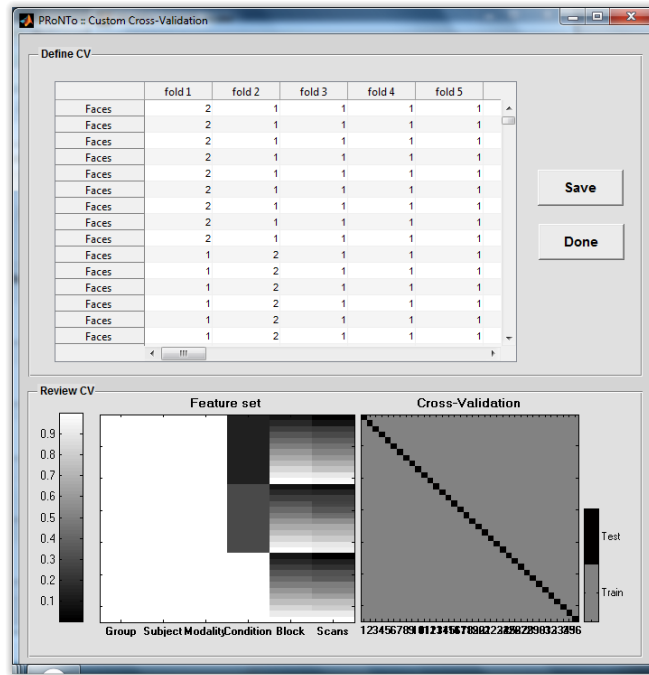


Figure 4.5: For each fold, specify which images/trials are part of the training and test set, or are unused

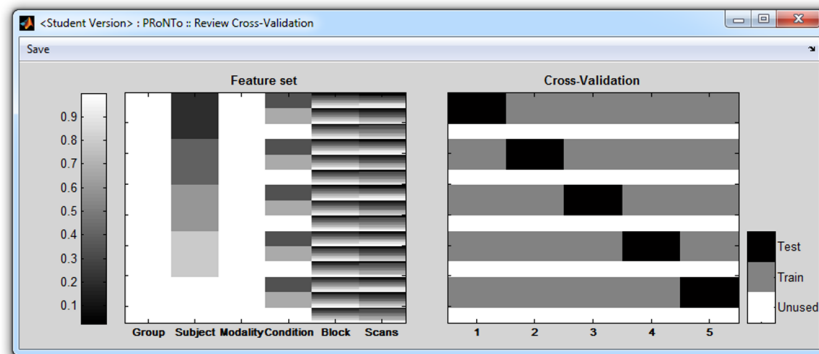


Figure 4.6: Review cross-validation matrix

1. **Sample averaging (within blocks):** constructs samples by computing the average of all scans within each block or event for each subject and condition.
2. **Sample averaging (within subjects):** constructs samples by computing the average of all scans within all blocks for each subject and condition.
3. **Mean centre features using training data:** subtract the voxel-wise mean from each data vector.
4. **Divide data vectors by their norm:** scales each data vector (i.e. each example) to lie on the unit hypersphere by dividing it by its Euclidean norm.
5. **Regress out covariates:** regresses out the covariates entered for each subject/image (entered 'by scans') from the kernel using training data only. If this operation is selected, PRoNTTo will always remove confounds first before other data operations are performed.

A crucial point to note is that all operations are embedded within the cross-validation structure such that they are applied independently to training and testing sets. This prevents a very common mistake in pattern recognition from occurring, whereby parameters are computed using the whole data set prior to cross-validation. Observing a complete split between training and testing sets during all phases of analysis ensures that accuracy measures are an appropriate reflection of the true generalisation ability of the machine and are not biased because of improper applications of preprocessing operations to the entire dataset.

Other points to note include: (i) the order of operations is potentially important. For example, subtracting the mean then dividing each data vector by its norm is not the same as performing the operations the other way around. (ii) operations (1) and (2) have no effect if no design is specified or for events with a length of one TR.

At a minimum, we recommend that features should be mean centered over scans during cross-validation. In addition, for multiple kernel learning, we advise the user to normalize each kernel after mean centering. This will compensate for the fact that different kernels might be computed from examples/samples with different number of features (e.g. different regions contain different numbers of voxels).

The different operations selected for a specific model can then be reviewed using the ‘Review Kernel and CV’ (starting from version 2.0). The selected operations will be listed below the kernels (‘Show kernel’).

4.6 Specify / Run model

Using the GUI, it is possible to either ‘Specify’ the model, or ‘Specify and Run’ the model. The first option saves all the parameters of the model in the PRT structure. This information can be found in `PRT.model(m).input`, where m is the index of the model. The second saves all the parameters of the model and then runs the model. In this case, the inputs, which include the cross-validation matrix, the target values or labels, and the machine (e.g. binary SVM, Gaussian Process, etc.), are fed to the estimation routines, which will then add to the PRT an output field (`PRT.model(m).output`) containing the estimated parameters, statistics, and other information from the learning process.

In some cases (e.g. multiple models to run or models with nested CV and/or slower machines), it would be desirable to estimate models later on (e.g. just before lunch break or at the end of the day). The ‘Run model’ option allows to select multiple models and run them one at a time automatically (Figure 4.7). The first thing that needs to be done using this window is to specify which PRT we would like to work with. PRoNTo will then read the available models from this structure and display the list of models on the left panel. These models can be selected (the selected models will show on the right panel) by clicking each model individually or by clicking the ‘Select all’ button in the middle of the panels. Finally, to estimate the model(s), one needs only to click the bottom button ‘Run model(s)’.

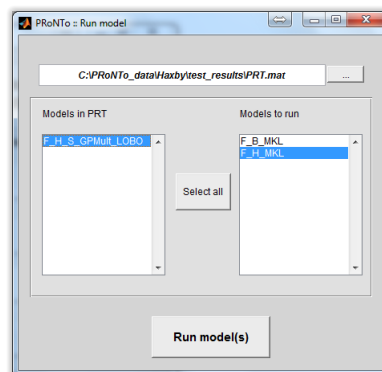


Figure 4.7: Choose models to be estimated

It is useful to have a look at what is displayed in the MATLAB command space when the model

is being estimated. Information such as the number of folds can help double-check that everything is going as expected. Furthermore, if some options were specified (e.g. using a feature set with multiple kernels) that are not available at the modelling step (e.g. to be modelled with SVM), warnings will be displayed, as in Figure 4.8.

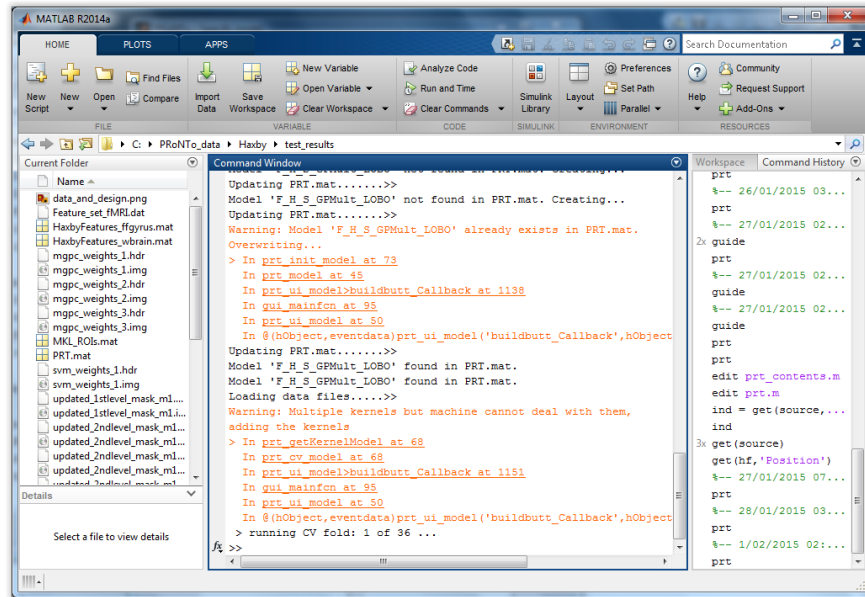


Figure 4.8: MATLABworkspace displaying warnings when kernels are added

Important note: multiple kernel feature sets can be modelled using any machine. For machines not supporting multiple kernels, these will first be added before the model is estimated. This corresponds to concatenating the features from the different regions and/or modalities.

4.7 Batch interface

The batch module provides all the functionality provided in the user interface and allows complex analyses to be scripted in advance. As noted, the batch module also provides functionality not available in the user interface. The most important difference is that the batch module allows customised MATLAB functions to be used as prediction machines. This functionality allows PRoNTto to be easily extended to allow many types of classification and regression algorithms not provided under the current framework. This can be achieved by selecting ‘Custom machine’ under the ‘Model Type’ heading. This allows a function name to be specified (i.e. any *.m function in the MATLAB search path). The behaviour of this custom machine can then be controlled by a free-format argument string. See the developer documentation and the examples in the **machines/** subdirectory of the PRoNTto distribution for more information. Another important difference between the batch and user interfaces is that mean centering data vectors across scans is enabled by default in the batch. Also, flexible CV is available in the batch only in the form of ‘load a .mat’. This .mat must contain a variable called ‘CV’, specifying the CV matrix for the selected trials/images.

An example of the batch window for model specification is provided in figure 4.9.

As displayed in Figure 4.9, the batch does not allow to specify and run the model directly. Instead, the user had to add a ‘Run model’ module. The batch has the advantage of allowing to perform permutations along model estimation (option available in the ‘Display results’ window in the GUI). Furthermore, it is possible to save the predictions and the balanced accuracy (for classification) for each permutation, to perform further statistical tests if needed. The ‘Run model’ batch module is presented in Figure 4.10. **Note:** Dependencies on the model name are available when performing a ‘Model specification’ followed by a ‘Run model’ module.

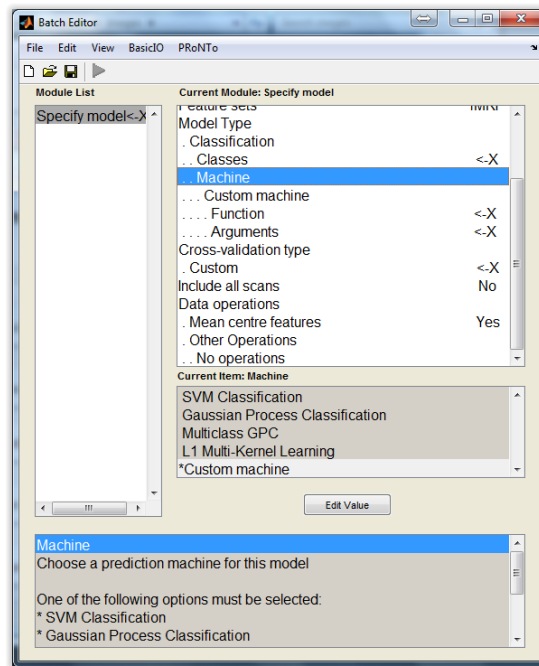


Figure 4.9: Batch interface to specify a model

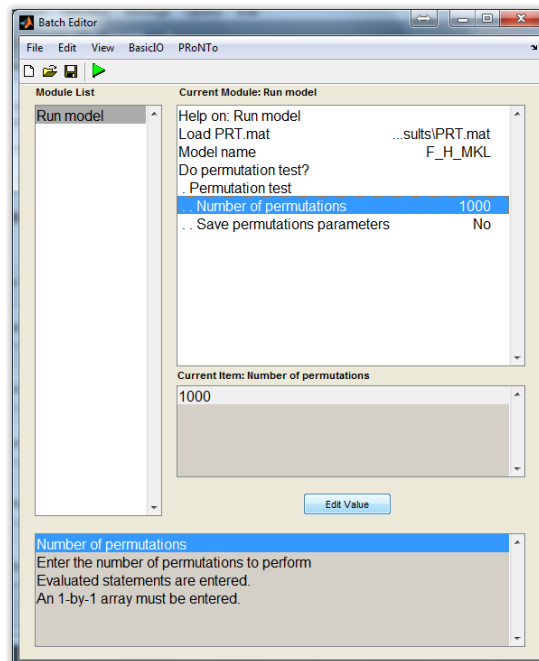


Figure 4.10: Batch interface to run a model

Chapter 5

Computing Feature and Region Contributions

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5.1 Introduction

The previous module allows the user to specify one or more models. These include the machine to be used, the cross-validation scheme and the classification/regression problem. The estimation of those models led to predictions on unseen/test data (in each fold), from which measures of performance of the model can be derived.

In addition, as PRoNTo uses linear models it provides the option of recovering the model weights in the original feature (voxel) space, and transforming the weights vector into an image, or map. These maps contain at each voxel the corresponding weight of the linear model (together defining the optimal decision function), and which related to how much this particular voxel contributed to the classification/regression task in question. The weights can later be displayed using the ‘Display results’ module (described below).

Furthermore, the MKL machine estimates contribution of each kernel to the final decision function. This means that there will be one value per region of interest as defined by an atlas and/or per modality (depending on how multiple kernels were built). Therefore, it is possible to build maps at the region level, in addition to the maps at the voxel level. Regions/modalities can then be ranked according to their contribution. Since L1-MKL is a sparse algorithm (i.e. only some kernels will have a non-null contribution to the model), this eases model interpretation.

5.2 Methods

The output of the linear kernel models in PRoNTo include the coefficients of the dual representation, i.e. the coefficients of the training examples. These coefficients are then multiplied by the training examples to obtain the model weights. The vector of model weights has the same dimensions of the original voxel space, and can therefore be converted to a 3D image. This computation is done for each fold. The resulting 3D images for all folds are then assembled into a single 4D NIFTI file with dimensions [3D x (number of folds + 1)], where 1 corresponds to an extra 3D image with the averaged weights over all folds. The NIFTI file is saved in the same directory as PRT.mat. In the case of multi-class classification, one image will be built for each class, the index of the class being saved in the image name (e.g. *image_name_c1.img*). In the case of multiple

modalities being considered as multiple kernels (i.e. not concatenated in samples), one image will be built for each modality, the modality name being appended to the image name.

In addition, it is possible to build an image containing the contributions of each region of interest as defined by an atlas (same dimensions as for the voxel weight images). Two options are available:

- Contributions of kernels estimated through MKL: In this case, the contributions of each region to the model are derived from the contributions of each kernel. This option is available for MKL modelling of feature sets containing multiple kernels based on ROIs defined by an atlas.
- Summarizing the weights according to ROIs: If a whole brain feature set was used, or if the kernels were added to perform single kernel modelling (e.g. SVM, GP, KRR, RVR), it is possible to select an atlas and summarize a posteriori the weights in each anatomically defined ROI. The contribution of each region is then simply the sum of the absolute values of the weights within that region, divided by the number of voxels in that region (see [17] for details). If summarizing weights by using an atlas is desired, this atlas should be used as a second level mask in the 'feature set' step to ensure a perfect overlap between the atlas and the model features. Otherwise, any voxels used as features in the model but not present in the atlas will be summarized in one extra region referred to as 'other' that will not correspond to any anatomical region.

In both cases, the contribution of each region is divided by the total contribution of all regions. The derived values can then be seen as percentages of contribution of each region to the decision function. The contributions can be ranked, leading to a list of regions sorted by descending contribution to the model. This list can also be computed if multiple modalities were built and used in an MKL model. In this case, each modality has a contribution to the model, that can be normalized and a sorted list can be derived.

Furthermore, for MKL models - which are sparse in the number of kernels contributing to the model - a bar graph can be built, representing the number of kernels with a non-null contribution to the model. The same graph bar will depict the contribution of each region to the decision function in the case of summarized weights. In this case, the bar graph will not be sparse.

5.3 Graphical user interface

If the user wants to create images of the weights, using the GUI, the user first needs to click the 'Compute weights' button on the main PRoNTTo window. This will launch the window shown in Fig 5.1. To estimate the weights and create the weight maps the user needs to select a `PRT.mat` file. The window is then divided in two panels: a 'Feature weights' panel and a 'Atlas-based weights' panel. In the first panel, PRoNTTo will show the list of available models, and the user can choose one model for which to estimate the weights. If the selected model is the MKL modelling of ROI-based kernels, the 'Atlas-based weights' panel will be automatically updated, and the name of the selected atlas at the feature set step will appear. Otherwise, those fields will stay blank. In the 'Feature weights' panel, it is also possible to define the name of the created image file, which is saved in the same directory as `PRT.mat`. Alternatively, if left empty, PRoNTTo will name the file according to the model name, class (if multi-class machine) and/or modality (if MKL on modalities). The 'Atlas-based weights' allows to estimate the contribution of each anatomically defined region to the model. If the model refers to an MKL machine estimated on kernels per region, the 'Atlas name' field will be filled automatically and the contribution of each region is derived from the contribution of each kernel. If this is not the case (single kernel machine or feature set), an atlas should be loaded (using the browse option). The weights will then be summarized for each region a posteriori.

5.4 matlabbatch interface

The `matlabbatch` module to compute the weights has the same options as the GUI. One main difference being that instead of listing the available models in a given PRT, it will ask for the

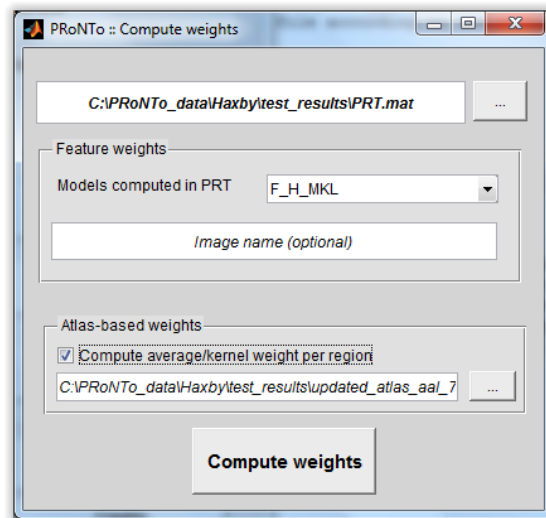


Figure 5.1: Weights computation GUI.

name (string) of the model to be used. As for estimating models, the name of the model should be exactly the name given in ‘Specify model’. Another difference is that the batch allows to compute weight images for each permutation. In this case, only the average across folds will be saved in a nifti. This potentially allows for statistical tests to be performed on weights and/or on the derived ranking of the regions (for MKL modelling of anatomically defined ROIs).

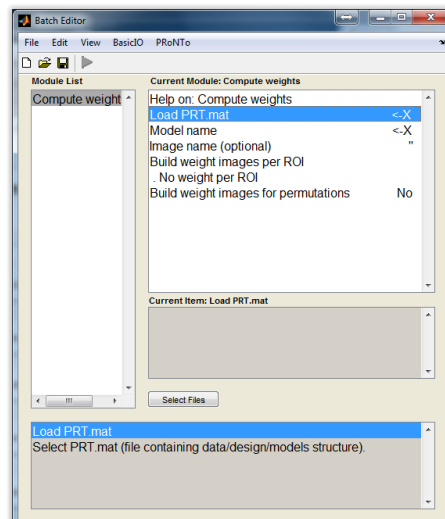


Figure 5.2: Weights computation GUI.

Chapter 6

Display Model Performance

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6.1 Introduction

Once a machine (e.g. a classifier or a regression function) has been specified, its parameters have been estimated over training data, and its performance has been evaluated over a testing set using cross-validation, it is necessary to examine the outcome of the whole procedure in detail. The results windows enables the user to see the model's performance evaluated by different metrics.

Examining model output and parameters is helpful in diagnosing the potentially bad performance of a particular model. For example, if the machine cannot perform above chance, it could be due to an inappropriate experimental paradigm, noisy data, insufficient amount of data, wrong choice of features, or the wrong choice of machine. It is important to recognise that any of these factors could cause the modelling to fail.

Model performance can be reviewed using the 'Display Results' GUI. Alternatively, all computed statistics are saved within the PRT structure, in the `PRT.model(m).output.stats` field, with `m`, being the index of the model to review.

6.2 Launching results display

Make sure all previous steps have been performed (Data and Design, Chapter 2; Prepare feature set, Chapter 3; Specify Model and Run Model, Chapter 4).

In the **Review Options** panel of the main PRTTo window, press **Display Results**. At the 'Select PRT.mat' window, navigate to where your `PRT.mat` file is stored (using the left column), and select it. The main results window will open and look as represented in Figure 6.1. In the **Model** panel in the top-right corner, the list of models that have been successfully estimated will appear. Note: there will be a 'beep' if one or more models were specified but not estimated ('Run model') and their name will appear in the command window.

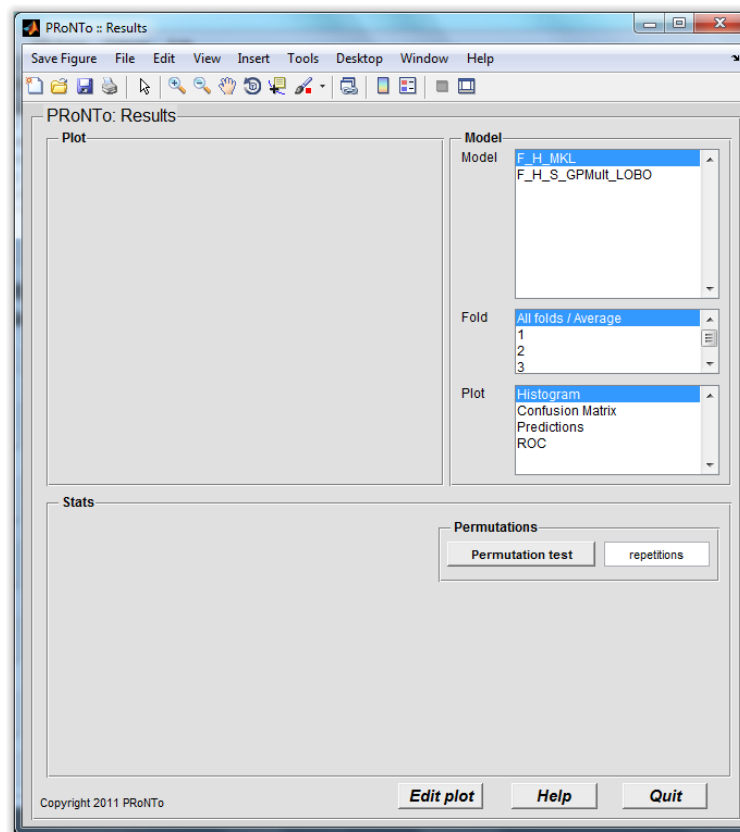


Figure 6.1: Initial state of the results display main window.

6.3 The main results display window

The window is divided into three panels; going clockwise from top left to bottom left, they are:

Plot : This panel displays the plots for the various analyses that can be performed on test results. With the exception of the confusion matrix plot, these cannot be interacted with.

Model : This panel allows the user to select the model to visualize, whether to visualize a particular fold or all folds at once, and which plot to produce.

Stats : The **stats** panel allows the user to visualize a variety of performance metrics (based on the selected fold), including accuracy statistics for classifiers and MSE for regression models. In addition, p-values for these metrics based on permutation tests can also be visualized.

To populate the ‘Plot’ panel, first click on a model in the **Model** selector, then on ‘all folds’ (or a particular fold) in the **Fold** selector, and finally on a plot in the **Plot** selector. The next section details the plots available.

The window also comprises ‘Edit plot’, ‘Help’ and ‘Quit’ buttons. The ‘Edit plot’ button exports the displayed plot in an extra window, such that it can be edited and easily saved. The ‘Help’ button provides information on each panel of the window (not as detailed as in this manual) and the ‘Quit’ button closes the results window. In addition, the GUI menu comports a ‘Save figure’ option (on the top left) that acts as a ‘printscreen’ of this window (with white background), which can be saved for records/publications.

6.4 Analysing a machine’s performance graphically

Looking at a machine output’s graphically can often yield insights into the performance of the machine. In PRoNTTo, plots are different for classification and regression.

6.4.1 Classification

Histogram plot

The histogram plot is a smoothed density version of the predictions plot, showing how function values are distributed. A good classifier would have minimal overlap between the densities. The error rate of the classifier is proportional to the area of the overlap. The ROC curve can be thought of as the result of sweeping a decision threshold over the range of functional values, and recording the joint sensitivity/specificity values for each decision threshold setting. A typical linear SVM would have a decision threshold at 0.

Figure 6.2 shows an example of such a plot for a binary classification (SPM EEG dataset, Faces versus Scrambled, LOBO CV).

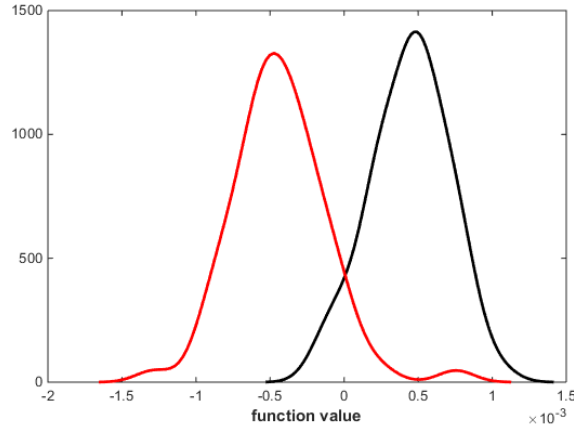


Figure 6.2: Example function values histogram curve for a binary problem modelled by L1-MKL.

Confusion matrix plot

The confusion matrix shows counts of predicted class labels $\hat{\omega}_n = f(\mathbf{x}_n)$ (in rows) versus true class labels ω_n (in columns). An ideal confusion matrix is diagonal: all predicted class labels correspond to the truth. Off-diagonal elements represent errors. It is important to check that none of the classes is “sacrificed” to gain accuracy in other classes - in other words, if all classes are equally important to classify, no class should have more off-diagonal than on-diagonal entries. Many summary statistics, including class accuracy, total accuracy, sensitivity, and specificity, can be computed from the confusion matrix.

Figure 6.3 shows an example of a confusion matrix (Haxby dataset, Faces versus Houses versus Scissors, LOBO CV).

Predictions plot

A prediction plot displays, for a particular fold (y-axis), the output value of the machine’s decision function for each test sample (x-axis, e.g., for a linear SVM, this could be $\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{x}_i + b$, for a probabilistic classifier this could be a posterior probability $P(\Omega = \omega | \mathbf{x}_i)$). The decision threshold is displayed by a vertical line at the centre of the plot. A well-performing classifier will yield very different function values for samples of different classes, i.e. samples from different classes will fall on different sides of the decision threshold. The inspection, in each fold, of the overlap of function values between classes, can help to identify which of the test blocks/subjects/conditions is atypical with respect to the training set. This plot is available for binary classification.

On the plot, each class is represented by a different marker and color, and indicated in the legend. Figure 6.4 shows an example predictions plot.

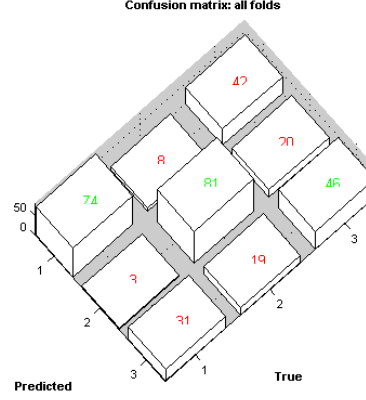


Figure 6.3: Example confusion matrix for all folds of a three-class problem modelled by GP.

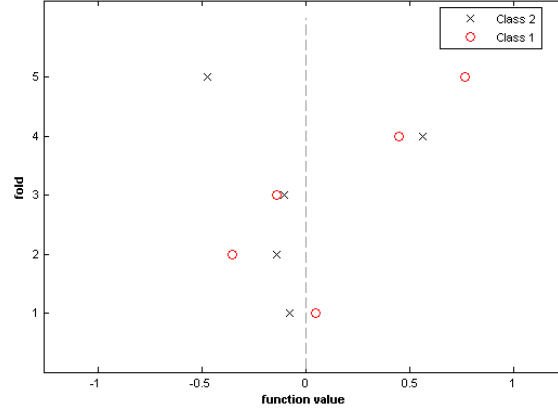


Figure 6.4: Example predictions plot for a two-class problem modelled by an SVM.

Receiver Operating Characteristic (ROC) plot

ROC curve is a commonly used measure to evaluate a binary classifier performance. It shows the trade off between the true positive rate (TPR) (sensitivity, the number of correctly classified positive instances divided by the total number of positive instances) and false positive rate (FPR) (1-specificity, the number of incorrectly classified negative instances divided by the total number of negative instances) across a number of thresholds. An ideal classifier would have an ROC passing through the top-left corner, depicting all true positives and no false positives. The area under curve (AUC) is a summary measure of classifier performance, where higher is better (1 represents perfect performance, 0.5 represents random performance). As with all summary measures, the AUC is but one way of comparing performance of machines, and cannot be used alone to declare a machine statistically significantly superior to another on a given dataset.

In PRoNTTo, the ROC and AUC are estimated within each fold if a specific fold is chosen or across folds by concatenating all test samples. Users may notice that sometimes AUC is ‘NaN’ (Not a Number) within fold. AUC is computed by using TPR and FPR, which are both proportions. However, if at least one of the two proportions doesn’t exist, AUC cannot be computed. For example, if users choose leave-one-subject-out as the CV scheme with one image per subject, there is only one test target in each fold. Hence, there will be no positive instance or negative instance from which we can compute TPR or FPR. AUC is therefore NaN. Another case leading to this NaN is that there is only one class in the test targets within one fold (e.g.

leave-one-block-out with one class per block as in Haxby dataset), even if there are multiple test targets. We display AUC when it is NaN, such that users are aware of this limitation.

Figure 6.5 shows an example of ROC plot (Haxby dataset, Faces versus Houses, 4-folds nested CV, LOBO outer CV, display All folds).

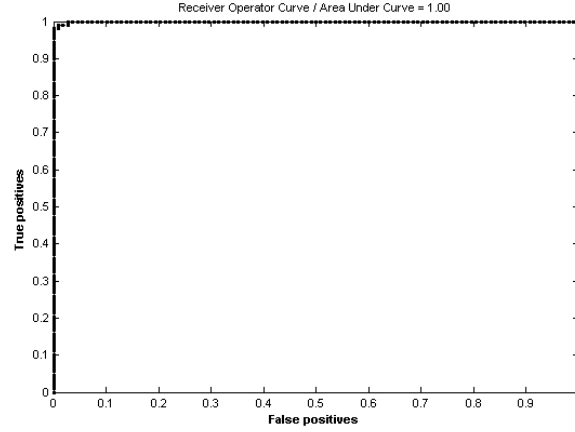


Figure 6.5: Example ROC curve for a two-class problem modelled by an MKL on ROIs.

6.4.2 Regression

Predictions (scatter)

This plot represents the predicted values (x-axis) against the real values or targets (y-axis). A perfect correspondence between targets and predictions would be represented by a diagonal on this plot. Figure 6.6 displays such a plot for the prediction of age from sMRI images (IXI dataset, 15 images acquired across 3 centres).

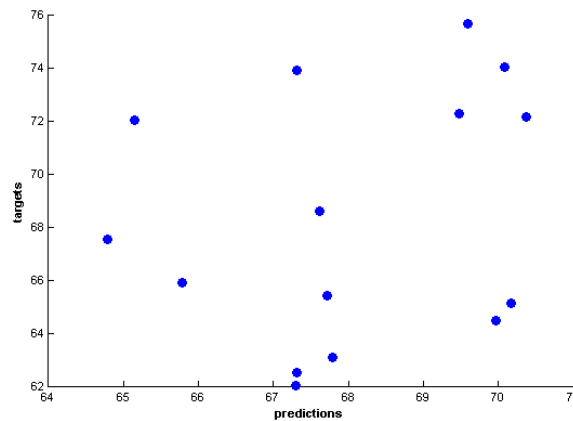


Figure 6.6: Example of scatter prediction plot on 15 data points modelled by KRR.

Predictions (bar)

This plot displays, for each image/subject, the target and the prediction in bar plots. An example plot is displayed in Figure 6.7 for the same model.

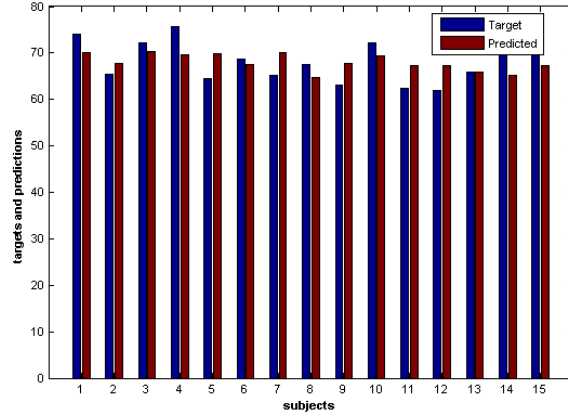


Figure 6.7: Example of bar prediction plot on 15 data points modelled by KRR.

Predictions (line)

This plot displays, for each fold, the target and the prediction, each in line plots. An example plot is displayed in Figure 6.8 for the same model.

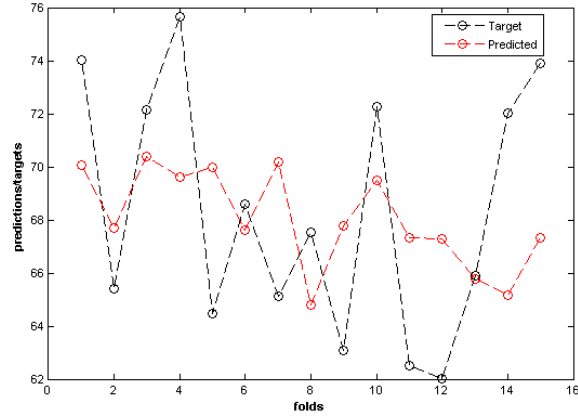


Figure 6.8: Example of line prediction plot on 15 data points modelled by KRR.

6.4.3 Influence of the hyper-parameter on performance

This plot will be present in the list if hyper-parameter optimization was performed. When displaying the average across folds, for each value of the hyper-parameter, it displays the average model performance (balanced accuracy for classification and MSE for regression, line on the plot) across nested folds, with an error bar representing the standard deviation of model performance. The frequency of selection of a hyper-parameter value (i.e. the number of times this value was returned as ‘optimal’ to the outer CV fold) is represented with a gray bar plot on the right-side y-axis. An example of such a plot is displayed in Figure 6.9 for the optimization of the soft-margin parameter in L1-MKL (Haxby dataset, Faces versus Houses, 4-folds nested CV, LOBO outer CV). When selecting a specific fold, this plot displays the model performance for each value of the hyper-parameter, and represents the optimal value (i.e. the one leading to highest performance) in red.

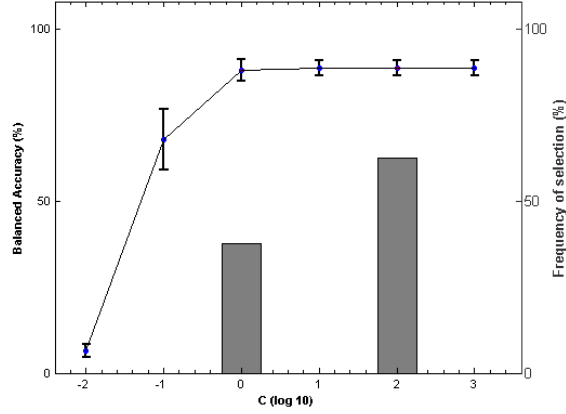


Figure 6.9: Example performance curve depending on the hyper-parameter value with frequency of selection of each hyper-parameter.

6.5 Statistical analysis of a machine's performance

One of the main questions to ask of a model is how precise its predictions are. In regression, goodness-of-fit is often assessed via mean squared error and coefficient of determination (R^2). In classification, a common practice is to compute prediction accuracy, both for each class and for all test data. Once a specific performance metric has been obtained, it is also possible to obtain a p-value for the metric, reflecting how certain we are that the result is not due to chance.

The statistics table gives a summary of the model's performance. Model performance is estimated differently for classification and for regression. In PRoNTTo, classification performance is assessed using total accuracy (TA), balanced accuracy (BA), class accuracies (CA) and class predictive values. For regression, the goodness-of-fit is assessed based on the coefficient of determination (R^2), the mean squared error (MSE), the normalized mean squared error, and the correlation between the targets and the predictions.

6.5.1 Classification

The accuracy acc is the total number of correctly classified test samples divided by the total number of test samples N , irrespective of class. The accuracy is exactly equivalent to

$$acc = 1 - \frac{1}{N} \sum_n l_{01}(y_n, f(\mathbf{x}_n)), \quad (6.1)$$

where $l_{01}(y_n, f(\mathbf{x}_n))$ is a 0-1 loss function that counts each classification error as costing 1 and each classification success as costing 0:

$$l_{01}(y_n, f(\mathbf{x}_n)) = \begin{cases} 0 & y_n = f(\mathbf{x}_n) \\ 1 & y_n \neq f(\mathbf{x}_n) \end{cases} \quad (6.2)$$

Balanced accuracy takes the number of samples in each class into account, and gives equal weight to the accuracies obtained on test samples of each class. In other words, the class-specific accuracy is computed by restricting the sum of equation 6.1 to be taken over C disjoint subsets of the whole testing data, where each subset contains only test samples from one class. This produces a set of class-specific accuracies $\{acc_1, \dots, acc_C\}$, from which the balanced accuracy can be computed as

$$acc^{bal} = \frac{1}{C} \sum acc_c. \quad (6.3)$$

Balanced accuracy is the measure of choice when there is class imbalance (one class, called the *majority class*, has much more data than others).

The stats panel also gives the class accuracies $\{acc_1, \dots, acc_C\}$, useful to check whether the model favours some classes over others. If class 1 represents control subjects, and class 2 represents patients, then class 1 accuracy is equivalent to specificity, and class 2 accuracy is equivalent to sensitivity. In the same way, the figure displays class positive predictive value, which represents the number of false positives for each class. An example of classification stats is displayed in Figure 6.10.

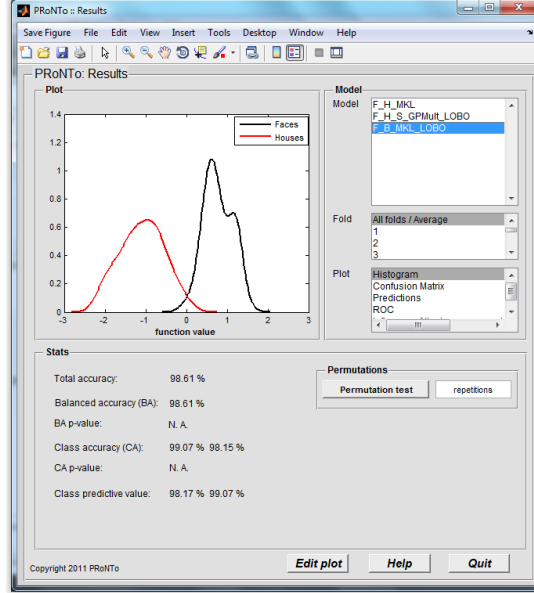


Figure 6.10: Example statistics for all folds of a two-class problem modelled by an L1-MKL.

6.5.2 Regression

As previously mentioned, model performance for regression is assessed by the correlation between the predictions and the targets (linear correlation), the coefficient of determination (R^2), the mean square error (MSE), and the normalized MSE. An example of such stats window is displayed in Figure 6.11.

The mean-squared error is calculated as:

$$MSE = \frac{1}{N} \sum_n (y_n - f(\mathbf{x}_n))^2 \quad (6.4)$$

This is the standard measure when assessing goodness-of-fit for regression models. Since the magnitude of the MSE depends on the scale of y , we also calculate the Normalised Mean Square Error, 'Norm. MSE':

$$Norm.MSE = \frac{MSE}{(y_{max} - y_{min})} \quad (6.5)$$

where we divide the MSE by the range of the targets over the data. This gives a scale invariant measure of prediction accuracy. In addition, the correlation coefficient of the targets and predictions are determined:

$$CORR = \frac{\sum_n (y_n - \mu_y)(f(\mathbf{x}_n) - \mu_f)}{\{\sum_n (y_n - \mu_y)^2 \sum_n (f(\mathbf{x}_n) - \mu_f)^2\}^{\frac{1}{2}}} \quad (6.6)$$

in which μ_y and μ_f are the sample means of the targets and predictions respectively. The resulting measure $-1 < CORR < 1$ provides a measure of the strength of the linear dependence between the targets and the predicted targets, with values close to zero indicating no relationship, values close to 1 indicating a positive relationship, and values close to -1 indicating a negative relationship.

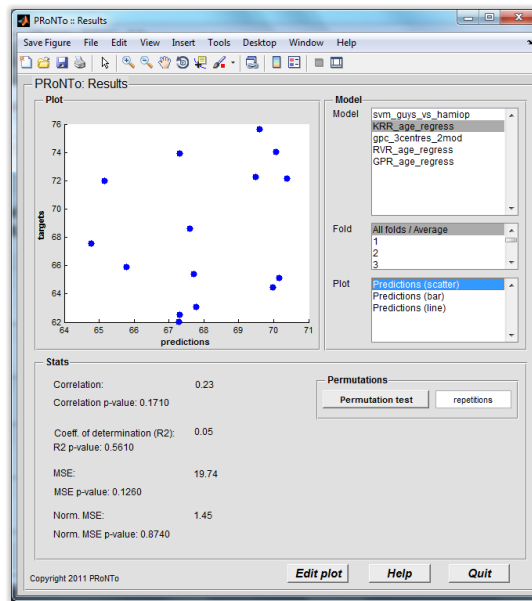


Figure 6.11: Example statistics for all folds of a KRR modelling on 15 data points.

Values of $CORR$ less than zero would imply that the model has performed poorly, as this would mean that targets with large values tend to be given smaller predicted values than targets with small values. However, it should be remembered that a large positive value of $CORR$ does not *necessarily* mean that the model is giving accurate predictions, since a global scaling and shifting of the predictions gives the same value for $CORR$. We would therefore recommend examining both $CORR$ and MSE , as well as the scatterplots, to verify that the model is performing well. For completeness, the statistics table also include the ‘coefficient of determination’ R^2 , which is given by

$$R^2 = CORR^2 \quad (6.7)$$

6.5.3 Permutation testing

Much of statistical theory and machine learning theory rests on the assumption that the data is IID (independently and identically distributed). However, in functional neuroimaging this assumption is often not met, due to e.g. within-run correlations and haemodynamic effects. Therefore, classical estimates of confidence intervals (such as the binomial confidence interval) may not always be appropriate. Permutation testing is a non-parametric procedure that allows to obtain meaningful confidence intervals and p-values in this case. Because it requires retraining the model a number of times, which can be costly in computation time, this is not done by default. After filling in the **repetitions** field with a number of repetitions R , pressing the **Permutation test** button will estimate the model for the specified number of times with permuted labels/targets, and produce a p-value for performance statistics (see Figure 6.10). The smallest increment in p-value is equal to $1/R$ (e.g. 20 permutations gives you increments of 0.05), with a minimum value of $1/R$ (i.e. running 10 permutations will never lead to statistically significant result at the commonly used threshold of $p < 0.05$). Usually, we would recommend computing several hundreds to a thousand permutations.

For both classification and regression models, the p-value associated with each performance measure can be estimated using permutations. Until they have been estimated, ‘N.A.’ will be displayed (standing for ‘not available’).

Important note: This step is essential to assess model performance! It is not methodologically sound to simply assume that the chance level is close to 50% and that any balanced accuracy higher than that threshold is significant. Please report p-values as computed from permutations along with model performance.

Chapter 7

Display voxel and region contribution

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7.1 Introduction

Another important aspect of pattern recognition modelling when applied to neuroimaging is trying to interpret the models' parameters or weights. Some brain areas are probably more informative about class membership/regression targets than others. For example, in a visual task, we would expect discriminative information in the occipital lobe. This can be seen as *information mapping*, and it can be helpful to evaluate a specific model - if the discriminative weight of a machine is concentrated in the eyes, for example, it is important to correct the mask used in the analysis to exclude them. In the case of linear kernels, the classifier/regression weight vector is a linear combination or weighted average of the training examples, and can be plotted as an image representing a weight map. The *weight map* is therefore a spatial representation of the decision function, i.e. every voxel within the mask contributes with a certain weight to the decision function. Pattern recognition models (classifiers or regression functions) are multivariate, i.e. they take into account correlations in the data. Since the discrimination or prediction is based on the whole brain pattern, rather than on individual regions or voxels, all voxels contribute to the classification or regression and no conclusions should be drawn about a particular subset of voxels in isolation.

Starting from PRoNTo v2.0, it is possible to derive weights at the region level (as anatomically defined by an atlas, from MKL or from summarizing the weights). This window allows to display maps of voxel and of region contribution. Furthermore, the region contributions can be ranked in descending order, yielding a sorted list of regions according to their contribution to the classification/regression model. We hope this will help the interpretation of model parameters in terms of cognitive neuroscience.

Important note: The implemented version of MKL ([15]) is sparse in the kernel combination. This means that only a few regions/modalities will contribute to the model. However, this selection of regions/modalities might depend on the dataset, and small variations in the dataset (as induced by cross-validation) might lead to different subsets of regions/modalities being selected. Therefore, care should be taken when reporting selected regions/modalities and each fold should be looked at separately. We also provide a quantification of the variability across folds of the

ranking of the regions/modalities ('Expected Ranking', see further) to provide some insights on this issue.

7.2 Displaying weights

To launch the 'Display weights' window, make sure that weight maps have been computed for at least one model (Compute Weights, Chapter 5).

In the **Review Options** panel, press **Display weights**. At the 'Select PRT.mat' window, navigate to where your PRT.mat file is stored (using the left column), and select it in the right column. The display window then opens (Figure 7.1).

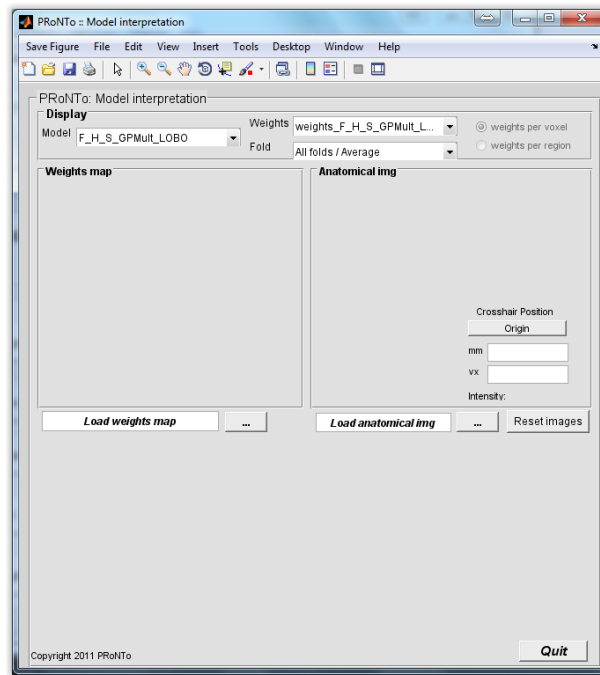


Figure 7.1: Display weights main window after selection of PRT.mat.

The window is divided into four panels; going from top left to bottom left, they are:

Display : This panel allows the user to choose which model and image to display, as well as whether to display the voxel weights or the region contributions.

Weights map : This displays three projections of the selected weight map and allows to navigate it.

Anatomical img : If an anatomical image has been loaded, this will display three projections, and the cross-hair will be synchronised with the weight map.

Additional plots : The blank area at the bottom of the window will display additional information about the model parameters, such as a sorted list of the regions according to their contribution (if weights per region were computed, in the form of a table) and a bar plot of the relative region contribution. If MKL modelling was performed based on multiple modalities, the same table and bar plot will display the relative contributions of each modality to the decision function.

7.2.1 Select image to display

The **Display** panel shows the models for which weights were computed and weight images were found in the same folder as the PRT. For each model, the list of images available is displayed

in the **Weights** pop-down list. Typically, one image will be created for a binary comparison or regression with only one modality or multiple modalities concatenated in samples (e.g. multiple runs). On the other hand, multiclass classification models will return one image per class (with the index of the class appended to the name of the image). In the same way, multiple modalities used in multiple kernels will lead to the building of *number of modalities* images. For each image, the weight map can be displayed for each fold or for their average. Starting from P_{Ro}N_{To} v2.0, it is possible to display the contributions of each voxel (**weights per voxel**) or of each region (**weights per region**, if previously computed).

Note: the weight images (per voxel and per region) are automatically detected in the list of files in the PRT folder according to the name specified in the ‘Compute weights’ step (Chapter 5). Modifying the image name afterwards or moving the images might lead to warning messages and the images will not be listed in the GUI.

To display a weight image, select a model, an image and a fold. If only weights per voxel were estimated, the window will look similar to Figure 7.2.

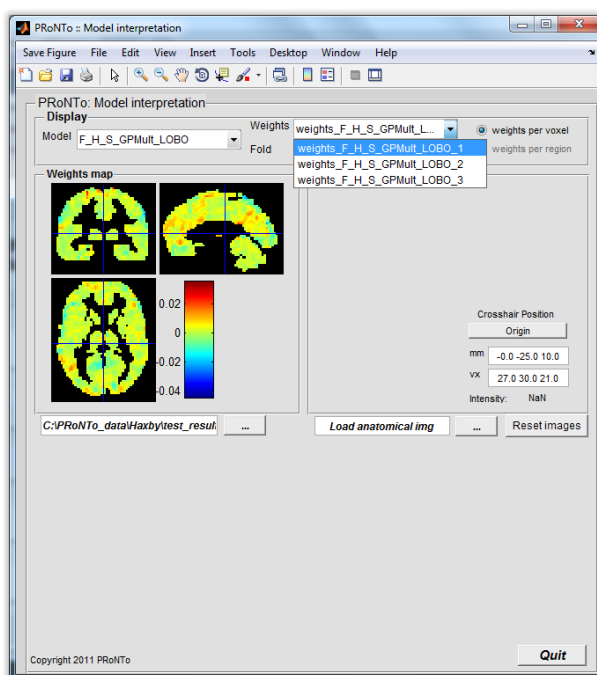


Figure 7.2: Displaying weight image for class 1 of a three-class GP model (Haxby dataset).

7.2.2 Weights map

The weight map is displayed with a cross-hair and a colorbar. The colorbar indicates the relative importance of the voxel in the decision function. This value is also indicated in the **intensity** field of the **Anatomical img** panel. Note that all voxels in the mask contribute to the decision function, since the analysis is multivariate. Contrary to common practice in Statistical Parametric Mapping, which is a mass-univariate approach, *it does not make sense to isolate part of the pattern and report only on the peaks of the distribution of the decision function’s weight map, unless they have perfectly null contribution (as might happen with sparse models such as L1-MKL modelling).*

In v2.1, the ‘browse’ ([...]) button under the edit box is disabled.

7.2.3 Anatomical image

By clicking on the [...] button next to the **Load anatomical img** field, a dialogue opens that allows you to select an anatomical images .img file that was co-registered with the data images.

In this panel, the cross-hair position is displayed in voxels and in mm. It can also be reset to the origin of the image. For each position, the corresponding voxel weight is displayed in the ‘intensity’ field.

7.2.4 Additional plots

Additional information will be displayed in two main cases:

- **Multiple Kernel Learning modelling:** MKL modelling, based on modalities or on regions as defined by an atlas, will provide weights at two levels: the kernel level and the voxel level. The kernel contributions, which sum to 1, can then be ranked in descending order.
- **Summarizing weights per region:** Starting from PRoNTo v2.0, weights can be summarized within regions of interest as defined by an atlas (user-specified). For each region, a normalized contribution can be defined, and those contributions can then be ranked in descending order. If the atlas was not selected as second-level mask at the feature set step, users might see one extra region in the ROI label column in a table labelled as ‘other’ (see 5).

In both cases, the region/modality contributions will be displayed in a table as well as in a bar plot, for each fold and for their average (according to the selected fold in the **Display** panel). An example is displayed in Figure 7.3, for weight summarization after GP modelling.

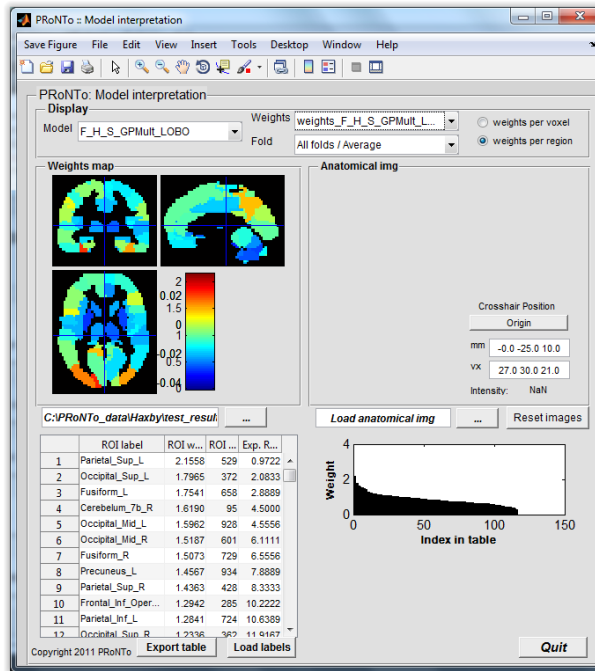


Figure 7.3: Displaying ROI contributions for class 1 of a three-class GP model (Haxby dataset).

In the case where kernels were built both at the modality and at the region level (i.e. multiple modalities with each multiple regions as defined by an atlas), two tables will be displayed (one for regions, one for modalities). The table for modalities will sum the contributions of each region within that modality.

Sorted table of region/modality contributions

The displayed table comprises one row per region and 5 columns (for an example on ROIs, as displayed in Figure 7.3):

- **Index of the ROI:** The first column displays the ranking of the region of interest in the selected fold, according to its contribution.
- **ROI Label:** When using the atlas provided in *your PProNTTo folder/atlas*, the labels of each region will be loaded automatically from a .mat, stored alongside the atlas. If using another atlas, the labels can be loaded through the ‘Load Labels’ button. In this case, the user should select a .mat comprising a cell array of size (number of regions,1), with the label for each region in the corresponding cell (in characters). The cell array should be saved under the variable name ‘ROI_names’. Otherwise, generic names will be used (e.g. ROI_1).
- **ROI weight:** The (normalized) contribution of each region is displayed in the third column (in %). The rows of the table are sorted in descending order according to this value.
- **ROI size:** This column displays the size of the ROI in voxels. This gives indications on the overlap between the atlas and the data.
- **Expected Ranking:** This measure reflects how stable the ranking of the region is across folds. It is computed from the ranking in each fold (see [17] for details), and is therefore the same, whether the user is displaying fold 1, or the average of all folds. If the Expected Ranking (ER) is close to the ranking in the selected fold, then it reflects that this region has a similar ranking across folds. On the contrary, if the ER is quite different from the ranking shown for the selected fold, this means that the ranking might be variable across folds. This variability can come from the fact that the region did not have the same contribution to slightly different datasets. It might also happen that it is not selected at all in some folds (as can happen with L1-MKL since it will not select kernels with correlated information).

When selecting a specific region label in the table, the weight map will only display colored voxel or region weights (according to which plot was selected) for this region, the rest of the image being in grey scale. This allows e.g. to look closely at the voxel weights within a region that highly contributes to the selected model and fold (Figure 7.4).

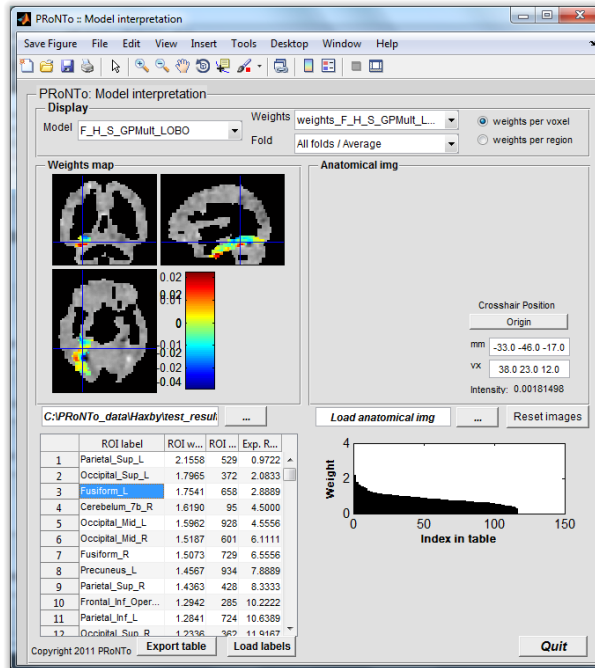


Figure 7.4: Displaying fusiform weights for binary MKL model (Haxby data).

Finally, the table can be exported as a text file using the ‘Export Table’ button.

Bar plot of contributions

The bar plot displays the third column of the table, i.e. the contribution of each ROI or modality to the decision function. The x-axis represents the index of the ROI in the table (i.e. first column of the table), in the selected fold, while the y-axis displays the contribution of each region/modality. The bar graph provides insights on how sparse or dense the region/modality contributions are.

Part II

Batch interfaces

Chapter 8

Data & Design

Specify the data and design for each group (minimum one group).

8.1 Directory

Select a directory where the PRT.mat file containing the specified design and data matrix will be written.

8.2 Groups

Add data and design for one group. Click 'new' or 'repeat' to add another group.

8.2.1 Group

Specify data and design for the group.

Name

Name of the group. Example: 'Controls'.

Select by

Depending on the type of data at hand, you may have many images (scans) per subject, such as a fMRI time series, or you may have many subjects with only one or a small number of images (scans) per subject, such as PET images. If you have many scans per subject select the option 'subjects'. If you have one scan for many subjects select the option 'scans'.

Subjects Add subjects/scans.

Subject Add new modality for this subject.

Modality Add new modality.

NAME Name of modality. Example: 'BOLD'. The names should be consistent accross subjects/groups and the same names specified in the masks.

INTERSCAN INTERVAL Specify interscan interval (TR). The units should be seconds.

SCANS Select scans (images) for this modality. They must all have the same image dimensions, orientation, voxel size etc.

DATA & DESIGN Specify data and design.

Load SPM.mat Load design from SPM.mat (if you have previously specified the experimental design with SPM).

Specify design Specify design: scans (data), onsets and durations.

Units for design The onsets of events or blocks can be specified in either scans or seconds.

Conditions Specify conditions. You are allowed to combine both event- and epoch-related responses in the same model and/or regressor. Any number of condition (event or epoch) types can be specified. Epoch and event-related responses are modeled in exactly the same way by specifying their onsets [in terms of onset times] and their durations. Events are specified with a duration of 0. If you enter a single number for the durations it will be assumed that all trials conform to this duration. For factorial designs, one can later associate these experimental conditions with the appropriate levels of experimental factors.

Condition Specify condition: name, onsets and duration.

Name Name of condition (alphanumeric strings only).

Onsets Specify a vector of onset times for this condition type.

Durations Specify the event durations. Epoch and event-related responses are modeled in exactly the same way but by specifying their different durations. Events are specified with a duration of 0. If you enter a single number for the durations it will be assumed that all trials conform to this duration. If you have multiple different durations, then the number must match the number of onset times.

Multiple conditions Select the *.mat file containing details of your multiple experimental conditions.

If you have multiple conditions then entering the details a condition at a time is very inefficient. This option can be used to load all the required information in one go. You will first need to create a *.mat file containing the relevant information.

This *.mat file must include the following cell arrays (each 1 x n): names, onsets and durations. eg. names=cell(1,5), onsets=cell(1,5), durations=cell(1,5), then names2='SSent-DSpeak', onsets2=[3 5 19 222], durations2=[0 0 0 0], contain the required details of the second condition. These cell arrays may be made available by your stimulus delivery program, eg. COGENT. The duration vectors can contain a single entry if the durations are identical for all events.

Time and Parametric effects can also be included. For time modulation include a cell array (1 x n) called tmod. It should have a single number in each cell. Unused cells may contain either a 0 or be left empty. The number specifies the order of time modulation from 0 = No Time Modulation to 6 = 6th Order Time Modulation. eg. tmod3 = 1, modulates the 3rd condition by a linear time effect.

For parametric modulation include a structure array, which is up to 1 x n in size, called pmod. n must be less than or equal to the number of cells in the names/onsets/durations cell arrays. The structure array pmod must have the fields: name, param and poly. Each of these fields is in turn a cell array to allow the inclusion of one or more parametric effects per column of the design. The field name must be a cell array containing strings. The field param is a cell array containing a vector of parameters. Remember each parameter must be the same length as its corresponding onsets vector. The field poly is a cell array (for consistency) with each cell containing a single number specifying the order of the polynomial expansion from 1 to 6.

Note that each condition is assigned its corresponding entry in the structure array (condition 1 parametric modulators are in pmod(1), condition 2 parametric modulators are in pmod(2), etc. Within a condition multiple parametric modulators are accessed via each fields cell arrays. So for condition 1, parametric modulator 1 would be defined in pmod(1).name1, pmod(1).param1, and pmod(1).poly1. A second parametric modulator for condition 1 would be defined as pmod(1).name2, pmod(1).param2 and pmod(1).poly2. If there was also a parametric modulator for condition 2, then remember the first modulator for that condition is in cell array 1: pmod(2).name1, pmod(2).param1, and pmod(2).poly1. If some, but not all conditions are parametrically modulated, then the non-modulated indices in the pmod structure can be left blank. For example, if conditions 1 and 3 but not condition 2 are modulated, then specify pmod(1) and pmod(3). Similarly, if conditions 1 and 2 are modulated but there are 3 conditions overall, it is only necessary for pmod to be a 1 x 2 structure array.

EXAMPLE:

Make an empty pmod structure:

```
pmod = struct('name','','param','','poly',);
```

Specify one parametric regressor for the first condition:

```
pmod(1).name1 = 'regressor1';
```



```

pmod(1).param1 = [1 2 4 5 6];
pmod(1).poly1 = 1;
Specify 2 parametric regressors for the second condition:
pmod(2).name1 = 'regressor2-1';
pmod(2).param1 = [1 3 5 7];
pmod(2).poly1 = 1;
pmod(2).name2 = 'regressor2-2';
pmod(2).param2 = [2 4 6 8 10];
pmod(2).poly2 = 1;

```

The parametric modulator should be mean corrected if appropriate. Unused structure entries should have all fields left empty.

No design Do not specify design. This option can be used for modalities (e.g. structural scans) that do not have an experimental design.

Scans Depending on the type of data at hand, you may have many images (scans) per subject, such as a fMRI time series, or you may have many subjects with only one or a small number of images (scans) per subject, such as PET images. Select this option if you have many subjects per modality to spatially normalise, but there is one or a small number of scans for each subject. This is a faster option with less information to specify than the 'select by subjects' option. Both options create the same 'PRT.mat' but 'select by scans' is optimised for modalities with no design.

Modality Specify modality, such as name and data.

Name Name of modality. Example: 'BOLD'. The names should be consistent accross subjects/groups and the same names specified in the masks.

Files Select scans (images) for this modality. They must all have the same image dimensions, orientation, voxel size etc.

Regression targets (per scans) Enter one regression target per scan. or enter the name of a variable. This variable should be a vector [Nscans x 1], where Nscans is the number of scans/images.

Covariates Select a .mat file containing your covariates (i.e. any other data/information you would like to include in your design). This file should contain a variable 'R' with a matrix of covariates. On covariate per image is expected.

8.3 Masks

Select first-level (pre-processing) mask for each modality. The name of the modalities should be the same as the ones entered for subjects/scans.

8.3.1 Modality

Specify name of modality and file for each mask. The name should be consistent with the names chosen for the modalities (subjects/scans).

Name

Name of modality. Example: 'BOLD'. The names should be consistent accross subjects/groups and the same names specified in the masks.

File

Select one first-level mask (image) for each modality. This mask is used to optimise the prepare data step. In 'specify model' there is an option to enter a second-level mask, which might be used to select only a few areas of the brain for subsequent analyses.

8.4 fMRI_Des

fMRI design specific parameters, HRF overlap and delay.

8.4.1 HRF overlap

If using fMRI data please specify the width of the hemodynamic response function (HRF). This will be used to calculate the overlap between events. Leave as 0 for other modalities (other than fMRI).

8.4.2 HRF delay

If using fMRI data please specify the delay of the hemodynamic response function (HRF). This will be used to calculate the overlap between events. Leave as 0 for other modalities (other than fMRI).

8.5 Review

Choose 'Yes' if you would like to review your data and design in a separate window.

Chapter 9

Feature set/Kernel

Compute feature set according to the design specified

9.1 Load PRT.mat

Select data/design structure file (PRT.mat).

9.2 Feature/kernel name

Target name for kernel matrix. This should contain only alphanumerical characters or underscores (-).

9.3 Modalities

Add modalities

9.3.1 Modality

Specify modality, such as name and data.

Modality name

Name of modality. Example: 'BOLD'. Must match design specification

Scans / Conditions

Which task conditions do you want to include in the kernel matrix? Select conditions: select specific conditions from the timeseries. All conditions: include all conditions extracted from the timeseries. All scans: include all scans for each subject. This may be used for modalities with only one scan per subject (e.g. PET), if you want to include all scans from an fMRI timeseries (assumes you have not already detrended the timeseries and extracted task components)

All scans No design specified. This option can be used for modalities (e.g. structural scans) that do not have an experimental design or for an fMRI design where you want to include all scans in the timeseries

All Conditions Include all conditions in this kernel matrix

Voxels to include

Specify which voxels from the current modality you would like to include

All voxels Use all voxels in the design mask for this modality

Specify mask file Select a mask for the selected modality.

Detrend

Type of temporal detrending to apply

None Do not detrend the data

Polynomial detrend Perform a voxel-wise polynomial detrend on the data (1 is linear detrend)

Order Enter the order for polynomial detrend (1 is linear detrend)

Discrete cosine transform Use a discrete cosine basis set to detrend the data.

Cutoff of high-pass filter (second) The default high-pass filter cutoff is 128 seconds (same as SPM)

Scale input scans

Do you want to scale the input scans to have a fixed mean (i.e. grand mean scaling)?

No scaling Do not scale the input scans

Specify from *.mat Specify a mat file containing the scaling parameters for each modality.

Use atlas to build ROI specific kernels

Select an atlas file to build one kernel per ROI. The AAL atlas (named 'aal_79x91x69.img') is available in the 'atlas' subdirectory of PRoNT

9.4 Use one kernel per modality

Select "Yes" to use one kernel per modality.

Chapter 10

Specify model

Construct model according to design specified

10.1 Load PRT.mat

Select data/design structure file (PRT.mat).

10.2 Model name

Name for model

10.3 Use kernels

Are the data for this model in the form of kernels/basis functions? If 'No' is selected, it is assumed the data are in the form of feature matrices

10.4 Feature sets

Enter the name of a feature set to include in this model. This can be kernel or a feature matrix.

10.5 Model Type

Select which kind of predictive model is to be used.

10.5.1 Classification

Specify classes and machine for classification.

Classes

Specify which elements belong to this class. Click 'new' or 'repeat' to add another class.

Class Specify which groups, modalities, subjects and conditions should be included in this class

Name Name for this class, e.g. 'controls'

Groups Add one group to this class. Click 'new' or 'repeat' to add another group.

Group Specify data and design for the group.

GROUP NAME Name of the group to include. Must exist in PRT.mat

SUBJECTS Subject numbers to be included in this class. Note that individual numbers (e.g. 1), or a range of numbers (e.g. 3:5) can be entered

CONDITIONS / SCANS Which task conditions do you want to include? Select conditions: select specific conditions from the timeseries. All conditions: include all conditions extracted from the timeseries. All scans: include all scans for each subject. This may be used for modalities with only one scan per subject (e.g. PET), if you want to include all scans from an fMRI timeseries (assumes you have not already detrended the timeseries and extracted task components)

Specify Conditions Specify the name of conditions to be included

Condition Specify condition:.

Name Name of condition to include.

All Conditions Include all conditions in this model

All scans No design specified. This option can be used for modalities (e.g. structural scans) that do not have an experimental design or for an fMRI design where you want to include all scans in the timeseries

Machine

Choose a prediction machine for this model

SVM Classification Binary support vector machine.

Optimize hyper-parameter Whether to optimize C, the SVM hyper-parameter, or not. If Yes, then provide a range of possible values for C, in the form min:step:max. Examples: 10. $\hat{[-2:5]}$ or 1:100:1000 or 0.01 0.1 1 10 100. If not, a default value will be used (C=1).

Soft-margin hyper-parameter Value(s) for prt_machine_svm_bin: soft-margin C. Examples: 10. $\hat{[-2:5]}$ or 1:100:1000 or 0.01 0.1 1 10 100.

Cross-validation type for hyper-parameter optimization Choose the type of cross-validation to be used

Leave one subject out Leave a single subject out each cross-validation iteration

k-folds CV on subjects k-partitioning of subjects at each cross-validation iteration

κ Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

Leave one subject per group out Leave out a single subject from each group at a time. Appropriate for repeated measures or paired samples designs.

k-folds CV on subjects per group K-partitioning of subjects from each group at a time. Appropriate for repeated measures or paired samples designs.

κ Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

Leave one block out Leave out a single block or event from each subject each iteration. Appropriate for single subject designs.

k-folds CV on blocks k-partitioning on blocks or events from each subject each iteration. Appropriate for single subject designs.

κ Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

Leave one run/session out Leave out a single run (modality) from each subject each iteration. Appropriate for single subject designs with multiple runs/sessions.

Gaussian Process Classification Gaussian Process Classification

Arguments Arguments for prt_machine_gpml

Multiclass GPC Multiclass GPC

Arguments Arguments for prt_machine_gpclap

L1 Multi-Kernel Learning Multi-Kernel Learning. Choose only if multiple kernels were built during the feature set construction (either multiple modalities or ROIs). It is strongly advised to "normalize" the kernels (in "operations").

Optimize hyper-parameter Whether to optimize C, the SVM hyper-parameter, or not. If Yes, then provide a range of possible values for C, in the form min:step:max. Examples: 10. $\hat{[-2:5]}$ or 1:100:1000 or 0.01 0.1 1 10 100. If not, a default value will be used (C=1).

Arguments Arguments for `prt_machine_sMKL_cla` (same as for SVM) Examples: 10. $\hat{[-2:5]}$ or 1:100:1000 or 0.01 0.1 1 10 100.

Cross-validation type for hyper-parameter optimization Choose the type of cross-validation to be used

Leave one subject out Leave a single subject out each cross-validation iteration

k-folds CV on subjects k-partitioning of subjects at each cross-validation iteration

κ Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

Leave one subject per group out Leave out a single subject from each group at a time. Appropriate for repeated measures or paired samples designs.

k-folds CV on subjects per group K-partitioning of subjects from each group at a time.

Appropriate for repeated measures or paired samples designs.

κ Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

Leave one block out Leave out a single block or event from each subject each iteration. Appropriate for single subject designs.

k-folds CV on blocks k-partitioning on blocks or events from each subject each iteration.

Appropriate for single subject designs.

κ Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

Leave one run/session out Leave out a single run (modality) from each subject each iteration. Appropriate for single subject designs with multiple runs/sessions.

Custom Load a cross-validation matrix comprising a CV variable

Custom machine Choose another prediction machine

Function Choose a function that will perform prediction.

Arguments Arguments for prediction machine.

10.5.2 Regression

Add group data and machine for regression.

Groups

Add one group to this regression model. Click 'new' or 'repeat' to add another group.

Group Specify data and design for the group.

Group name Name of the group to include. Must exist in PRT.mat

Subjects Subject numbers to be included in this class. Note that individual numbers (e.g. 1), or a range of numbers (e.g. 3:5) can be entered

Machine

Choose a prediction machine for this model

Kernel Ridge Regression Kernel Ridge Regression.

Optimize hyper-parameter Whether to optimize K, the KRR hyper-parameter, or not. If Yes, then provide a range of possible values for K, in the form min:step:max. Examples: 10.[-2:5] or 1:100:1000 or 0.01 0.1 1 10 100. If not, a default value will be used.

Regularization Regularization for `prr_machine_krr`. Examples: 10.[-2:5] or 1:100:1000 or 0.01 0.1 1 10 100.

Cross-validation type for hyper-parameter optimization Choose the type of cross-validation to be used

Leave one subject out Leave a single subject out each cross-validation iteration

k-folds CV on subjects k-partitioning of subjects at each cross-validation iteration

κ Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

Leave one subject per group out Leave out a single subject from each group at a time. Appropriate for repeated measures or paired samples designs.

k-folds CV on subjects per group K-partitioning of subjects from each group at a time. Appropriate for repeated measures or paired samples designs.

κ Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

Leave one block out Leave out a single block or event from each subject each iteration. Appropriate for single subject designs.

k-folds CV on blocks k-partitioning on blocks or events from each subject each iteration. Appropriate for single subject designs.

κ Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

Leave one run/session out Leave out a single run (modality) from each subject each iteration. Appropriate for single subject designs with multiple runs/sessions.

Custom Load a cross-validation matrix comprising a CV variable

Relevance Vector Regression Relevance Vector Regression. Tipping, Michael E.; Smola, Alex (2001).

"Sparse Bayesian Learning and the Relevance Vector Machine". Journal of Machine Learning Research 1: 211-244.

Gaussian Process Regression Gaussian Process Regression

Arguments Arguments for `prr_machine_gpr`

Multi-Kernel Regression Multi-Kernel Regression

Optimize hyper-parameter Whether to optimize C, the MKL hyper-parameter, or not. If Yes, then provide a range of possible values for C, in the form min:step:max. Examples: 10.[-2:5] or 1:100:1000 or 0.01 0.1 1 10 100. If not, a default value will be used (C=1).

Arguments Arguments for `prr_machine_sMKL_reg`

Cross-validation type for hyper-parameter optimization Choose the type of cross-validation to be used

Leave one subject out Leave a single subject out each cross-validation iteration

k-folds CV on subjects k-partitioning of subjects at each cross-validation iteration

κ Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

Leave one subject per group out Leave out a single subject from each group at a time. Appropriate for repeated measures or paired samples designs.

k-folds CV on subjects per group K-partitioning of subjects from each group at a time. Appropriate for repeated measures or paired samples designs.

κ Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

Leave one block out Leave out a single block or event from each subject each iteration. Appropriate for single subject designs.

k-folds CV on blocks k-partitioning on blocks or events from each subject each iteration. Appropriate for single subject designs.

k Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

Leave one run/session out Leave out a single run (modality) from each subject each iteration. Appropriate for single subject designs with multiple runs/sessions.

Custom Load a cross-validation matrix comprising a CV variable

Custom machine Choose another prediction machine

Function Choose a function that will perform prediction.

Arguments Arguments for prediction machine.

10.6 Cross-validation type

Choose the type of cross-validation to be used

10.6.1 Leave one subject out

Leave a single subject out each cross-validation iteration

10.6.2 k-folds CV on subjects

k-partitioning of subjects at each cross-validation iteration

k

Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

10.6.3 Leave one subject per group out

Leave out a single subject from each group at a time. Appropriate for repeated measures or paired samples designs.

10.6.4 k-folds CV on subjects per group

K-partitioning of subjects from each group at a time. Appropriate for repeated measures or paired samples designs.

k

Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

10.6.5 Leave one block out

Leave out a single block or event from each subject each iteration. Appropriate for single subject designs.

10.6.6 k-folds CV on blocks

k-partitioning on blocks or events from each subject each iteration. Appropriate for single subject designs.

k

Number of folds/partitions for CV. To create a 50

10.6.7 Leave one run/session out

Leave out a single run (modality) from each subject each iteration. Appropriate for single subject designs with multiple runs/sessions.

10.6.8 Custom

Load a cross-validation matrix comprising a CV variable

10.7 Include all scans

This option can be used to pass all the scans for each subject to the learning machine, regardless of whether they are directly involved in the classification or regression problem. For example, this can be used to estimate a GLM from the whole timeseries for each subject prior to prediction. This would allow the resulting regression coefficient images to be used as samples.

10.8 Data operations

Specify operations to apply

10.8.1 Mean centre features

Select an operation to apply.

10.8.2 Other Operations

Include other operations?

No operations

No design specified. This option can be used for modalities (e.g. structural scans) that do not have an experimental design or for an fMRI design where you want to include all scans in the timeseries

Select Operations

Add zero or more operations to be applied to the data before the prediction machine is called. These are executed within the cross-validation loop (i.e. they respect training/test independence) and will be executed in the order specified.

Operation Select an operation to apply.

Chapter 11

Run model

Trains and tests the predictive machine using the cross-validation structure specified by the model.

11.1 Load PRT.mat

Select PRT.mat (file containing data/design structure).

11.2 Model name

Name of a model. Must match your entry in the
'Specify model' batch module.

11.3 Do permutation test?

Perform a permutation test on accuracy, or not

11.3.1 No permutation test

Do not perform permutation test

11.3.2 Permutation test

Perform a permutation test.

Number of permutations

Enter the number of permutations to perform

Save permutations parameters

Set to Yes to save the parameters obtained from each permutation.

Part III

Data processing examples

Chapter 12

Block design fMRI dataset

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This chapter will describe the steps necessary to perform a classification using PRoNTTo. The dataset¹ used in this chapter can be found in PRoNTTo's website <http://www.mlnl.cs.ucl.ac.uk/pronto/prtdata.html> (data set 1) and the whole² dataset is available in <http://data.pymvpa.org/datasets/haxby2001/>.

This fMRI dataset originates from a study on face and object representation in human ventral temporal cortex [6]. In this study, the subject was shown a set of grey scale images of 8 categories (faces, houses, cats, chairs, bottles, scissors, shoes and scrambled pictures), with 12 runs/blocks. Each image was displayed for 500 ms and was followed by a 1500 ms rest interval. This experiment consisted on a block-design of 9 scans of task followed by 6 scans of inter-stimulus interval. Images were acquired with a TR of 2.5 s. The full-brain fMRI data was made up by 1452 volumes with 40 x 64 x 64 voxels, each of which with dimensions of 3.5 x 3.75 x 3.75 mm.

For simplicity, in this example we will use PRoNTTo to predict if the subject is viewing an image of a Face or a House based on the fMRI scans. We will classify the whole brain images using Support Vector Machines, and a leave one block out cross-validation scheme.

12.1 GUI analysis

We will first analyse the data using PRoNTTo's GUI and then repeat the analysis using the `matlabbatch` system.

To start, create a new directory in which to save the results of the analysis, then start up MATLAB and type 'prt' or 'pronto' in the MATLAB prompt. This will open the main interface of PRoNTTo (Figure 12.1).

¹Pre-processed (realigned and normalised) data from participant 1.

²Not pre-processed.

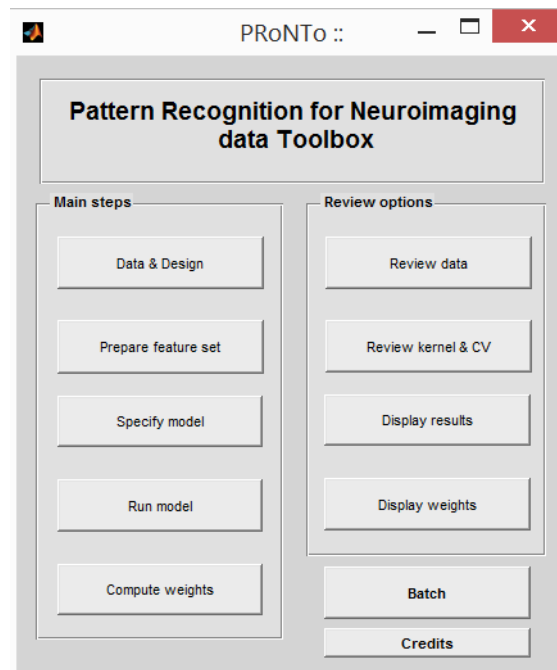


Figure 12.1: Main interface of PRoNTTo.

12.1.1 Data & Design

- In PRoNTTo's main window, click on 'Data & Design' and a new window will open, 'Data and design' (Figure 12.2). Then, browse the directory in which to save the PRT structure (saved as 'PRT.mat');

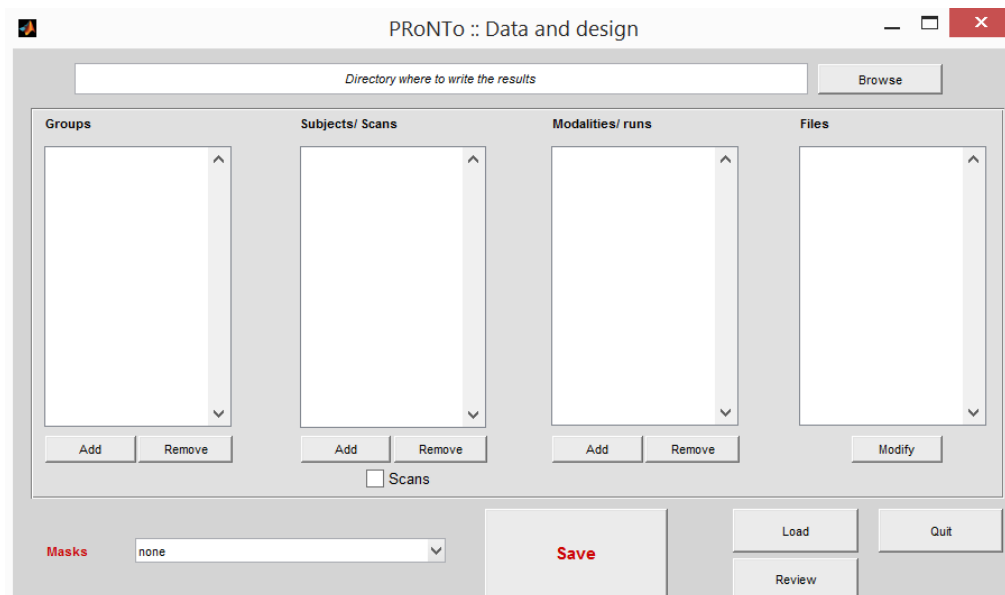


Figure 12.2: 'Data and design' GUI.

- In the panel 'Groups', click on 'Add' and provide a name to the group (we only have one group/subject), with no spaces, e.g. 'G1';
- Add a subject in the 'Subject/Scans' option, e.g. 's1', and leave the 'Scans' tick box below the panel unchecked. See Chapter 2 of the manual for more information on this option;

- In the ‘Modalities’ panel, click on ‘Add’ and provide a name to the modality, e.g. ‘fMRI’. In the ‘Design’ field, choose the option ‘Load SPM.mat’ (Figure 12.3). This file is available with the Haxby dataset on PRoNTo’s website³ inside the folder Haxby_dataset/design/;

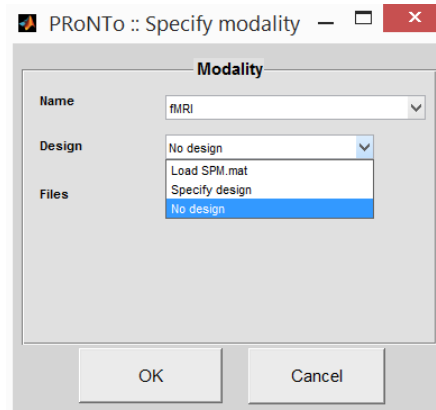


Figure 12.3: ‘Specify modality’ GUI allows one to load a specified design from an ‘SPM.mat’ file.

- In case there is no ‘SPM.mat’ file available to use, create a new design by selecting the option ‘Specify design’. Choose how many conditions you have, which in this case are 8 conditions (corresponding to the 8 categories of images). This will open another window that allows the user to write the names, onsets and durations (if the duration is the same for all events only one value is required) of each condition (Figure 12.4). The unit in which the onsets/durations are read in this case is ‘scans’ and the interscan interval (TR) is 2.5 seconds. The design information (names, onsets and durations) can be found inside the ‘Haxby_design.pdf’ file in the Haxby dataset folder.

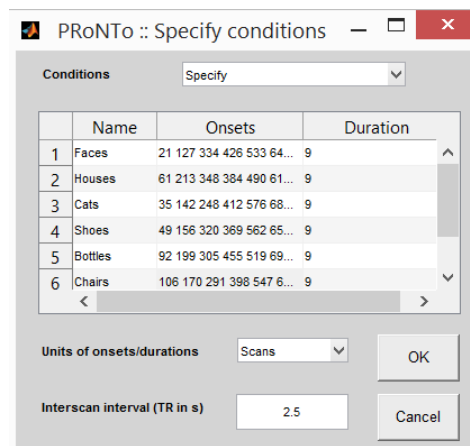


Figure 12.4: ‘Specify design’ GUI to enter the conditions, the units of design, TR and covariates.

- Finally, load all the image files available in the fMRI directory (Haxby_dataset/fMRI/). You can select all the files by using the right mouse button and clicking on the option ‘Select All’ (Figure 12.5). When all the images are selected, click on the ‘Done’ button;
- In the ‘Masks’ field, on the bottom left of the ‘Data and design’ window, select the ‘whole_brain’ mask for the modality specified (Figure 12.6). The mask is available in the masks directory inside the folder Haxby_dataset/masks/;

³<http://www.mhl.cs.ucl.ac.uk/pronto/prtdata.html>

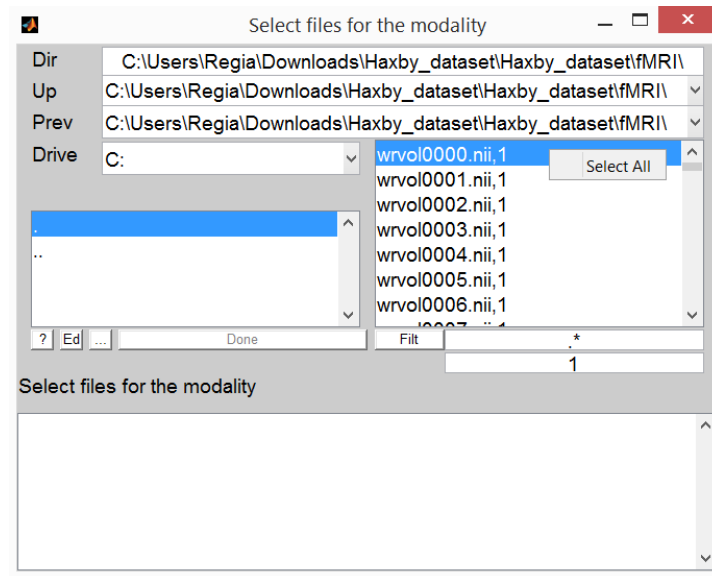


Figure 12.5: ‘Files’ field is used to select the scans/images for the selected subject.

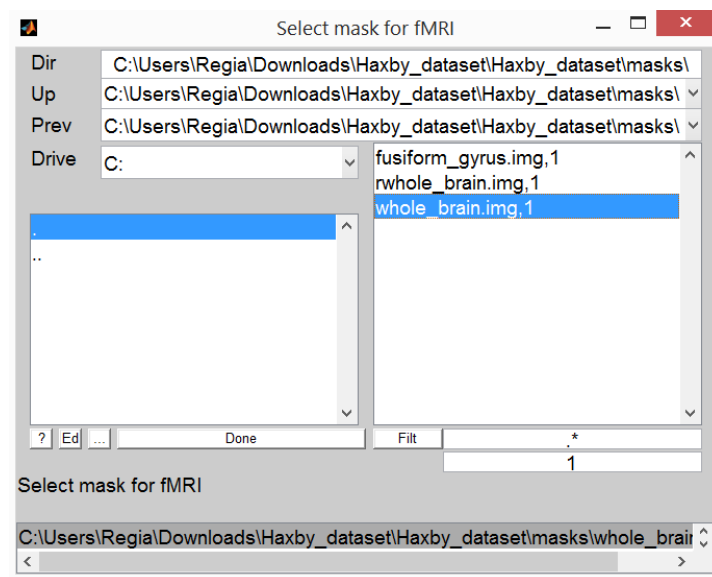


Figure 12.6: This window is called when one clicks ‘Masks’.

- Click on ‘Review’ button to check the data and the design inserted in this modality (Figure 12.7). For more information on what one can do with the Review option please see Chapter 2;
- The ‘Data and design’ window should look similar to the Figure 12.8. Click on ‘Save’ button to create ‘PRT.mat’ file with the structure containing the information that has been previously specified. If no errors are shown in the MATLAB command window, leave the ‘Data and design’ window by clicking ‘Quit’.

12.1.2 Prepare feature set

- In PRoNTTo’s main window, click on ‘Prepare feature set’ and a new window will open, ‘Prepare feature set’ (Figure 12.9);
- Select the ‘PRT.mat’ file previously created in the ‘Data & Design’ step and another window

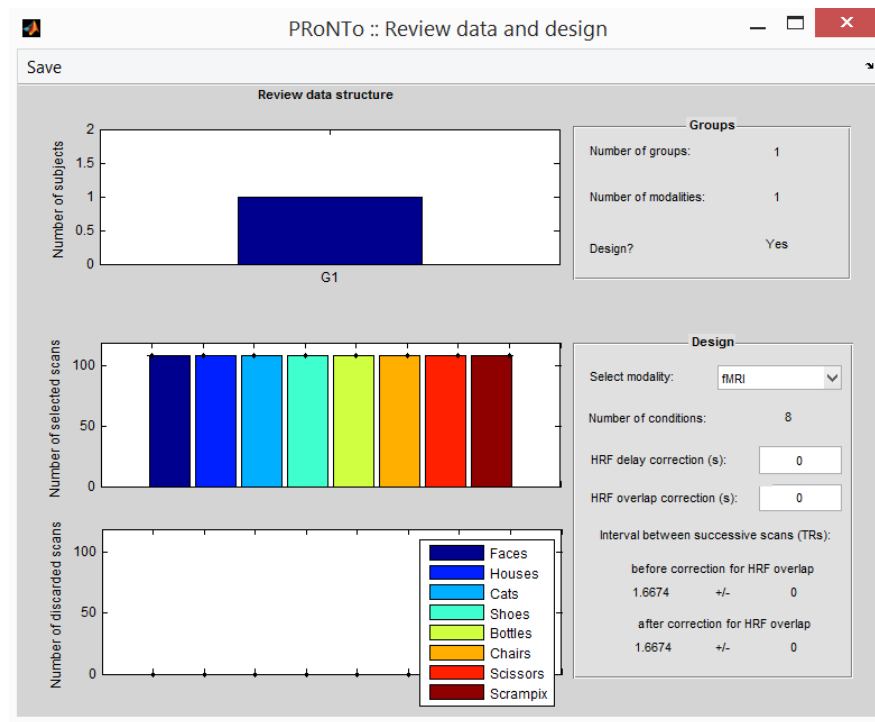


Figure 12.7: 'Review' GUI allows the user to check the data and design.

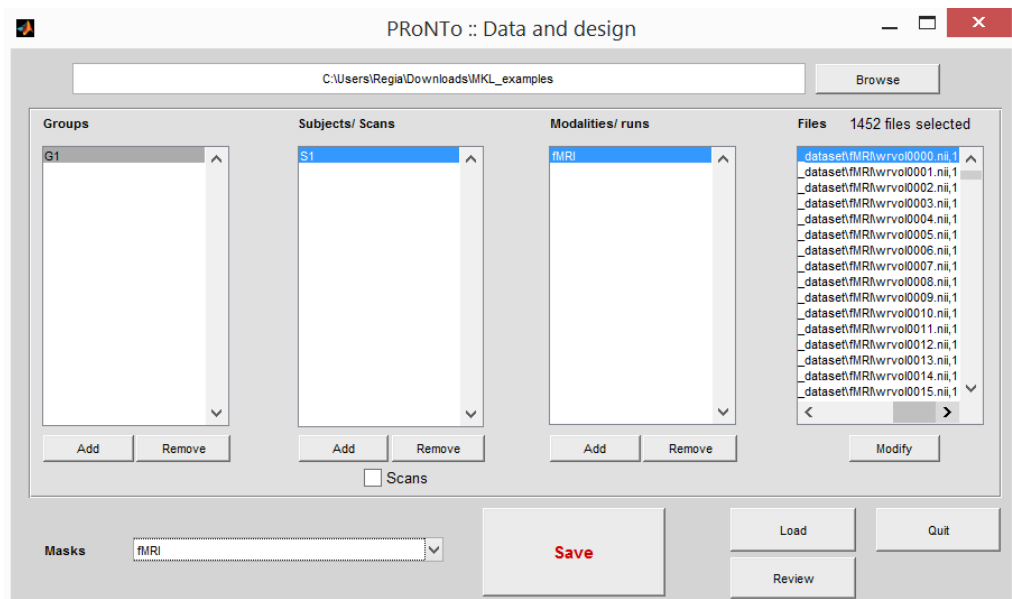


Figure 12.8: 'Data and design' GUI final configuration.

will open, 'Specify modality to include' (Figure 15.4), to set the specification of different parameters and options for each modality, which are:

- 'Modality' field: select the modality previously specified in the 'Data & Design' step, 'fMRI';
- 'Conditions' field: select 'All scans';
- Parameters box: select the polynomial detrend with order 1 and the 'No scaling' option;

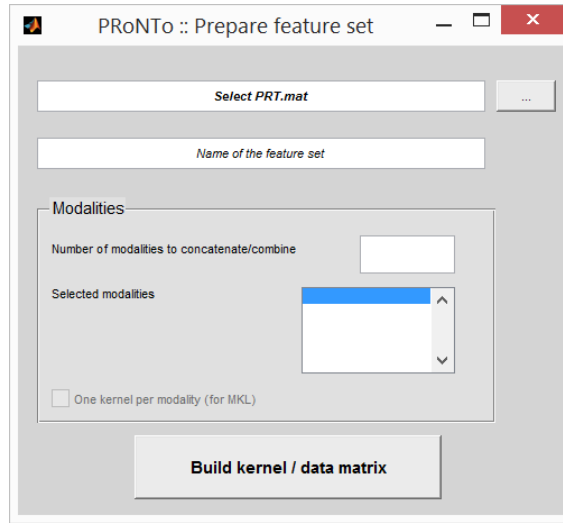


Figure 12.9: ‘Prepare feature set’ GUI.

- Features box: leave the additional mask field as it is and the ‘build one kernel per region’ tick box unchecked. Then, click on the ‘Done’ button.
- * As an optional step, in the ‘Additional mask for selected modality’ field, the user can specify a ‘second-level’ mask, which can be used to select regions of interest (ROIs) on which the classification can be performed. For instance, we can enter the ‘fusiform_gyrus’ mask available with this dataset;

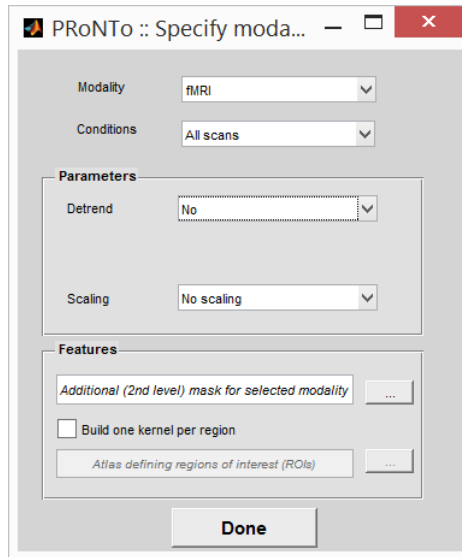


Figure 12.10: ‘Specify modality to include’ GUI.

- In the ‘Prepare feature set’ window, provide a name for the feature set, e.g. ‘HaxbyFeatures’;
- Click on ‘Build kernel/data matrix’ to build the feature set and kernel (Figure 12.11). It takes a few minutes.

12.1.3 Specify model

- In PRoNTTo’s main window, click on ‘Specify model’ and a new window will open, ‘Specify model’ (Figure 12.12);

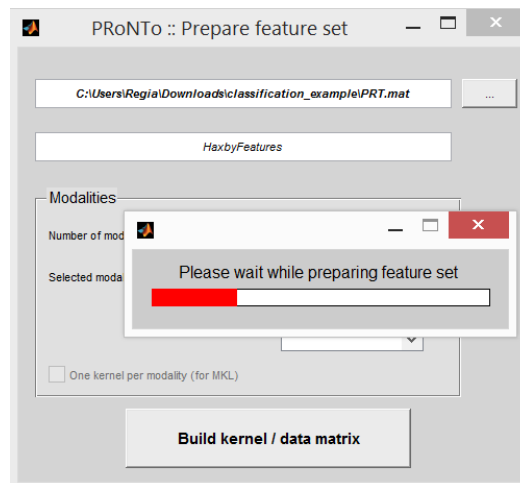


Figure 12.11: Preparing feature set.

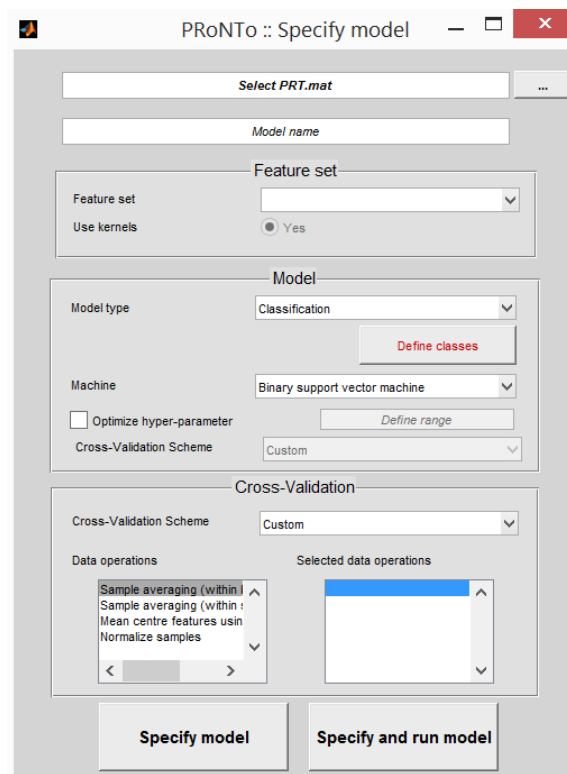


Figure 12.12: ‘Specify Model’ GUI.

- Select the ‘PRT.mat’ file and provide a name to the model, e.g. ‘svmFacesHouses’;
- Select one of the ‘Feature Set’ previously defined. In this case, there is only one ‘HaxbyFeatures’;
- Leave the option ‘Use kernels’ tick box as it is, i.e. ‘Yes’;
- Select the ‘Classification’ model type and click on ‘Define classes’ button. A new window will open, ‘Specify classes’ (Figure 12.13), to define the number of classes and a name for each class. We will define 2 classes. For ‘Class 1’ select subject ‘S1’ and the condition ‘Faces’ and, similarly, for ‘Class 2’ select subject ‘S1’ and the condition ‘Houses’. Click on ‘Done’;

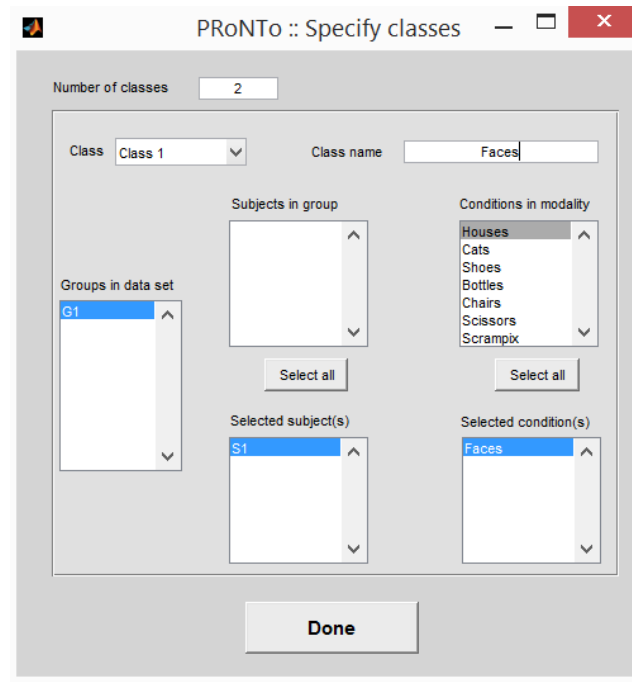


Figure 12.13: ‘Specify classes’ GUI.

- Select the ‘Binary support vector machine’ option, in the ‘Machine’ field;
- Leave the option ‘Optimize hyper-parameter’ tick box unchecked and ‘Cross-Validation Scheme’ (internal loop) as it is;
- Select the ‘Leave One Block Out’ cross-validation scheme (external loop);
- In the ‘Data operations’ box, select the ‘Sample averaging (within block)’ option, which corresponds to a temporal compression of the data within each block, and ‘Mean centre features using training data’ option. Then, the ‘Specify model’ window should look similar to Figure 16.5;
- Click on ‘Specify and run model’ and the model will be immediately estimated, therefore there is no need to use the ‘Run model’ module in this case;
- If you do not wish to average the scans within each block (i.e. to do temporal compression), go back to the ‘Specify model’ window, give another name to the model and select the same options mentioned above, except in the data operations part. Here, choose only the ‘Mean centre features using training data’ option. Finish by clicking on the ‘Specify and run model’ button.

12.1.4 Display model (optional step)

- To review the model specification, in the main PRoNTo GUI, click on ‘Review kernel & CV’ and a new window will open, ‘Review Model Specification’ (Figure 12.15);
- Select the model, ‘svmFacesHouses’, from the list at the top and click on ‘Review model’; then, select one class from the list of ‘Class’ to see which groups, subjects and conditions this class comprises (Figure 12.16);
- To review the data and cross-validation matrix click on ‘Review CV’ (Figure 12.17). For more information on what these matrices mean, please consult the previous chapters of the manual;
- To review the kernel, click on ‘Show kernel’ (Figure 12.18).

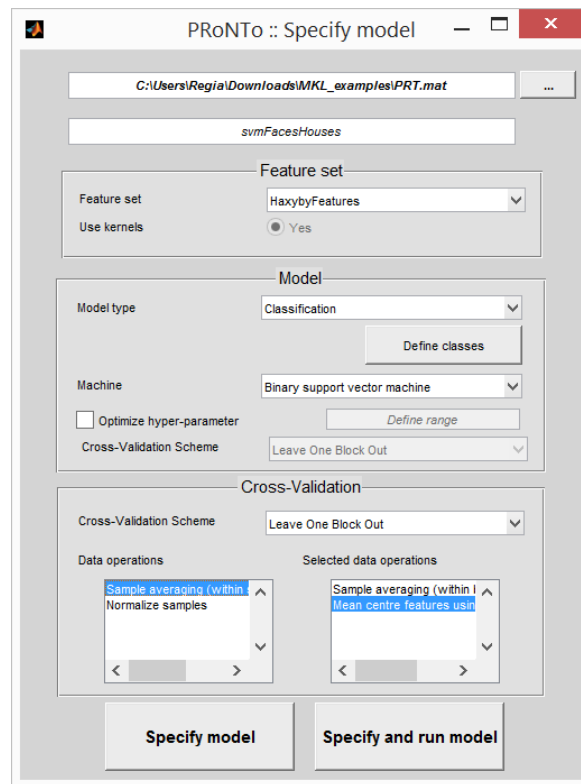


Figure 12.14: 'Specify model' GUI final configuration.

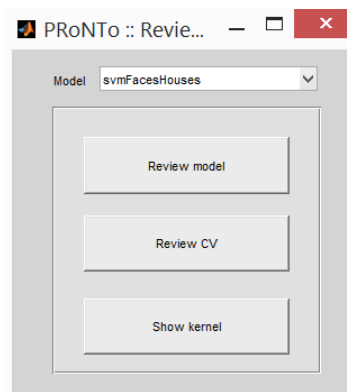


Figure 12.15: Review CV & kernel window.

12.1.5 Compute weights (optional step)

- In PRoNTTo's main window, click on 'Compute weights' and a new window will open, 'Compute weights' (Figure 12.19);
- Select the 'PRT.mat' file;
- Select the model from the list to 'Models computed in PRT', 'svmFacesHouses' model;
- Leave the option 'Compute average/kernel weight per region' tick box unchecked;
- Click on 'Compute weights' button. Computations will be displayed on the MATLAB command window.

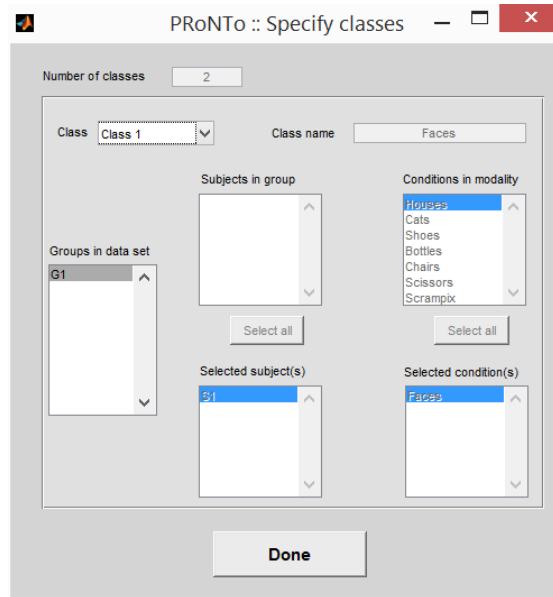


Figure 12.16: Review model specification window to Class 1.

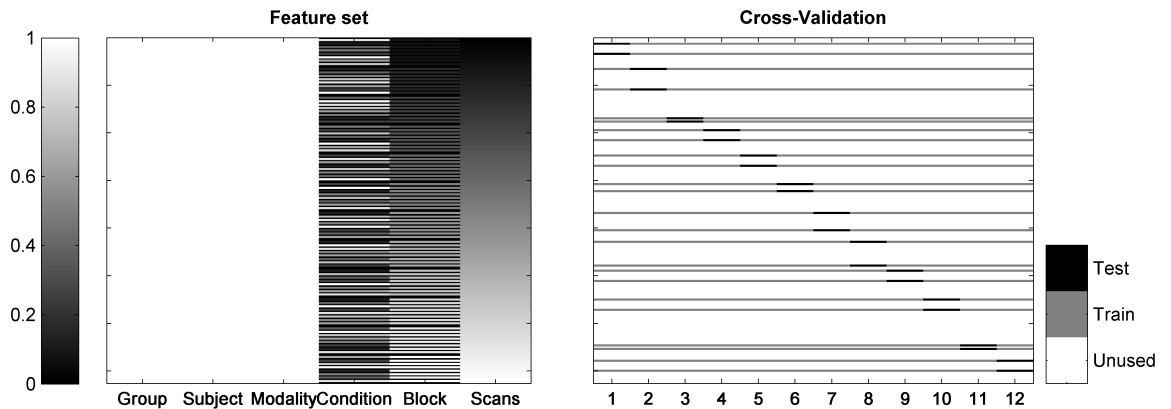


Figure 12.17: Data and cross-validation matrix from ‘Review CV’ option.

12.1.6 Display results

- In PRoNTTo’s main window, click on ‘Display results’ and select the ‘PRT.mat’ file. This will open the main results window (Figure 15.7);
- In the ‘Model’ panel, select the model that you want to view, ‘svmFacesHouses’. The performance should be similar to the one in Figure 12.21;
- In the ‘Results’ window, one can select a different plot in the ‘Plots’ list;
- Finally, to check the significance of the results, run a permutation test by clicking on ‘Permutation test’ button with 100 repetitions. Results will be displayed on the MATLAB prompt (Figure 12.22). Please note that 100 repetitions is a small amount, if possible, this should be greater (e.g. 1000).

12.1.7 Display weights

- In PRoNTTo’s main window, click on ‘Display weights’ and select the ‘PRT.mat’ file. This will open the ‘Model interpretation’ window (Figure 12.23);

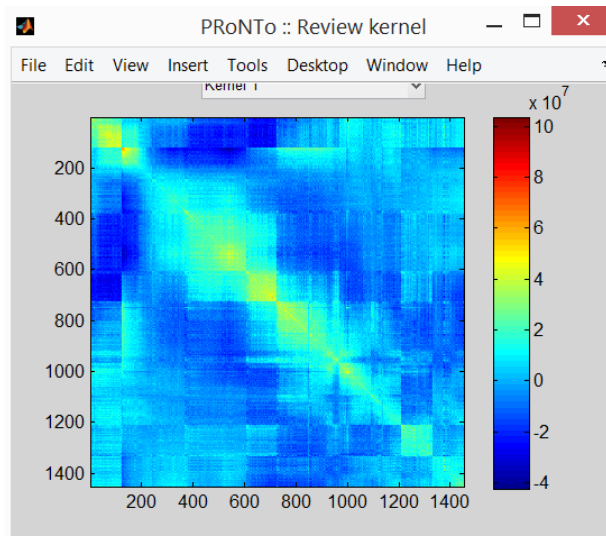


Figure 12.18: Kernel matrix used for classification.

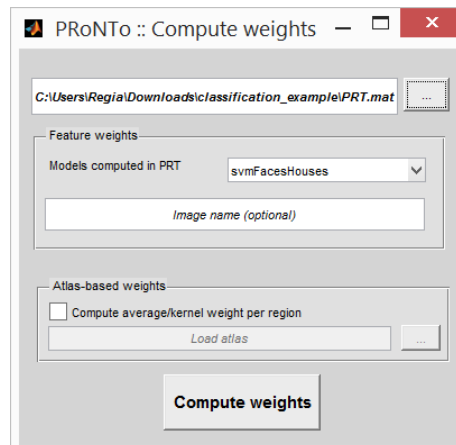


Figure 12.19: 'Compute weights' GUI.

- By clicking on 'Model', svmFacesHouses, an image will appear in the 'Weights map' box; and to show the 'Anatomical img' you have to load an anatomical image for reference. A template image can be found in SPM's canonical folder ('single_subj_T1' file). The final window will look similar to the one shown in the Figure 12.24.

12.2 Batch analysis

This tutorial will now show how to analyse the same data but using the `matlabbatch` system.

Once again, create a new directory where you wish to save the results. On the main interface of PRoNTo click on the 'Batch' button to open the 'matlabbatch'. Alternatively, type 'prt_batch' on the MATLAB command window. On the menu bar of the batch, there is a PRoNTo menu with the 5 options shown in the main steps interface (Figure 12.25).

12.2.1 Data & Design

- Click on 'Data & Design' in the PRoNTo menu (Figure 12.26);
- In the 'Directory' field, select a directory where the 'PRT.mat' file will be saved. There are three ways of editing all fields in `matlabbatch`: (i) by using the right mouse button

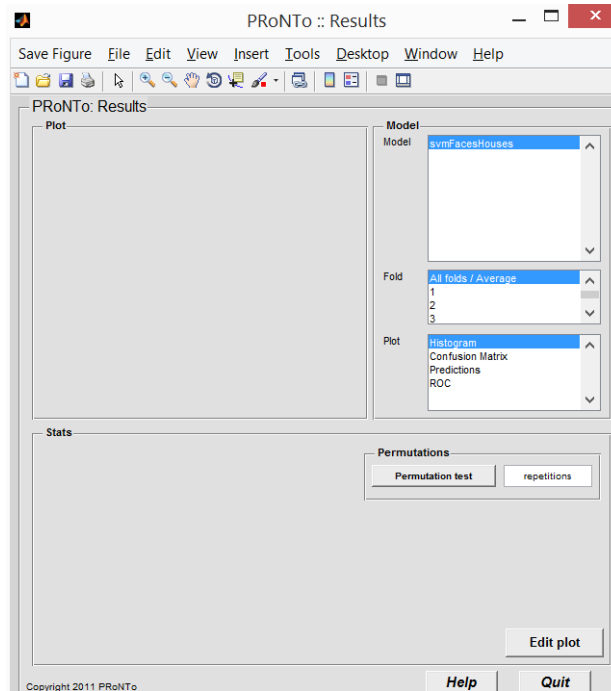


Figure 12.20: ‘Results’ GUI.

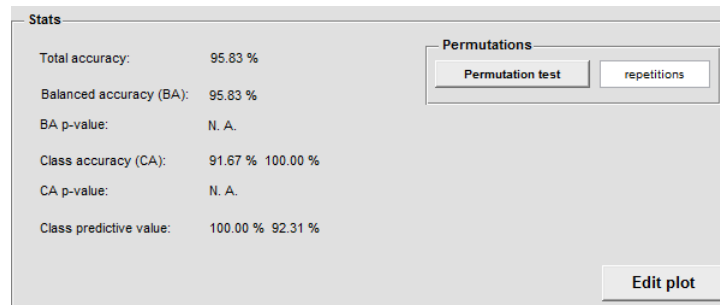


Figure 12.21: Summary for model's performance.

and clicking on the current option, (ii) clicking on current button in the window or (iii) by double clicking;

- In the ‘Groups’ field:

- Add one group;
- In the field ‘Name’, provide a name without spaces to that group, e.g. ‘G1’;
- In the field ‘Select by’, select the ‘Subjects’ option and add one subject;
- Add one modality for this subject and provide a name, e.g. ‘fMRI’; define the interscan interval of 2.5 seconds; and in the field ‘Scans’, select all the image files available in the fMRI directory of the Haxby dataset;
- In the ‘Data & Design’ field, choose ‘Load SPM.mat’ option. This file is available with the Haxby dataset on PRoNTTo’s website⁴ inside the folder Haxby_dataset/design/. The batch editor should look similar to the one in Figure 12.27;

* In case there is no ‘SPM.mat’ file available to use, create a new design by selecting the option ‘Specify design’. Choose how many conditions you have, which in this case are 8 conditions (corresponding to the 8 categories of images). The unit

⁴<http://www.mhl.cs.ucl.ac.uk/pronto/prtdata.html>

```

Command Window
Total nSV = 19
.....*.....*
optimization finished, #iter = 336
nu = 0.000000
obj = -0.000003, rho = 0.016512
nSV = 19, nBSV = 0
Total nSV = 19
.....*.....*
optimization finished, #iter = 238
nu = 0.000000
obj = -0.000003, rho = -0.150821
nSV = 18, nBSV = 0
Total nSV = 18
.....*.....*
optimization finished, #iter = 310
nu = 0.000000
obj = -0.000003, rho = -0.029135
nSV = 19, nBSV = 0
Total nSV = 19
.....*.....*
optimization finished, #iter = 290
nu = 0.000000
obj = -0.000003, rho = 0.038576
nSV = 18, nBSV = 0
Total nSV = 18
fx >> |
<

```

Figure 12.22: Sample of the MATLAB window after the permutation test (100 repetitions).

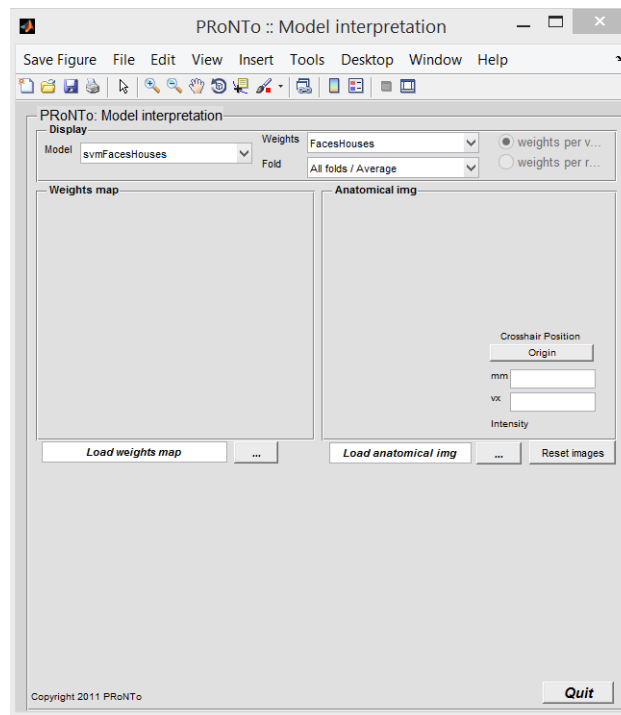


Figure 12.23: ‘Model interpretation’ GUI.

in which the onsets/durations are read is ‘Scans’. Write the names, onsets and durations of each condition (Figure 12.28);

- In the ‘Masks’ field, add a new modality and provide the same modality name, ‘fMRI’; and select the ‘whole.brain’ mask available in the masks directory of the Haxby dataset. The name of the modality here has to be exactly the same as in ‘Modalities’, otherwise it will not work;

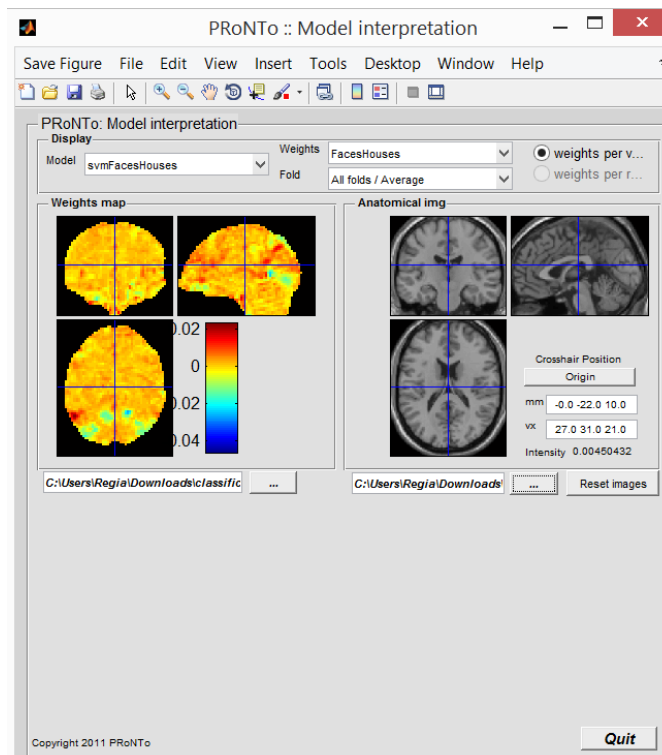
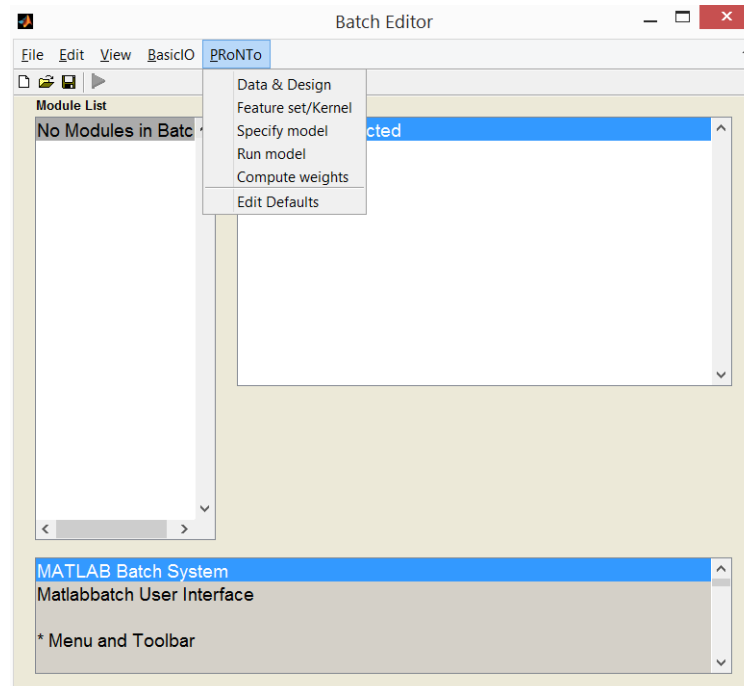
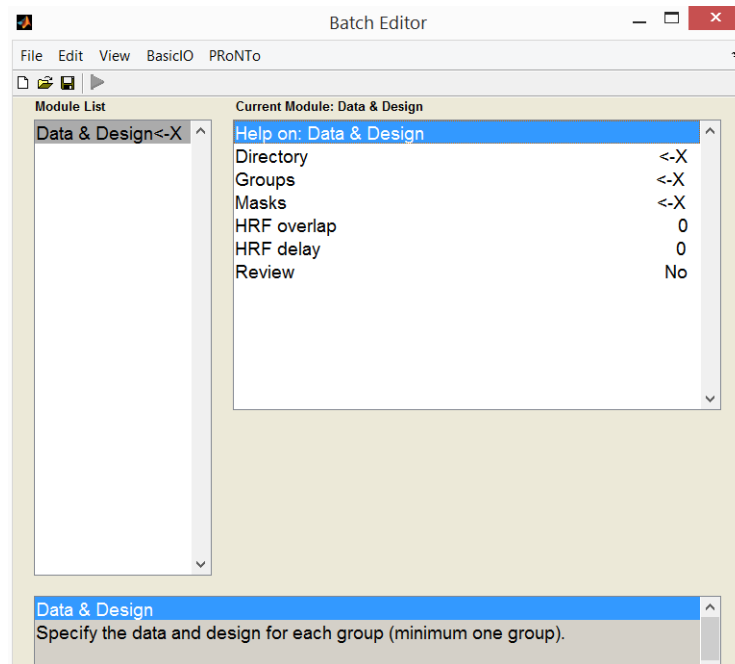
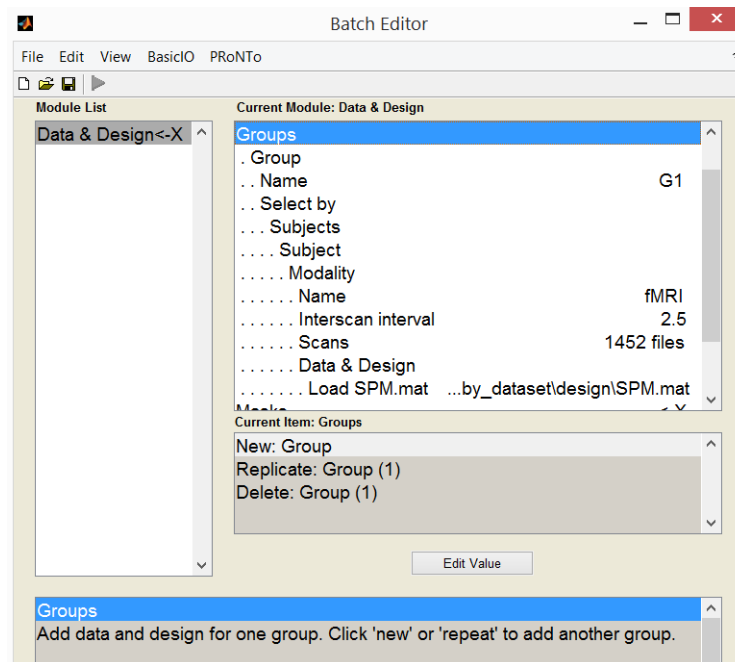


Figure 12.24: ‘Model interpretation’ GUI with results.

Figure 12.25: Menu PRoNTTo in the main `matlabbatch` window.

- Leave the ‘HRF overlap’ and the ‘HRF delay’ fields as default;
- In the ‘Review’ field, select ‘Yes’ if you would like to review your data and design in a separate window. Otherwise, leave as it is, i.e. ‘No’.

Figure 12.26: Data and design module in `matlabbatch`.Figure 12.27: Data and design module in `matlabbatch`.

12.2.2 Feature set / Kernel

- Click on 'Feature set / Kernel' option on PRoNTTo's `matlabbatch` menu (Figure 12.29);
- With 'Load PRT.mat' field selected, click on the 'Dependency' button to associate the 'PRT.mat' file created in the previous 'Data & Design' step (Figure 12.30) or click on the 'Select files' button to browse where 'PRT.mat' file was saved;
- Provide a name to the 'Feature/kernel' set, e.g. 'HaxbyFeatures';

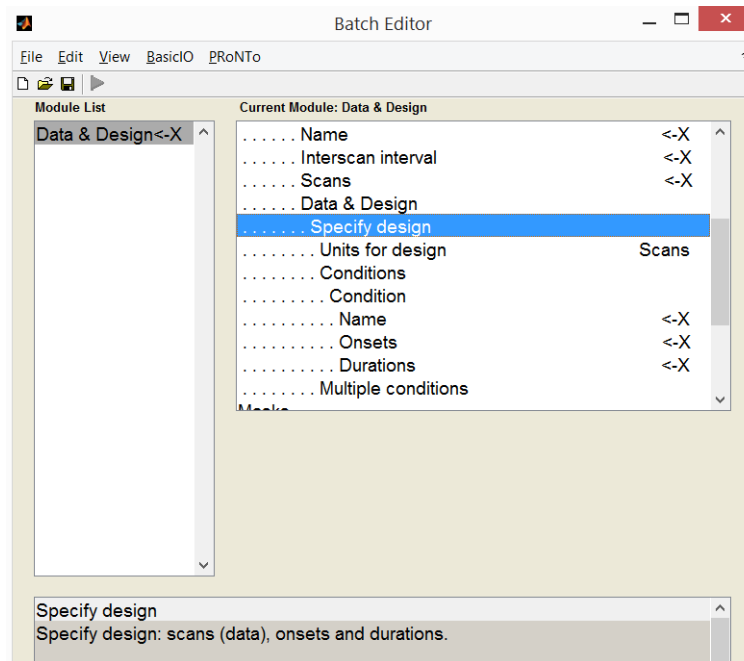
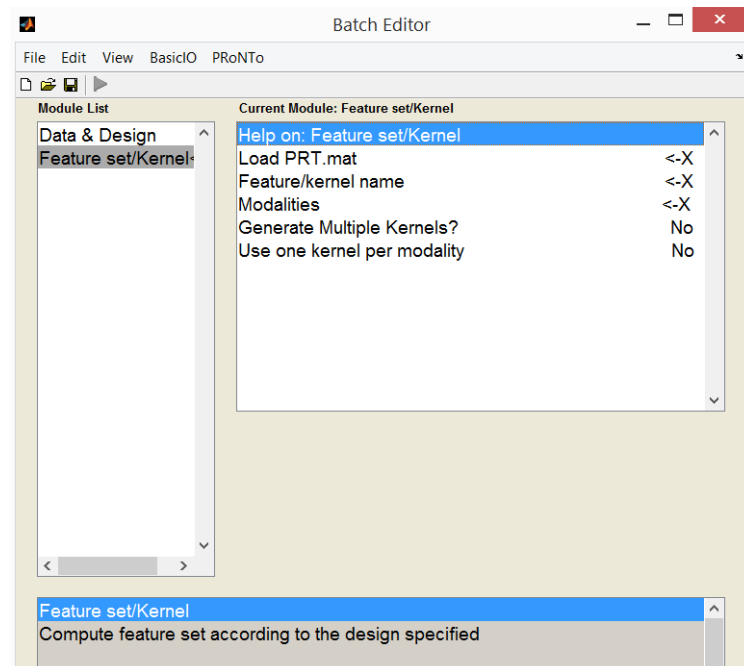


Figure 12.28: Data and design module. The ‘Specify design’ option.

Figure 12.29: Feature set/Kernel module in `matlabbatch`.

- Add one modality and select the modality name with the ‘Dependency’ button⁵(Data & Design:Mod#1 name);
 - In the ‘Scans/Conditions’ field , select the ‘All scans’ option;
 - In the ‘Voxels to include’ field, select ‘All voxels’ option, this means we are not entering an additional second-level mask;

⁵Or type it in manually, ‘fMRI’, but the name needs to be *exactly* the same as the one specified in the ‘Data & Design’ module.

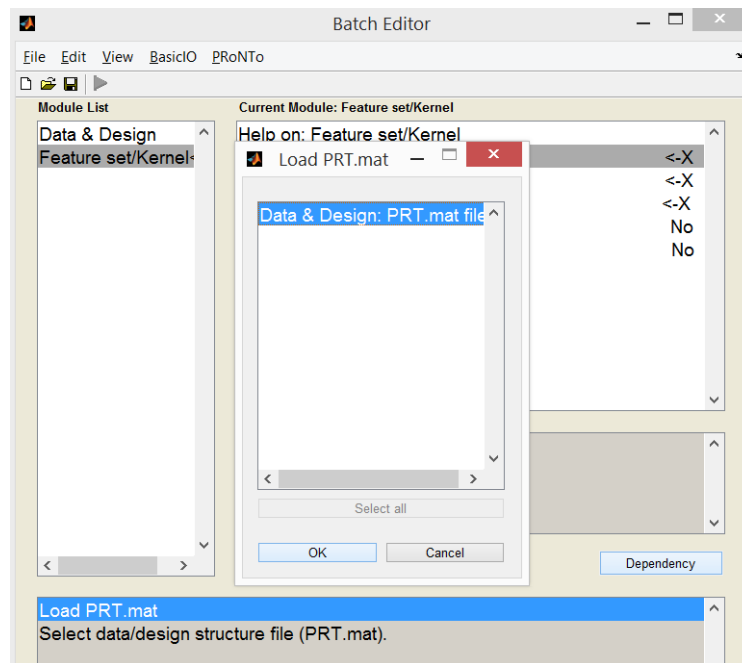


Figure 12.30: Feature set / Kernel module in `matlabbatch`. This window is called to establish a dependency connection with the previous ‘Data and design’ module.

- * This is an optional step. In the ‘Voxels to include’ options, the user can specify a ‘second-level’ mask, which would define regions of interest (ROIs) on which the classification can be performed. In this case, select the ‘fusiform_gyrus’ mask;
- In the ‘Detrend’ field, select ‘Polynomial detrend’ option with order 1;
- In the ‘Scale input scans’ field, select ‘No scaling’ option;
- Leave ‘Load Atlas’ as default. After all these steps, the batch editor should look similar to the one in Figure 12.31;
- Leave the ‘Generate Multiple Kernels’ and the ‘Use one kernel per modality’ fields as default.

12.2.3 Specify model

- Click on ‘Specify model’ option on PRoNTTo’s `matlabbatch` menu (Figure 12.32);
- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Feature set / Kernel’ step (Figure 12.33) or click on ‘Select files’ button to browse where ‘PRT.mat’ file was saved;
- Provide a name to the model, e.g. ‘svmFacesHouses’;
- Leave the ‘Use kernels’ field as it is, i.e. ‘Yes’;
- In the ‘Feature sets’ field, select the feature set name with the ‘Dependency’ button⁶;
- Select the ‘Classification’ model type:
 - Add 2 new classes;
 - For Class (1) write ‘Faces’ on the name field and add one group. Select the group name from the ‘Data & Design’ module (‘Data & Design:Group#1 name’) with the ‘Dependency’ button⁷. Similarly, for Class (2) write ‘Houses’ on the name field and add the group created in the ‘Data & Design’ module, ‘G1’;

⁶or write it *exactly* as previously defined in the ‘Feature set / Kernel’ module (option ‘Feature set/Kernel: Feature/kernel name’), here ‘HaxbyFeatures’.

⁷Or write it *exactly*, as previously defined in the Data & Design’ module, here ‘G1’

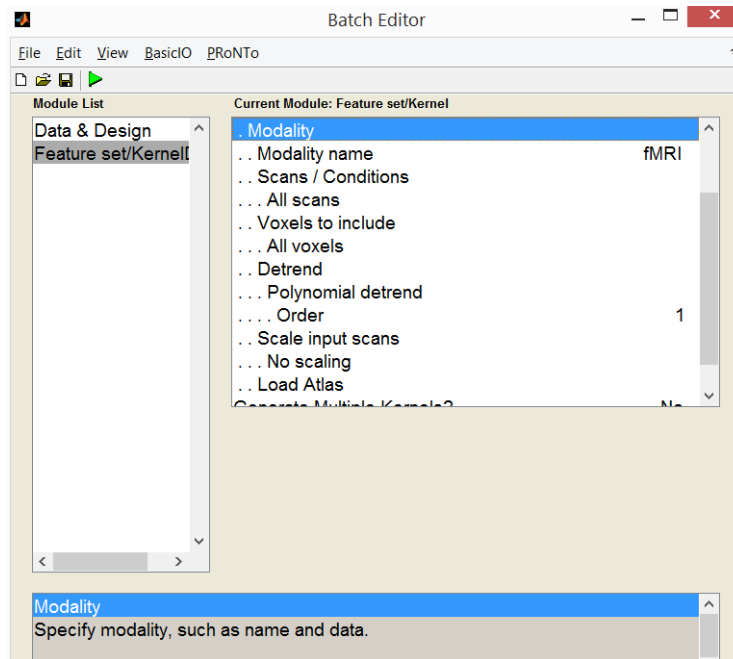


Figure 12.31: Feature set / Kernel module. Selected parameters in the Modality option.

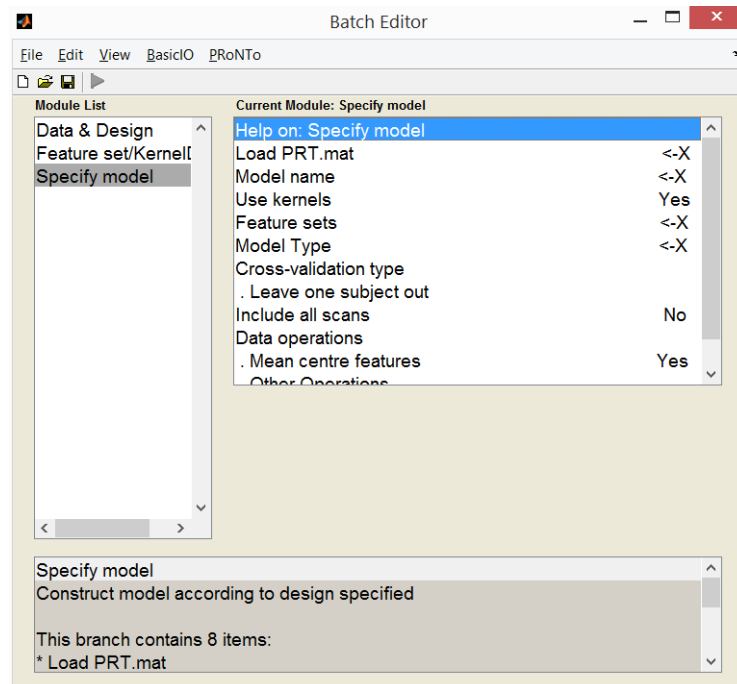


Figure 12.32: Specify model module in `matlabbatch`.

- In the 'Subjects' field, type '1' (only subject 1 is selected);
- In the 'Conditions / Scans' field, select the 'Specify Conditions' option and add a new condition. Provide a name for this condition, i.e. for Class (1) 'Faces' and for Class (2) 'Houses'. Note that this name needs to be spelled exactly as specified in the 'Data & Design' module: if you simply loaded an 'SPM.mat' file for the design, you *must* know the names of the conditions;
- After all this steps, the batch editor should look similar to the one in Figure 12.34

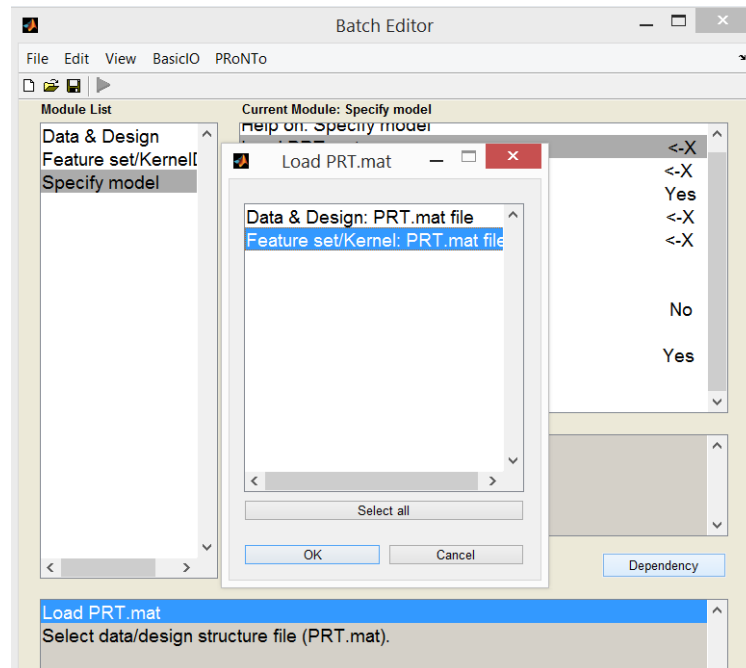


Figure 12.33: Specify model module in `matlabbatch`. This window is called to establish a dependency connection with the previous ‘Feature set / Kernel’ module.

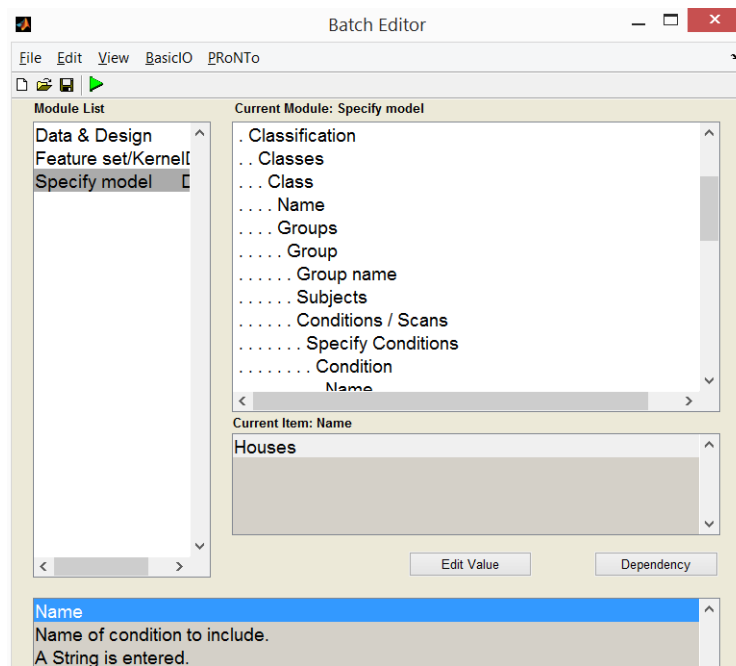


Figure 12.34: Specify model module. Selected parameters in the Class option.

- In the ‘Machine’ field:
 - Select the ‘SVM Classification’ option;
 - Leave the ‘Optimize hyper-parameter’ field as it is, i.e. ‘No’;
 - Leave the ‘Soft-margin hyper-parameter’ field as it is, i.e. ‘1’;
 - Leave the ‘Cross validation type for hyper-parameter optimization’ field as it is, i.e. ‘Leave one subject out’;

- In the ‘Cross-validation type’ field, select ‘Leave one block out’ option;
- Leave the ‘Include all scans’ field as it is, i.e. ‘No’;
- In the ‘Data operations’ field:
 - Leave the ‘Mean centre features’ field as it is, i.e. ‘Yes’;
 - Leave the ‘Other Operations’ field as it is, i.e. ‘No operations’;

12.2.4 Run model

- Click on the ‘Run model’ option on PRoNTTo’s `matlabbatch` menu (Figure 12.35);

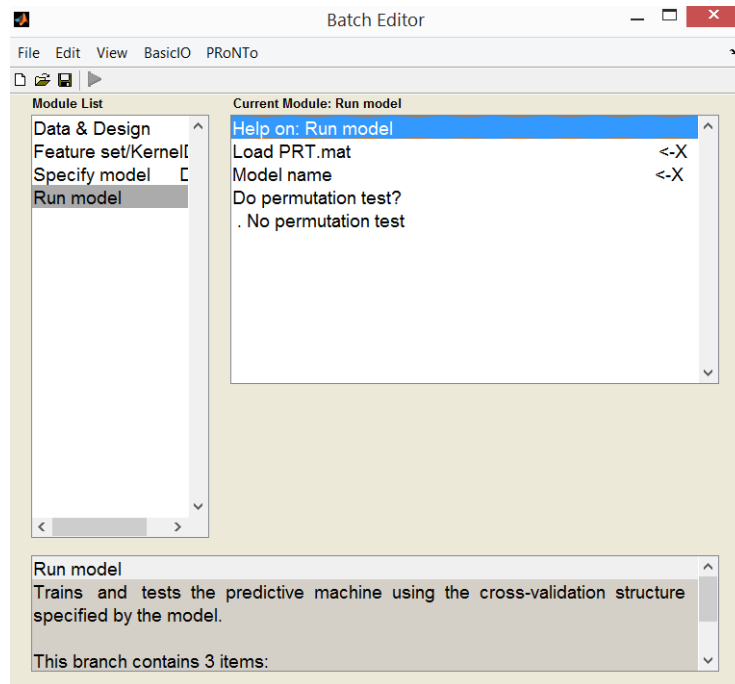


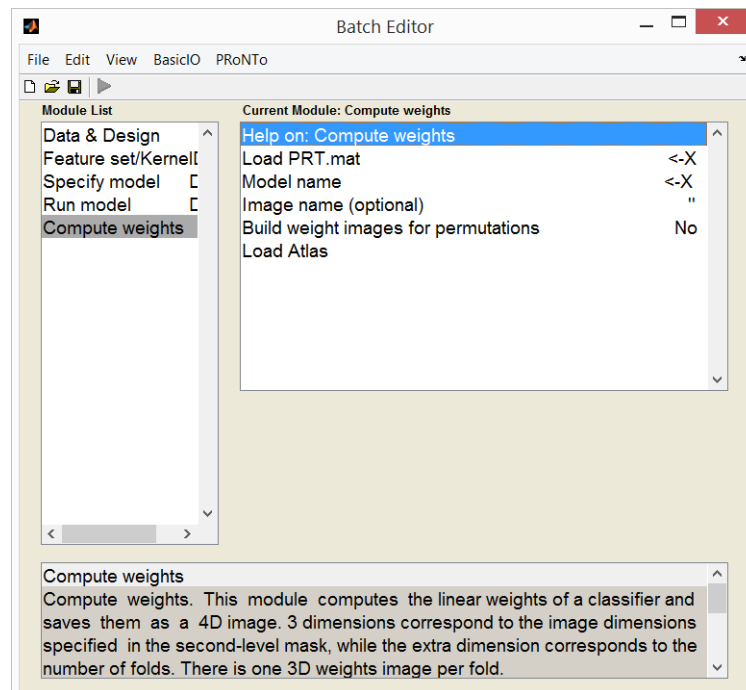
Figure 12.35: Run model module in `matlabbatch`.

- With the ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Specify model’ step;
- Select the model name from the ‘Specify model’ module with the ‘Dependency’ button⁸;
- In the field ‘Do permutation test?’, select ‘yes’ with 100 repetitions or leave as default (1000 repetitions).

12.2.5 Compute weights (optional step)

- Click on the ‘Compute weights’ option on PRoNTTo’s `matlabbatch` menu (Figure 12.36);
- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Run model’ step;
- Select the model name from the ‘Specify model’ module with the ‘Dependency’ button;
- It’s optional to define a name for the image;
- Leave the ‘Build weights images for permutations’ field as it is, i.e. ‘No’;

⁸Or write it *exactly*, as previously defined in the ‘Specify model’ module, here ‘svmFacesHouses’

Figure 12.36: Compute weights module in `matlabbatch`.

- Leave the 'Load Atlas' field as default.

Finally, save the batch (e.g. as `batch_run_all.m`) and click on the 'Run Batch' option, in the 'File menu'. The batch file created can then be opened and edited for further analyses. The results will be the same as those obtained using the GUI (see Section 12.1.6 of this chapter). Please note that in this case the 'Sample averaging (within block)' operation was not selected when specifying the model. In order to obtain the same results as before, the model has to use the same data operations.

Chapter 13

Regression dataset

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This chapter will describe the steps necessary to perform a regression using PRoNTTo. These are similar to the ones in the previous chapter, thus, the reader is advised to complete the tutorial in Chapter 12 before moving on, since the explanation of some steps will be less descriptive. The dataset used in this chapter can be found on PRoNTTo's website <http://www.mlnl.cs.ucl.ac.uk/pronto/prtdata.html> (data set 3).

13.1 GUI analysis

As in Chapter 12, the analysis of the data will start with the PRoNTTo's GUI. Please create a folder in your computer to store the results and type 'prt' or 'pronto' on the MATLAB command window. This will open the main interface of PRoNTTo (see Figure 12.1 in the previous chapter).

13.1.1 Data & Design

- In PRoNTTo's main window, click on 'Data & Design'. Like in the previous chapter, browse the directory in which to save the PRT structure (saved as 'PRT.mat');
- In the panel 'Groups', click on 'Add' and provide a name to the group, e.g. 'Aged';
- Unlike the previous chapter, all the images in the dataset correspond to different subjects; therefore, click on the 'Scans' tick box. This will lock the 'Subjects/Scans' field, allowing you to skip to the third field;
- In the 'Modalities' panel, click on 'Add' and provide a name for the modality, e.g. 'fMRI';
- Load all the image files available in the directory (IXIdata/aged/Guys/). You can select all the files by using the right mouse button and clicking on the option 'Select All'. When all the images are selected, click on the 'Done' button;

- Into the ‘Regression targets’ field, write (or paste) the list of target values available in the ‘Age_old_Guys’ file (IXIdata/aged/). The final window should look like to the Figure 13.1. Press ‘OK’;

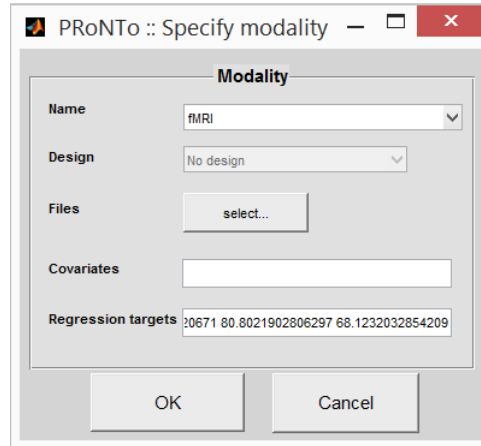


Figure 13.1: ‘Specify modality’ GUI.

- In the ‘Masks’ field, on the bottom left of the ‘Data and design’ window, select the ‘SPM_mask_noeyes’ mask for the specified modality. The mask is available in the path where you have installed PRoNTTo (PRoNTTo/masks/);
- The ‘Data and design’ window should look similar to Figure 13.2. Click on the ‘Save’ button to create ‘PRT.mat’ file with the structure containing the information that has been previously specified. If no errors are shown in the MATLAB command, leave the ‘Data and design’ window by clicking ‘Quit’.

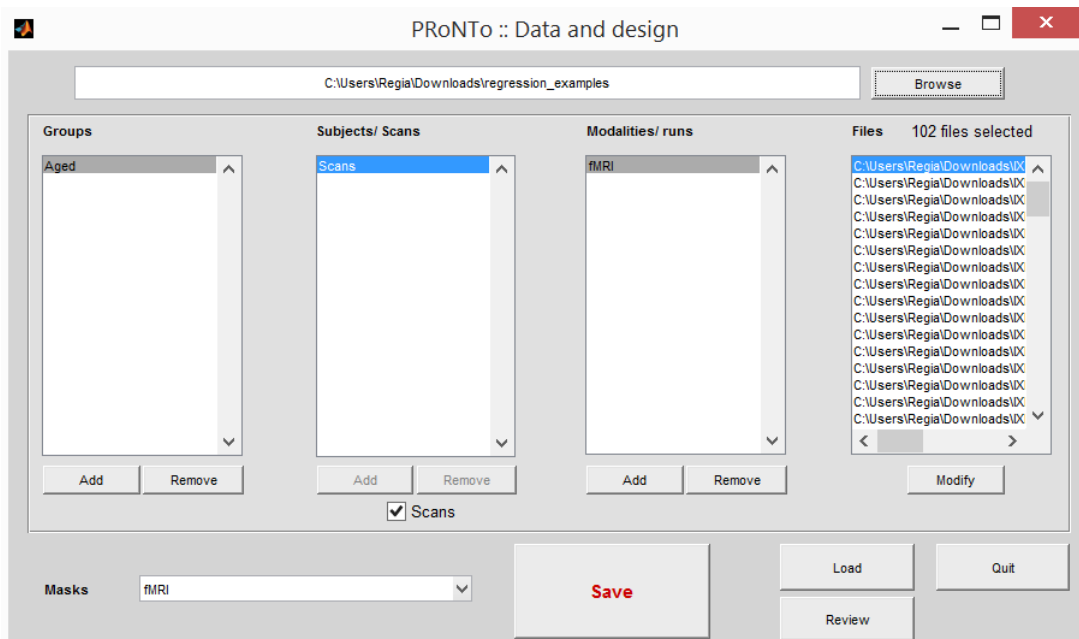


Figure 13.2: ‘Data and design’ GUI final configuration.

13.1.2 Prepare feature set

- In PRoNTTo's main window, click on 'Prepare feature set' and a new window will open, 'Prepare feature set' (see Figure 12.9 in the previous chapter);
- Select the 'PRT.mat' file previously created in the 'Data & Design' step and another window will open, 'Specify modality to include' (Figure 13.3). There is no need to change anything for this example. Just click on the 'Done' button;

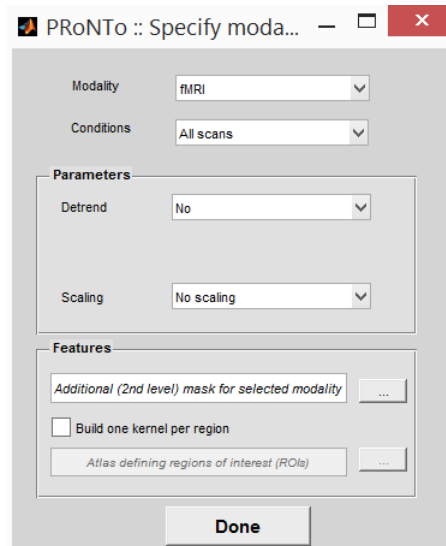


Figure 13.3: 'Specify modality to include' GUI.

- In the 'Prepare feature set' window, provide a name to the feature set, e.g. 'Scalar_Momentum'; and click on 'Build Kernel / data matrix' to build the feature set and kernel;

13.1.3 Specify model

- In PRoNTTo's main window, click on 'Specify model' and a new window will open, 'Specify model' (see Figure 12.12 in the previous chapter);
- Select the 'PRT.mat' file and provide a name to the model, e.g. 'KRR';
- Select one of the 'Feature Set' previously defined. In this case, there is only one: 'Scalar_Momentum';
- Leave the option 'Use kernels' tick box as it is, i.e. 'Yes';
- Select the 'Regression' model type and click on the 'Select subjects/scans' button. This will open a new window, 'Specify subjects/scans to regress', click on the 'Select all' button to use all the scans for the regression (Figure 13.4);
- Select the 'Kernel Ridge Regression' option, in the Machine field;
- Leave the option 'Optimize hyper-parameter' tick box unchecked and 'Cross-Validation Scheme' (internal loop) as it is;
- Select the 'Leave One Subject Out' cross-validation scheme (external loop);
- In the 'Data operations' box, select the 'Mean centre features using training data' option. The final 'Specify model' window should look similar to the Figure 13.5. Click on the 'Specify and run model' button;

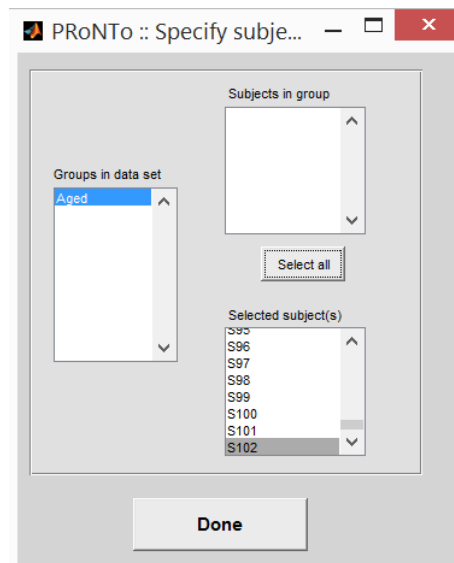


Figure 13.4: ‘Specify subjects/scans to regress’ GUI.

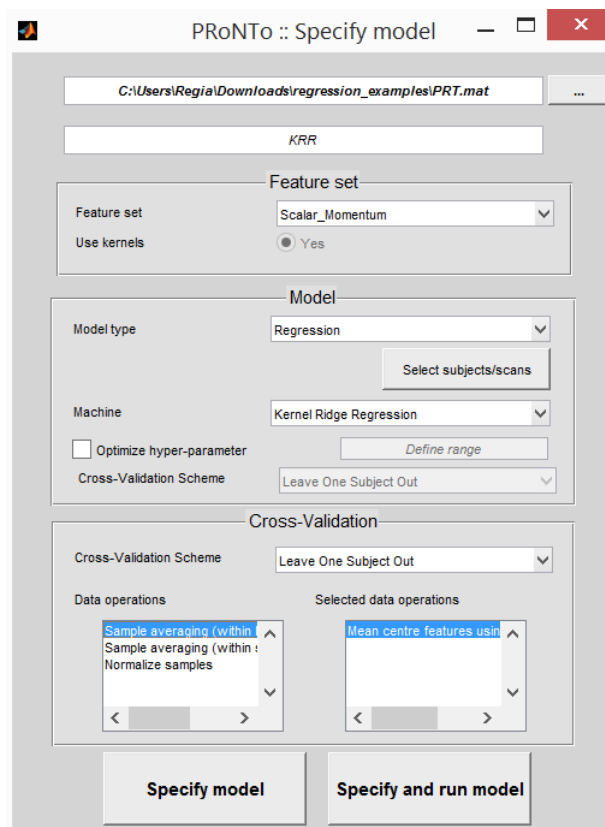


Figure 13.5: ‘Specify model’ GUI final configuration.

- Repeat the process two times using the other two machines. To do this, just follow the same steps in this section, but select the other options in the ‘Machine’ drop-down list (‘Relevance Vector Regression’ and ‘Gaussian Process Regression’) and give different names to the each model.

13.1.4 Display results

- In PRoNTTo's main window, click on 'Display results' and select the 'PRT.mat' file. This will open the main results window similar to the Figure 13.6;

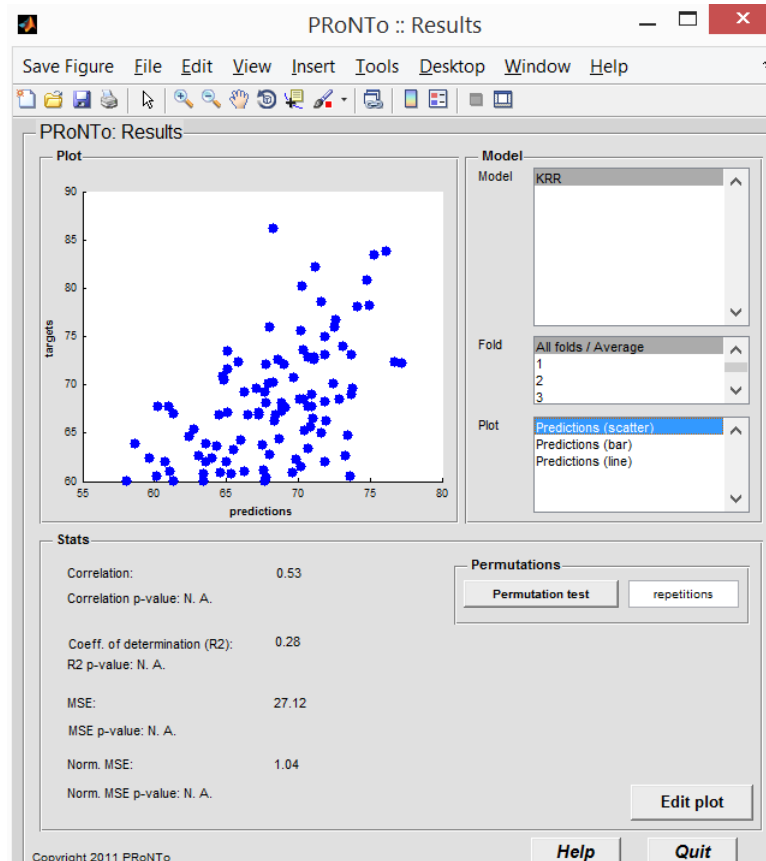


Figure 13.6: 'Results' GUI.

- In the 'Results' window, one can select the different regression models in the 'Model' list on the upper right region. This will show the results obtained using each one of the regression models.

13.2 Batch analysis

In this section, the previous experiment will be repeated using the 'matlabbatch' system. The reader is advised to complete the tutorial in Section 12.2 before continuing, since the explanation of each step will be less descriptive.

Once again, to analyse the data, create a new directory in which to save the results of the analysis. On the main interface of PRoNTTo click on the 'Batch' button to open the 'matlabbatch'. Alternatively, type 'prt_batch' in the MATLAB prompt.

13.2.1 Data & Design

- Click on 'Data & Design' in the PRoNTTo menu (see Figure 12.26 in the previous chapter);
- In the 'Directory' field, select a directory where the 'PRT.mat' file will be saved;
- In the 'Groups' field:
 - Add one group;

- In the field ‘Name’, provide a name without spaces for this group, e.g. ‘Aged’;
- In the field ‘Select by’, select the ‘Scans’ option and add a new modality. For more information on the Scans option please consult Chapter 2;
- Provide a name for this modality, e.g. ‘fMRI’; select the image files available in the ‘aged/Guy’ directory of the IXI dataset and write (or paste) the regression targets¹ in the ‘Regression targets (per scans)’ field;
- Leave ‘Covariates’ field as default. The batch editor should look similar to the Figure 13.7;

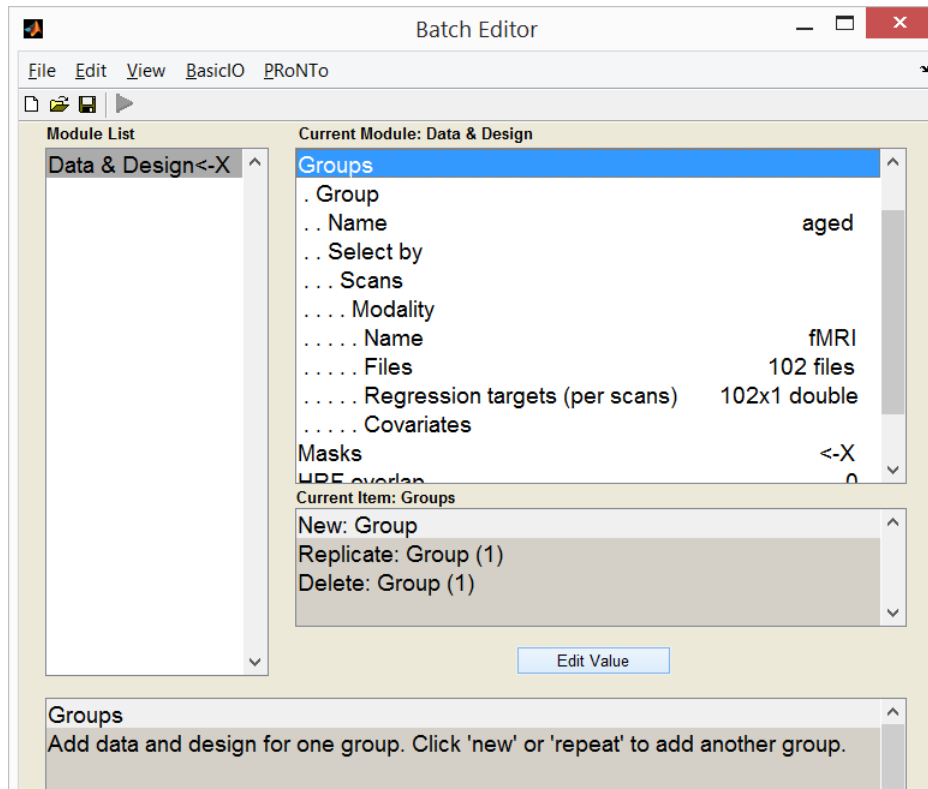


Figure 13.7: Data and design module in `matlabbatch`.

- In the ‘Masks’ field, add a new modality and provide the same modality name, ‘fMRI’; and select the ‘SPM_mask_noeyes’ mask available in the path where you have installed PRoNTTo (PRoNTTo/masks/). The name of the modality here has to be exactly the same as in ‘Modalities’, otherwise it will not work;
- Leave the ‘HRF overlap’ and the ‘HRF delay’ fields as default;
- In the ‘Review’ field, select ‘Yes’ if you would like to review your data and design in a separate window. Otherwise, leave as it is, i.e. ‘No’.

13.2.2 Feature set/Kernel

- Click on the ‘Feature set / Kernel’ option on PRoNTTo’s `matlabbatch` menu (see Figure 12.29 in the previous chapter);
- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Data & Design’ step or click on the ‘Select files’ button to browse where ‘PRT.mat’ file was saved;

¹Available in the ‘Age-old-Guys’ file (IXIdata/aged/)

- Provide a name to the ‘Feature/kernel’ set, e.g. ‘Scalar_Momentum’;
- Add one modality and select the modality name with the ‘Dependency’ button²(Data & Design:Mod#1 name);
 - In the ‘Scans/Conditions’ field, select ‘All scans’ option;
 - In the ‘Voxels to include’ field, select ‘All voxels’ option, this means we are not entering with an additional second-level mask;
 - In the ‘Detrend’ field, select the ‘None’ option;
 - In the ‘Scale input scans’ field, select the ‘No scaling’ option;
 - Leave ‘Load Atlas’ as default. After all these steps, the batch editor should look similar to the one in Figure 13.8;

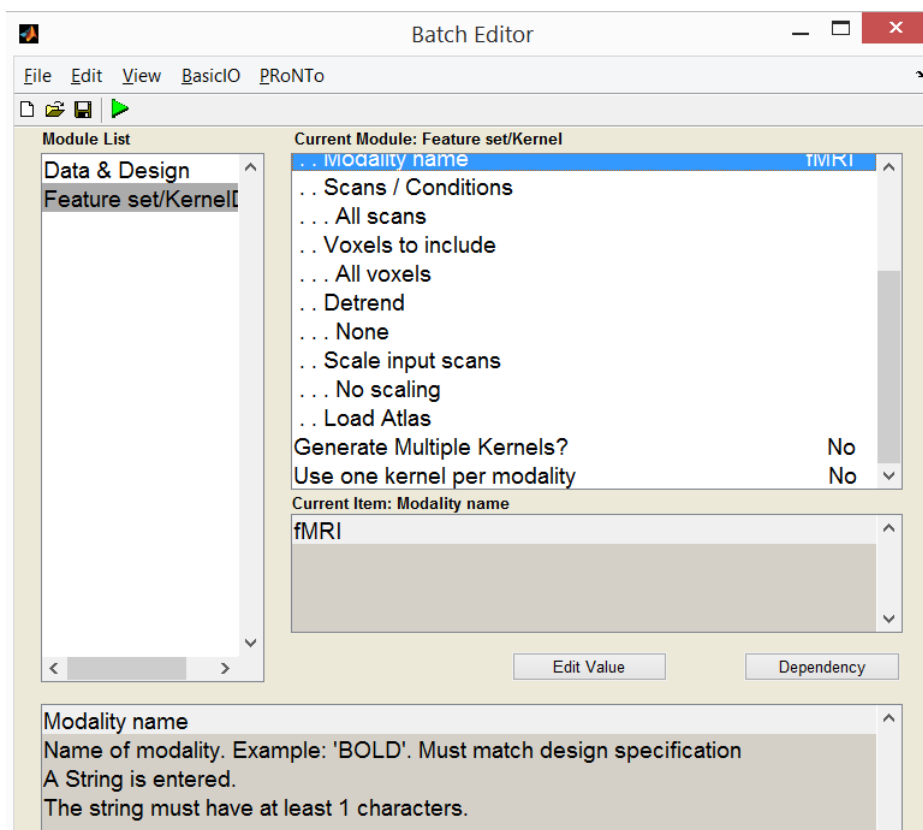


Figure 13.8: Feature set / Kernel module. Selected parameters in the Modality option.

- Leave the ‘Generate Multiple Kernels’ and the ‘Use one kernel per modality’ fields as default.

13.2.3 Specify model (KRR)

- Click on the ‘Specify model’ option on PRoNTto’s `matlabbatch` menu (see Figure 12.32 in the previous chapter);
- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Feature set / Kernel’ step or click on the ‘Select files’ button to browse where ‘PRT.mat’ file was saved;
- Provide a name to the model, e.g. ‘KRR’;

²Or type it in manually, ‘fMRI’, but the name needs to be *exactly* the same as the one specified in the ‘Data & Design’ module.

- Leave the ‘Use kernels’ field as it is, i.e. ‘Yes’;
- Select the feature set name with the ‘Dependency’ button³;
- Select the ‘Regression’ model type:
 - Add a new group and call it ‘Aged’;
 - In the ‘Subjects’ field, type ‘1:170’. This will instruct the program to use all the 170 scans, i.e. from scan 1 to scan 170;
- In the ‘Machine’ field:
 - Select the ‘Kernel Ridge Regression’ option;
 - Leave the ‘Optimize hyper-parameter’ field as it is, i.e. ‘No’;
 - Leave the ‘Regularization’ field as it is, i.e. ‘1’;
 - Leave the ‘Cross validation type for hyper-parameter optimization’ field as it is, i.e. ‘Leave one subject out’;
- In the ‘Cross-validation type’ field, select ‘Leave One Subject Out’ option;
- Leave the ‘Include all scans’ field as it is, i.e. ‘No’;
- In the ‘Data operations’ field:
 - Leave the ‘Mean centre features’ field as it is, i.e. ‘Yes’;
 - Leave the ‘Other Operations’ field as it is, i.e. ‘No operations’;

13.2.4 Run model (KRR)

- Click on the ‘Run model’ option on PRoNTTo’s `matlabbatch` menu (see Figure 12.35 in the previous chapter);
- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Specify model’ step;
- Select the model name from the ‘Specify model’ module with the ‘Dependency’ button⁴;
- In the field ‘Do permutation test?’, leave as it is, i.e. ‘No permutation test’

13.2.5 Specify and Run model (RVR and GPR)

The specification of the other models (‘Relevance Vector Regression’ and ‘Gaussian Process Regression’) follows the same procedure as the ‘KRR’. The only difference is that in the ‘Machine’ field of the ‘Specify model’ module, one has to choose the appropriate machine to use (‘Relevance Vector Regression’ or ‘Gaussian Process Regression’). The parameters used for each machine should be the default ones.

Note that when the ‘PRT.mat’ file is loaded in each module, the user should select the latest option on the list.

When all the models are defined, the ‘Module List’ should contain 8 modules:

1. Data & Design;
2. Feature set/Kernel;
3. Specify model;
4. Run model;

³or write it *exactly* as previously defined in the ‘Feature set / Kernel’ module (option ‘Feature set/Kernel: Feature/kernel name’), here ‘Scalar_Momentum’.

⁴or write it *exactly* as previously defined in the ‘Specify model’ module, here ‘KRR’

5. Specify model;
6. Run model;
7. Specify model;
8. Run model.

Note that modules 3 and 4 correspond to the KRR model; 5 and 6 to the RVR model; 7 and 8 to the GPR model.

When all the modules are added, just click on the ‘Run Batch’ button. The resulting ‘PRT.mat’ file will be saved in the specified directory and the results can be viewed using the process described in [Section 13.1.4](#).

Chapter 14

Multiple Kernel Learning Example

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This chapter will describe the steps necessary to perform a classification with SimpleMKL <http://asi.insa-rouen.fr/enseignants/~arakoto/code/mklindex.html> [15] using PRoNTTo. These are similar to the ones in Chapter 12, thus, the reader is advised to complete the tutorial in Chapter 12 before moving on, since the explanation of some steps will be less descriptive.

Many practical learning problems involve multiple and heterogeneous data sources. In this way, Multiple Kernel Learning (MKL) [2] has been proposed to simultaneously learn and combine different models, represented by different kernels, in supervised learning settings. In MKL, the kernel K can be considered as a linear combination of M ‘basis kernels’. For further details, please refer to [2].

One example of a MKL approach based on SVM is the SimpleMKL algorithm [15]. Essentially, the algorithm is based on a gradient descent on the SVM objective value and iteratively determine the combination of kernels by a gradient descent wrapping [15]. For further details, please refer to [15].

We will use the same dataset used in Chapter 12, this fMRI dataset originates from a study on face and object representation in human ventral temporal cortex [6]. The dataset¹ used in this chapter can be found in PRoNTTo’s website <http://www.mlnl.cs.ucl.ac.uk/pronto/prtdata.html> (data set 1) and the whole² dataset is available in <http://data.pympva.org/datasets/haxby2001/>.

¹Pre-processed (realigned and normalised) data from participant 1.

²Not pre-processed.

For simplicity, in this example we will use PRoNTo to predict if the subject is viewing an image of a Face or a House based on the fMRI scans. We will classify the whole brain images using SimpleMKL and a leave one block out cross-validation scheme.

14.1 GUI analysis

We will first analyse the data using PRoNTo's GUI and then repeat the analysis using the `matlabbatch` system.

To start, create a new directory in which to save the results of the analysis, then start up MATLAB and type 'prt' or 'pronto' in the MATLAB prompt. This will open the main interface of PRoNTo (Figure 14.1).

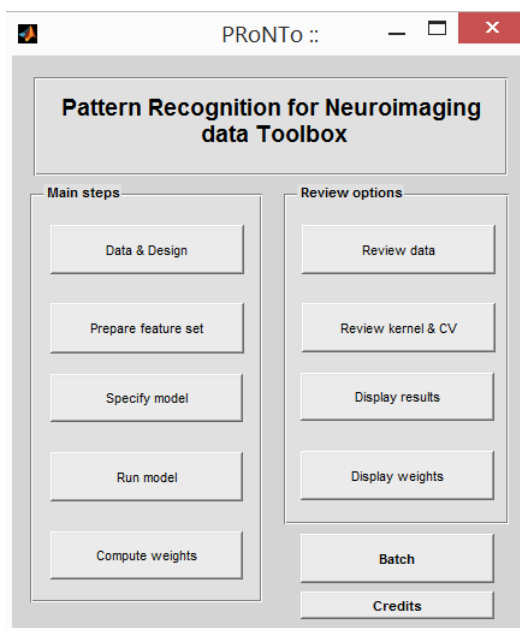


Figure 14.1: Main interface of PRoNTo.

14.1.1 Data & Design

- In PRoNTo's main window, click on 'Data & Design'. Like in the previous chapters, browse the directory in which to save the PRT structure (saved as 'PRT.mat');
- In the panel 'Groups', click on 'Add' and provide a name to the group (we only have one group/subject), with no spaces, e.g. 'G1';
- Add a subject in the 'Subject/Scans' option, e.g. 'S1', and leave the 'Scans' tick box below the panel unchecked. See Chapter 2 of the manual for more information on this option;
- In the 'Modalities' panel, click on 'Add' and provide a name to the modality, e.g. 'fMRI'. In the 'Design' field, choose the option 'Load SPM.mat'. This file is available with the Haxby dataset on PRoNTo's website³ inside the folder Haxby_dataset/design/;
 - In case there is no 'SPM.mat' file available to use, create a new design by selecting the option 'Specify design'. Choose how many conditions you have, which in this case are 8 conditions (corresponding to the 8 categories of images). This will open another window that allows the user to write the names, onsets and durations (if the duration is the same for all events only one value is required) of each condition. The unit in

³<http://www.mhl.cs.ucl.ac.uk/pronto/prtdata.html>

which the onsets/durations are read in this case is ‘scans’ and the interscan interval (TR) is 2.5 seconds. The design information (names, onsets and durations) can be found inside the ‘Haxby_design.pdf’ file in the Haxby dataset folder.

- Finally, load all the image files available in the fMRI directory (Haxby_dataset/fMRI/). You can select all the files by using the right mouse button and clicking on the option ‘Select All’. When all the images are selected, click on the ‘Done’ button;
- In the ‘Masks’ field, on the bottom left of the ‘Data and design’ window, select the ‘whole_brain’ mask for the specified modality. The mask is available in the masks directory inside the folder Haxby_dataset/masks/;
- Click on the ‘Review’ button to check the data and the design inserted for this modality. For more information on what one can do with the Review option, please see Chapter 2;
- The ‘Data and design’ window should look similar to the one in Figure 14.2. Click on the ‘Save’ button to create the ‘PRT.mat’ file with the structure containing the information that has been previously specified. If no errors are shown in the MATLAB command, leave the ‘Data and design’ window by clicking ‘Quit’.

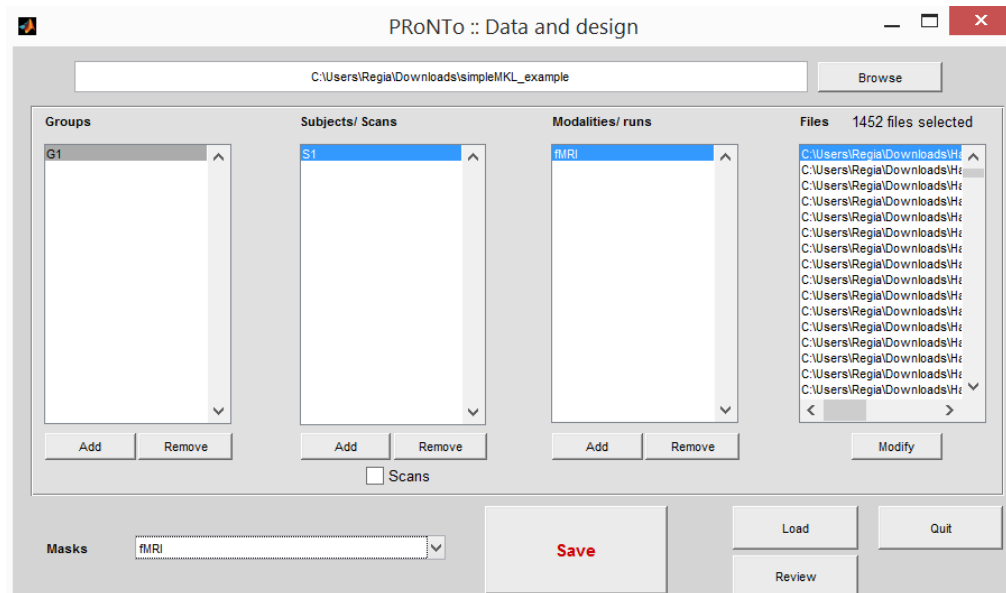


Figure 14.2: ‘Data and design’ GUI final configuration.

14.1.2 Prepare feature set

- In PRoNTTo’s main window, click on ‘Prepare feature set’ and a new window called ‘Prepare feature set’ will open (see Figure 12.9 in Chapter 12);
- Select the ‘PRT.mat’ file previously created in the ‘Data & Design’ step and another window will open, ‘Specify modality to include’ (see Figure 15.4 in Chapter 12), to set the specification of different parameters and options for each modality, which are:
 - ‘Modality’ field: select the modality previously specified in the ‘Data & Design’ step, ‘fMRI’;
 - ‘Conditions’ field: select ‘All scans’;
 - ‘Parameters’ box: select the polynomial detrend with order 1 and the ‘No scaling’ option;

- ‘Features’ box: select the ‘Build one kernel per region’ tick box and load the ‘AAL’ atlas (named ‘aal_79x91x69’) available in the PRoNTTo directory (PRoNTTo/atlas/). Then, click on the ‘Done’ button. The final ‘Specify modality to include’ window should look similar to the one in Figure 14.3;

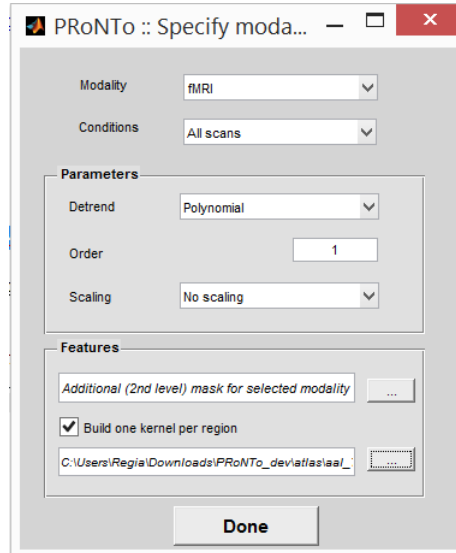


Figure 14.3: ‘Specify modality to include’ GUI final configuration.

- In the ‘Prepare feature set’ window, provide a name to the feature set, e.g. ‘HaxbyFeatures’;
- Click on ‘Build kernel/data matrix’ to build the feature set and kernel. It will take a few minutes.

14.1.3 Specify model

- In PRoNTTo’s main window, click on ‘Specify model’ and a new window called ‘Specify model’ will open (see Figure 12.12 in Chapter 12);
- Select the ‘PRT.mat’ file and provide a name to the model, e.g. ‘mklFacesHouses’;
- Select one of the feature sets previously defined. In this case, there is only one: ‘HaxbyFeatures’;
- Leave the option ‘Use kernels’ tick box as it is, i.e. ‘Yes’;
- Select the ‘Classification’ model type and click on the ‘Define classes’ button. A new window will open, ‘Specify classes’, to define the number of classes and a name for each class. We will define 2 classes:
 - for ‘Class 1’ select subject ‘S1’ and the condition ‘Faces’ and;
 - for ‘Class 2’ select subject ‘S1’ and the condition ‘Houses’. Click on ‘Done’.
- Select the ‘L1- Multi-Kernel Learning’ option, in the Machine field;
- Select the ‘Optimize hyper-parameter’ tick box and leave the textbox empty. This will force PRoNTTo to use an array with default hyper-parameter values for the optimization. You can choose other values by inputting them in this box (e.g. [0.1, 1, 100]);
- In the ‘Cross-Validation Scheme’ (internal loop) field, select the option ‘k-fold CV on Block’. A window will appear asking to define the value of k, set it to 4;
- Select the ‘Leave One Block Out’ cross-validation scheme (external loop);

- In the ‘Data operations’ box, select the ‘Mean centre features using training data’ and ‘Normalize samples’ options. Then, the ‘Specify model’ window should look similar to the one in Figure 14.4;

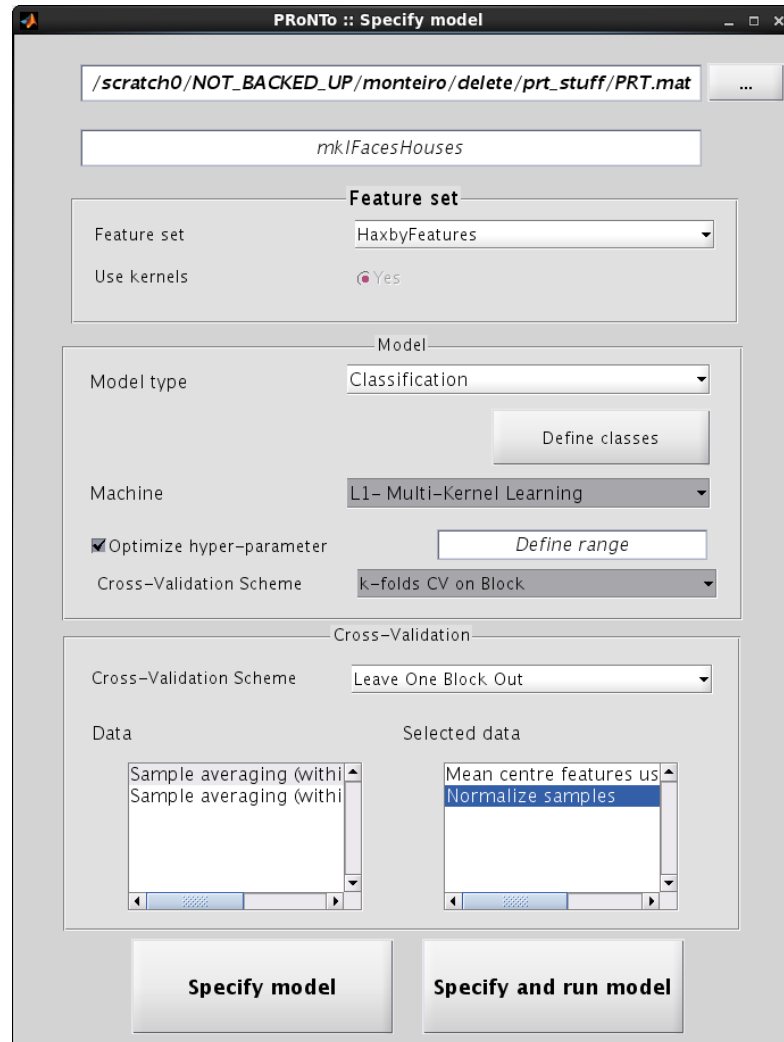


Figure 14.4: ‘Specify model’ GUI final configuration.

- Click on ‘Specify and run model’ and the model will be immediately estimated, therefore there is no need to use the ‘Run model’ module in this case. It will take a few minutes to complete.

14.1.4 Display model (optional step)

- To review the model specification, in the main PRoNTTo GUI, click on ‘Review kernel & CV’ and a new window will open, ‘Review Model Specification’ (see Figure 12.15 in Chapter 12);
- Select the model, ‘mklFacesHouses’, from the list at the top and click on ‘Review model’; then, select one class from the list to see which groups, subjects and conditions belong to this class (see Figure 12.16 in Chapter 12);
- To review the data and cross-validation matrix click on ‘Review CV’ (Figure 14.5). For more information on what these matrices mean, please consult the previous chapters of the manual;
- To review the kernel, click on ‘Show kernel’ (Figure 14.6).

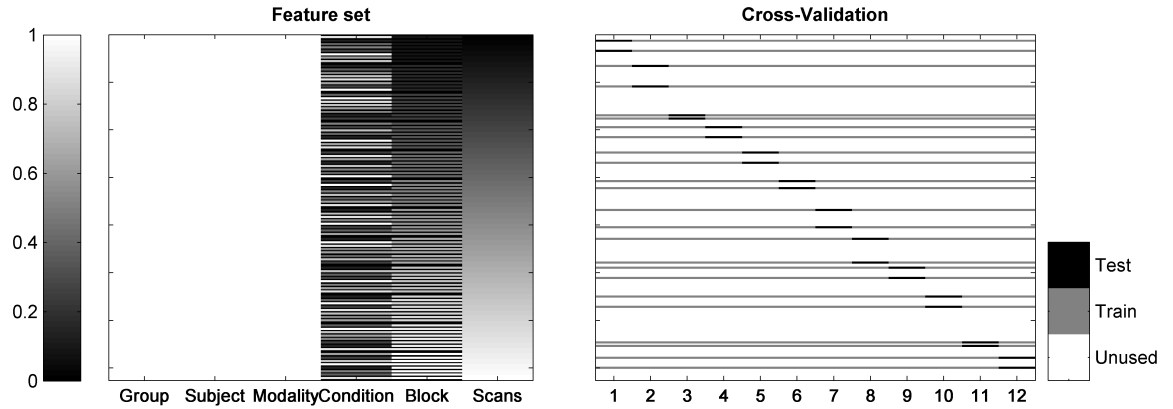


Figure 14.5: Data and cross-validation matrix from ‘Review CV’ option.

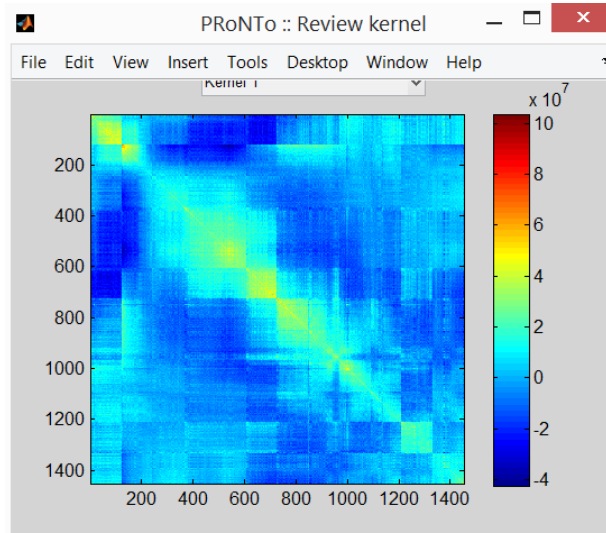


Figure 14.6: Kernel matrix used for classification.

14.1.5 Compute weights (optional step)

- In PRoNTTo’s main window, click on ‘Compute weights’ and a new window will open, ‘Compute weights’ (see Figure 12.19 in Chapter 12);
- Select the ‘PRT.mat’ file;
- Select the model from the list to ‘Models computed in PRT’, ‘mklFacesHouses’ model;
- Check the tick box option ‘Compute average/kernel weight per region’;
- Click on the ‘Compute weights’ button. Computations will be displayed on the MATLAB prompt.

14.1.6 Display results

- In PRoNTTo’s main window, click on ‘Display results’ and select the ‘PRT.mat’ file. This will open the main results window. In the ‘Model’ panel, select the model that you want to view, ‘mklFacesHouses’, and the results through performance will be similar to the one in Figure 14.7;

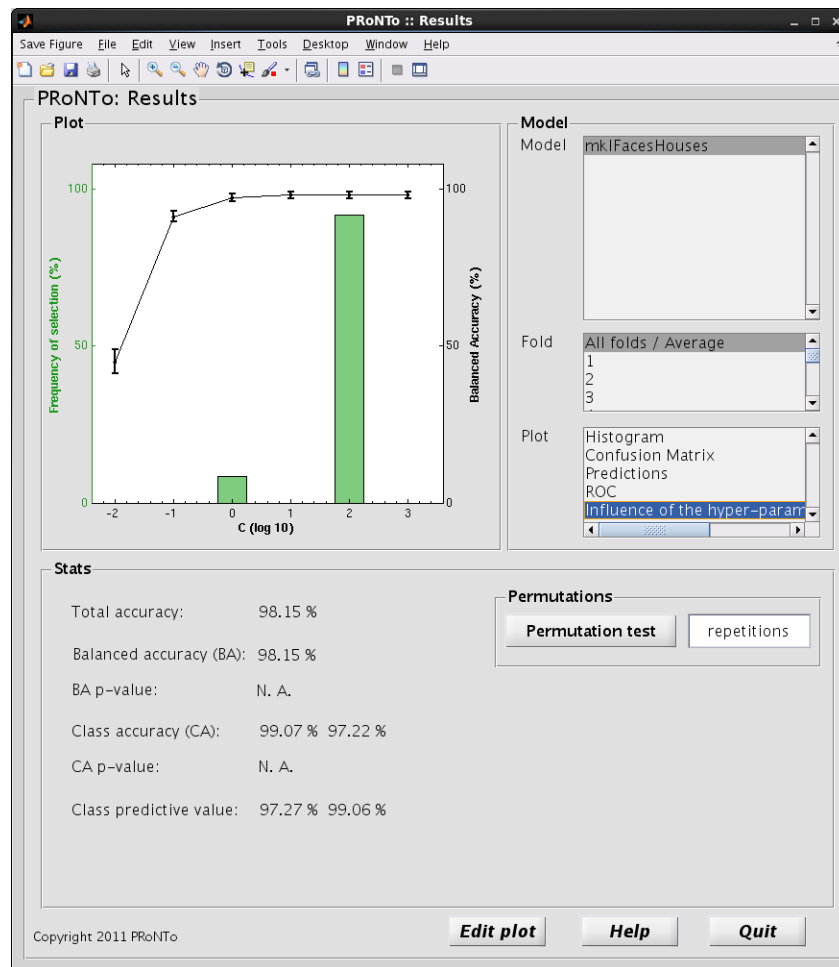


Figure 14.7: Summary for model's performance.

- In the 'Results' window, one can select the different plots in the 'Plots' list. Please note that there is a new plot on the list, this displays information about the hyper-parameter optimization, for more information, please refer to Chapter 6.

14.1.7 Display weights

- In PRoNTTo's main window, click on 'Display weights' and select the 'PRT.mat' file. This will open the 'Model interpretation' window. By clicking on 'Model', mklFacesHouses, an image will appear in the 'Weights map' box; and to show the 'Anatomical img' you have to load an anatomical image for reference. A template image can be found in the SPM's canonical folder 'single_subj_T1'. The final result window will look similar to that shown in Figure 14.8.
- Since the machine used in the example was MKL with a kernel calculated for each brain region, it is possible to see the contributions of each region. The labels for the regions can be found in the same folder where the atlas is located (PRoNTTo/atlas). For more information, please refer to Chapter 7.

14.2 Batch analysis

This tutorial will now show how to analyse the same data but using the `matlabbatch` system.

Once again, to analyse the data, create a new directory in which to save the results of the analysis, saved as 'PRT.mat'. On the main interface of PRoNTTo click on the 'Batch' button to

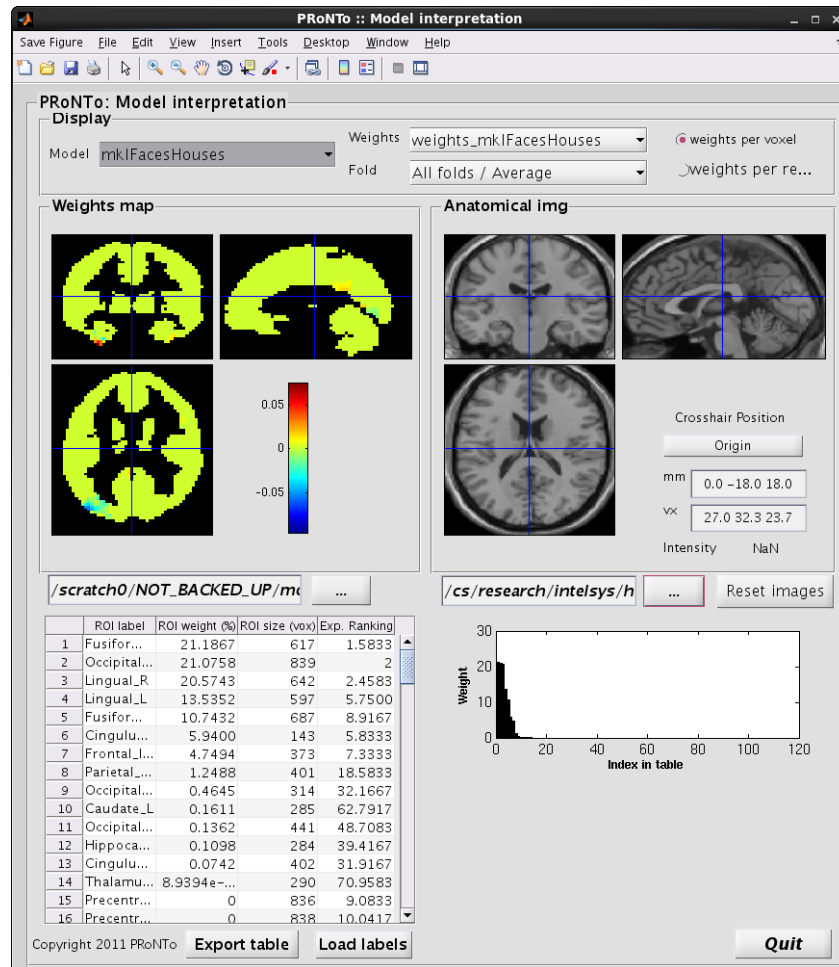
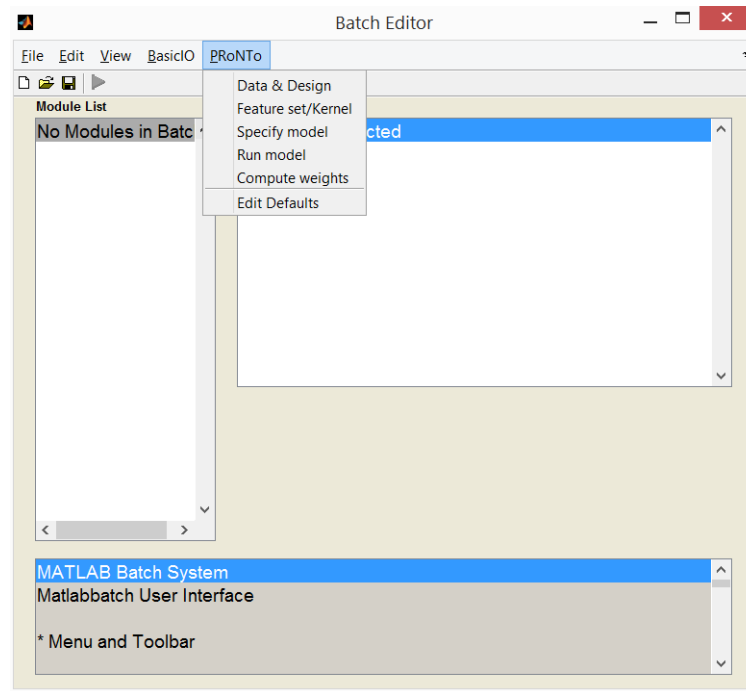
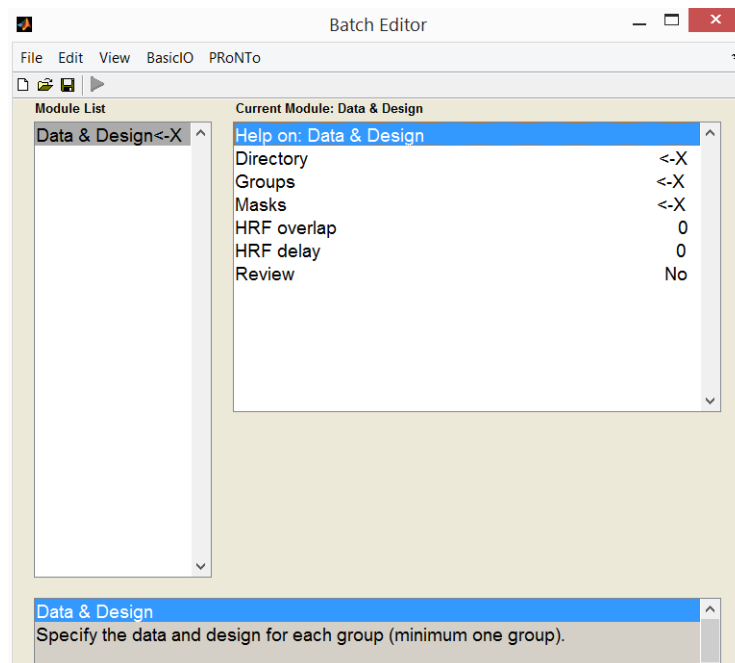


Figure 14.8: Summary for model's performance.

open the 'matlabbatch'. Alternatively, type 'prt_batch' in the MATLAB prompt. On the menu bar of the batch, there is a PRoNTTo menu with the 5 options shown in the main steps interface (Figure 14.9).

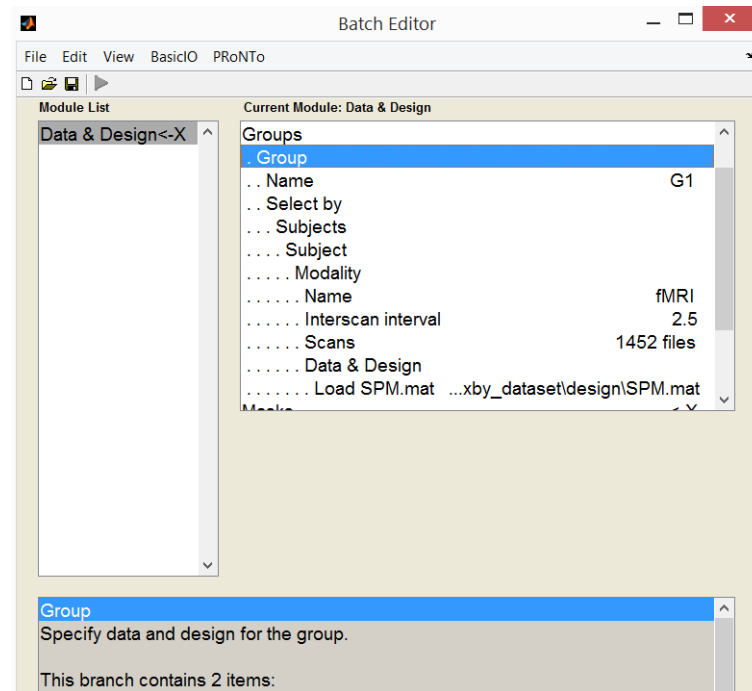
14.2.1 Data & Design

- Click on 'Data & Design' in the PRoNTTo menu (Figure 14.10);
- In the 'Directory' field, select a directory where the 'PRT.mat' file will be saved. There are three options to edit all fields in `matlabbatch`: (i) by using the right mouse button and clicking on the current option, (ii) clicking on current button in the window or (iii) by double clicking;
- In the 'Groups' field:
 - Add one group;
 - In the field 'Name', provide a name without spaces to that group, e.g. 'G1';
 - In the field 'Select by', select the 'Subjects' option and add one subject;
 - Add on modality for this subject and provide a name, e.g. 'fMRI'; define the 'Interscan interval' of 2.5 seconds; and in the field 'Scans', select all the image files available in the fMRI directory of the Haxby dataset;

Figure 14.9: Menu PRoNTTo in the main `matlabbatch` window.Figure 14.10: Data and design module in `matlabbatch`.

- In the ‘Data & Design’ field, choose ‘Load SPM.mat’ option. This file is available with the Haxby dataset on PRoNTTo’s website⁴ inside the folder `Haxby_dataset/design/`. The batch editor should look similar to the Figure 14.11;
- * In case there is no ‘SPM.mat’ file already available to use, create a new design by selecting the option ‘Specify design’. Choose how many conditions you have, which in this case are 8 conditions (corresponding to the 8 categories of images). The

⁴<http://www.mhl.cs.ucl.ac.uk/pronto/prtdata.html>

Figure 14.11: Data and design module in `matlabbatch`.

unit in which the onsets/durations are read is ‘Scans’. Write the names, onsets and durations of each condition (Figure 14.12);

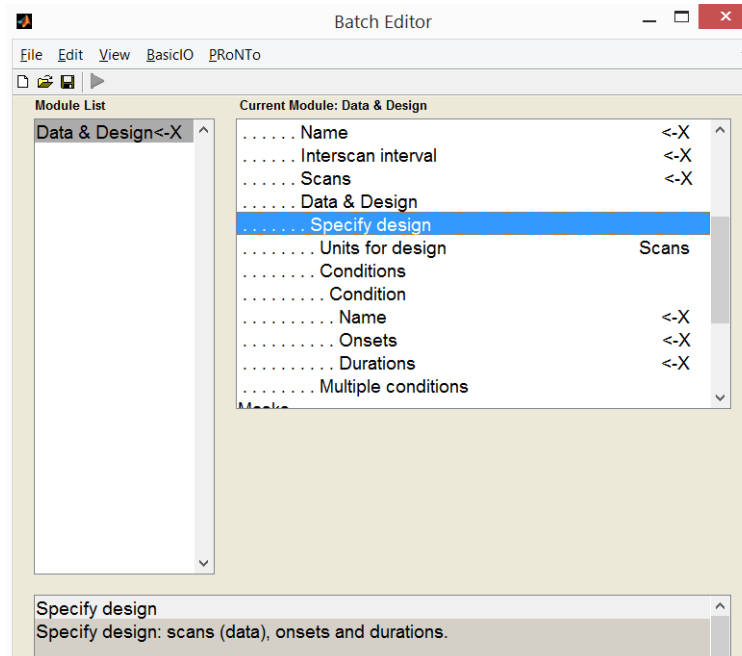


Figure 14.12: Data and design module. The ‘Specify design’ option.

- In the ‘Masks’ field, add a new modality and provide the same modality name, ‘fMRI’; and select the ‘whole.brain’ mask available in the masks directory of the Haxby dataset. The name of the modality here has to be exactly the same as in ‘Modalities’, otherwise it will not work;

- Leave the ‘HRF overlap’ and the ‘HRF delay’ options as default;
- In the ‘Review’ field, select ‘Yes’ if you would like to review your data and design in a separate window. Otherwise, leave as it is, i.e. ‘No’.

14.2.2 Feature set / Kernel

- Click on the ‘Feature set / Kernel’ option on PRoNTTo’s `matlabbatch` menu (Figure 14.13);

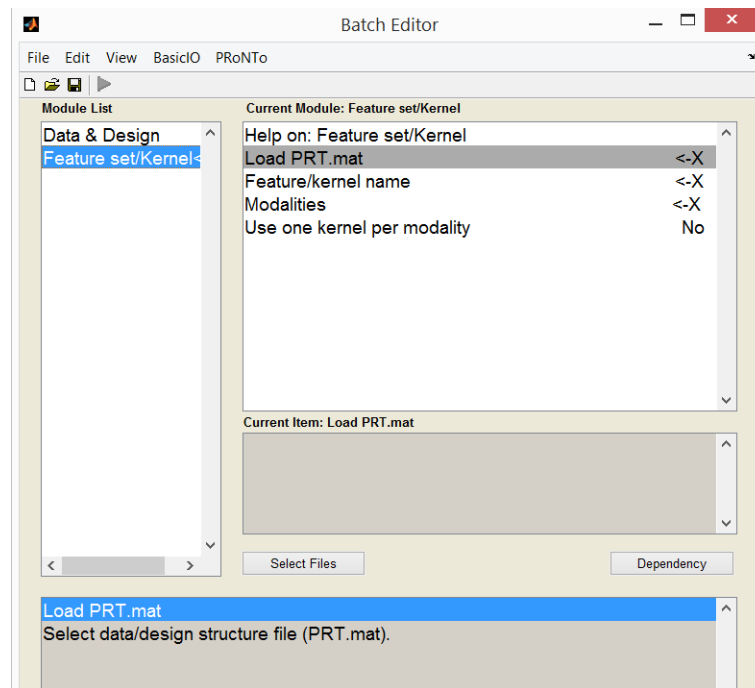


Figure 14.13: Feature set/Kernel module in `matlabbatch`.

- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Data & Design’ step (Figure 14.14) or click on the ‘Select files’ button to browse where ‘PRT.mat’ file was saved;
- Provide a name to the ‘Feature/kernel’ set, e.g. ‘HaxbyFeatures’;
- Add one modality and select the modality name with the ‘Dependency’ button⁵(Data & Design:Mod#1 name);
 - In the ‘Scans/Conditions’ field , select ‘All scans’ option;
 - In the ‘Voxels to include’ field, select ‘All voxels’ option, this means we are not entering an additional second-level mask;
 - In the ‘Detrend’ field, select ‘Polynomial detrend’ option with order 1;
 - In the ‘Scale input scans’ field, select ‘No scaling’ option;
 - In the ‘Use atlas to build ROI specific kernels’, select an atlas file AAL (named ‘aal.79x91x69’) available in the PRoNTTo directory (PRoNTTo/atlas/).
- In the field ‘Use one kernel per modality’, select the ‘No’ option.

After all this steps, the batch editor should look similar to the one in Figure 14.15.

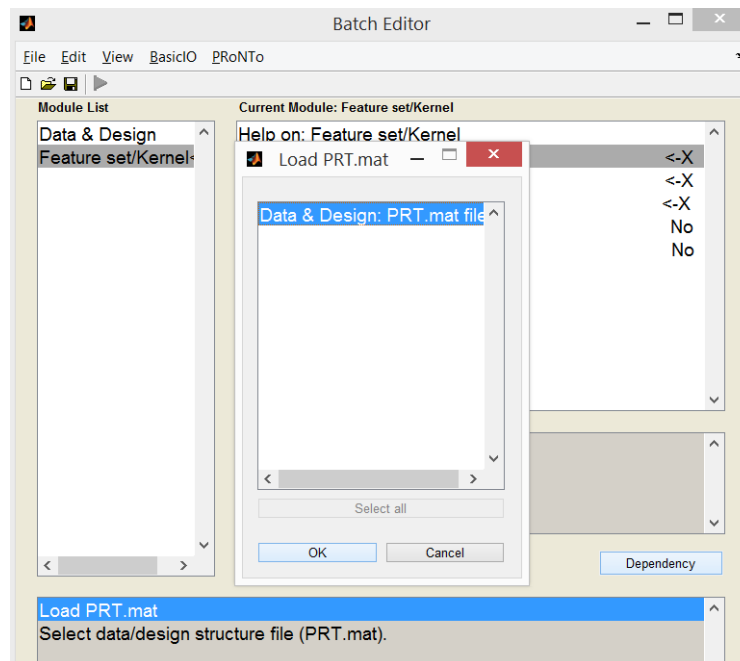


Figure 14.14: Feature set / Kernel module in `matlabbatch`. This window is called to establish a dependency connection with the previous ‘Data and design’ module.

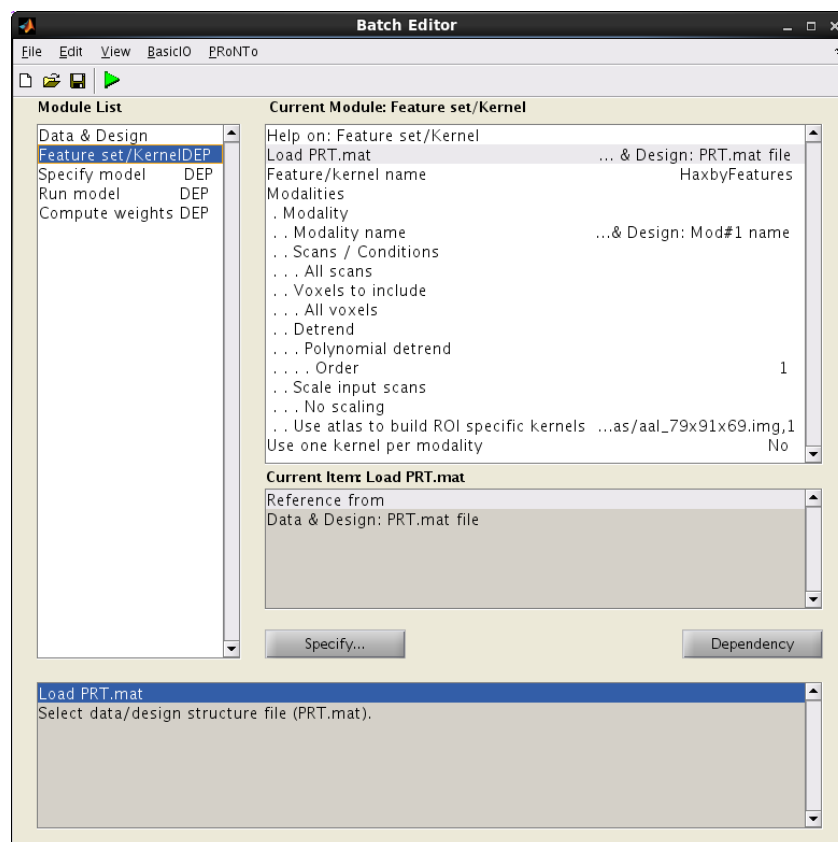
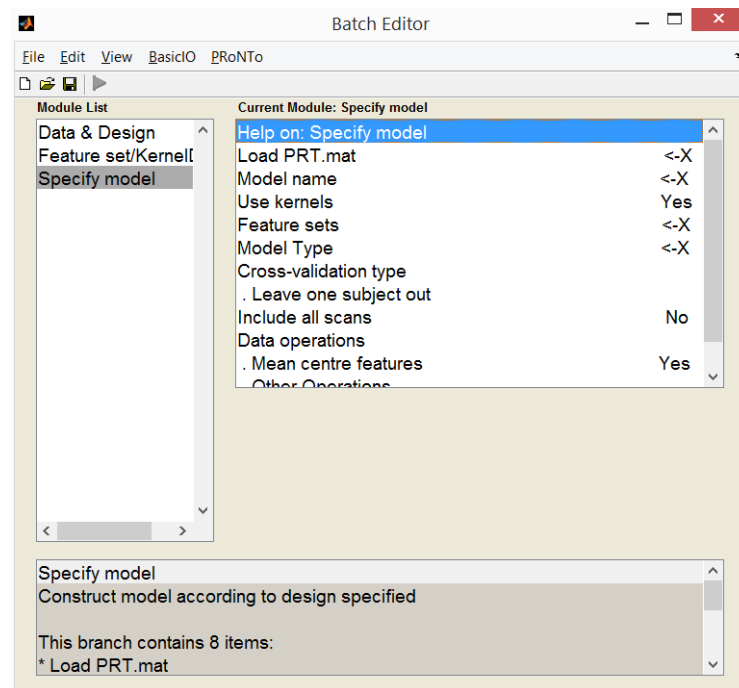


Figure 14.15: Feature set / Kernel module. Selected parameters in the Modality option.

Figure 14.16: Specify model module in `matlabbatch`.

14.2.3 Specify model

- Click on the ‘Specify model’ option on PRoNTTo’s `matlabbatch` menu (Figure 14.16);
- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Feature set / Kernel’ step or click on the ‘Select files’ button to browse where ‘PRT.mat’ file was saved;
- Provide a name to the model, e.g. ‘mklFacesHouses’;
- Leave the ‘Use kernels’ field as it is, i.e. ‘Yes’;
- In the ‘Feature sets’ field, select the feature set name with the ‘Dependency’ button⁶;
- Select the ‘Classification’ model type:
 - Create 2 new classes;
 - For Class (1) write ‘Faces’ on the name field and add one group. Select the group name from the ‘Data & Design’ module (‘Data & Design:Group#1 name’) with the ‘Dependency’ button⁷. Similarly, for Class (2) write ‘Houses’ on the name field and add the group created in the ‘Data & Design’ module, ‘G1’;
 - In the ‘Subjects’ field, type ‘1’ (only subject one is selected);
 - In the ‘Conditions / Scans’ field, select the ‘Specify Conditions’ option and add a new condition. Provide a name for this condition, i.e. for Class (1) ‘Faces’ and for Class (2) ‘Houses’. Note that this name need to be exactly as specified in the ‘Data & Design’ module: if you simply loaded an ‘SPM.mat’ file for the design, you *must* know the names of the conditions;
 - After all this steps, the batch editor should look similar to the Figure 14.17

⁵Or type it in manually, ‘fMRI’, but the name needs to be *exactly* the same as the one specified in the ‘Data & Design’ module.

⁶or write it *exactly* as previously defined in the ‘Feature set / Kernel’ module (option ‘Feature set/Kernel: Feature/kernel name’), here ‘HaxbyFeatures’.

⁷Or write it *exactly* as previously defined in the Data & Design’ module, here ‘G1’

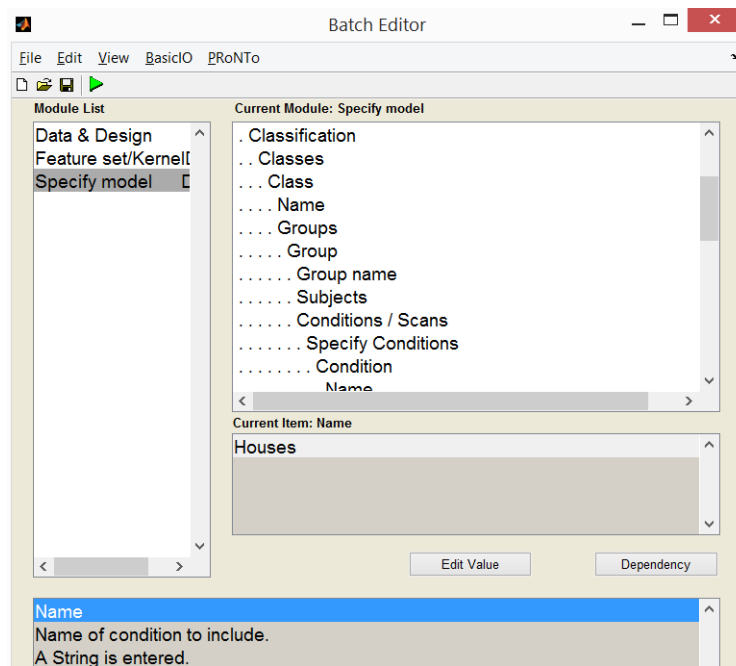


Figure 14.17: Specify model module. Selected parameters in the Class option.

- In the ‘Machine’ field:
 - Select ‘L1 Multi-Kernel Learning’ option;
 - In the ‘Optimize hyper-parameter’ field, select the ‘Yes’ option;
 - In the ‘Arguments’ field, input the hyper-parameters that you wish to use for the hyper-parameter optimization (e.g. [0.01, 0.1, 1, 10, 100, 1000]);
 - In the ‘Cross validation type for hyper-parameter optimization’ (internal loop) field, select the ‘k-folds CV on blocks’ option and on the field ‘k’ input the value 4;
- In the ‘Cross validation type’ (external loop) field, select ‘Leave one block out’ option;
- Leave the ‘Include all scans’ field as it is, i.e. ‘No’;
- In the ‘Data operations’ field:
 - Leave the ‘Mean centre features’ field as it is, i.e. ‘Yes’;
 - Click on the ‘Other Operations’ field and select the option ‘Select Operations’, then add a new operation and select the ‘Normalize samples’ option;

14.2.4 Run model

- Click on the ‘Run model’ option on PRoNTTo’s `matlabbatch` menu (Figure 14.18);
- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Specify model’ step;
- Select the model name from the ‘Specify model’ module with the ‘Dependency’ button⁸;
- Leave the ‘Do permutation test?’ field as it is, i.e. ‘No permutation test’.

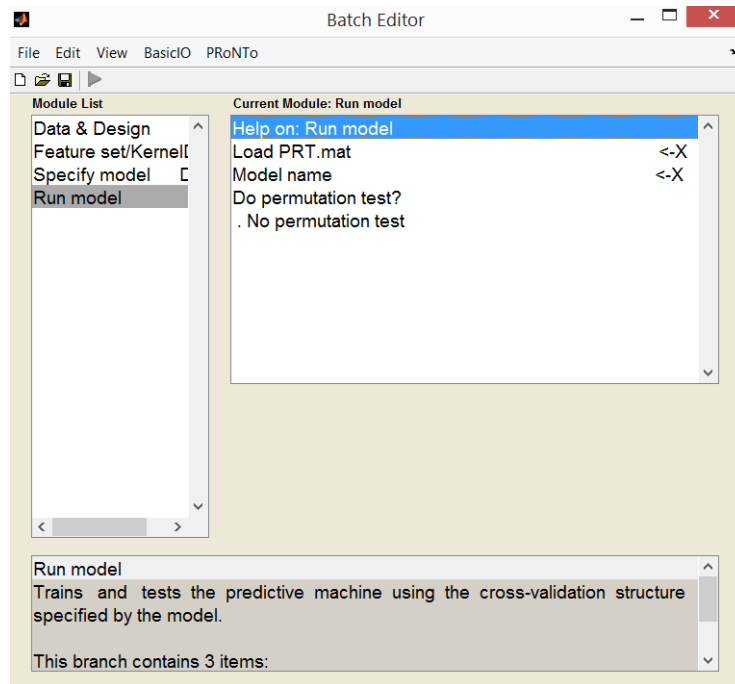
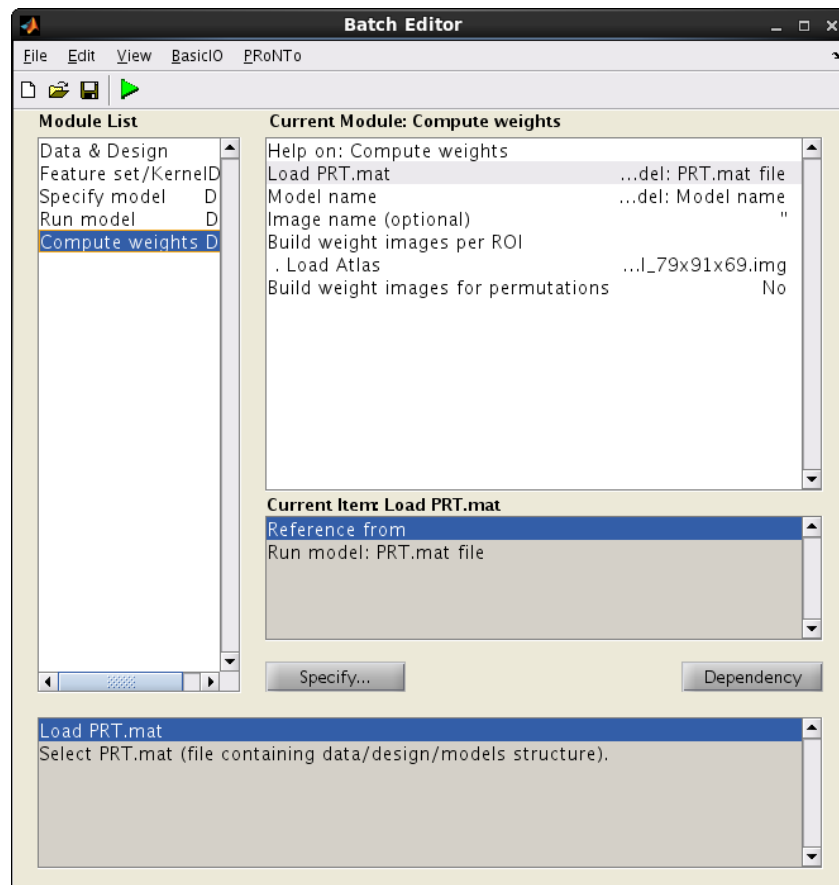


Figure 14.18: Run model module in matlabbatch.



14.2.5 Compute weights (optional step)

- Click on the ‘Compute weights’ option on PRoNTo’s `matlabbatch` menu (Figure 14.19);
- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Run model’ step;
- Select the model name from the ‘Specify model’ module with the ‘Dependency’ button;
- It’s optional to define a name for the image;
- In the ‘Build weight images per ROI’, load the atlas that was used for building the feature set, which can be found in PRoNTo/atlas/;
- Leave the ‘Build weights images for permutations’ field as it is, i.e. ‘No’;

Finally, save the batch (e.g. as `batch_run_all.m`) and click on the ‘Run Batch’ option, in the ‘File menu’. The batch file created can then be opened and edited for further analyses. The results will be the same as those obtained using the GUI (see Section 14.1.6 of this tutorial).

⁸Or write it *exactly* as previously defined in the ‘Specify model’ module, here ‘`mklFacesHouses`’

Chapter 15

Removing confounds: a classification example

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15.1 Introduction

This chapter describes the steps necessary to remove confounding effects using PRoNTo. Confounds (also known as nuisance variables) are removed from predictive variables to improve the statistical significance as well as classification performance. Age, gender or the site where the medical imaging were acquired (in case of a multi-site study) are examples of what can be used to ensure that the results obtained reflect the variable of interest (e.g. disease or healthy) and are not due to other secondary variables. Please see section 2.2.5 for important considerations on covariates.

The dataset used in this chapter can be found in OASIS's website <http://www.oasis-brains.org> (data set 1) and consists of a longitudinal collection of 150 subjects aged 60 to 96. Each subject was scanned on two or more visits, separated by at least one year for a total of 373 imaging sessions. For each subject, 3 or 4 individual T1-weighted MRI scans obtained in single scan sessions are included. The subjects are all right-handed and include both men and women. 72 of the subjects were characterized as nondemented throughout the study. 64 of the included subjects were characterized as demented at the time of their initial visits and remained so for subsequent scans, including 51 individuals with mild to moderate Alzheimers disease. Another 14 subjects were characterized as nondemented at the time of their initial visit and were subsequently characterized as demented at a later visit. In this example, 100 subjects were selected from OASIS

dataset with 50 demented patients and 50 nondemented subjects. Age and gender are considered as the confounds.

Firstly, we will use PRoNTo to predict if the subject suffers from dementia or not based on MRI scans. We will classify the whole brain images using Multiple Kernel Learning, so the reader is advised to complete the tutorial in Chapter 12 and Chapter 14 before moving on. Chapter 14 is based on Chapter 12, hence the following contents will refer to Chapter 12.

As in previous Chapters, we will start analyzing the data with the PRoNTo's GUI and then repeat the analysis using the `matlabbatch` system. Please create a folder in your computer to store the results and type `prt` in MATLAB.

15.2 GUI analysis

15.2.1 Data & Design

- In PRoNTo's main window, click on 'Data & Design' and a new window will open, 'Data and design' (Figure 12.2). Like in previous chapters, browse the directory in which to save the PRT structure (saved as 'PRT.mat');
- In the panel Groups, click on Add and provide a name to the group, e.g. 'Dem'. We will first add all the information about the demented subjects.
- All the images in the dataset correspond to different subjects; therefore, click on the Scans tick box. This will lock the Subjects/Scans field, please see Chapter 2.3.3 of the manual for more information on this option;
- In the 'Modalities' panel, click on 'Add' and provide a name to the modality, e.g. 'MRI_GM', where we used gray matter images.
- Load all the image files belonging to the first group. You can select all the files by using the right mouse button and clicking on the option 'Select All', or clicking on the first subject then Shift-click on the last. Please ensure that the order of the images in the selection is as what you are expecting. When all the images are selected, click on the 'Done' button;
- In the 'Covariates' field, type the covariates you want to regress out. Or you can save all the covariates in a matrix named `R` and input the full path of this matrix to Covariates. Each variable is a column, hence if there is only one covariate, `R` is a column vector; if there are multiple variables, `R` will be a matrix containing multiple columns where each column is a covariate. In this example, we input the full path of a matrix where gender and age are the chosen confounding factors (Figure 15.1);
- In the 'Masks' field, on the bottom left of the 'Data and design window, select the 'mask_GM' mask for the modality specified (Figure 15.2).
- Finally, repeat the previous steps for the non-demented group 'NonDem', including the corresponding images and covariates, and using the same modality and mask as for the 'Dem' group. The 'Data and design' window should look similar to Figure 15.3. Click on the 'Save' button to create the 'PRT.mat' file with the structure containing the information that has been previously specified. If no errors are shown in the MATLAB command, leave the 'Data and design' window by clicking 'Quit'.

15.2.2 Prepare feature set

- In PRoNTo's main window, click on 'Prepare feature set' and a new window will open, 'Prepare feature set' (3);
- Select the 'PRT.mat' file previously created in the 'Data & Design' step and another window will open, 'Specify modality to include' (Figure 15.4). Click 'Build one kernel per region' and choose the AAL atlas in the atlas folder in PRoNTo. Leave all the other default options and click 'Done';

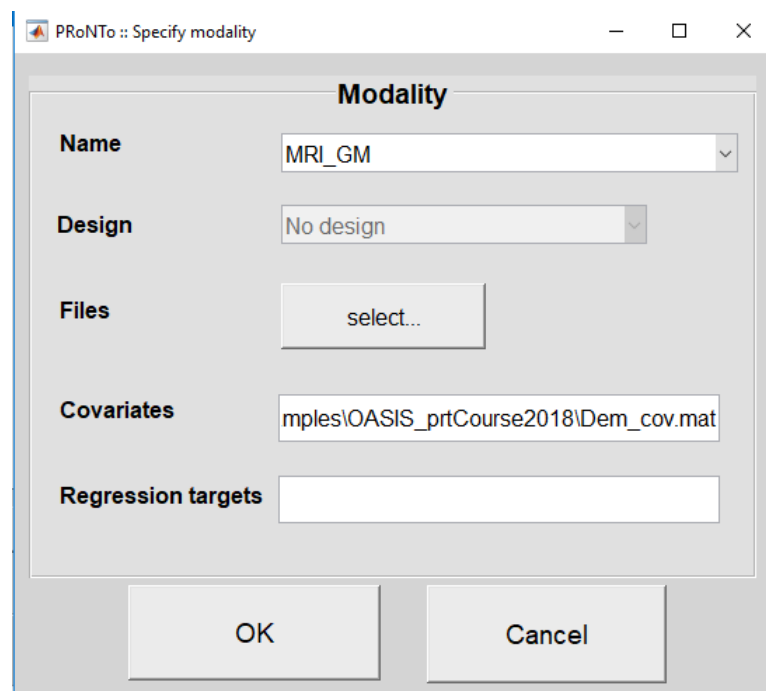


Figure 15.1: ‘Specify modality’ GUI allows one to enter the covariates to be regressed out.

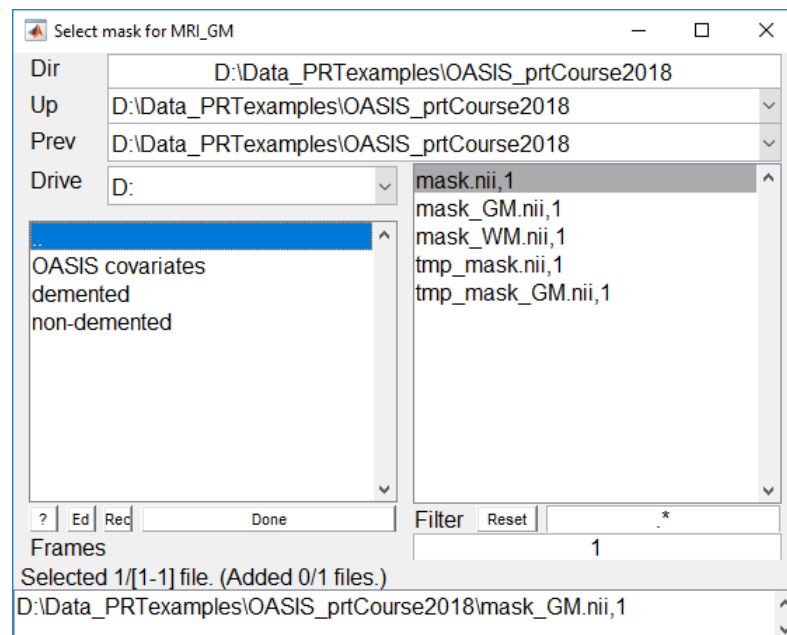


Figure 15.2: This window is called when one clicks ‘Masks’.

- This will bring you back to the ‘Prepare feature set’ window. Provide a name for the feature set, e.g. ‘OASIS_ConfEffects_withCov’;
- Click ‘Build kernel/data matrix’ to build the feature set and kernel.

15.2.3 Specify model

- In PRoNTTo’s main window, click on ‘Specify model’ and a new window will open, ‘Specify model’ (4);

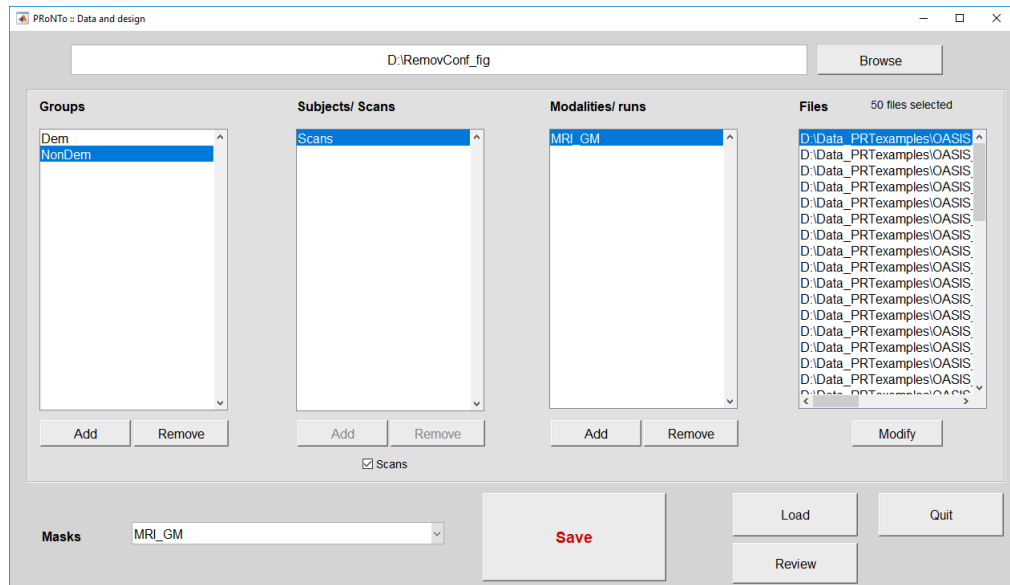


Figure 15.3: ‘Data and design’ GUI final configuration.

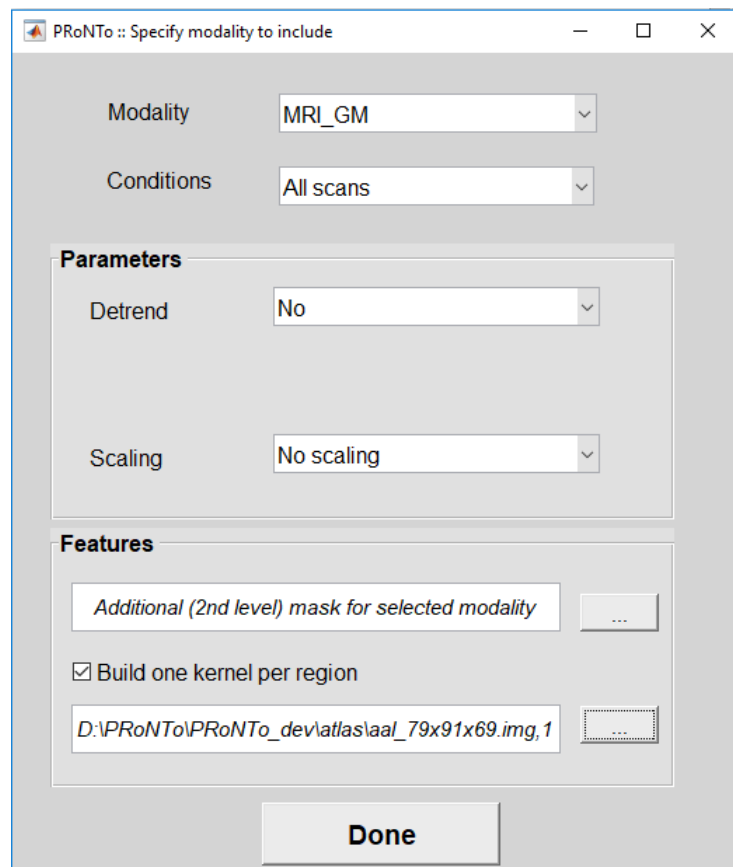


Figure 15.4: ‘Specify modality to include’ GUI.

- Select the ‘PRT.mat’ file and provide a name to the model, e.g. ‘mkl_OASIS_ConfEffects_withCov’;
- Select one of the ‘Feature Set’ previously defined. In this case, there is only one: ‘OASIS_ConfEffects_withCov’;
- Leave the option ‘Use kernels’ tick box as it is, i.e. ‘Yes’;

- Select the ‘Classification’ model type and click on ‘Define classes’ button. A new window will open, ‘Specify classes’ (Figure 15.5), to define the number of classes and a name for each class. We will define 2 classes. For ‘Class 1’ select group ‘Dem’, and all subjects in this first group and, similarly, for ‘Class 2’ select group ‘NonDem’ and all the subjects in this group. The class names can be any names users prefer. Here we simply use the same names to the group names.

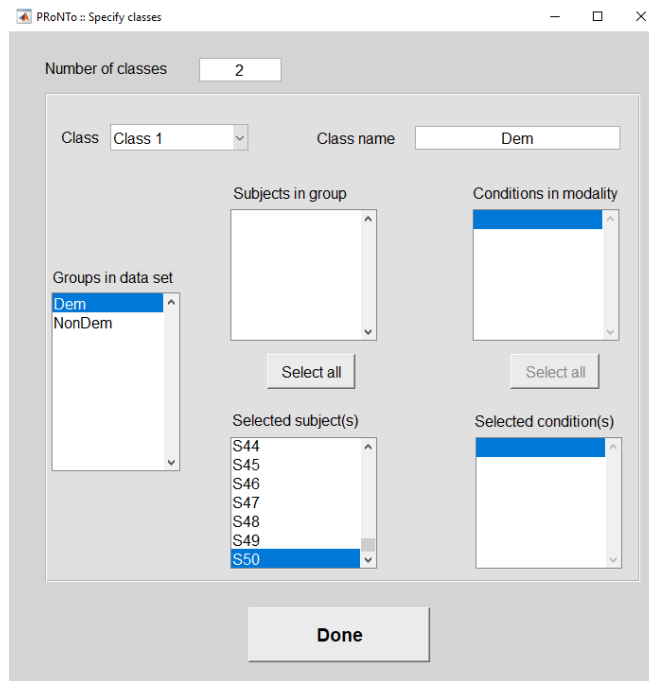


Figure 15.5: ‘Specify classes’ GUI.

- Select the ‘L1-Multi-Kernel Learning’ option, in the ‘Machine’ field;
- Click the ‘Optimize hyper-parameter’ tick box and leave the range unspecified, i.e. use the default hyperparameter range. Choose ‘k-folds CV on Subject per Group’ for the ‘Cross-Validation Scheme’ (internal loop), and input 5 in the pop up window defining the number of folds;
- Similar to the inner loop, select the ‘k-folds CV on Subject per Group’ cross-validation scheme for the external loop, where $k=10$;
- In the ‘Data operations’ box, select the ‘Mean centre features using training data’, ‘Normalize samples’ and ‘Regress out covariates (subject level)’ option. The ‘Regress out covariates (subject level)’ option corresponds to the removal of the contribution of the external variables from the data. Then, the ‘Specify model’ window should look similar to (Figure 15.6). Click on the ‘Specify and run model’ button;

15.2.4 Display results

- In PRoNTo’s main window, click on ‘Display results’ and select the ‘PRT.mat’ file. This will open the main results window (Figure 15.7);
- In the ‘Results’ window, one can select a different plot in the ‘Plots’ list;

15.3 Batch analysis

In this section, the previous experiment will be repeated using the ‘matlabbatch’ system. The reader is advised to complete the tutorial in Section 12.2 before continuing, since the explanation

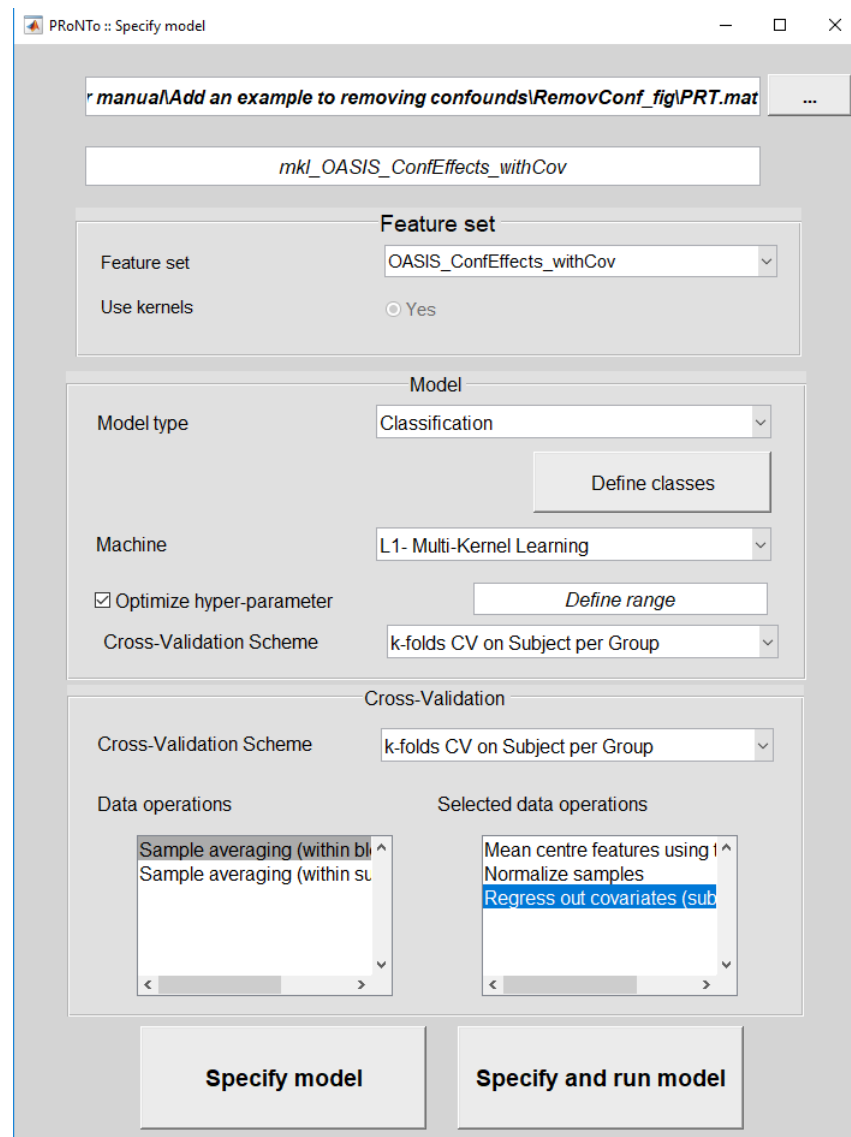


Figure 15.6: ‘Specify model’ GUI final configuration.

of each step will be less descriptive.

Once again, to analyse the data, create a new directory to save the results of the analysis. On the main interface of PRoNTTo click on the ‘Batch’ button to open the ‘matlabbatch’. Alternatively, type ‘prt_batch’ in the MATLABprompt.

15.3.1 Data & Design

- Click on ‘Data & Design’ in the PRoNTTo menu (see Figure 12.26 in Chapter 12);
- In the ‘Directory’ field, select a directory where the ‘PRT.mat’ file will be saved;
- In the ‘Groups’ field:
 - Add two groups;
 - In the field ‘Name’, provide a name without spaces to both groups, e.g. ‘Dem’ and ‘NonDem’;
 - In the field ‘Select by’, select the ‘Scans’ option and add a new modality. For more information on the Scans option please refer to chapter 2;

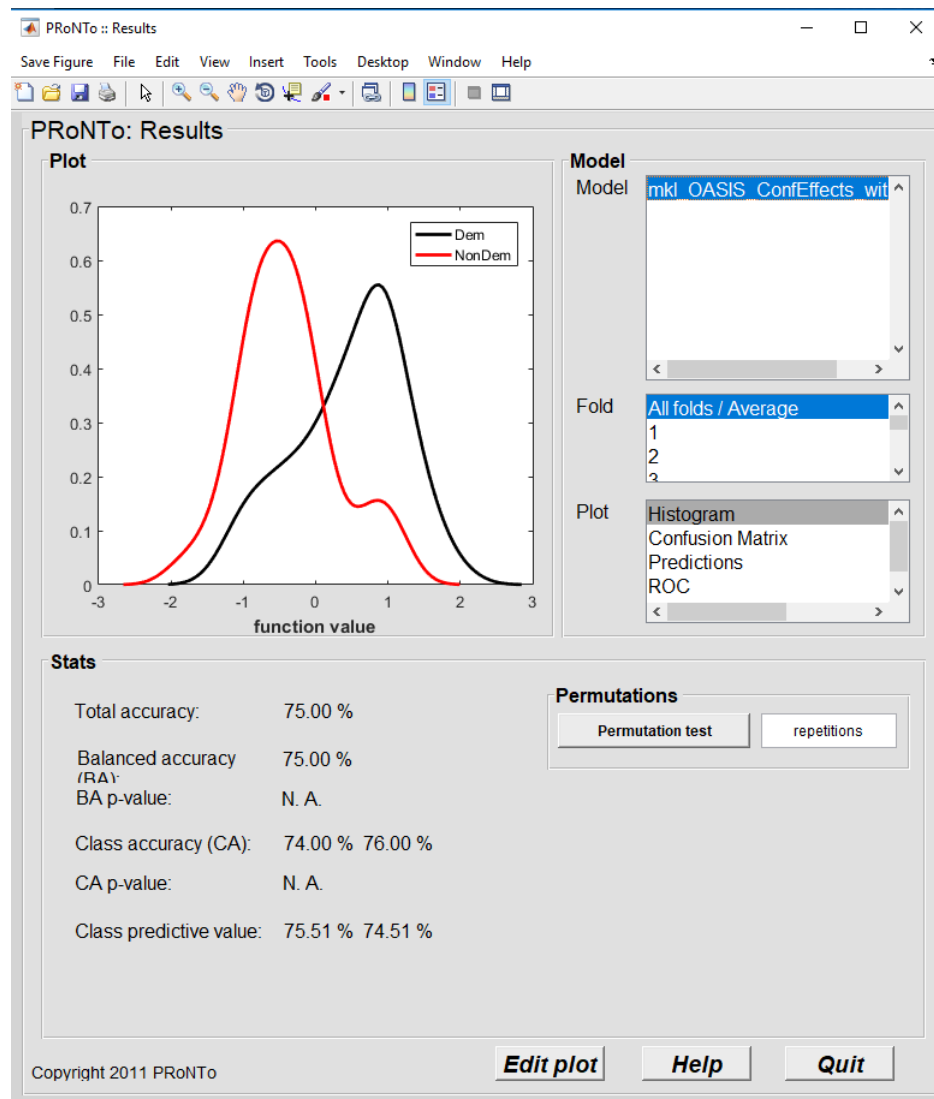
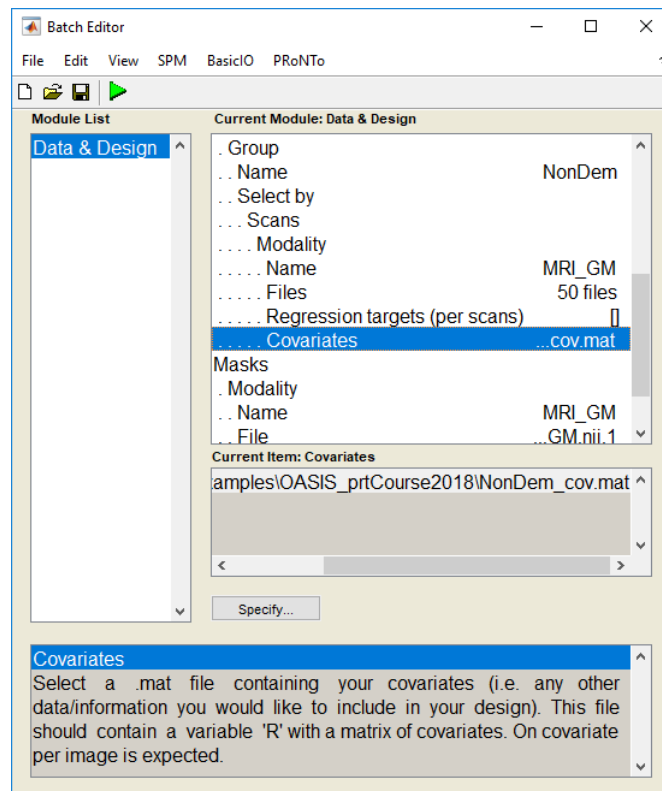


Figure 15.7: ‘Results’ GUI.

- Add one modality and provide a name, e.g. ‘MRI_GM’; and in the field ‘scans’, select the proper images for each of the groups;
- Specify in the ‘Covariates’ the file with the confounds you want to remove. Remember that this file should contain a variable ‘R’ with a matrix of covariates. The batch editor should look similar to the Figure 15.8;
- In the ‘Masks’ field, add a new modality and provide the same modality name, ‘MRI_GM’; and select the ‘mask_GM’ mask available in the Oasis dataset. The name of the modality here has to be exactly the same as in ‘Modalities’;
- Leave the ‘HRF overlap’ and the ‘HRF delay’ fields as default;
- In the ‘Review’ field, select ‘Yes’ if you would like to review your data and design in a separate window. Otherwise, leave as it is, i.e. ‘No’. Note: if ‘Yes’ is selected, users will need to close the Review window after Running the batch to allow following modules execute.

The batch can either be run directly or the following modules can be added to complete multiple steps of the analysis at once. We typically suggest users save and run the ‘Data and Design’ step in a separate batch to avoid deleting/overwriting the PRT each time the batch is run.

Figure 15.8: Data and design module in `matlabbatch`.

15.3.2 Feature set / Kernel

- Click on the ‘Feature set / Kernel’ option on PRoNTTo’s `matlabbatch` menu (see Figure 12.29 in Chapter 12);
- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Data & Design’ step (Figure 12.30) or click on the ‘Select files’ button to browse where ‘PRT.mat’ file was saved;
- Provide a name to the ‘Feature/kernel’ set, e.g. ‘OASIS_ConfEffects-withCov’;
- Add one modality and select the modality name with the ‘Dependency’ button¹(Data & Design:Mod#1 name);
 - In the ‘Scans/Conditions’ field, select the ‘All scans’ option;
 - In the ‘Voxels to include’ field, select ‘All voxels’ option, this means we are not entering an additional second-level mask;
 - In the ‘Detrend’ field, select ‘None’;
 - In the ‘Scale input scans’ field, select ‘No scaling’ option;
 - In ‘Use atlas to build ROI specific kernels’, load the AAL atlas as we did in the GUI section. After all these steps, the batch editor should look similar to the one in Figure 15.9;
- Leave the ‘Use one kernel per modality’ field as default, i.e. ‘No’.

¹Or type it in manually, ‘MRI_GM’, but the name needs to be *exactly* the same as the one specified in the ‘Data & Design’ module.

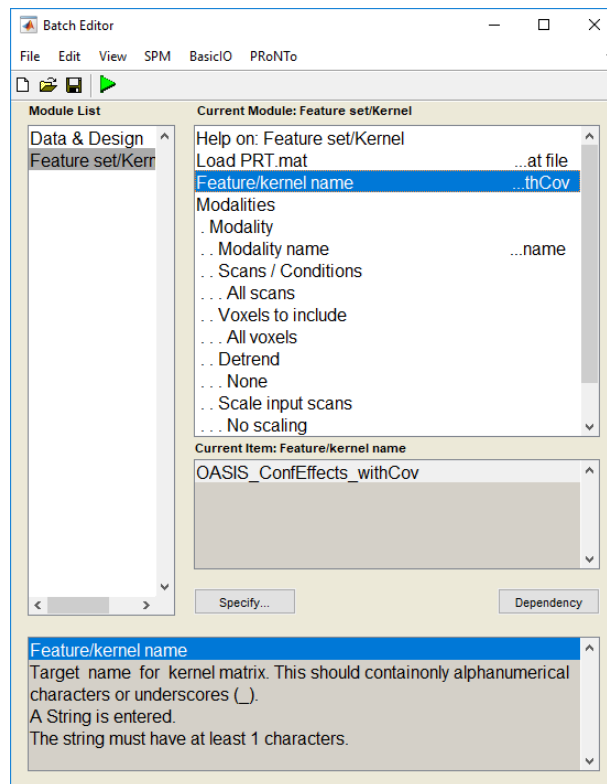


Figure 15.9: Feature set / Kernel module. Selected parameters in the Modality option.

15.3.3 Specify model

- Click on the 'Specify model' option on PRoNTTo's `matlabbatch` menu (see Figure 12.32 in Chapter 12);
- With 'Load PRT.mat' field selected, click on the 'Dependency' button to associate the 'PRT.mat' file created in the previous 'Feature set / Kernel' step or click on the 'Select files' button to browse where 'PRT.mat' file was saved;
- Provide a name to the model, e.g. 'mkl_OASIS_ConfEffects_withCov';
- Leave the 'Use kernels' field as it is, i.e. 'Yes';
- Select the feature set name with the 'Dependency' button²;
- Select the 'Classification' model type:
 - Add 2 new classes;
 - For Class (1) write 'Dem' on the name field, or use Dependency to choose the first group's name defined in 'Data & Design' and add one group. The class name doesn't have to be the same as the group name, this example uses this only for simplicity. After this step, select the group name from the 'Data & Design' module ('Data & Design:Group#1 name') with the 'Dependency' button³. In the 'Subjects' field of the Group 1, type '1:50'. This will tell the program to use all the 50 scans, i.e. from scan 1 to scan 50. In Conditions/Scans, select 'All scans';
 - Similar to Class (1), write 'NonDem' on the name field for Class (2), or use Dependency to choose the second group's name. Then fill the group name using Dependency, i.e.

²or write it *exactly* as previously defined in the 'Feature set / Kernel' module (option 'Feature set/Kernel: Feature/kernel name'), here 'OASIS_ConfEffects_withCov'.

³Or write it *exactly*, as previously defined in the 'Data & Design' module, here 'Dem'

the second group's name created in the 'Data & Design' module, 'NonDem'. In the 'Subjects' field of the Group 2, type '1:50'. In Conditions/Scans, select 'All scans'. If there are many repetitions in the Classes and Groups, users can use the Replicate option when clicking Classes and Groups, respectively. Then change the places specific to each Class or Group;

- In the 'Machine' field:
 - Select the 'L1-Multi-Kernel Learning' option;
 - Set 'Optimize hyper-parameter' field to 'Yes'. Input ' $10^{-2:3}$ ' to the Arguments field;
 - In the 'Cross validation type for hyper-parameter optimization' field, choose 'k-folds CV on subjects per group', and input '5' in the field 'k';
- In the 'Cross-validation type' field, choose 'k-folds CV on subjects per group', and input '10' in the field 'k';
- Leave the 'Include all scans' field as it is, i.e. 'No';
- In the 'Data operations' field:
 - Leave the 'Mean centre features' field as it is, i.e. 'Yes';
 - Click on the 'Other Operations' button, choose 'Select operations', 'New Operation' and select the 'Normalize samples'. Click 'Select operations', 'New Operation', and select 'Regress out covariates (subject level)' option from the list. After all these steps, the batch editor should look similar to the one in Figure 15.10;

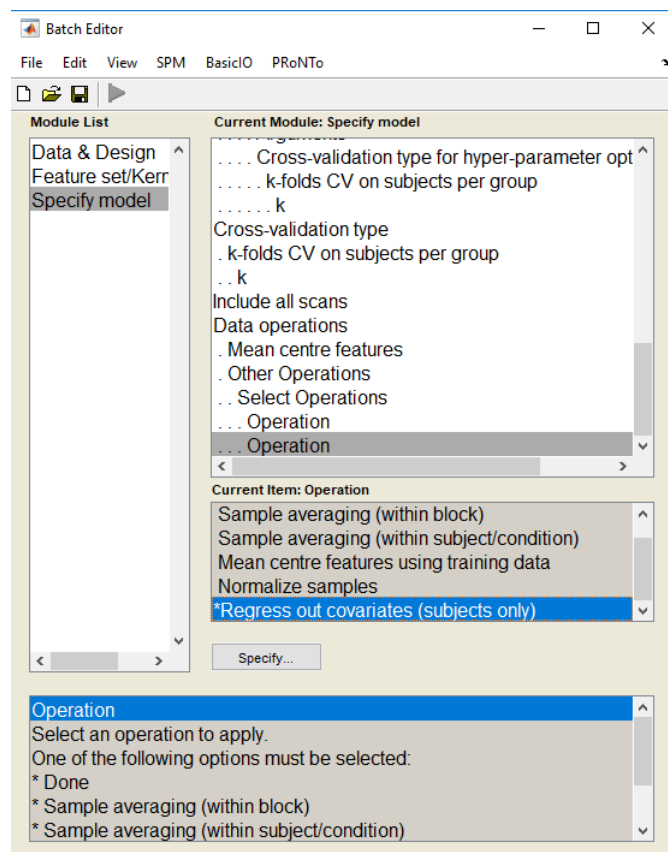


Figure 15.10: Data and design module in `matlabbatch`.

15.3.4 Run model

- Click on the ‘Run model’ option in PRoNTo’s `matlabbatch` menu (see Figure 12.35 in Chapter 12);
- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Specify model’ step;
- Select the model name from the ‘Specify model’ module with the ‘Dependency’ button⁴;
- In the field ‘Do permutation test?’, leave as it is, i.e. ‘No permutation test’.

15.3.5 Compute weights (optional)

- Click on the ‘Compute weights’ option in PRoNTo’s `matlabbatch` menu;
- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Run model’ step;
- In ‘Model name’ field, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the model name from the ‘Specify model’ module;
- In ‘Build weight images per ROI’, users can choose ‘Yes’ to see weight image with summarized information from each ROI. This example uses MKL, where AAL atlas is selected in the Feature set module, hence the atlas will be automatically loaded here if ‘Yes’ is selected;
- Leave the other fields as default.

We are now ready to run the batch: the arrow on top of the `matlabbatch` should be green and can be clicked. If the arrow is gray, please check for missing inputs in different modules (e.g., displayed with an ‘X’).

15.3.6 Display weights (optional)

- In PRoNTo’s main window, click on ‘Display weights’ and select the ‘PRT.mat’ file. This will open the ‘PRoNTo::Weights’ window.
- In the Display panel, click the model name in the ‘Model’ field, ‘mkl_OASIS_ConfEffects_withCov’. An image will appear in the ‘Weights map’ box. To show the ‘Anatomical img’ you have to load an anatomical image for reference. A template image can be found in SPM’s canonical folder (‘single_subj_T1’ file). If selecting ‘weights per voxel’, the weight image shows the weight map using each voxel as the unit. If selecting ‘weights per region’, the weight image shows the weight map per ROI. In the table below Weights map, information on contributions from each ROI and the corresponding ranks are listed. A histogram on the right to this table shows the ranks/contributions of the ROI to the model. For more detailed descriptions to the weights and Display weights module, please see Chapter 5. The final window will look similar to the one shown in the Figure 15.11.

15.4 An example of the effects of removing covariates

This section shows the differences between results with and without removing covariates. Figure 15.12 shows accuracies of the MKL model using OASIS dataset without removing covariates (gender and age), compared to Figure 15.7. Without removing confounds, the accuracy decreased from 75% to 65%. Please note that for the categorical variable gender, we have two categories, i.e. male and female. Hence, we use one-hot encoding and obtain two columns in the R matrix for this gender variable. Another column in R stores values of the age variable.

⁴or write it *exactly* as previously defined in the ‘Specify model’ module, here ‘mkl_OASIS_ConfEffects_withCov’

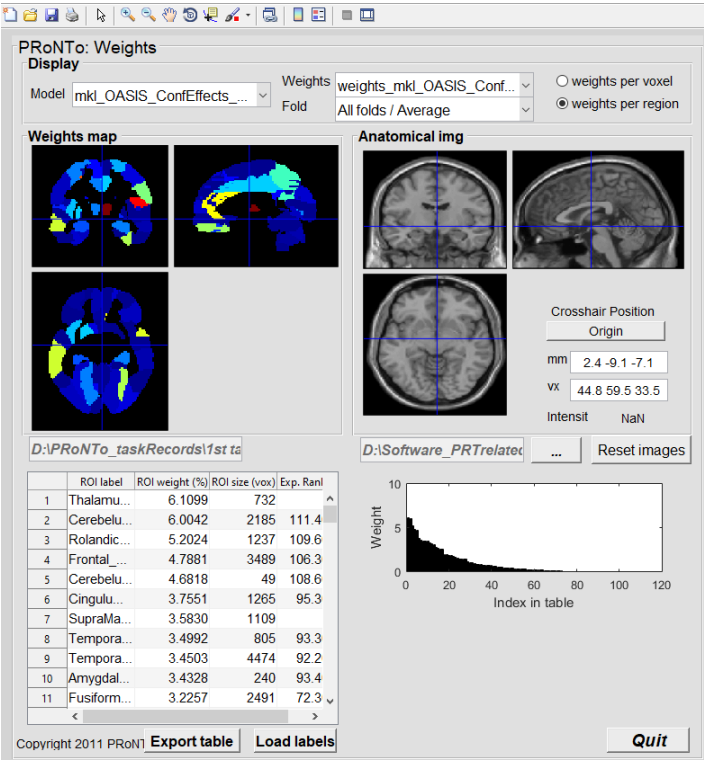


Figure 15.11: Weights map

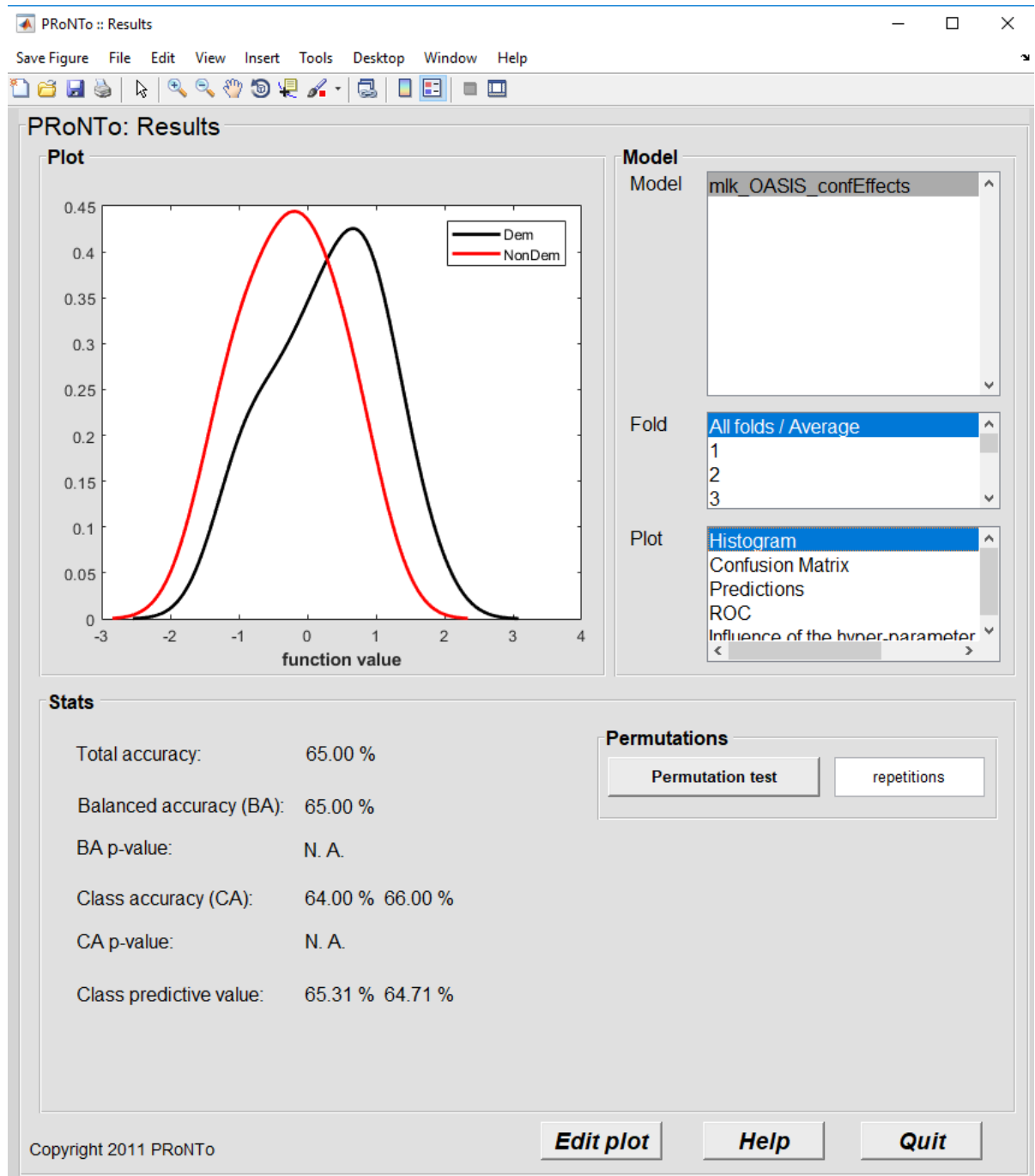


Figure 15.12: ‘Accuracies of MKL without removing covariates’ GUI.

Chapter 16

Removing confounds: a regression example

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16.1 Introduction

This chapter will describe the steps necessary to remove confounding effects using PRoNTo in a regression approach. These are similar to the ones used in the previous chapter, thus, the reader is advised to complete the tutorial in Chapter 15 before moving on, since the explanation of some steps will be less descriptive. The dataset used in this chapter can be found on PRoNTo's website <http://www.mlnl.cs.ucl.ac.uk/pronto/prtdata.html> (data set 3).

As in previous Chapters, we will start analyzing the data with PRoNTo's GUI and then repeating the analysis using the `matlabbatch` system. Please create a folder in your computer to store the results and type 'prt' or 'pronto' in the MATLAB prompt. This will open the main interface of PRoNTo (see Figure 12.1 in Chapter 12).

16.2 GUI analysis

16.2.1 Data & Design

- In PRoNTo's main window, click on 'Data & Design' and a new window will open, 'Data and design' (Figure 12.2). Like in previous chapters, browse the directory in which to save the PRT structure (saved as 'PRT.mat');
- In the panel Groups, click on Add and provide a name to the group, e.g. 'Aged'.

- All the images in the dataset correspond to different subjects; therefore, click on the Scans tick box. This will lock the Subjects/Scans field, allowing you to skip to the third field.
- In the ‘Modalities’ panel, click on ‘Add’ and provide a name to the modality, e.g. ‘MRI’.
- Load all the image files available in the directory (IXIdata/aged/Guys/). You can select all the files by using the right mouse button and clicking on the option ‘Select All’ or clicking on the first image then shift-click on the last. Please ensure that the order of the images in the selection is as expected (e.g. SPM can place scan10 before scan2). When all the images are selected, click on the ‘Done’ button;
- In the ‘Covariates’ field, type the covariates you want to regress out. In this example, ‘Gender’ is the one chosen. As in the previous chapter, covariates can be input to PRoNTTo by directly copying values into the Covariate if there is only one confounding factor, or by typing the full path of the R matrix containing either one column or multiple columns. As ‘Gender’ is categorical, one-hot encoding was used (i.e. one column for males and one column for females in the ‘R’ matrix).
- In the ‘Regression targets’ field, write (or paste) the list of target values available in the ‘Age_old_Guys’ file (IXIdata/aged/), or input the full path of a file containing the target values in a column (saved in a ‘rt_subj’ variable). The final window should look like to the Figure 16.1. Press ‘OK’;

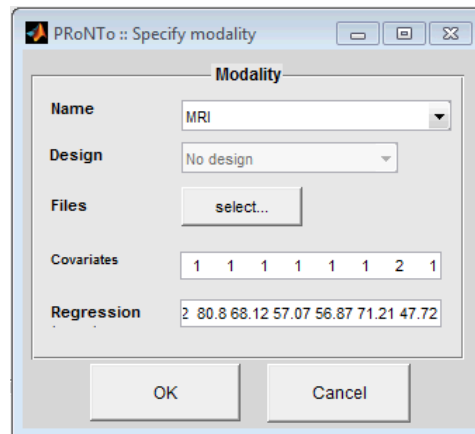


Figure 16.1: ‘Specify modality’ GUI allows one to enter the covariates to be regressed out.

- In the ‘Masks’ field, on the bottom left of the ‘Data and design’ window, select the ‘mergedsmwrc1_mask_01’ mask for the modality specified;
- The ‘Data and design’ window should look similar to Figure 16.2. Click on the ‘Save’ button to create the ‘PRT.mat’ file with the structure containing the information that has been previously specified. If no errors are shown in the MATLABcommand, leave the ‘Data and design’ window by clicking ‘Quit’.

16.2.2 Prepare feature set

- In PRoNTTo’s main window, click on ‘Prepare feature set’ and a new window will open, ‘Prepare feature set’ (see Figure 12.9 in Chapter 12);
- Select the ‘PRT.mat’ file previously created in the ‘Data & Design’ step and another window will open, ‘Specify modality to include’ (see Figure 15.4 in Chapter 15);
- In the ‘Prepare feature set’ window, provide a name for the feature set, e.g. ‘KRRAGED’;
- Click on ‘Build kernel/data matrix’ to build the feature set and kernel.

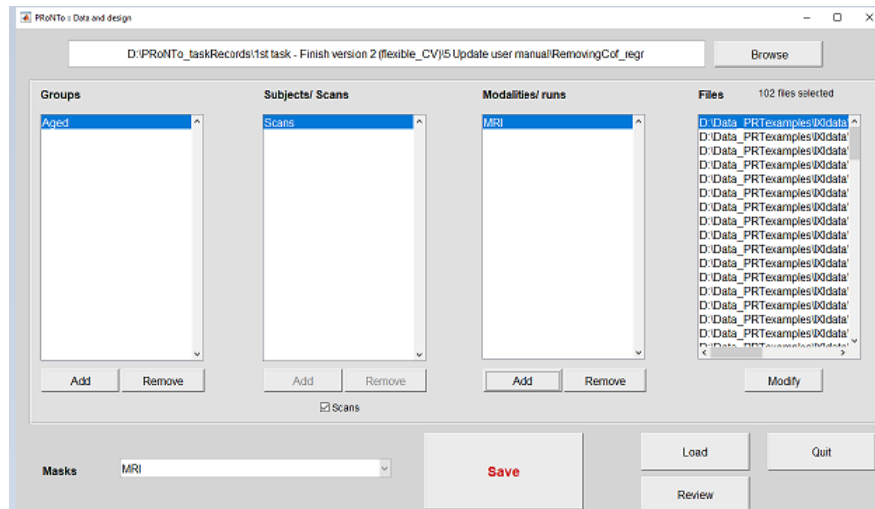


Figure 16.2: ‘Data and design’ GUI final configuration.

16.2.3 Specify model

- In PRoNTto’s main window, click on ‘Specify model’ and a new window will open, ‘Specify model’ (see Figure 12.12 in Chapter 12);
- Select the ‘PRT.mat’ file and provide a name to the model, e.g. ‘KRR’;
- Select one of the ‘Feature Set’ previously defined. In this case, there is only one: ‘KRRaged’;
- Leave the option ‘Use kernels’ tick box as it is, i.e. ‘Yes’;
- Select the ‘Regression’ model type and click on the ‘Select subjects/scans’ button. This will open a new window, ‘Specify subjects/scans to regress’, click on the ‘Select all’ button to use all the scans for the regression (Figure 16.3);

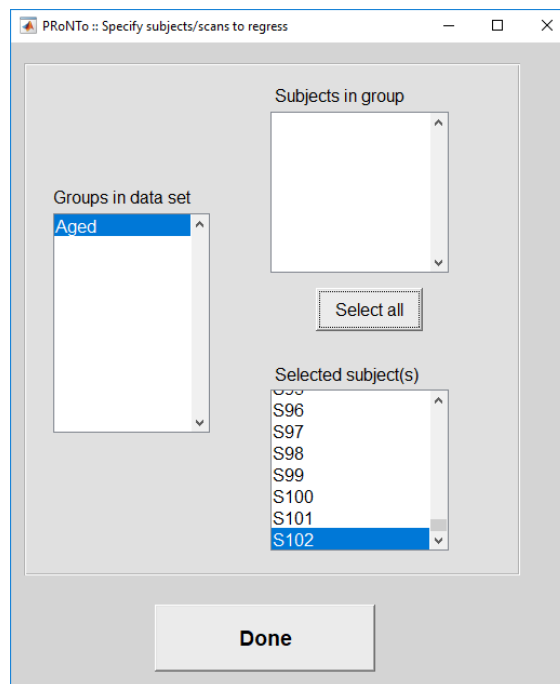


Figure 16.3: ‘Specify classes’ GUI.

- Select the ‘Kernel Ridge Regression’ option, in the Machine field;
- Check the option ‘Optimize hyper-parameter’ tick box. Type ‘10.^[-5:5]’ on the right field. Then, select ‘k-fold CV on Subject-Out’ option in the ‘Cross-Validation Scheme’ field (internal loop). After that, type ‘5’ in the new window that will open (see Figure 16.4);

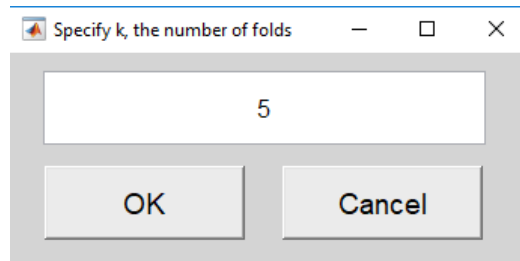


Figure 16.4: Number of folds selected in the internal loop.

- Select the ‘Leave One Subject Out’ cross-validation scheme (external loop);
- In the ‘Data operations’ box, select the ‘Regress out covariates (subject level)’ option, which corresponds to the removal of the contribution of some external variables to the data, and ‘Mean centre features using training data’ option. Then, the ‘Specify model’ window should look similar to Figure 16.5. Click on the ‘Specify and run model’ button;

16.2.4 Display results

- In PRoNTTo’s main window, click on ‘Display results’ and select the ‘PRT.mat’ file. This will open the main results window (Figure 16.6);
- In the ‘Results’ window, select the ‘KRR’ model and ‘All folds’. The results should look like:

16.2.5 Compute weights (optional step)

- In PRoNTTo’s main window, click on ‘Compute weights’ and a new window will open, ‘Compute weights’ (Figure 16.7);
- Select the ‘PRT.mat’ file;
- Select the model from the list to ‘Models computed in PRT’, ‘KRR’ model;
- Leave the option ‘Compute average/kernel weight per region’ tick box unchecked;
- Click on ‘Compute weights’ button. Computations will be displayed on the MATLAB command window.

16.3 Batch analysis

In this section, the previous experiment will be repeated using the ‘matlabbatch’ system. The reader is advised to complete the tutorial in Section 12.2 before continuing, since the explanation of each step will be less descriptive.

Once again, to analyse the data, create a new directory in which to save the results of the analysis. On the main interface of PRoNTTo click on the ‘Batch’ button to open the ‘matlabbatch’. Alternatively, type ‘prt_batch’ in the MATLAB prompt.

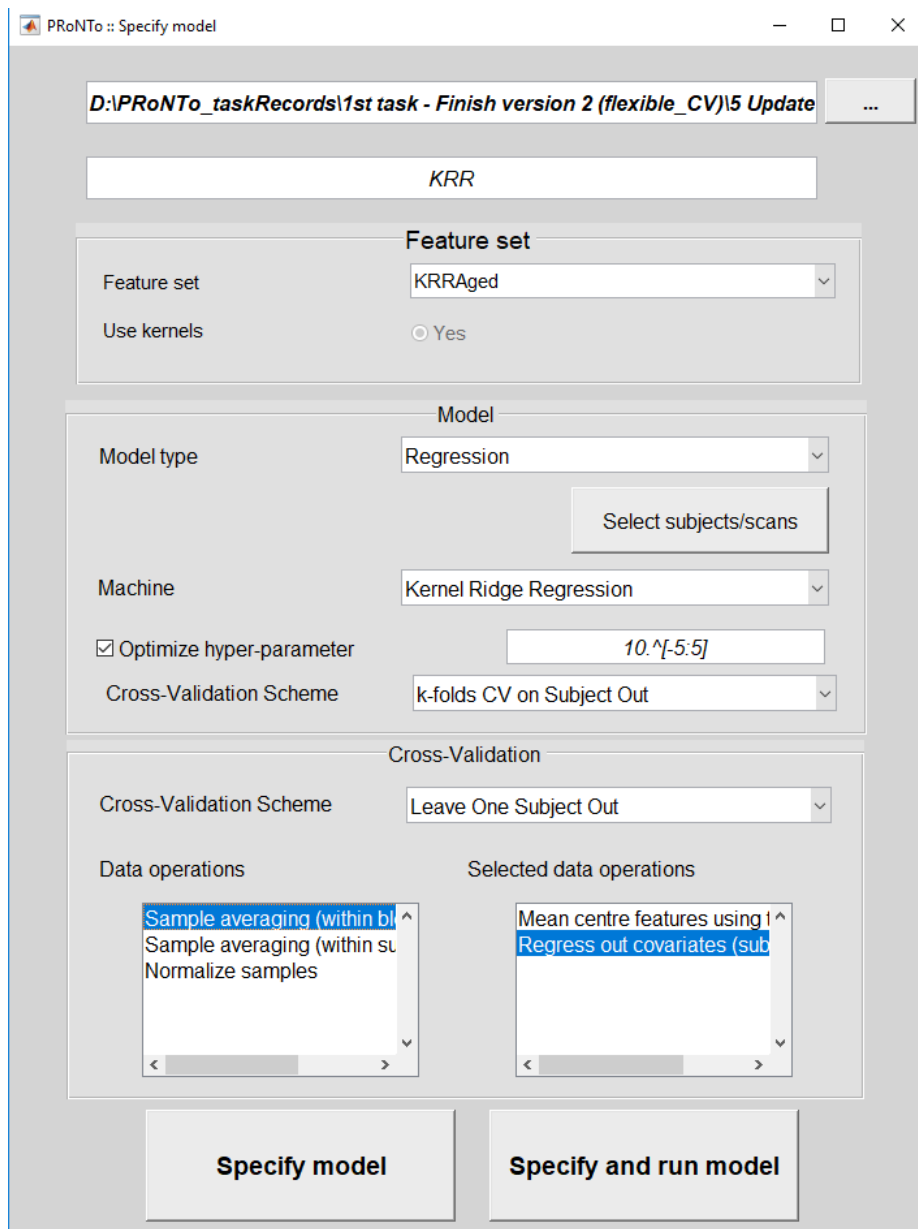


Figure 16.5: ‘Specify model’ GUI final configuration.

16.3.1 Data & Design

- Click on ‘Data & Design’ in the PProNTTo menu (see Figure 12.26 in Chapter 12);
- In the ‘Directory’ field, select a directory where the ‘PRT.mat’ file will be saved;
- In the ‘Groups’ field:
 - Add one group;
 - In the field ‘Name’, provide a name without spaces for this group, e.g. ‘Aged’;
 - In the field ‘Select by’, select the ‘Scans’ option and add a new modality. For more information on the Scans option please consult Chapter 2;
 - Provide a name for this modality, e.g. ‘MRI’; select the image files available in the ‘aged/Guys’ directory of the IXI dataset and write (or paste) the regression targets¹

¹Available in the ‘Age-old-Guys’ file (IXIdata/aged/)

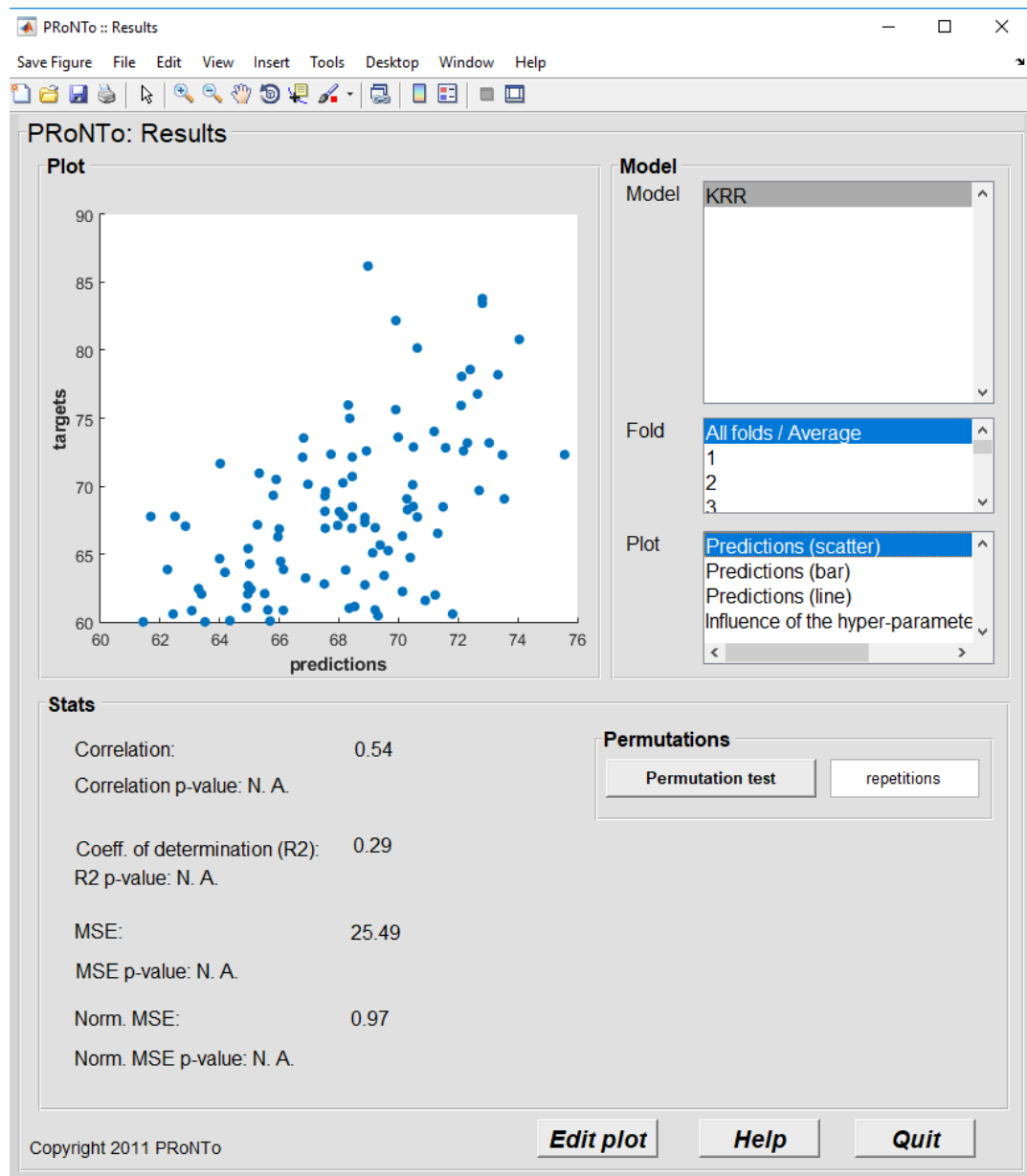


Figure 16.6: 'Results' GUI.

in the 'Regression targets (per scans)' field;

- Specify in the 'Covariates' the file with the confounds you want to remove. Remember that this file should contain a variable 'R' with a matrix of covariates (Data & Design:Mod#1 name)²;
- In the 'Masks' field, add a new modality and provide the same modality name, 'MRI'; and select the 'mergedsmwrc1_mask_01' mask for the modality specified.
- Leave the 'HRF overlap' and the 'HRF delay' fields as default;
- In the 'Review' field, select 'Yes' if you would like to review your data and design in a separate window. Otherwise, leave as it is, i.e. 'No'.

²It is possible to regress out more than one covariate just adding to the variable 'R' as many columns as the number of covariates

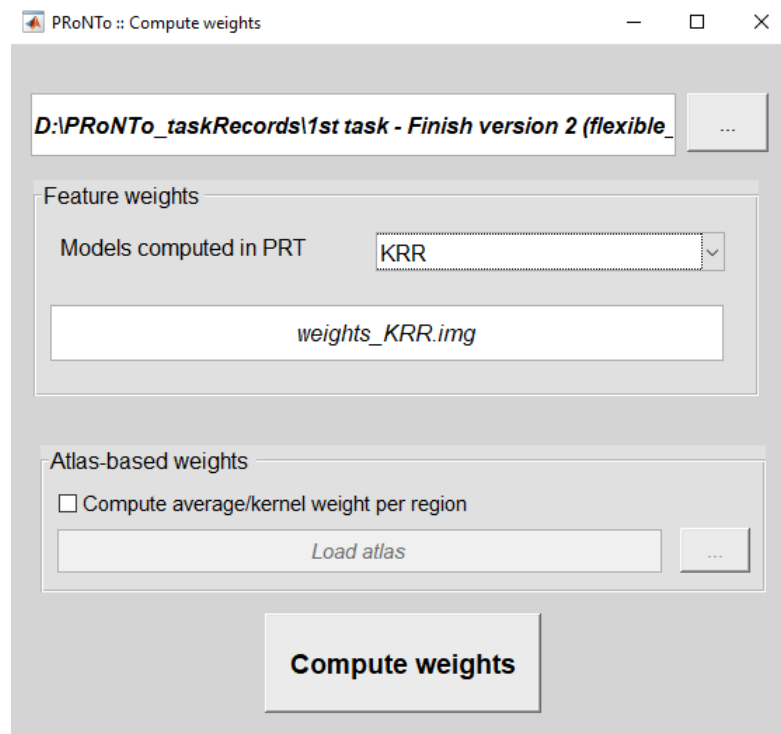


Figure 16.7: ‘Compute weights’ GUI.

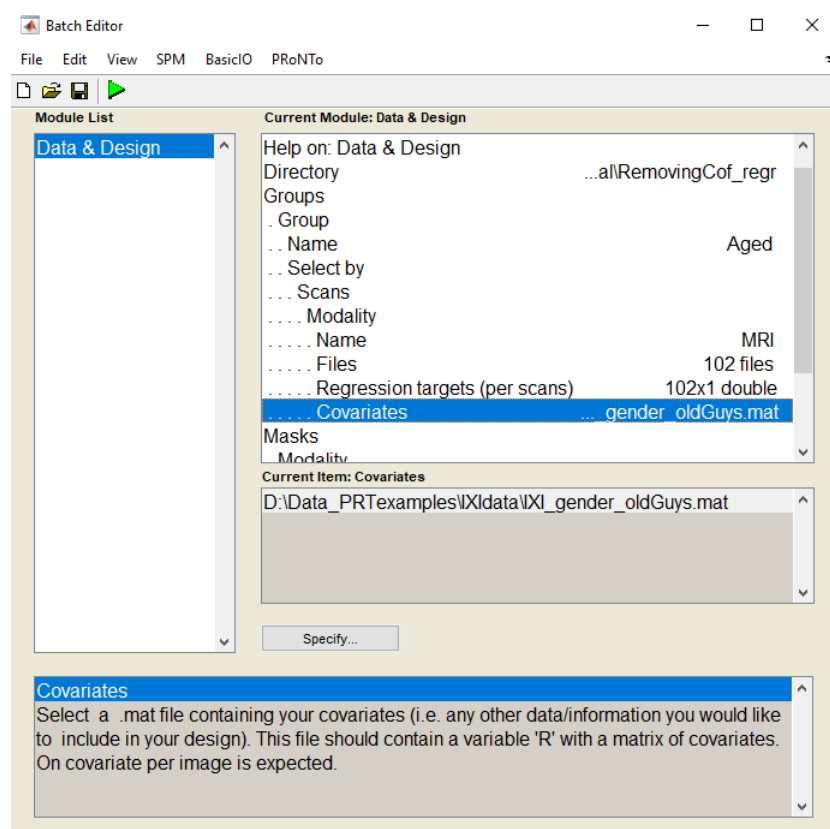


Figure 16.8: Data and design module in matlabbatch.

16.3.2 Feature set / Kernel

- Click on the ‘Feature set / Kernel’ option on PRoNTTo’s `matlabbatch` menu (see Figure 12.29 in Chapter 12);
- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Data & Design’ step (Figure 12.30) or click on the ‘Select files’ button to browse where ‘PRT.mat’ file was saved;
- Provide a name to the ‘Feature/kernel’ set, e.g. ‘KRRaged’;
- Add one modality and select the modality name with the ‘Dependency’ button³(Data & Design:Mod#1 name);
 - In the ‘Scans/Conditions’ field , select the ‘All scans’ option;
 - In the ‘Voxels to include’ field, select ‘All voxels’ option, this means we are not entering an additional second-level mask;
 - In the ‘Detrend’ field, select ‘None’;
 - In the ‘Scale input scans’ field, select ‘No scaling’ option;
 - Leave ‘Load Atlas’ as default. After all these steps, the batch editor should look similar to the one in Figure 16.9;

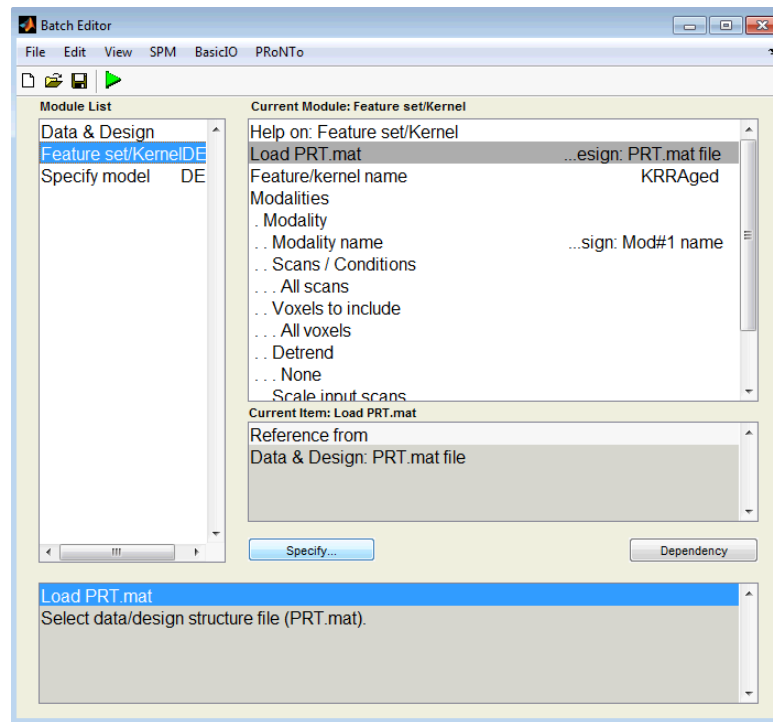


Figure 16.9: Feature set / Kernel module. Selected parameters in the Modality option.

- Leave the ‘Use one kernel per modality’ field as default.

16.3.3 Specify model

- Click on the ‘Specify model’ option on PRoNTTo’s `matlabbatch` menu (see Figure 12.32 in Chapter 12);

³Or type it in manually, ‘MRI’, but the name needs to be *exactly* the same as the one specified in the ‘Data & Design’ module.

- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Feature set / Kernel’ step or click on the ‘Select files’ button to browse where ‘PRT.mat’ file was saved;
- Provide a name to the model, e.g. ‘KRR’;
- Leave the ‘Use kernels’ field as it is, i.e. ‘Yes’;
- Select the feature set name with the ‘Dependency’ button⁴;
- Select the ‘Regression’ model type:
 - Add a new group and call it ‘Aged’, as in the ‘Data and Design’ step;
 - In the ‘Subjects’ field, type 1:102. This will instruct the program to use all the 102 scans, i.e. from scan 1 to scan 102;
- In the ‘Machine’ field:
 - Select the ‘Kernel Ridge Regression’ option:
 - Change the ‘Optimize hyper-parameter’ field as to ‘Yes’; Type ‘10.^[-5:5]’ on the ‘Regularization’ field. Then, select ‘k-fold CV on Subject-Out’ option in the ‘Cross-Validation Scheme’ field (internal loop). After that, type 5 in ‘k’ field;
- In the ‘Cross-validation type’ field, select ‘Leave one subject out’ option;
- Leave the ‘Include all scans’ field as it is, i.e. ‘No’;
- In the ‘Data operations’ field:
 - Leave the ‘Mean centre features’ field as it is, i.e. ‘Yes’;
 - Click on the ‘Other Operations’ button, choose ‘Select operations’, ‘New Operation’ and select the ‘Regress out covariates (subject level)’ option from the list. After all these steps, the batch editor should look similar to the one in Figure 16.10;

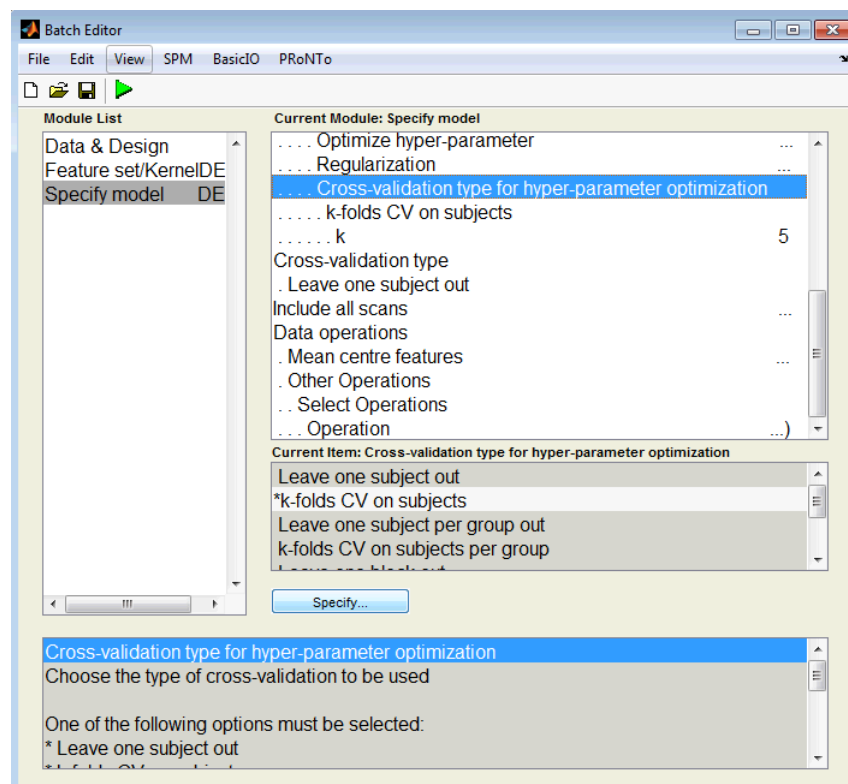
16.3.4 Run model

- Click on the ‘Run model’ option on PRoNTo’s `matlabbatch` menu (see Figure 12.35 in Chapter 12);
- With ‘Load PRT.mat’ field selected, click on the ‘Dependency’ button to associate the ‘PRT.mat’ file created in the previous ‘Specify model’ step;
- Select the model name from the ‘Specify model’ module with the ‘Dependency’ button⁵;
- In the field ‘Do permutation test?’, leave as it is, i.e. ‘No permutation test’

We are now ready to run the batch: the arrow on top of the `matlabbatch` should be green and can be clicked. If the arrow is gray, check the different modules for missing inputs (displayed by an ‘X’). The outputs should be the same as with the GUI.

⁴or write it *exactly* as previously defined in the ‘Feature set / Kernel’ module (option ‘Feature set/Kernel: Feature/kernel name’), here ‘KRR Aged’.

⁵or write it *exactly* as previously defined in the ‘Specify model’ module, here ‘KRR’

Figure 16.10: Data and design module in `matlabbatch`.

Part IV

Advanced topics

Chapter 17

Developer's guide

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17.1 Introduction

As described in the Introduction, PRoNTTo was developed using a modular structure. There are five main modules ('Data and Design', 'Prepare Feature set', 'Specify model', 'Run model' and 'Compute weights') and three reviewing and displaying modules ('Review data', 'Review kernel and CV' and 'Display results'). This structure not only facilitates the use of the toolbox but also new contributions from developers. These modules have very few dependencies between each other, and for most of them to work, one needs only to provide the 'PRT.mat' obtained from the previous module and a few more module specific inputs. This means that the developer can contribute with code for any of the modules without having to adapt the whole toolbox to the changes. Developers can also work only on the module of interest and do not need to be familiar with the functions and sub functions that comprise the rest of the toolbox. In this chapter, we provide a brief description of how the code is organised and how one can contribute with new code, in particular new GUIs and Batch functions. At the end of this chapter, we provide instructions on how to integrate a new machine into PRoNTTo. In the current version of PRoNTTo, this is the most straightforward extension that can be added.

17.2 Code organisation

Although from the user's point of view there are five main modules, from the developer's side one can see PRoNTTo's functions as belonging to three categories, depending on what they deal with (Figure 17.1). The first set of functions and sub-functions is responsible for creating PRoNTTo's GUIs and matlabbatch menu. The second set of functions comprise all the core routines that implement the machine learning methods (including extraction and preparation of the features, specification and estimation of a model, cross-validation, etc.). The last set of functions correspond to the actual machine learning algorithms that PRoNTTo uses for classification and regression. We call these functions the 'machines'. The main difference between this last set of functions and the rest, is that one does not need to be familiar with PRoNTTo's PRT.mat structure or the rest of the code to be able to integrate a new machine. This can be done very easily, as shown below.

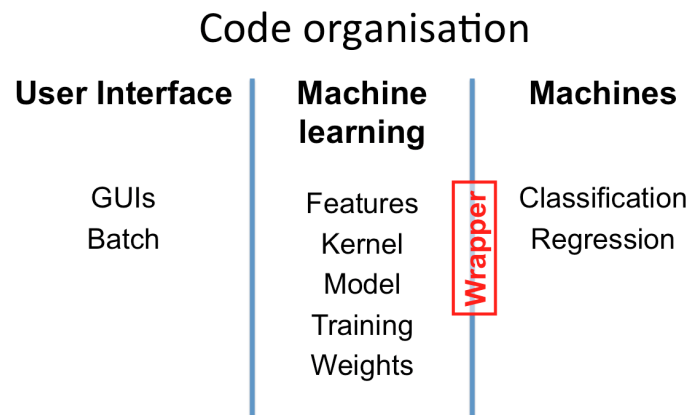


Figure 17.1: Organisation of PRoNTTo's functions. From the developer's perspective the code is organised in functions and sub functions that deal with the user interface experience (such as GUI and batch functions), the core functions that implement the machine learning approaches (including extracting and preparing the features, specification and estimation of a model, cross-validation routines, etc.) and the actual machine learning algorithms (also known as machines).

17.2.1 User interface

The functions that deal with creating and running PRoNTTo's main GUIs have the prefix 'prt_ui'. All GUI functions ('.m' files) have a corresponding '.fig' file. This file can be opened and edited using MATLAB's guide functionality. This way one can change the GUI and add extra options to the available menus (for more information, please consult MATLAB's documentation¹).

PRoNTTo's matlabbatch functions have either the prefix 'prt_cfg', to create a new menu on the batch interface and the prefix 'prt_run', to execute instructions using the variables from the corresponding 'prt_cfg' function. PRoNTTo's batch functionalities work exactly like SPM. For more information on how to contribute with new matlabbatch functions please consult the developer's guide on the SPM8 manual².

17.2.2 Machine learning

The machine learning routines comprise the core of PRoNTTo. These routines do most of the necessary instructions to run all machine learning procedures currently implemented in the toolbox. They don't have a specific prefix but from the name of the .m file it is easy to find out what the function does (e.g. prt_compute_weights.m deals with creating new weights images). Most of the functions take as input the PRT.mat structure. Therefore, knowledge of this structure (see next chapter) is required in order to contribute with new code. In the future, we intend to make the process of introducing new feature selection algorithms and other model functionalities as easy as implementing a new machine, as described below.

17.2.3 Machines

Integrating a new machine algorithm, i.e. classifier or regressor, into the PRoNTTo framework is straightforward. PRoNTTo provides a function called 'prt_machine.m' that works as a wrapper around the different machine learning algorithms (functions with prefix 'prt_machine'). In brief, this wrapper translates PRoNTTo's structure and internal variables into the required inputs for each machine. This way, the machine function needs only to read a simple input format that does not depend on knowledge of how PRoNTTo works or of the PRT.mat fields (Figure 17.2).

More specifically, to contribute with a new machine the developer needs to provide a matlab function, which reads the following input data structure, *d*, and optional arguments, *args*, (all

¹<http://www.mathworks.com/help/techdoc>

²<http://www.fil.ion.ucl.ac.uk/spm/doc/manual.pdf>

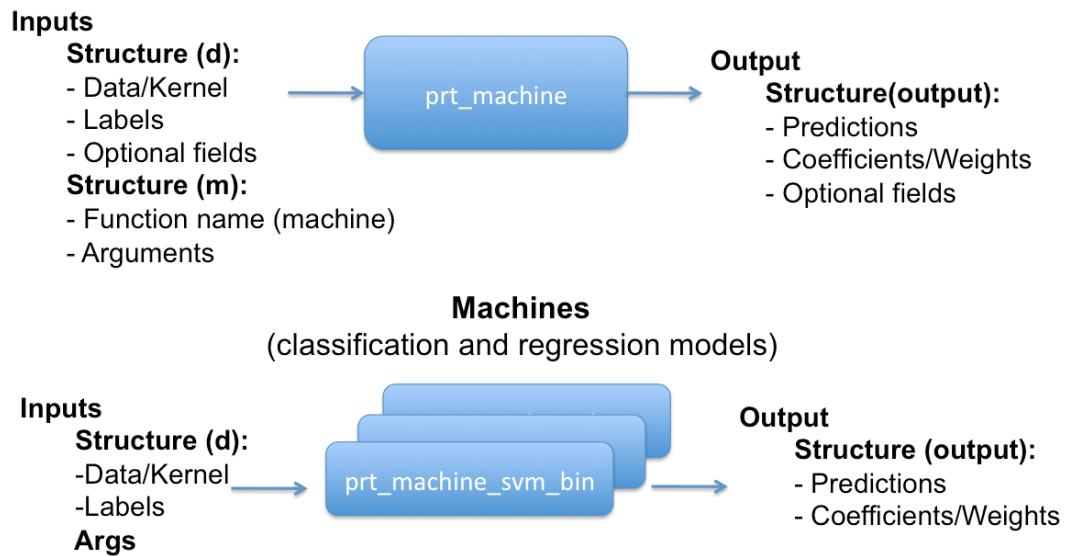


Figure 17.2: Code organisation for integrating a new machine with PRoNTo. ‘prt_machine.m’ works has a wrapper that translates PRoNTo’s inputs into the machine format inputs and performs extensive error checks on these variables. The machines (such as ‘prt_machine_svm_bin.m’) perform the classifier/regression algorithms and have inputs and outputs that are not dependent on PRoNTo’s internal structures.

fields are mandatory except where otherwise stated):

- *d* - data structure with input to the classifier/regressor:
 - .train* - training data (cell array of matrices of row vectors, each [Ntr x D]). Each matrix contains one representation of the data. This is useful for approaches such as multiple kernel learning. Ntr is the number of training examples and D is the dimension of the feature set (e.g. number of voxels).
 - .test* - testing data (cell array of matrices row vectors, each [Nte x D]). Nte is the number of testing examples and D the dimension of the feature set.
 - .tr_targets* - training labels (for classification) or values (for regression) (column vector, [Ntr x 1]).
 - .use_kernel* - flag: is data in form of kernel matrices (true) or in form of features (false)?
- *args* (optional) - anything else that is specific to the algorithm (e.g. LIBSVM arguments).

In addition, the outputs of the function need to have the following format, so that they can be read by the wrapper and translated back to the PRoNTo framework (all fields are mandatory except where otherwise stated) (Figure 17.2):

- *output* - output structure with fields:
 - .predictions* - predictions of classification or regression [Nte x D]. Nte is the number of test examples and D the dimension of the feature set.
 - .func_val* (optional) - value of the decision function (if it applies).
 - .type* (optional) - type of machine (string: ‘classifier’ or ‘regressor’).

The rest of the function can be designed entirely as the developer wishes. The last thing to have in mind is the name of the function itself. It needs to have the prefix ‘prt_machine’ (e.g. ‘prt_machine_svm_bin’ is a function that implements support vector machine binary classification by calling the LIBSVM library). Importantly, the cross-validation and performance measures are performed outside in the main PRoNTo framework, and therefore the machine function should provide only the necessary instructions to implement the classifier/regressor algorithm.

```

function output = prt_machine_svm_bin(d,args)
% Run binary SVM - wrapper for libSVM
% FORMAT output = prt_machine_svm_bin(d,args)
% Inputs:
%   d          - structure with data information, with mandatory fields:
%   .train      - training data (cell array of matrices of row vectors,
%                 each [Ntr x D]). each matrix contains one representation
%                 of the data. This is useful for approaches such as
%                 multiple kernel learning.
%   .test       - testing data (cell array of matrices row vectors, each
%                 [Nte x D])
%   .tr_targets - training labels (for classification) or values (for
%                 regression) (column vector, [Ntr x 1])
%   .use_kernel - flag, is data in form of kernel matrices (true) or in
%                 form of features (false)
%   args       - libSVM arguments
% Output:
%   output      - output of machine (struct).
%   * Mandatory fields:
%   .predictions - predictions of classification or regression [Nte x D]
%   * Optional fields:
%   .func_val     - value of the decision function
%   .type        - which type of machine this is (here, 'classifier')
%
% Copyright (C) 2011 Machine Learning & Neuroimaging Laboratory

```

Figure 17.3: ‘prt_machine.m’ function help. Example of a PRoNTo machine for 2-class SVM classification.

Finally, the new machine is easily integrated with PRoNTo by including the name of the file in the corresponding GUI and Batch functions (prt_ui_model.m and prt_cfg_model.m, respectively).

The same procedure applies to the weights functions. PRoNTo provides a wrapper function called ‘prt_weights’. The procedure for integrating a new weights function is exactly the same as for a new machine.

Both wrapper functions, ‘prt_machine’ and ‘prt_weights’, perform extensive tests to make sure the machines and weights code complies to the specific inputs and outputs required by the framework.

Chapter 18

PRT structure

This is how the main PRT structure is organised.
PRT

- group
 - gr_name
 - subject
 - subj_name
 - modality
 - mod_name
 - detrend
 - covar
 - rt_subj
 - design
 - conds
 - cond_name()
 - onsets()
 - durations()
 - scans()
 - blocks()
 - discardedscans()
 - hrfdiscardedscans()
 - stats
 - overlap
 - goodscans
 - discscans
 - meanovl
 - stdovl
 - mgoodovl
 - sgoodovl
 - goodovl
 - TR
 - unit
 - covar
 - scans
- masks
 - mod_name

- fname
- hrfoverlap
- hrfdelay
- type
- fs
 - fs_name
 - k_file
 - id_col_names
 - fas
 - im
 - ifa
 - modality
 - mod_name
 - detrend
 - param_dt
 - mode
 - idfeat_fas
 - normalise
 - type
 - scaling
 - idfeat_img
 - num_ROI
 - igood_kerns
 - id_mat
 - multkernelROI
 - multkernel
 - atlas_name
 - atlas_label
- fas
 - mod_name
 - dat
 - detrend
 - param_dt
 - hdr
 - fname
 - dim
 - dt
 - pinfo
 - mat
 - n
 - descrip
 - private
 - idfeat_img
- model

- model_name()
- input()
 - use_kernel
 - type
 - machine
 - function
 - args
 - use_nested_cv
 - nested_param
 - cv_type_nested
 - cv_k_nested
 - class
 - class_name()
 - group()
 - gr_name
 - subj
 - fs
 - fs_name
 - samp_idx
 - include_allscans
 - targets
 - targ_allscans
 - covar
 - cov_allscans
 - cv_k
 - cv_mat
 - cv_type
 - operations
- output()
 - fold
 - param_effect()
 - param
 - opt_param
 - vary_param
 - targets()
 - predictions()
 - stats()
 - con_mat
 - acc
 - c_acc
 - b_acc
 - c_pv
 - acc_lb
 - acc_ub
 - func_val()
 - type()
 - alpha()

- b()
 - totalSV()
- stats
 - con_mat
 - acc
 - c_acc
 - b_acc
 - c_pv
 - acc_lb
 - acc_ub
- weight_ROI
- weight_idfeatroi
- weight_atlas
- weight_img

Chapter 19

List of PRoNTo functions

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This is the list of PRoNTTo functions, including the subdirectories: `machines` and `utils`.

19.1 pronto.m

Function launching PRoNTTo (Pattern Recognition for Neuroimaging Toolbox), see `prt.m` for more details

19.2 prt.m

Pattern Recognition for Neuroimaging Toolbox, PRoNTTo.

This function initializes things for PRoNTTo and provides some low level functionalities

19.3 prt_apply_operation.m

function to apply a data operation to the training, test and

```

in.train:      training data
in.tr_id:      id matrix for training data
in.use_kernel: are the data in kernelised form
in.tr_targets: training targets (optional field)
in.pred_type:  'classification' or 'regression' (required for tr_targets)

```

A test set may also be specified, which require the following fields:

```

in.test:      test data
in.testcov:   test covariance (only if use_kernel = true)
in.te_targets: test targets
in.te_id:     id matrix for test data

```

`opid` specifies the operation to apply, where:

- 1 = Temporal Compression
- 2 = Sample averaging (average samples for each subject/condition)
- 3 = Mean centre features over subjects
- 4 = Divide data vectors by their norm
- 5 = Perform a GLM (fMRI only)

N.B: - all operations are applied independently to training and test partitions
 - see Chu et. al (2011) for mathematical descriptions of operations 1 and 2 and Shawe-Taylor and Cristianini (2004) for a description of operation 3.

References:

Chu, C et al. (2011) Utilizing temporal information in fMRI decoding: classifier using kernel regression methods. *Neuroimage*. 58(2):560-71.
 Shawe-Taylor, J. and Cristianini, N. (2004). *Kernel methods for Pattern analysis*. Cambridge University Press.

19.4 prt_batch.m

Pattern Recognition for Neuroimaging Toolbox, PRoNTo.

This function prepares and launches the batch system.
 This builds the whole tree for the various tools and their GUI at the first call to this script.

19.5 prt_build_region_weights.m

19.6 prt_check.m

Function to automatically test PRoNTo's integrity

The goal is to have PRoNTo run through typical analysis and check if the calculations proceed smoothly.

This relies on pre-specified

- organisation of data in subdirectories
- batches with all the operations, in a .mat file with known location

Data sets considered, in this *specific order*:

1. "Haxby" - Haxby data, single subject, fmri
2. "IXI" - IXI data, multi subject, divergence & momentum maps
3. "Faces" - SPM's famous-vs-nonfamous faces data, multi subject.

See the subfunctions for a detailed description of the tests performed.

FORMAT ok = prt_check(list_check,dir_root)

INPUT

- list_check - list of data sets to use, [1 2 3] by default
- dir_root - root directory of data sets (you'd better set this for your own HD organization!)

OUTPUT:

- ok - vector of output (1='ok', 0='failed', -1='not tested')

NOTE:

- For a more automatic testing on your own system, then up date the default 'dir_root' variable with the path to the 'PRoNTo_data' directory on your system.
- This will close all Matlab windows before relaunching PRoNTo and the matlabbatch system.

WARNING:

This version was developped for and is running on ****SPM12****

19.7 prt_check_design.m

FORMAT [conds] = prt_check_design(cond,tr,units,hrfoverlap)

Check the design and discards scans which are either overlapping between conditions or which do not respect a minimum time interval between conditions (due to the width of the HRF function).

INPUT

- cond : structure containing the names, durations and onsets of the conditions
- tr : interscan interval (TR)
- units : 1 for seconds, 0 for scans
- hrfoverlap : value to correct for BOLD overlap (in seconds)
- hrfdelay : value to correct for BOLD delay (in seconds)

OUTPUT

the same cond structure containing supplementary fields:

- scans : scans retained for further classification
- discardedscans: scans discarded because they overlapped between conditions
- hrfdiscardedscans: scans discarded because they didn't respect the minimum time interval between conditions
- blocks: represents the grouping of the stimuli (for cross-validation)
- stats: struct containing the original time intervals, the time interval with only the 'good' scans, their means and standard deviation

19.8 prt_check_flag.m

FORMAT flags = prt_check_flag(flags_o,flags)

Function to automatically check the content of a "flag" structure, using a "default flag structure", adding the missing fields and putting in the default value if none was provided.

INPUT:

- flags_o default or reference structure
- flags input flag/option structure that need to be filled for missing fields with default values

OUTPUT:

- flags filled flag/option structure

NOTE:

This function was originally named 'crc_check_flag' and was distributed with the FASST toolbox:

<http://www.montefiore.ulg.ac.be/~phillips/FASST.html>

19.9 prt_comp_ranking_dist.m

Function to compute the distance between two ranking vectors, as detailed in Lampel and Moran, 2005 (in Information Retrieval, 8, 245-264).

INPUT : two ranking vectors of the same size
OUTPUT: their distance

19.10 prt_compute_cv_mat.m

19.11 prt_compute_weights.m

FORMAT `prt_compute_weights(PRT,in)`

This function calls `prt_weights` to compute weights

Inputs:

<code>PRT</code>	- data/design/model structure (it needs to contain at least one estimated model).
<code>in</code>	- structure with specific information to create weights
<code>.model_name</code>	- model name (string)
<code>.img_name</code>	- (optional) name of the file to be created (string)
<code>.pathdir</code>	- directory path where to save weights (same as the one for <code>PRT.mat</code>) (string)
<code>.atl_name</code>	- name of the atlas for post-hoc local averages of
<code>flag</code>	- set to 1 to compute the weight images for each permutation (default: 0)
<code>flag2</code>	- set to 1 to build image of weight per ROI weights according to atlas

Output:

<code>img_name</code>	- name of the <code>.img</code> file created
<code>+</code>	image file created on disk

19.12 prt_compute_weights_class.m

FORMAT `prt_compute_weights_class(PRT,in,model_idx)`

This function calls `prt_weights` to compute weights

Inputs:

<code>PRT</code>	- data/design/model structure (it needs to contain at least one estimated model).
<code>in</code>	- structure with specific information to create weights
<code>.model_name</code>	- model name (string)
<code>.img_name</code>	- (optional) name of the file to be created (string)
<code>.pathdir</code>	- directory path where to save weights (same as the one for <code>PRT.mat</code>) (string)
<code>model_idx</code>	- model index (integer)

```

        flag          - compute weight images for each permutation if 1
        ibe           - which beta to use for MKL and multiple modalities
        flag2         - build image of weights per region
Output:
        img_name      - name of the .img file created
        + image file created on disk

```

19.13 prt_compute_weights_regre.m

FORMAT prt_compute_weights_regre(PRT,in,model_idx)

This function calls prt_weights to compute weights

Inputs:

```

        PRT           - data/design/model structure (it needs to contain
                        - at least one estimated model).
        in            - structure with specific information to create
                        weights
        .model_name   - model name (string)
        .img_name     - (optional) name of the file to be created
                        (string)
        .pathdir      - directory path where to save weights (same as the
                        one for PRT.mat) (string)
        model_idx     - model index (integer)
        flag          - compute weight images for each permutation if 1
        ibe           - which beta to use for MKL and multiple modalities
        flag2         - build image of weights per region

```

Output:

```

        img_name      - name of the .img file created
        + image file created on disk

```

19.14 prt_cv_fold.m

Function to run a single cross-validation fold

Inputs:

```

PRT:          data structure
in.mid:       index to the model we are working on
in.ID:        ID matrix
in.CV:        Cross-validation matrix (current fold only)
in.Phi_all:   Cell array of data matri(ces) (training and test)
in.t          prediction targets

```

Outputs:

```

model:        the model returned by the machine
targets.train: training targets
targets.test: test targets

```

Notes:

The training and test targets output by this function are not necessarily equivalent to the targets that are supplied to the function. e.g. some data operations can modify the number of samples (e.g. sample

averaging). In such cases `size(targets.train) ~= size(in.t)`

19.15 prt_cv_model.m

Function to run a cross-validation structure on a given model

Inputs:

PRT: data structure
in.fname: filename for PRT.mat (string)
in.model_name: name for this model (string)

Outputs:

Writes the following fields in the PRT data structure:

PRT.model(m).output.fold(i).targets: targets for fold(i)
PRT.model(m).output.fold(i).predictions: predictions for fold(i)
PRT.model(m).output.fold(i).stats: statistics for fold(i)
PRT.model(m).output.fold(i).custom: optional fields

Notes:

The PRT.model(m).input fields are set by `prt_init_model`, not by this function

19.16 prt_cv_opt_param.m

Function to pass optional (advanced) parameters into the classifier.

This is primarily used for prediction methods that need to know something about the experimental design that is normally not accessible to ordinary (i.e. generic) prediction functions (e.g. task onsets or TR). Examples of this kind of method include multi-class classifier using kernel regression (MCKR) and the machine that implements nested cross-validation

Inputs:

PRT: data structure
ID: id matrix for the current cross-validation fold
model_id: which model are we working on?

Outputs:

param.id_fold: the id matrix for this fold
param.model_id: id for the model being computed
param.PRT: PRT data structure

Notes:

The outputs (param.xxx) are provided for use by the classifier

19.17 prt_data_conditions.m

PRT_DATA_CONDITIONS M-file for prt_data_conditions.fig

PRT_DATA_CONDITIONS, by itself, creates a new PRT_DATA_CONDITIONS or raises the existing singleton*.

H = PRT_DATA_CONDITIONS returns the handle to a new PRT_DATA_CONDITIONS or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_DATA_CONDITIONS('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_DATA_CONDITIONS.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_DATA_CONDITIONS('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_DATA_CONDITIONS or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before prt_data_conditions_OpeningFcn gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to prt_data_conditions_OpeningFcn via varargin.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.18 prt_data_modality.m

PRT_DATA_MODALITY M-file for prt_data_modality.fig

PRT_DATA_MODALITY, by itself, creates a new PRT_DATA_MODALITY or raises the existing singleton*.

H = PRT_DATA_MODALITY returns the handle to a new PRT_DATA_MODALITY or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_DATA_MODALITY('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_DATA_MODALITY.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_DATA_MODALITY('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_DATA_MODALITY or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before prt_data_modality_OpeningFcn gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to prt_data_modality_OpeningFcn via varargin.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.19 prt_data_review.m

PRT_DATA_REVIEW M-file for prt_data_review.fig

PRT_DATA_REVIEW, by itself, creates a new PRT_DATA_REVIEW or raises the existing singleton*.

H = PRT_DATA_REVIEW returns the handle to a new PRT_DATA_REVIEW or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_DATA_REVIEW('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_DATA_REVIEW.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_DATA_REVIEW('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_DATA_REVIEW or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before prt_data_review_OpeningFcn gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to prt_data_review_OpeningFcn via varargin.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.20 prt_defaults.m

Sets the defaults which are used by the Pattern Recognition for Neuroimaging Toolbox, aka. PRoNTTo.

FORMAT prt_defaults

This file can be customised to any the site/person own setup. Individual users can make copies which can be stored on their own matlab path. Make sure your 'prt_defaults' is the first one found in the path. See matlab documentation for details on setting path.

Care must be taken when modifying this file!

The structure and content of this file are largely inspired by SPM:
<http://www.fil.ion.ucl.ac.uk/spm>

19.21 prt_fs.m

Function to build file arrays containing the (linearly detrended) data and compute a linear (dot product) kernel from them

Inputs:

in.fname: filename for the PRT.mat (string)
 in.fs_name: name of fs and relative path filename for the kernel matrix

in.mod(m).mod_name: name of modality to include in this kernel (string)
 in.mod(m).detrend: detrend (scalar: 0 = none, 1 = linear)
 in.mod(m).param_dt: parameters for the kernel detrend (e.g. DCT bases)
 in.mod(m).mode: 'all_cond' or 'all_scans' (string)

```

in.mod(m).mask:      mask file used to create the kernel
in.mod(m).normalise: 0 = none, 1 = normalise_kernel, 2 = scale modality
in.mod(m).matnorm:   filename for scaling matrix
in.mod(m).multroi    1 if one kernel per region required
in.mod(m).atlasroi   name of the atlas to build one kernel per region

```

```

in.flag_mm:   Perform multi-kernel learning (1) or not (0)? If yes, the
kernel is saved as a cell vector, with one kernel per modality

```

Outputs:

Calls prt_init_fs to populate basic fields in PRT.fs(f)...

Writes PRT.mat

Writes the kernel matrix to the path indicated by in.fs_name

19.22 prt_fs_modality.m

Function to build file arrays containing the (linearly detrended) data and compute a linear (dot product) kernel from them

Inputs:

```

in.fname:      filename for the PRT.mat (string)
in.fs_name:    name of fs and relative path filename for the kernel matrix

```

```

in.mod(m).mod_name: name of modality to include in this kernel (string)
in.mod(m).detrend:   detrend (scalar: 0 = none, 1 = linear)
in.mod(m).param_dt:  parameters for the kernel detrend (e.g. DCT bases)
in.mod(m).mode:      'all_cond' or 'all_scans' (string)
in.mod(m).mask:      mask file used to create the kernel
in.mod(m).normalise: 0 = none, 1 = normalise_kernel, 2 = scale modality
in.mod(m).matnorm:   filename for scaling matrix

```

```

in.fid:        index of feature set to create
in.tocomp:     vector of booleans indicating whether to build the feature set
in.precmask:   cell array containing the names of the second-level mask for
               each modality to build

```

```

flag:         set to 1 to compute one kernel per region as labelled in atlas
addin:        additional inputs for this operation to optimize computation

```

Outputs:

Writes the kernel matrix to the path indicated by in.fs_name and the feature set in a file array if it needs to be computed

19.23 prt_func2html.m

Script to generate the list of .m functions into html files which can be browsed around with your favourite browser.

Note that this script relies on the M2HTML package which is **NOT** distributed with PRoNTTo!

For more information, please read the M2HTML tutorial and FAQ at:
 \$<\$<http://www.artefact.tk/software/matlab/m2html/>>\$

19.24 prt_getKernelModel.m

Function to load the kernels according to the samples considered in a given model

Inputs:

PRT: data structure
 prt_dir: path for PRT.mat (string)
 mid : index of model in the data structure / PRT.mat

Output:

Phi_all : cell array with one kernel per cell (in case of multiple kernels) or a single cell with the samples considered in the specified model, as defined by the class selection.
 ID : the ID matrix for the considered samples
 fid : index of feature set in data structure / PRT.mat

19.25 prt_get_defaults.m

Get/set the defaults values associated with an identifier

FORMAT defaults = prt_get_defaults
 Return the global "defaults" variable defined in prt_defaults.m.

FORMAT defval = prt_get_defaults(defstr)
 Return the defaults value associated with identifier "defstr".
 Currently, this is a '.' subscript reference into the global "prt_def" variable defined in prt_defaults.m.

FORMAT prt_get_defaults(defstr, defval)
 Sets the defaults value associated with identifier "defstr". The new defaults value applies immediately to:
 * new modules in batch jobs
 * modules in batch jobs that have not been saved yet
 This value will not be saved for future sessions of PRoNTTo. To make persistent changes, edit prt_defaults.m.

The structure and content of this file are largely inspired by SPM & Matlabbatch.
<http://www.fil.ion.ucl.ac.uk/spm>
<http://sourceforge.net/projects/matlabbatch/>

19.26 prt_get_filename.m

out = prt_get_filename(ids)

19.27 prt_init_fs.m

function to initialise the kernel data structure

FORMAT: Two modes are possible:

```
fid = prt_init_fs(PRT, in)
[fid, PRT, tocomp] = prt_init_fs(PRT, in)
```

USAGE 1:

function will return the id of a feature set or an error if it doesn't exist in PRT.mat

Input:

in.fs_name: name for the feature set (string)

Output:

fid : is the identifier for the feature set in PRT.mat

USAGE 2:

function will create the feature set in PRT.mat and overwrite it if it already exists.

Input:

in.fs_name: name for the feature set (string)

in.fname: name of PRT.mat

in.mod(m).mod_name: name of the modality

in.mod(m).detrend: type of detrending

in.mod(m).mode: 'all_scans' or 'all_cond'

in.mod(m).mask: mask used to create the feature set

in.mod(m).param_dt: parameters used for detrending (if any)

in.mod(m).normalise: scale the input scans or not

in.mod(m).matnorm: mat file used to scale the input scans

Output:

fid : is the identifier for the model constructed in PRT.mat

Populates the following fields in PRT.mat (copied from above):

PRT.fs(f).fs_name

PRT.fs(f).fas

PRT.fs(f).k_file

Also computes the following fields:

PRT.fs(f).id_mat: Identifier matrix (useful later)

PRT.fs(f).id_col_names: Columns in the id matrix

Note: this function does not write PRT.mat. That should be done by the calling function

19.28 prt_init_model.m

function to initialise the model data structure

FORMAT: Two modes are possible:

```
mid = prt_init_model(PRT, in)
[mid, PRT] = prt_init_model(PRT, in)
```

USAGE 1:

function will return the id of a model or an error if it doesn't exist in PRT.mat

Input:

in.model_name: name of the model (string)

Output:

mid : is the identifier for the model in PRT.mat

USAGE 2:

function will create the model in PRT.mat and overwrite it if it already exists.

Input:

in.model_name: name of the model to be created (string)

in.use_kernel: use kernel or basis functions for this model (boolean)

in.machine: prediction machine to use for this model (struct)

in.type: 'classification' or 'regression'

Output:

Populates the following fields in PRT.mat (copied from above):

PRT.model(m).input.model_name

PRT.model(m).input.type

PRT.model(m).input.use_kernel

PRT.model(m).input.machine

Note: this function does not write PRT.mat. That should be done by the calling function

19.29 prt_latex.m

Extract information from the toolbox m-files and output them as usable .tex files which can be directly included in the manual.

There are 2 types of m2tex operations:

1. converting the job configuration tree, i.e. *_cfg_* files defining the batching interface into a series of .tex files.

NOTE: Only generate .tex files for each exec_branch of prt_batch.

2. converting the help header of the functions into .tex files.

These files are then included in a manually written `prt_manual.tex` file, which also includes chapter/sections written manually.

FORMAT `prt_latex(opt)`

INPUT

`opt:` option structure

`.tex_cfg` : turn the config files help into a tex file (1), or not (0)

`.tex_fct` : turn the functions help into a tex file (1), or not (0)

NOTE:

File derived from that of the SPM8 distribution.

<http://www.fil.ion.ucl.ac.uk/spm>

19.30 `prt_load.m`

Function to load the `PRT.mat` and check its integrity regarding the kernels and feature sets that it is supposed to contain. Updates the `set` feature name if needed.

`input` : name of the `PRT.mat`, path included

`output` : `PRT` structure updated

19.31 `prt_load_blocks.m`

Load one or more blocks of data.

This script is a effectively a wrapper function that for the routines that actually do the work (SPM `nifti` routines)

The syntax is either:

`img = prt_load_blocks(filenamees, block_size, block_range)` just to specify continuous blocks of data

or

`img = prt_load_blocks(filenamees, voxel_index)` to access non continuous blocks

19.32 `prt_model.m`

Function to configure and build the `PRT.model` data structure

Input:

`PRT` fields:

`model.fs(f).fs_name:` feature set(s) this CV approach is defined for

`model.fs(f).fs_features:` feature selection mode ('all' or 'mask')

`model.fs(f).mask_file:` mask for this feature set (`fs_features='mask'`)

`in.fname:` filename for `PRT.mat`

```

in.model_name: name for this cross-validation structure
in.type:       'classification' or 'regression'
in.use_kernel: does this model use kernels or features?
in.operations: operations to apply before prediction

in.fs(f).fs_name:      feature set(s) this CV approach is defined for

in.class(c).class_name
in.class(c).group(g).subj(s).num
in.class(c).group(g).subj(s).modality(m).mod_name
EITHER: in.class(c).group(g).subj(s).modality(m).conds(c).cond_name
OR:      in.class(c).group(g).subj(s).modality(m).all_scans
OR:      in.class(c).group(g).subj(s).modality(m).all_cond

in.cv.type:      type of cross-validation ('loso','losgo','custom')
in.cv.mat.file:  file specifying CV matrix (if type='custom');

```

Output:

This function performs the following functions:

1. populates basic fields in PRT.model(m).input
2. computes PRT.model(m).input.targets based on in.class(c)...
3. computes PRT.model(m).input.samp_idx based on targets
4. computes PRT.model(m).input.cv_mat based on the labels and CV spec

19.33 prt_nested_cv.m

Function to perform the nested CV

Inputs:

```

in.nc:      number of classes
in.ID:      ID matrix
in.mid:     model id
in.CV:      cross-validation matrix
in.Phi_all: Kernel

```

Outputs:

```

out.opt_param: optimal hyper-parameter choosen using the stats from
               the inner CVs
out.vary_param: stats values associated with all the hyper-parameters

```

19.34 prt_permutation.m

Function to compute permutation test

Inputs:

```

PRT:      PRT structured including model
n_perm:   number of permutations
modelid:  model ID
path:     path

```


flag: boolean variable. set to 1 to save the weights for each
 permutation. default: 0

Outputs:

```
for classification
permutation.c_acc:      Permuted accuracy per class
permutation.b_acc:      Permuted balanced accuracy
permutation.pvalue_b_acc: p-value for c_acc
permutation.pvalue_c_acc: p-value for b_acc

for regression
permutation.corr: Permuted correlation
permutation.mse:  Permuted mean square error
permutation.pval_corr: p-value for corr
permutation.pval_r2: p-value for r2;
permutation.pval_mse:  p-value for mse
permutation.pval_nmse: p-value for nmse
```

19.35 prt_plot_ROC.m

FORMAT prt_plot_ROC(PRT, model, fold, axes_handle)

This function plots the ROC plot that appears on prt_ui_results

Inputs:

PRT	- data/design/model structure (it needs to contain at least one estimated model).
model	- the number of the model that will be plotted
fold	- the number of the fold
axes_handle	- (Optional) axes where the plot will be displayed

Output:

None

19.36 prt_plot_confusion_matrix.m

FORMAT prt_plot_confusion_matrix(PRT, model, fold, axes_handle)

This function plots the confusion matrix that appears on prt_ui_results

Inputs:

PRT	- data/design/model structure (it needs to contain at least one estimated model).
model	- the number of the model that will be plotted
fold	- the number of the fold
axes_handle	- (Optional) axes where the plot will be displayed

Output:

None

19.37 prt_plot_histograms.m

FORMAT `prt_plot_histograms(PRT, model, fold, axes_handle)`

This function plots the histogram that appears on `prt_ui_results`.

The maximum number of classes that can be plotted is 7. However, this can be increased by editing the function. Just add more colours to the `colourList` variable.

Inputs:

<code>PRT</code>	- data/design/model structure (it needs to contain at least one estimated model).
<code>model</code>	- the number of the model that will be plotted
<code>fold</code>	- the number of the fold
<code>axes_handle</code>	- (Optional) axes where the plot will be displayed

Output:

None

19.38 `prt_plot_nested_cv.m`

FORMAT `prt_plot_nested_cv(PRT, model, fold, axes_handle)`

Plots the results of the nested cv that appear on `prt_ui_results`.

Inputs:

<code>PRT</code>	- data/design/model structure (it needs to contain at least one estimated model).
<code>model</code>	- the number of the model that will be plotted
<code>fold</code>	- the number of the fold
<code>axes_handle</code>	- (Optional) axes where the plot will be displayed

Output:

None

19.39 `prt_plot_prediction.m`

FORMAT `prt_plot_prediction(PRT, model, fold, marker_size, axes_handle)`

This function plots the prediction plot that appears on `prt_ui_results`

Inputs:

<code>PRT</code>	- data/design/model structure (it needs to contain at least one estimated model).
<code>model</code>	- the number of the model that will be plotted
<code>fold</code>	- the number of the fold
<code>marker_size</code>	- (Optional) the size of the markers in the plot, the default is 7
<code>axes_handle</code>	- (Optional) axes where the plot will be displayed

Output:

None

19.40 prt_plot_prediction_reg_bar.m

FORMAT prt_plot_prediction_reg_bar(PRT, model, axes_handle)

This function plots the bar plot that appears on prt_ui_results

Inputs:

- | | |
|-------------|---|
| PRT | - data/design/model structure (it needs to contain at least one estimated model). |
| model | - the number of the model that will be plotted |
| axes_handle | - (Optional) axes where the plot will be displayed |

Output:

None

19.41 prt_plot_prediction_reg_line.m

FORMAT prt_plot_prediction_reg_line(PRT, model, axes_handle)

This function plots the line plot that appears on prt_ui_results

Inputs:

- | | |
|-------------|---|
| PRT | - data/design/model structure (it needs to contain at least one estimated model). |
| model | - the number of the model that will be plotted |
| axes_handle | - (Optional) axes where the plot will be displayed |

Output:

None

19.42 prt_plot_prediction_reg_scatter.m

FORMAT prt_plot_prediction_reg_scatter(PRT, model, axes_handle)

This function plots the scatter plot that appears on prt_ui_results

Inputs:

- | | |
|-------------|---|
| PRT | - data/design/model structure (it needs to contain at least one estimated model). |
| model | - the number of the model that will be plotted |
| axes_handle | - (Optional) axes where the plot will be displayed |

Output:

None

19.43 prt_region_histogram.m

19.44 prt_remove_confounds.m

[Kr, R] = prt_remove_confounds(K,C)

Function to remove confounds from kernel.

19.45 prt_stats.m

Function to compute predictions machine performance statistics

Inputs:

model.predictions: predictions derived from the predictive model
 model.type: what type of prediction machine (e.g. 'classifier','regression')

 tte: true targets (test set)
 nk: number of classes if classification (empty otherwise)
 flag: 'fold' for statistics in each fold
 'model' for statistics in each model

Outputs:

Classification:

stats.con_mat: Confusion matrix (nClasses x nClasses matrix, pred x true)
 stats.acc: Accuracy (scalar)
 stats.b_acc: Balanced accuracy (nClasses x 1 vector)
 stats.c_acc: Accuracy by class (nClasses x 1 vector)
 stats.c_pv: Predictive value for each class (nClasses x 1 vector)

Regression:

stats.mse: Mean square error between test and prediction
 stats.corr: Correlation between test and prediction
 stats.r2: Squared correlation

19.46 prt_struct.m

fields that it is supposed to contain. Updates the PRT if needed.

input : PRT structure to check

output : PRT structure updated

19.47 prt_struct2latex.m

Function that takes in a structure S and writes down the latex code describing the whole structure and substructures recursively. The routine specifically generates the 'adv_PRTstruct.tex' file that is included, in the prt_manual.

Bits of the code are copied/inspired by spm_latex.m from the SPM8 distribution: <http://www.fil.ion.ucl.ac.uk/spm>

19.48 prt_text_input.m

PRT_TEXT_INPUT M-file for prt_text_input.fig

PRT_TEXT_INPUT, by itself, creates a new PRT_TEXT_INPUT or raises the

existing singleton*.

H = PRT_TEXT_INPUT returns the handle to a new PRT_TEXT_INPUT or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_TEXT_INPUT('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_TEXT_INPUT.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_TEXT_INPUT('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_TEXT_INPUT or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before prt_text_input_OpeningFcn gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to prt_text_input_OpeningFcn via varargin.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.49 prt_ui_compute_weights.m

PRT_UI_COMPUTE_WEIGHTS M-file for prt_ui_compute_weights.fig

PRT_UI_COMPUTE_WEIGHTS, by itself, creates a new PRT_UI_COMPUTE_WEIGHTS or raises the existing singleton*.

H = PRT_UI_COMPUTE_WEIGHTS returns the handle to a new PRT_UI_COMPUTE_WEIGHTS or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_UI_COMPUTE_WEIGHTS('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_UI_COMPUTE_WEIGHTS.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_UI_COMPUTE_WEIGHTS('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_UI_COMPUTE_WEIGHTS or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before prt_ui_compute_weights_OpeningFcn gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to prt_ui_compute_weights_OpeningFcn via varargin.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.50 prt_ui_custom_CV.m

PRT_UI_CUSTOM_CV M-file for prt_ui_custom_CV.fig

PRT_UI_CUSTOM_CV, by itself, creates a new PRT_UI_CUSTOM_CV or raises the existing singleton*.

H = PRT_UI_CUSTOM_CV returns the handle to a new PRT_UI_CUSTOM_CV or the handle to the existing singleton*.

`PRT_UI_CUSTOM_CV('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...)` calls the local function named `CALLBACK` in `PRT_UI_CUSTOM_CV.M` with the given input arguments.

`PRT_UI_CUSTOM_CV('Property','Value',...)` creates a new `PRT_UI_CUSTOM_CV` or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before `prt_ui_custom_CV_OpeningFcn` gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to `prt_ui_custom_CV_OpeningFcn` via `varargin`.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: `GUIDE`, `GUIDATA`, `GUIHANDLES`

19.51 `prt_ui_cv_model.m`

`PRT_UI_CV_MODEL` M-file for `prt_ui_cv_model.fig`

`PRT_UI_CV_MODEL`, by itself, creates a new `PRT_UI_CV_MODEL` or raises the existing singleton*.

`H = PRT_UI_CV_MODEL` returns the handle to a new `PRT_UI_CV_MODEL` or the handle to the existing singleton*.

`PRT_UI_CV_MODEL('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...)` calls the local function named `CALLBACK` in `PRT_UI_CV_MODEL.M` with the given input arguments.

`PRT_UI_CV_MODEL('Property','Value',...)` creates a new `PRT_UI_CV_MODEL` or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before `prt_ui_cv_model_OpeningFcn` gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to `prt_ui_cv_model_OpeningFcn` via `varargin`.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: `GUIDE`, `GUIDATA`, `GUIHANDLES`

19.52 `prt_ui_design.m`

`PRT_UI_DESIGN` M-file for `prt_ui_design.fig`

`PRT_UI_DESIGN`, by itself, creates a new `PRT_UI_DESIGN` or raises the existing singleton*.

`H = PRT_UI_DESIGN` returns the handle to a new `PRT_UI_DESIGN` or the handle to the existing singleton*.

`PRT_UI_DESIGN('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...)` calls the local

function named CALLBACK in PRT_UI_DESIGN.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_UI_DESIGN('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_UI_DESIGN or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before prt_ui_design_OpeningFcn gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to prt_ui_design_OpeningFcn via varargin.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.53 prt_ui_disp_weights.m

PRT_UI_DISP_WEIGHTS MATLAB code for prt_ui_disp_weights.fig

PRT_UI_DISP_WEIGHTS, by itself, creates a new PRT_UI_DISP_WEIGHTS or raises the existing singleton*.

H = PRT_UI_DISP_WEIGHTS returns the handle to a new PRT_UI_DISP_WEIGHTS or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_UI_DISP_WEIGHTS('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_UI_DISP_WEIGHTS.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_UI_DISP_WEIGHTS('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_UI_DISP_WEIGHTS or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before prt_ui_disp_weights_OpeningFcn gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to prt_ui_disp_weights_OpeningFcn via varargin.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.54 prt_ui_kernel_construction.m

PRT_UI_KERNEL MATLAB code for prt_ui_kernel.fig

PRT_UI_KERNEL, by itself, creates a new PRT_UI_KERNEL or raises the existing singleton*.

H = PRT_UI_KERNEL returns the handle to a new PRT_UI_KERNEL or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_UI_KERNEL('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_UI_KERNEL.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_UI_KERNEL('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_UI_KERNEL or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before prt_ui_kernel_OpeningFcn gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application

stop. All inputs are passed to `prt_ui_kernel_OpeningFcn` via `varargin`.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.55 `prt_ui_main.m`

PRT_UI_MAIN M-file for `prt_ui_main.fig`

PRT_UI_MAIN, by itself, creates a new PRT_UI_MAIN or raises the existing singleton*.

H = PRT_UI_MAIN returns the handle to a new PRT_UI_MAIN or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_UI_MAIN('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_UI_MAIN.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_UI_MAIN('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_UI_MAIN or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before `prt_ui_main_OpeningFcn` gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to `prt_ui_main_OpeningFcn` via `varargin`.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.56 `prt_ui_model.m`

PRT_UI_KERNEL_CONSTRUCTION M-file for `prt_ui_kernel.construction.fig`

PRT_UI_KERNEL_CONSTRUCTION, by itself, creates a new PRT_UI_KERNEL_CONSTRUCTION or raises the existing singleton*.

H = PRT_UI_KERNEL_CONSTRUCTION returns the handle to a new PRT_UI_KERNEL_CONSTRUCTION or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_UI_KERNEL_CONSTRUCTION('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_UI_KERNEL_CONSTRUCTION.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_UI_KERNEL_CONSTRUCTION('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_UI_KERNEL_CONSTRUCTION or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before `prt_ui_kernel.construction_OpeningFcn` gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to `prt_ui_kernel.construction_OpeningFcn` via `varargin`.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.57 prt_ui_prepare_data.m

PRT_UI_KERNEL MATLAB code for prt_ui_kernel.fig

PRT_UI_KERNEL, by itself, creates a new PRT_UI_KERNEL or raises the existing singleton*.

H = PRT_UI_KERNEL returns the handle to a new PRT_UI_KERNEL or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_UI_KERNEL('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_UI_KERNEL.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_UI_KERNEL('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_UI_KERNEL or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before prt_ui_kernel_OpeningFcn gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to prt_ui_kernel_OpeningFcn via varargin.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.58 prt_ui_prepare_datamod.m

PRT_UI_KERNEL_MODALITY M-file for prt_ui_kernel_modality.fig

PRT_UI_KERNEL_MODALITY, by itself, creates a new PRT_UI_KERNEL_MODALITY or raises the existing singleton*.

H = PRT_UI_KERNEL_MODALITY returns the handle to a new PRT_UI_KERNEL_MODALITY or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_UI_KERNEL_MODALITY('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_UI_KERNEL_MODALITY.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_UI_KERNEL_MODALITY('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_UI_KERNEL_MODALITY or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before prt_ui_kernel_modality_OpeningFcn gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to prt_ui_kernel_modality_OpeningFcn via varargin.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.59 prt_ui_results.m

PRT_UI_RESULTS MATLAB code for prt_ui_results.fig

PRT_UI_RESULTS, by itself, creates a new PRT_UI_RESULTS or raises the existing singleton*.

H = PRT_UI_RESULTS returns the handle to a new PRT_UI_RESULTS or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_UI_RESULTS('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_UI_RESULTS.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_UI_RESULTS('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_UI_RESULTS or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before prt_ui_results_OpeningFcn gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to prt_ui_results_OpeningFcn via varargin.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.60 prt_ui_results_ROI.m

PRT_UI_RESULTS_ROI M-file for prt_ui_results_ROI.fig

PRT_UI_RESULTS_ROI, by itself, creates a new PRT_UI_RESULTS_ROI or raises the existing singleton*.

H = PRT_UI_RESULTS_ROI returns the handle to a new PRT_UI_RESULTS_ROI or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_UI_RESULTS_ROI('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_UI_RESULTS_ROI.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_UI_RESULTS_ROI('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_UI_RESULTS_ROI or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before prt_ui_results_ROI_OpeningFcn gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to prt_ui_results_ROI_OpeningFcn via varargin.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.61 prt_ui_results_help.m

PRT_UI_RESULTS_HELP MATLAB code for prt_ui_results_help.fig

`PRT_UI_RESULTS_HELP`, by itself, creates a new `PRT_UI_RESULTS_HELP` or raises the existing singleton*.

`H = PRT_UI_RESULTS_HELP` returns the handle to a new `PRT_UI_RESULTS_HELP` or the handle to the existing singleton*.

`PRT_UI_RESULTS_HELP('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...)` calls the local function named `CALLBACK` in `PRT_UI_RESULTS_HELP.M` with the given input arguments.

`PRT_UI_RESULTS_HELP('Property','Value',...)` creates a new `PRT_UI_RESULTS_HELP` or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before `prt_ui_results_help_OpeningFcn` gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to `prt_ui_results_help_OpeningFcn` via `varargin`.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: `GUIDE`, `GUIDATA`, `GUIHANDLES`

19.62 `prt_ui_results_stats.m`

`PRT_UI_RESULTS_STATS` MATLAB code for `prt_ui_results_stats.fig`

`PRT_UI_RESULTS_STATS`, by itself, creates a new `PRT_UI_RESULTS_STATS` or raises the existing singleton*.

`H = PRT_UI_RESULTS_STATS` returns the handle to a new `PRT_UI_RESULTS_STATS` or the handle to the existing singleton*.

`PRT_UI_RESULTS_STATS('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...)` calls the local function named `CALLBACK` in `PRT_UI_RESULTS_STATS.M` with the given input arguments.

`PRT_UI_RESULTS_STATS('Property','Value',...)` creates a new `PRT_UI_RESULTS_STATS` or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before `prt_ui_results_stats_OpeningFcn` gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to `prt_ui_results_stats_OpeningFcn` via `varargin`.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: `GUIDE`, `GUIDATA`, `GUIHANDLES`

19.63 `prt_ui_reviewCV.m`

`PRT_UI_REVIEWCV` M-file for `prt_ui_reviewCV.fig`

`PRT_UI_REVIEWCV`, by itself, creates a new `PRT_UI_REVIEWCV` or raises the existing singleton*.

`H = PRT_UI_REVIEWCV` returns the handle to a new `PRT_UI_REVIEWCV` or the handle to the existing singleton*.

`PRT_UI_REVIEWCV('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...)` calls the local function named `CALLBACK` in `PRT_UI_REVIEWCV.M` with the given input arguments.

`PRT_UI_REVIEWCV('Property','Value',...)` creates a new `PRT_UI_REVIEWCV` or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before `prt_ui_reviewCV_OpeningFcn` gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to `prt_ui_reviewCV_OpeningFcn` via `varargin`.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: `GUIDE`, `GUIDATA`, `GUIHANDLES`

19.64 prt_ui_reviewmodel.m

`PRT_UI_REVIEWMODEL` M-file for `prt_ui_reviewmodel.fig`

`PRT_UI_REVIEWMODEL`, by itself, creates a new `PRT_UI_REVIEWMODEL` or raises the existing singleton*.

`H = PRT_UI_REVIEWMODEL` returns the handle to a new `PRT_UI_REVIEWMODEL` or the handle to the existing singleton*.

`PRT_UI_REVIEWMODEL('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...)` calls the local function named `CALLBACK` in `PRT_UI_REVIEWMODEL.M` with the given input arguments.

`PRT_UI_REVIEWMODEL('Property','Value',...)` creates a new `PRT_UI_REVIEWMODEL` or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before `prt_ui_reviewmodel_OpeningFcn` gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to `prt_ui_reviewmodel_OpeningFcn` via `varargin`.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: `GUIDE`, `GUIDATA`, `GUIHANDLES`

19.65 prt_ui_select_class.m

`PRT_UI_SELECT_CLASS` M-file for `prt_ui_select_class.fig`

`PRT_UI_SELECT_CLASS`, by itself, creates a new `PRT_UI_SELECT_CLASS` or raises the existing singleton*.

`H = PRT_UI_SELECT_CLASS` returns the handle to a new `PRT_UI_SELECT_CLASS` or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_UI_SELECT_CLASS('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_UI_SELECT_CLASS.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_UI_SELECT_CLASS('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_UI_SELECT_CLASS or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before prt_ui_select_class_OpeningFcn gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to prt_ui_select_class_OpeningFcn via varargin.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.66 prt_ui_select_reg.m

PRT_UI_SELECT_REG M-file for prt_ui_select_reg.fig

PRT_UI_SELECT_REG, by itself, creates a new PRT_UI_SELECT_REG or raises the existing singleton*.

H = PRT_UI_SELECT_REG returns the handle to a new PRT_UI_SELECT_REG or the handle to the existing singleton*.

PRT_UI_SELECT_REG('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...) calls the local function named CALLBACK in PRT_UI_SELECT_REG.M with the given input arguments.

PRT_UI_SELECT_REG('Property','Value',...) creates a new PRT_UI_SELECT_REG or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before prt_ui_select_reg_OpeningFcn gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to prt_ui_select_reg_OpeningFcn via varargin.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: GUIDE, GUIDATA, GUIHANDLES

19.67 prt_ui_specify_CV_basis.m

19.68 prt_ui_stats.m

PRT_UI_STATS MATLAB code for prt_ui_stats.fig

PRT_UI_STATS, by itself, creates a new PRT_UI_STATS or raises the existing singleton*.

`H = PRT_UI_STATS` returns the handle to a new `PRT_UI_STATS` or the handle to the existing singleton*.

`PRT_UI_STATS('CALLBACK',hObject,eventData,handles,...)` calls the local function named `CALLBACK` in `PRT_UI_STATS.M` with the given input arguments.

`PRT_UI_STATS('Property','Value',...)` creates a new `PRT_UI_STATS` or raises the existing singleton*. Starting from the left, property value pairs are applied to the GUI before `prt_ui_stats_OpeningFcn` gets called. An unrecognized property name or invalid value makes property application stop. All inputs are passed to `prt_ui_stats_OpeningFcn` via `varargin`.

*See GUI Options on GUIDE's Tools menu. Choose "GUI allows only one instance to run (singleton)".

See also: `GUIDE`, `GUIDATA`, `GUIHANDLES`

19.69 `prt_ui_sure.m`

19.70 `machines`

19.70.1 `machines\prt_KRR.m`

`w = prt_KRR(K,t,reg)`

19.70.2 `machines\prt_machine.m`

Run machine function for classification or regression

FORMAT output = `prt_machine(d,m)`

Inputs:

`d` - structure with information about the data, with fields:
Mandatory fields:
`.train` - training data (cell array of matrices of row vectors, each [Ntr x D]). each matrix contains one representation of the data. This is useful for approaches such as multiple kernel learning.
`.test` - testing data (cell array of matrices row vectors, each [Nte x D])
`.tr_targets` - training labels (for classification) or values (for regression) (column vector, [Ntr x 1])
`.use_kernel` - flag, is data in form of kernel matrices (true) or in form of features (false)
Optional fields: the machine is responsible for dealing with this optional fields (e.g. `d.testcov`)
`m` - structure with information about the classification or regression machine to use, with fields:
`.function` - function for classification or regression (string)
`.args` - function arguments (either a string, a matrix, or a struct). This is specific to each machine, e.g. for an L2-norm linear SVM this could be the `C` parameter

Output:

output - output of machine (struct).
 Mandatory fields:
 .predictions - predictions of classification or regression
 [Nte x D]
 Optional fields: the machine is responsible for returning
 parameters of interest. For exemple for an SVM this could be the
 number of support vector used in the hyperplane weights computation

19.70.3 machines\prt_machine_RT_bin.m

Run binary Ensemble of Regression Tree - wrapper for Pierre Geurt's
 RT code

FORMAT output = prt_machine_RT_bin(d,args)

Inputs:

d - structure with data information, with mandatory fields:
 .train - training data (cell array of matrices of row vectors,
 each [Ntr x D]). each matrix contains one representation
 of the data. This is useful for approaches such as
 multiple kernel learning.
 .test - testing data (cell array of matrices row vectors, each
 [Nte x D])
 .tr_targets - training labels (for classification) or values (for
 regression) (column vector, [Ntr x 1])
 .use_kernel - flag, is data in form of kernel matrices (true) or in
 form of features (false)
 args - vector of RT arguments
 args(1) - number of trees (default: 501)

Output:

output - output of machine (struct).
 * Mandatory fields:
 .predictions - predictions of classification or regression [Nte x D]
 * Optional fields:
 .func_val - value of the decision function
 .type - which type of machine this is (here, 'classifier')

19.70.4 machines\prt_machine_gpclap.m

Run multiclass Gaussian process classification (Laplace approximation)

FORMAT output = prt_machine_gpclap(d,args)

Inputs:

d - structure with data information, with mandatory fields:
 .train - training data (cell array of matrices of row vectors,
 each [Ntr x D]). each matrix contains one representation
 of the data. This is useful for approaches such as
 multiple kernel learning.
 .test - testing data (cell array of matrices row vectors, each
 [Nte x D])
 .testcov - testing covariance (cell array of matrices row vectors,
 each [Nte x Nte])
 .tr_targets - training labels (for classification) or values (for
 regression) (column vector, [Ntr x 1])
 .use_kernel - flag, is data in form of kernel matrices (true) or in
 form of features (false)
 args - argument string, where
 -h - optimise hyperparameters (otherwise don't)

```

-c covfun - covariance function:
            'covLINKcell' - simple dot product
            'covLINGlm'   - construct a GLM
experimental args (use at your own risk):
-p          - use priors for the hyperparameters. If specified, this
            indicates that a maximum a posteriori (MAP) approach
            will be used to set covariance function
            hyperparameters. The priors are obtained
            by calling prt_gp_priors('covFuncName')

```

N.B.: for the arguments specifying functions, pass in a string, not a function handle. This script will generate a function handle

Output:

```

output - output of machine (struct).
* Mandatory fields:
.predictions - predictions of classification or regression [Nte x D]
* Optional fields:
.type        - which type of machine this is (here, 'classifier')
.func_val    - predictive probabilities
.loghyper    - log hyperparameters
.nlml        - negative log marginal likelihood
.mu          - test latent means
.s2          - test latent variances
.alpha       - GP weighting coefficients

```

19.70.5 machines\prt_machine_gpml.m

Run Gaussian process model - wrapper for gpml toolbox

FORMAT output = prt_machine_gpml(d,args)

Inputs:

```

d          - structure with data information, with mandatory fields:
.train     - training data (cell array of matrices of row vectors,
            each [Ntr x D]). each matrix contains one representation
            of the data. This is useful for approaches such as
            multiple kernel learning.
.test      - testing data (cell array of matrices row vectors, each
            [Nte x D])
.testcov   - testing covariance (cell array of matrices row vectors,
            each [Nte x Nte])
.tr_targets - training labels (for classification) or values (for
            regression) (column vector, [Ntr x 1])
.use_kernel - flag, is data in form of kernel matrices (true) or in
            form of features (false)
args       - argument string, where
-h         - optimise hyperparameters (otherwise don't)
-f iter    - max # iterations for optimiser (ignored if -h not set)
-l likfun  - likelihood function:
            'likErf' - erf/probit likelihood (binary only)
-c covfun  - covariance function:
            'covLINKcell' - simple dot product
            'covLINGlm'   - construct a GLM
-m meanfun - mean function:
            'meanConstcell' - suitable for dot product
            'meanConstglm'  - suitable for GLM
-i inffun  - inference function:

```



```

                                'prt_infEP' - Expectation Propagation
experimental args (use at your own risk):
    -p          - use priors for the hyperparameters. If specified, this
                  indicates that a maximum a posteriori (MAP) approach
                  will be used to set covariance function
                  hyperparameters. The priors are obtained by calling
                  prt_gp_priors('covFuncName')

```

N.B.: for the arguments specifying functions, pass in a string, not a function handle. This script will generate a function handle

Output:

```

output - output of machine (struct).
* Mandatory fields:
  .predictions - predictions of classification or regression [Nte x D]
* Optional fields:
  .type        - which type of machine this is (here, 'classifier')
  .func_val    - predictive probabilities
  .mu          - test latent means
  .s2          - test latent variances
  .loghyper    - log hyperparameters
  .nlml        - negative log marginal likelihood
  .alpha       - GP weighting coefficients
  .sW          - likelihood matrix (see Rasmussen & Williams, 2006)
  .L           - Cholesky factor

```

19.70.6 machines\prt_machine_gpr.m

Run Gaussian process regression - meta-wrapper for regression with gpml
 FORMAT output = prt_machine_gpml(d,args)

Inputs:

```

d          - structure with data information, with mandatory fields:
  .train    - training data (cell array of matrices of row vectors,
                  each [Ntr x D]). each matrix contains one representation
                  of the data. This is useful for approaches such as
                  multiple kernel learning.
  .test     - testing data (cell array of matrices row vectors, each
                  [Nte x D])
  .testcov  - testing covariance (cell array of matrices row vectors,
                  each [Nte x Nte])
  .tr_targets - training labels (for classification) or values (for
                  regression) (column vector, [Ntr x 1])
  .use_kernel - flag, is data in form of kernel matrices (true) or in
                  form of features (false)
args       - argument string, where
  -h        - optimise hyperparameters (otherwise don't)
  -f iter   - max # iterations for optimiser (ignored if -h not set)
  -l likfun - likelihood function:
                  'likErf' - erf/probit likelihood (binary only)
  -c covfun - covariance function:
                  'covLINKcell' - simple dot product
                  'covLINGlm'  - construct a GLM
  -m meanfun - mean function:
                  'meanConstcell' - suitable for dot product
                  'meanConstglm'  - suitable for GLM
  -i inffun - inference function:

```

```

                                'prt_infEP' - Expectation Propagation
experimental args (use at your own risk):
    -p          - use priors for the hyperparameters. If specified, this
                  indicates that a maximum a posteriori (MAP) approach
                  will be used to set covariance function
                  hyperparameters. The priors are obtained by calling
                  prt_gp_priors('covFuncName')

```

N.B.: for the arguments specifying functions, pass in a string, not a function handle. This script will generate a function handle

Output:

```

output - output of machine (struct).
* Mandatory fields:
  .predictions - predictions of classification or regression [Nte x D]
* Optional fields:
  .type        - which type of machine this is (here, 'classifier')
  .func_val    - predictive probabilities
  .mu          - test latent means
  .s2          - test latent variances
  .loghyper    - log hyperparameters
  .nlml        - negative log marginal likelihood
  .alpha       - GP weighting coefficients
  .sW          - likelihood matrix (see Rasmussen & Williams, 2006)
  .L           - Cholesky factor

```

19.70.7 machines\prt_machine_krr.m

Kernel ridge regression

FORMAT output = prt_machine_svm_bin(d,args)

Inputs:

```

d          - structure with data information, with mandatory fields:
  .train    - training data (cell array of matrices of row vectors,
                  each [Ntr x D]). each matrix contains one representation
                  of the data. This is useful for approaches such as
                  multiple kernel learning.
  .test     - testing data (cell array of matrices row vectors, each
                  [Nte x D])
  .tr_targets - training labels (for classification) or values (for
                  regression) (column vector, [Ntr x 1])
  .use_kernel - flag, is data in form of kernel matrices (true) or in
                  form of features (false)
args       - libSVM arguments

```

Output:

```

output - output of machine (struct).
* Mandatory fields:
  .predictions - predictions of classification or regression [Nte x D]
* Optional fields:
  .func_val    - value of the decision function
  .type        - which type of machine this is (here, 'classifier')

```

19.70.8 machines\prt_machine_rvr.m

Relevance vector regression (training and testing)

FORMAT output = prt_machine_svm_bin(d,args)

Inputs:

```

d          - structure with data information, with mandatory fields:
.train     - training data (cell array of matrices of row vectors,
              each [Ntr x D]). each matrix contains one representation
              of the data. This is useful for approaches such as
              multiple kernel learning.
.test      - testing data (cell array of matrices row vectors, each
              [Nte x D])
.tr_targets - training labels (for classification) or values (for
              regression) (column vector, [Ntr x 1])
.use_kernel - flag, is data in form of kernel matrices (true) or in
              form of features (false)
args       - libSVM arguments

```

Output:

```

output - output of machine (struct).
* Mandatory fields:
.predictions - predictions of classification or regression [Nte x D]
* Optional fields:
.func_val - value of the decision function
.type     - which type of machine this is (here, 'classifier')

```

19.70.9 machines\prt_machine_sMKL_cla.m

Run L1-norm MKL - wrapper for simpleMKL

FORMAT output = prt_machine_sMKL_cla(d,args)

Inputs:

```

d          - structure with data information, with mandatory fields:
.train     - training data (cell array of matrices of row vectors,
              each [Ntr x D]). each matrix contains one representation
              of the data. This is useful for approaches such as
              multiple kernel learning.
.test      - testing data (cell array of matrices row vectors, each
              [Nte x D])
.tr_targets - training labels (for classification) or values (for
              regression) (column vector, [Ntr x 1])
.use_kernel - flag, is data in form of kernel matrices (true) or in
              form of features (false)
args       - simpleMKL arguments

```

Output:

```

output - output of machine (struct).
* Mandatory fields:
.predictions - predictions of classification or regression [Nte x D]
* Optional fields:
.func_val - value of the decision function
.type     - which type of machine this is (here, 'classifier')
.

```

19.70.10 machines\prt_machine_sMKL_reg.m

Run L1-norm MKL - wrapper for simpleMKL

FORMAT output = prt_machine_sMKL_reg(d,args)

Inputs:

```

d          - structure with data information, with mandatory fields:
.train     - training data (cell array of matrices of row vectors,
              each [Ntr x D]). each matrix contains one representation

```

of the data. This is useful for approaches such as multiple kernel learning.

- .test - testing data (cell array of matrices row vectors, each [Nte x D])
- .tr_targets - training labels (for classification) or values (for regression) (column vector, [Ntr x 1])
- .use_kernel - flag, is data in form of kernel matrices (true) or in form of features (false)
- args - simpleMKL arguments

Output:

- output - output of machine (struct).
- * Mandatory fields:
 - .predictions - predictions of classification or regression [Nte x D]
- * Optional fields:
 - .func_val - value of the decision function
 - .type - which type of machine this is (here, 'classifier')

19.70.11 machines\prt_machine_svm_bin.m

Run binary SVM - wrapper for libSVM

FORMAT output = prt_machine_svm_bin(d,args)

Inputs:

- d - structure with data information, with mandatory fields:
 - .train - training data (cell array of matrices of row vectors, each [Ntr x D]). each matrix contains one representation of the data. This is useful for approaches such as multiple kernel learning.
 - .test - testing data (cell array of matrices row vectors, each [Nte x D])
 - .tr_targets - training labels (for classification) or values (for regression) (column vector, [Ntr x 1])
 - .use_kernel - flag, is data in form of kernel matrices (true) or in form of features (false)
- args - libSVM arguments

Output:

- output - output of machine (struct).
- * Mandatory fields:
 - .predictions - predictions of classification or regression [Nte x D]
- * Optional fields:
 - .func_val - value of the decision function
 - .type - which type of machine this is (here, 'classifier')

19.70.12 machines\prt_rvr.m

Optimisation for Relevance Vector Regression

[w,alpha,beta,ll] = prt_rvr(Phi,t)

Phi - MxM matrix derived from kernel function of vector pairs

t - the values to be matched

w - weights

alpha - 1/variance for the prior part of the model

beta - 1/variance for the likelihood part of the model

ll - the negative log-likelihood.

```
[w,alpha,beta,nu,ll]=spm_rvr(K,t,opt)
K      - a cell-array of MxM dot-product matrices.
t      - the values to be matched
opt    - either 'Linear' or 'Gaussian RBF'
          'Linear'      is for linear regression models, where
                        the optimal kernel is generated by
                        [nu(1)*K1 + nu(1)*K2... ones(size(K1,1),1)]
          'Gaussian RBF' is for regression using Gaussian radial basis
                        functions. The kernel is generated from
                        P1 = nu(1)*K1 + nu(1)*K2 ... ;
                        P2 = repmat(diag(P1) ,1,size(P1,2)) +...
                        repmat(diag(P1)',size(P1,1),1) - 2*P1;
                        Phi = exp([-0.5*P2 ones(size(P1,1),1)]);
w      - weights
alpha  - 1/variance for the prior part of the model
beta   - 1/variance for the likelihood part of the model
nu     - parameters that convert the dot-product matrices into
        a kernel matrix (Phi).
ll     - the negative log-likelihood.
```

The first way of calling the routine simply optimises the weights. This involves estimating a restricted maximum likelihood (REML) solution, which maximises $P(\alpha, \beta | t, \Phi)$. Note that REML is also known as Type II Maximum Likelihood (ML-II). The ML-II solution tends towards infinite weights for some the regularisation terms (i.e. $1/\alpha(i)$ approaches 0). The appropriate columns are removed from the model when this happens.

The second way of calling the routine also estimates additional input scale parameters as described in Appendix C of Tipping (2001). This method is much slower, as a full optimisation for the scale parameters is done after each update of the alphas and beta.

see: <http://research.microsoft.com/mlp/RVM/relevance.htm>

Refs:

The Relevance Vector Machine.

In S. A. Solla, T. K. Leen, and K.-R. Mller (Eds.),
Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 12,
pp. 652-658. Cambridge, Mass: MIT Press.

Michael E. Tipping

Sparse Bayesian Learning and the Relevance Vector Machine
Journal of Machine Learning Research 1 (2001) 211-244

19.70.13 machines\prt_weights.m

Run function to compute weights

FORMAT weights = prt_weights(d,m)

Inputs:

```
d      - data structure
        (fields of .d can vary depending on weights function)
m      - machine structure
        .function - function to compute weights (string)
        .args     - function arguments
```

Output:

weights - weights vector [Nfeatures x 1]

19.70.14 machines\prt_weights_bin_linkernel.m

Run function to compute weights for linear kernel binary classifiers

FORMAT weights = prt_weights_bin_linkernel (d,args)

Inputs:

d - data structure
 .datamat - data matrix [Nfeatures x Nexamples]
 .coeffs - coefficients vector [Nexamples x 1]
 args - function arguments (can be empty)

Output:

weights - vector with weights [Nfeatures x 1]

19.70.15 machines\prt_weights_gpclap.m

Run function to compute weights for linear multiclass classifiers

FORMAT weights = prt_weights_gpclap (d,args)

Inputs:

d - data structure
 .datamat - data matrix [Nfeatures x Nexamples]
 .coeffs - coefficients vector [Nexamples x 1]
 args - function arguments (can be empty)

Output:

weights - vector with weights Nclass[Nfeatures x 1]

19.70.16 machines\prt_weights_sMKL_cla.m

Run function to compute weights for binary MKL

FORMAT weights = prt_weights_sMKL (d,args)

Inputs:

d - data structure
 .datamat - data matrix [Nfeatures x Nexamples]
 .coeffs - coefficients vector [Nexamples x 1]
 .betas - kernel weights
 .idfeat_img - cell with indece
 args - function arguments (can be left empty)

Output:

weights - vector with weights [Nfeatures x 1]

19.70.17 machines\prt_weights_sMKL_reg.m

Run function to compute weights for binary MKL

FORMAT weights = prt_weights_sMKL (d,args)

Inputs:

d - data structure
 .datamat - data matrix [Nfeatures x Nexamples]
 .coeffs - coefficients vector [Nexamples x 1]
 .betas - kernel weights
 .idfeat_img - cell with indece
 args - function arguments (can be left empty)

Output:

weights - vector with weights [Nfeatures x 1]

19.70.18 machines\prt_weights_svm_bin.m

Run function to compute weights for binary SVM

FORMAT weights = prt_weights_svm_bin (d,args)

Inputs:

d - data structure
 .datamat - data matrix [Nfeatures x Nexamples]
 .coeffs - coefficients vector [Nexamples x 1]
 args - function arguments (can be left empty)

Output:

weights - vector with weights [Nfeatures x 1]

19.71 utils

19.71.1 utils\prt_centre_kernel.m

This function centres the kernel matrix, respecting the independence of training and test partitions. See Shawe-Taylor and Cristianini for background on this approach.

Shawe-Taylor, J. and Cristianini, N. (2004). Kernel methods for Pattern analysis. Cambridge University Press.

19.71.2 utils\prt_checkAlphaNumUnder.m

check whether a given string is alphanumerical or underscore

FORMAT out = prt_checkAlphaNumUnder(s)

Inputs:

s - a string of arbitrary length to check

Output:

out - logical 1 if the all chars in the string are alphanumerical
 logical 0 otherwise

Based on isalpha_num in the identification toolbox

19.71.3 utils\prt_normalise_kernel.m

FORMAT K_normalised = prt_normalise_kernel(K)

This function normalises the kernel matrix such that each entry is divided by the product of the std deviations, i.e.

$K_{\text{new}}(x,y) = K(x,y) / \sqrt{\text{var}(x) \cdot \text{var}(y)}$

19.71.4 utils\prt_utils_update_mask.m

Part V

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